

Quantity One[®]

User Guide for Version 4.2.3

Windows and Macintosh

Quantity One User Guide

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Preface

1. About This Document

This user guide is designed to be used as a reference in your everyday use of Quantity One®. It provides detailed information about the tools and commands of Quantity One for the Windows and Macintosh platforms. Any platform differences in procedures and commands are noted in the text.

This guide assumes you have a working knowledge of your computer operating system and its conventions, including how to use a mouse and standard menus and commands, and how to open, save, and close files. For help with any of these techniques, see the documentation that came with your computer.

This guide uses certain text conventions to describe specific commands and functions.

Example	Indicates
File > Open	Choosing the Open command under the File menu.
Dragging	Positioning the cursor on an object and holding down the left mouse button while you move the mouse.
Ctrl+s	Holding down the Control key while typing the letter s.
Right-click/ Left-click/ Double-click	Clicking the right mouse button/ Clicking the left mouse button/ Clicking the left mouse button twice.

Some of the illustrations of menus and dialog boxes found in this manual are taken from the Windows version of the software, and some are taken from the Macintosh version. Both versions of a menu or dialog box will be shown only when there is a significant difference between the two.

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2. Bio-Rad Listens

The staff at Bio-Rad are receptive to your suggestions. Many of the new features and enhancements in this version of Quantity One are a direct result of conversations with our customers. Please let us know what you would like to see in the next version of Quantity One by faxing, calling, or e-mailing our Technical Services staff. You can also use Solobug (installed with Quantity One) to make software feature requests.

1. Introduction

1.1 Overview of Quantity One

Quantity One® is a powerful, flexible software package for imaging and analyzing 1-D electrophoresis gels, dot blots and other arrays, and colonies.

The software runs in a Windows or Macintosh environment and has a graphical interface with standard pull-down menus, toolbars, and keyboard commands.

Quantity One can image and analyze a wide variety of biological data, including radioactive, chemiluminescent, fluorescent, and color-stained samples acquired from densitometers, phosphor imagers, fluorescent imagers, and gel documentation systems.

An image of a sample is captured using the controls in the imaging device window and displayed on your computer monitor. Image processing and analysis operations are performed using commands from the menus and toolbars.

Images can be magnified, annotated, rotated, and resized. They can be printed using standard and video printers.

All data in the image can be quickly and accurately quantitated using the Volume tools.

The lane-based functions can be used to calculate molecular weights, isoelectric points, VNTRs, Rf values, and other values. The software can measure total and average quantities, determine relative and actual amounts of protein, and count colonies in a Petri dish.

The software can cope with distortions in the shape of lanes and bands. Lanes can be adjusted along their lengths to compensate for any curvature or smiling of gels.

Data captured by the imaging device are stored in a file under a user-defined name. Files can be shared among all the Discovery Series™ software, or

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images can be easily converted into TIFF format for compatibility with other Macintosh and Windows applications.

1.2 Digital Data and Signal Intensity

The Bio-Rad imaging devices supported by Quantity One are light and/or radiation detectors that convert signals from biological samples into digital data. Quantity One then displays the digital data on your computer screen, in the form of gray scale or color images.

A data object as displayed on the computer is composed of tiny individual screen pixels. Each pixel has an X and Y coordinate, and a value Z. The X and Y coordinates are the pixel's horizontal and vertical positions on the image, and the Z value is the signal intensity of the pixel.

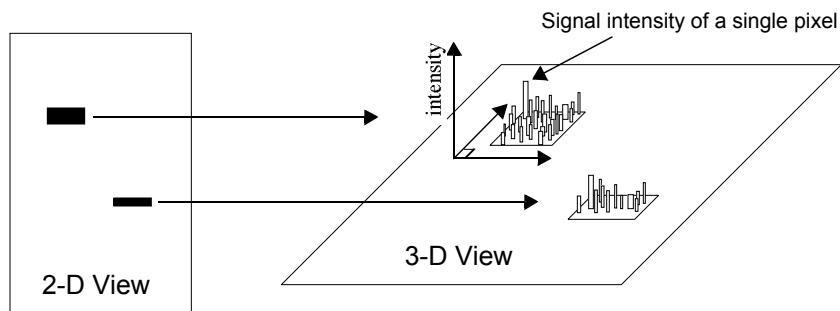


Fig. 1-1. Representation of the pixels in two digitally imaged bands in a gel.

For a data object to be visible and quantifiable, the intensity of its clustered pixels must be higher than the intensity of the pixels that make up the background of the image. The total intensity of a data object is the sum of the intensities of all the pixels that make up the object. The mean intensity of a data object is the total intensity divided by the number of pixels in the object.

The units of signal intensity are Optical Density (O.D.) in the case of the GS-700 and GS-710 densitometers, the Gel Doc and Chemi Doc with a white

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light source, or the Fluor-S and Fluor-S MAX MultiImagers with white light illumination. Signal intensity is expressed in counts when using the Personal FX or FX, or in the case of the Gel Doc, Chemi Doc, Fluor-S, or Fluor-S MAX when using the UV light source.

1.3 About Gel Quality

Quantity One is very tolerant of an assortment of electrophoretic artifacts. Lanes need not be perfectly straight or parallel. Bands need not be perfectly resolved.

However, for accurate lane-based quantitation, we suggest that bands be reasonably flat and horizontal. Lane-based quantitation involves calculating the average intensity of pixels across the band width and integrating over the band height. For the automatic band finder to function optimally, bands should be well-resolved.

Dots that appear as halos, rings, or craters, or that are of unequal diameter, may be incorrectly quantified using the automatic functions.

1.4 Quantity One Workflow

The following steps are involved in using Quantity One.

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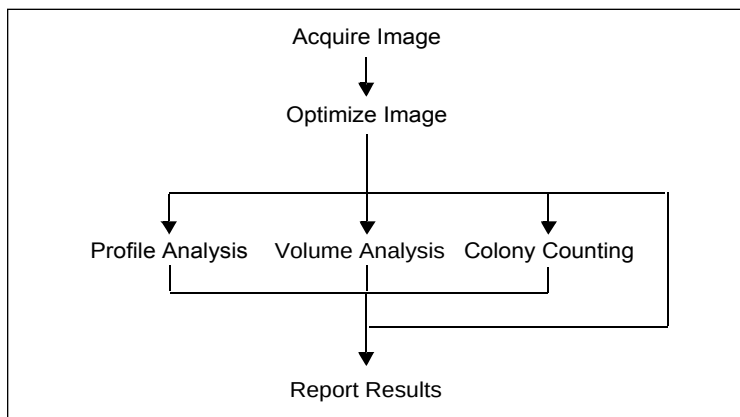


Fig. 1-2. Quantity One workflow.

Acquire Image

Before you can use Quantity One to analyze a biological image, you need to capture the image into your computer. This may be done with one of the several Bio-Rad instruments supported by this software: the Molecular Imager FX and Personal Molecular Imager FX; the GS-700 and GS-710 Imaging Densitometers; the Gel Doc 1000/2000 and Chemi Doc gel documentation systems; and the Fluor-S and Fluor-S MAX MultiImagers.

The resulting images are stored in files on your hard disk, network file server, or removable storage media.

Optimize Image

Once you have acquired an image of your sample, you may need to reduce any noise or background density caused by film fogging or the opacity of your carrier medium. A variety of functions exist to minimize background noise while maintaining data integrity.

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Analyze Image

Once a “clean” image is available, you can use Quantity One to gather and analyze your data. In the case of 1-D gels, the software has tools for identifying lanes and defining, quantifying, and matching bands. Volume tools allow you to easily measure and compare the quantities of bands, spots, or arrays. The colony counting controls allow you to count the number of colonies in a Petri dish, as well as perform batch analysis.

Qualitative and quantitative data can be displayed in tabular and graphical formats.

Report Results

When your imaging and analysis are complete, you can print your results in the form of simple images, images with overlays, reports, tables, and graphs. You can export your images and data to other applications for further analysis.

1.5 Computer Requirements

This software will run on a PC as a Windows 98, ME, NT 4.0, or 2000 application, or on a Macintosh PowerPC.

The amount of computer memory required for using the program is mainly determined by the file size of the images you will scan and analyze. Images scanned at high resolution can be quite large. For this reason, we recommend that you archive images on a network file server or removable storage media.

PC

The following are the **minimum** system requirements for installing and running on a PC:

Operating system: Windows 98, ME, NT 4.0, or 2000.

Processor: Pentium 166.

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RAM:	64 MB for Gel Doc, Chemi Doc, and Fluor-S imaging systems. 128 MB for FX, Personal FX, and densitometers.
Hard disk space:	3 GB. Recommended: Removable storage media (such as an Iomega Jaz drive) or a network file server.
Monitor:	17" monitor, 1024 x 768 resolution, True Color (24- or 32-bit).
SCSI:	Required for all Bio-Rad imaging devices except the Gel Doc and Chemi Doc. Adaptec SCSI card with EZ-SCSI software.
Printer:	Optional.

Macintosh

Note: The default amount of memory assigned to this program on the Macintosh is 64 MB. If the total RAM in your Macintosh is 64 MB or less (the minimum recommended amount is 128 MB), you should reduce the amount of memory assigned to the program to 10 MB less than your total RAM. With the application icon selected, go to File > Get Info in your Finder to reduce the memory requirements for the application. See your Macintosh computer documentation for details.

The following are the **minimum** system requirements for installing and running on a Macintosh:

Operating system:	System 8.0 or higher.
Processor/Model:	PowerPC Macintosh 9500.
RAM:	64 MB for Gel Doc, Chemi Doc, and Fluor-S imaging systems. 128 MB for FX, Personal FX, and densitometers.
Hard disk space:	3 GB. Recommended: Removable storage media (such as an Iomega Jaz drive) or network file server.
Monitor:	17" monitor, 1024 x 768 resolution, Millions of colors (24-bit).

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SCSI:	Required to run all Bio-Rad imaging devices except the Gel Doc and Chemi Doc. Macintosh has built-in SCSI.
Printer:	Optional.

1.6 Installation

Windows

Note: Windows NT and 2000 users: You must be a member of the Administrators group to install Discovery Series software. After installation, members of the Users group must have “write” access to the Discovery Series folder to use the software.

Insert the Discovery Series CD-ROM into your computer. The installer will start automatically. (If the CD does not auto-start, use Windows Explorer to open the root directory on the CD-ROM and double-click on the **Setup.exe** file.)

The installer program will guide you through the installation. The installer will create a default directory under Program Files on your computer called Bio-Rad\The Discovery Series (you can select your own directory if you wish). The application program will be placed in the Bin folder inside the Discovery Series folder. Additional directories for storing user profiles and sample images will also be created.

The installer will place an application icon on your desktop and create a Discovery Series folder under Programs on your Windows Start menu.

After installation, you must reboot your computer before using an imaging device.

Macintosh

Insert the Discovery Series CD-ROM into your Macintosh. The TDS-Mac folder will open on your desktop, displaying the installers for the Discovery Series applications. Double-click on the installer for your application.

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Fig. 1-3. Installation program icon (Macintosh).

The installer will guide you through a series of screens. The installer will create a folder on your hard drive that contains the main application and associated sample images (you can select a different folder if you wish). The installation will also create a folder called The Discovery Series in the Preferences folder in your System folder; this contains the Help file and various system files.

Once installation is complete, the folder containing the application icon will appear open on your desktop.

Before running the software, you must install the Hardware Security Key on your computer (unless you have installed a computer download version of the software).

1.7 Hardware Security Key (HSK)

Note: Network license holders do not receive a Hardware Security Key for their individual computer, and can skip this section.

Discovery Series software is password-protected using a Hardware Security Key (HSK), which is included in your software package. You must attach the Hardware Security Key to your computer before you can run the software.

Introduction

Windows



Fig. 1-4. PC Hardware Security Key

Before proceeding, please turn off your computer.

The HSK attaches to the parallel port on the back of your PC. If a printer cable is attached to this port, turn off the printer and disconnect it. After you have attached the HSK, you can attach the printer cable to the key itself and restart your computer and printer.

Note: Some parallel port devices such as zip drives may be incompatible with HSKs. Please check with your peripherals vendor.

The code for the PC hardware security key is EYYCY. This is printed on the key itself.

You will also need to install the system driver that allows the computer to recognize the HSK.

Note: Windows NT and 2000 users must be in the local administrator group to install the HSK driver.

To install the driver, open the Windows Start menu and select Programs > The Discovery Series. Select Install HASP Hardware Security Key driver to begin installation.

Note: Windows 98 and ME users must reboot their computer after installing the HSK. Windows NT and 2000 users do not have to reboot.

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Macintosh

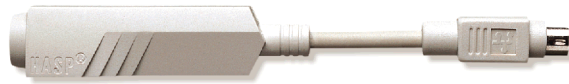


Fig. 1-5. Macintosh Hardware Security Key

Before proceeding, please turn off your Macintosh.

The Macintosh HSK must be inserted in the Apple Desktop Bus (ADB) path. The ADB port is located on the back of your Macintosh.



Fig. 1-6. Apple Desktop Bus icon on back of Macintosh.

The HSK can be inserted at any point in the ADB path—between the computer and the keyboard, between the keyboard and the mouse, between the keyboard and the monitor, etc. After you have attached the HSK, you can restart your computer.

The code for the Macintosh HSK is QCDIY. This code is printed on the key itself.

1.8 Starting the Program

The Hardware Security Key must be attached to the computer before you can start the software (unless you are using a network license).

Windows

The installation program creates an application icon on your desktop. To start the program, double-click on this icon.

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Fig. 1-7. Application icon.

You can also start the program from the Windows Start menu. Click on the Start button, select Programs, select The Discovery Series, and select the application name.

Macintosh

After installation, the main application folder will be open on your desktop. To start the program, double-click on the application icon shortcut inside the folder. You can move this shortcut icon to your desktop.

1.9 Software License

When the software opens for the first time, you will see a Software License screen that shows the current status of your software license.

With a new HSK or network license, you receive a 30-day temporary license ("Your license will expire on _____"). The temporary license is designed to give you time to purchase the software, if you have not already done so.

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Fig. 1-8. Temporary license screen.

During the 30-day period, the Software License screen will appear every time you open the software. To use the software during this period, click on the Run button.

Network license holders can click on the Check License button at any time during the 30-day period to activate their full network license. (If your network license is not activated when you click on Check License, notify your network administrator.)

HSK users have 30 days to purchase the software and obtain a purchase order number and software serial number from Bio-Rad. When you have this information, click on the Check License or Registration Form button in the Software License screen to register your software.

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The screenshot shows a window titled "Software License Registration Form". Inside, it says: "Please fill out the form below to authorize full use of your software." It provides instructions for users with and without Internet access. For Internet users, it says to click the "Submit via Internet" button. For non-Internet users, it says to print the form and send it to Bio-Rad, with a note that there will be a delay. It lists three options: 1. Fax the form to Bio-Rad at 1-510-741-5801. 2. Call 1-800-424-6723, option 1 (inside U.S.) or 1-510-741-6996 (Intl.) and ask for Software Registration. 3. E-mail the contents of this form to LSG.Software.Registration@Bio-Rad.com. Below the instructions are four tabs: "Software User", "Company or Institution", "Purchase Information", and "Software and System". The "Software User" tab is active, showing fields for "Dr./Mr./Ms.", "First Name*", "Last Name*", "Phone #*", "Fax #", and "E-mail". At the bottom are buttons for "Submit via Internet", "Print", "Exit", and "Close".

Fig. 1-9. Software License Registration Form.

Fill out the information in the Software License Registration Form. Be sure to enter your purchase order number and software serial number under the Purchase Information tab when registering.

Registering by Internet

If you have Internet access from your computer, click on the Submit via Internet button to send the Software Registration Form directly to Bio-Rad.

Your information will be submitted, and a temporary password will be generated automatically and sent back to your computer. Simply continue to run the application as before.

Bio-Rad will confirm your purchase information and generate a permanent license. After 2–3 days, click on Check License in the Software License screen again to update to a permanent password. (The Software License screen will not appear automatically after the temporary password has been generated;

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the software will simply open normally. Go to the Help menu and select Register to open the Software License screen.)

Registering by Fax or E-mail

If you do not have Internet access, click on the Print button in the Software License Registration Form and fax the form to Bio-Rad at the number listed on the form. Alternatively, you can enter the contents of the form into an e-mail and send it to Bio-Rad at the address listed in the Registration Form.

Bio-Rad will contact you by fax or e-mail in 2–3 days with a full license.

Entering a Password

If you fax or e-mail your registration information, you will receive a password from Bio-Rad. You must enter this password manually.

To enter your password, click on Enter Password in the Software License screen. If you are not currently in the Software License screen, select Register from the Help menu.

Enter Password

To register, please contact Bio-Rad during US/Pacific business hours:

Phone: (800) 424-6723 opt 2 opt 3 (in the U.S.)
(510) 741-6576

Fax: (510) 741-5082

e-mail: LSG_TechServ_US@Bio-Rad.com (in the U.S.)
LSG_TechServ_Intl@Bio-Rad.com (International)

Please provide the information in the completed registration form.

Current license
No license.

System ID
357316D0

Password
Quantity One

OK Not OK

Enter Cancel

Fig. 1-10. Enter Password screen.

In the Enter Password screen, type in your password in the field.

Once you have typed in the correct password, the OK light next to the password field will change to green and the Enter button will activate. Click on Enter to run the program.

1.10 Downloading from the Internet

You can download a trial version of the software from Bio-Rad's Web site. Go to the Discovery Series download page at www.bio-rad.com and select from the list of applications. Follow the instructions to download the installer onto your computer, then run the installer.

After installation, double-click on the application icon to run the program. The software will open and the Software License screen will be displayed.

Note: If you attempt to start the downloaded program and receive an "Unable to obtain authorization" message, you will need a Hardware Security Key to run the program. Contact Bio-Rad to obtain a key.

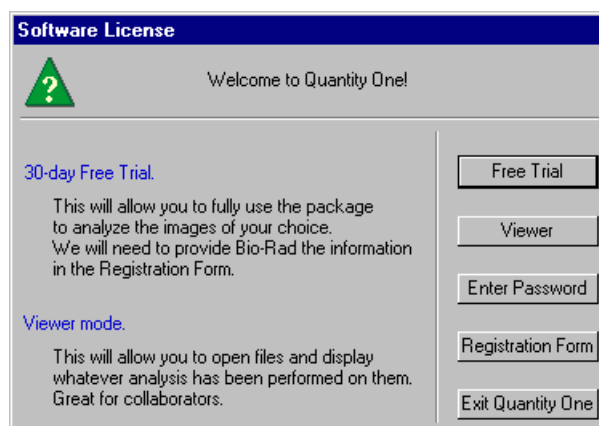


Fig. 1-11. Free Trial screen.

In the Software License screen, click on the Free Trial button. This will open the Software License Registration Form. Enter the required information (you will not have a purchase order number or software serial number, and can leave these fields blank) and click on Submit Via Internet.

A free trial password will be automatically downloaded to your computer. This password will allow you to use the software for 30 days.

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If you decide to purchase the software during that period, contact Bio-Rad to receive a software package and a Hardware Security Key. You can then complete the registration process as described in the previous sections.

1.11 Contacting Bio-Rad

Bio-Rad technical service hours are from 8:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m., Pacific Standard Time in the U.S.

Phone: 800-424-6723, option 2, option 3

510-741-2612

Fax: 510-741-5802

E-mail: LSG.TechServ.US@Bio-Rad.com (in the U.S.)

LSG.TechServ.Intl@Bio-Rad.com (International)

For software registration, phone:

800-424-6723, option 1 (in the U.S.)

510-741-6996 (outside the U.S.)

2. General Operation

2.1 Graphical Interface

2.1.a Menu Bar

Quantity One has a standard menu bar with pulldown menus that contain all the major features and functions available in the software.

- File—General file commands (Open, Save, Print), imaging device acquisition windows (Gel Doc, Chemi Doc, GS-700, GS-710, Fluor-S, Fluor-S MAX, Personal FX, FX).
- Edit—Text Overlay tools, Preferences, miscellaneous editing tools.
- View—General viewing tools (Zoom Box, Grab), quick analysis tools (Density in Box, Plot Density).
- Image—Transform function, image processing tools (Crop, Flip, Subtract Background), Invert Data.
- Lane—Lane-finding tools.
- Band—Band-finding and band-modeling tools.
- Match—Standards, band matching tools.
- Volume—Volume tools, array tools
- Analysis—Colony counting, Differential Display, VNTR analysis.
- Reports—Analysis reports (Lanes, Matches, Volumes, VNTR), Phylogenetic Tree, Similarity Matrix.
- Window—Tile windows commands, imitate zoom.
- Help—Quick Guides, on-line Help, software registration.

Below the menu bar is the main toolbar, containing some of the most commonly used commands. Next to the main toolbar are the status boxes, which provide information about cursor selection and toolbar buttons.

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2.1.b Main Toolbar

The main toolbar appears below the menu. It includes buttons for the main file commands (Open, Save, Print) and essential viewing tools (Zoom Box, Grab, etc.), as well as buttons that open the secondary toolbars and the most useful Quick Guides (Printing, Volumes, Molecular Weight, and Colony Counting).

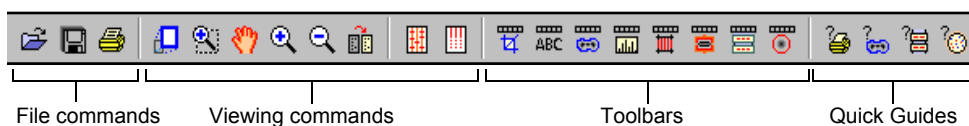


Fig. 2-1. Main toolbar.

Tool Help

If you hold the cursor over a toolbar icon, the name of the command will pop up below the icon. This utility is called Tool Help. Tool Help appears on a time delay basis that can be specified in the Preferences dialog box under Edit > Preferences. You can also specify how long the Tool Help will remain displayed.

2.1.c Status Boxes

There are two status boxes, which appear to the right of the main toolbar.

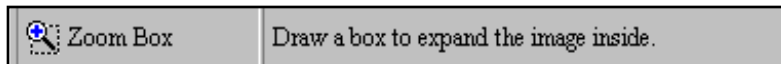


Fig. 2-2. Status boxes.

The first box displays any function that is assigned to the mouse (see section 2.2, Mouse-assignable Tools). If you select a command such as Zoom Box, the name and icon of that command will appear in this status box and remain there until another mouse function is selected or the mouse is deassigned.

General Operation

The second status box is designed to supplement Tool Help (see above). It provides additional information about the toolbar buttons. If you hold your cursor over a button, a short explanation about that command will be displayed in this second status box.

2.1.d Secondary Toolbars

Secondary toolbars contain groups of related functions. You can open these toolbars from the main toolbar or from the View > Toolbars pulldown menu. These toolbars “float” over the application.

The secondary toolbars can be toggled between vertical, horizontal, and expanded formats by clicking on the resize button on the toolbar itself.

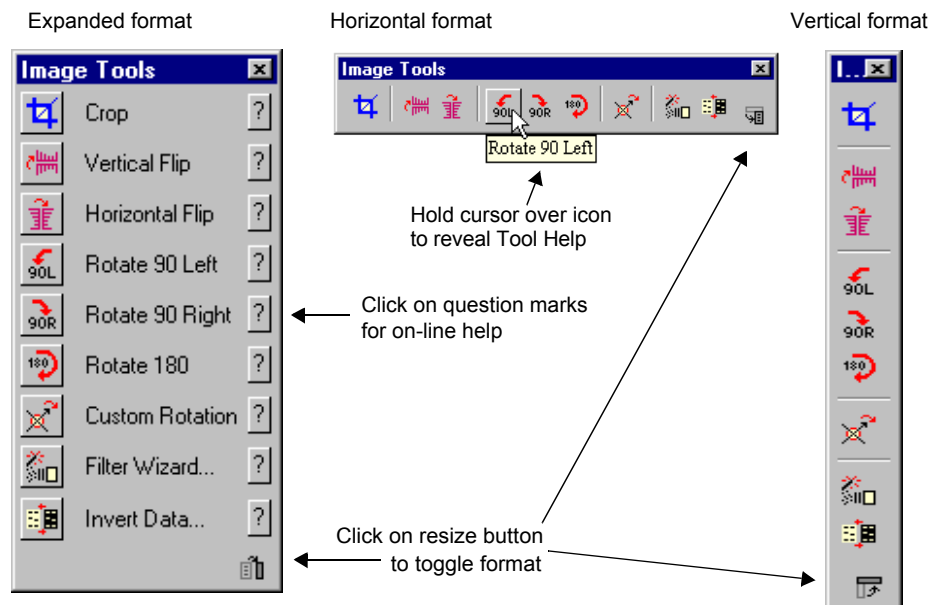


Fig. 2-3. Secondary toolbar formats and features.

The expanded toolbar format shows the name of each of the commands. Click on the “?” icon next to the name to display on-line Help for that command.

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2.1.e Quick Guides

The Quick Guides are designed to guide you through the major applications of the software. They are listed under the Help menu; four of these are also available on the main toolbar.

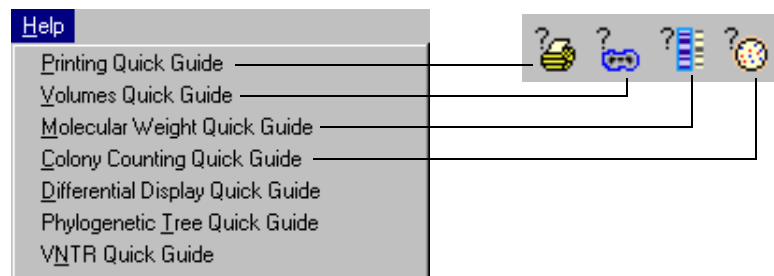


Fig. 2-4. Quick Guides listed on Help menu and main toolbar.

The Quick Guides are similar in design to the secondary toolbars, but are application-specific.

Each Quick Guide contains all of the functions necessary for a particular application, from opening the image to outputting data.

General Operation

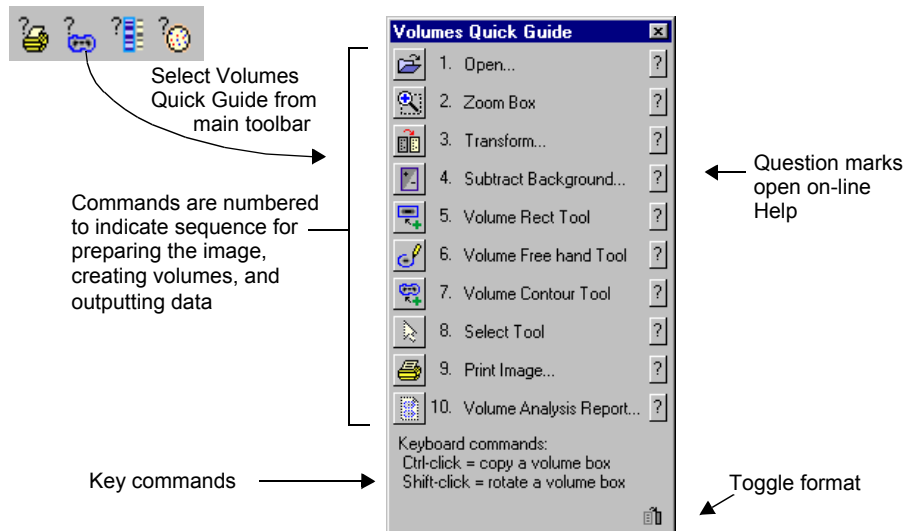


Fig. 2-5. Example of a Quick Guide: Volumes

Note: You will find that as you become more familiar with the application, you will skip operations that are not needed for your particular images.

In their expanded format, the Quick Guide commands are numbered as well as named, so that the order of operation is clear. Simply follow the steps and the Quick Guide will lead you through the analysis.

As with the secondary toolbars, you can click on the “?” next to the name of a function to display the Help text.

2.2 Mouse-assignable Tools

A number of commands don’t perform actions right away, but instead “assign” a function to your mouse (e.g., Zoom Box, Density at Cursor, Lane Background). You first select one of these tools from a menu or toolbar, then execute the command by clicking or dragging on the image.

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Note: Mouse-assignable tools selected using the keyboard have slightly different behavior. See the next section.

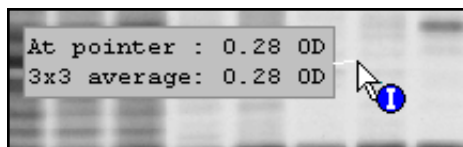


Fig. 2-6. Example of a mouse-assignable tool: Density at Cursor

When a “mouse-assignable” function is selected, the cursor appearance changes. The name and icon of the function appear in the status box next to the main toolbar (see section 2.1.c).

To *deassign* a function from the mouse, click on the toolbar button of the assigned function or click in the status box displaying the assigned function. You can also double-click on the Hide Overlays button.

2.3 Keyboard Commands

Many commands and functions may be executed using keyboard commands (e.g., pressing the F1 key will activate the View Entire Image command). A list of key combinations and their associated commands will be displayed if you select Keyboard Layout from the Help menu.

The pulldown menus also list the shortcut keys for the menu commands.

Note: Mouse-assignable commands (see above) behave differently if you assign them using the keyboard versus selecting them from the menus or toolbars. For example, to use the Zoom Box command as a keyboard command, position your cursor on the image where you want to begin to create the magnifying box, then press the F2 key. The command is assigned to your mouse and immediately activated, so that when you move your cursor over the image, the zoom box is created. When you click the mouse button once, the defined region is magnified and the tool is automatically deassigned from your mouse.

2.4 File Commands and Functions

This section describes the basic file commands and functions. These are selected from the File menu.

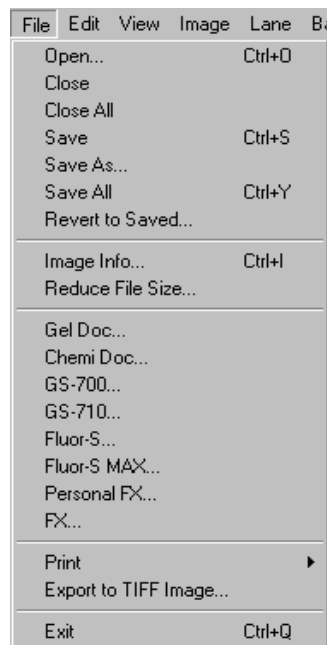


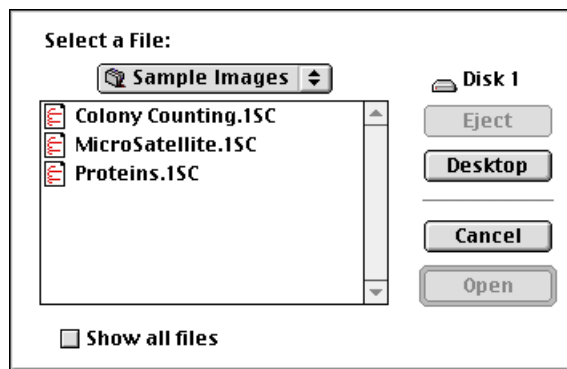
Fig. 2-7. File menu.

Open

To open a previously saved image, select Open from the File menu or main toolbar. This opens the Open dialog box.

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Macintosh version:



Windows version:

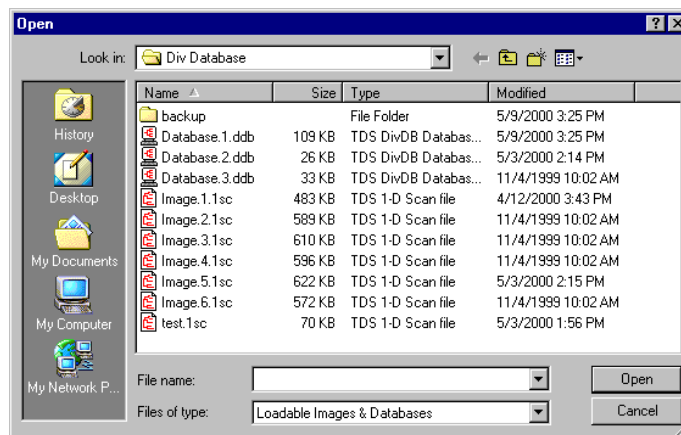


Fig. 2-8. Open dialog box.

In the dialog box, open a file by selecting the file name and clicking on the Open button. To look for files in other directories, use the directory pulldown menu at the top of the dialog box.

An image created in the Windows version of Quantity One can be opened in the Macintosh version, and visa versa. However, you must add a .1sc extension to your Macintosh files to open them in Windows.

Note: This version of Quantity One will open any image created with an earlier version of Quantity One.

General Operation

You can also open images captured by other Discovery Series software and Multi-Analyst™ software.

The application comes with a selection of sample images. In Windows, these may be found in the Discovery Series/Sample Images/1D directory. On the Macintosh, they are stored in the Sample Images folder in the Quantity One folder.

Opening TIFF Images

The Open command can also be used to import TIFF images from other software applications.

There are many types of TIFF formats that exist on the market. Not all are supported by the Discovery Series. There are two broad categories of TIFF files that are supported:

1. 8-bit Grayscale. Most scanners have an option between line art, full color, and grayscale formats. Select grayscale for use with the Discovery Series software. In a grayscale format, each pixel is assigned a value from 0 to 255, with each value corresponding to a particular shade of gray.
2. 16-bit Grayscale. Bio-Rad's Molecular Imager (storage phosphor) and Fluor-S imaging systems use 16-bit pixel values to describe intensity of scale. Molecular Dynamics™ and Fuji™ imagers also use 16-bit pixel values. The Discovery Series understands these formats and can interpret images from both Bio-Rad and Molecular Dynamics storage phosphor systems.

Note: The program can import 8- and 16-bit TIFF images from both Macintosh and PC platforms.

TIFF files that are *not* supported include:

1. 1-bit Line Art. This format is generally used for scanning text for optical character recognition or line drawings. Each pixel in an image is read as either black or white. Because the software needs to read continuous gradations to perform gel analysis, this on-off pixel format is not used.
2. 24-bit Full Color or 256 Indexed Color. These formats are frequently used for retouching photographs and are currently unsupported in the

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Discovery Series, although most scanners that are capable of producing 24-bit and indexed color images will be able to produce grayscale scans as well.

3. Compressed Files. The software does not read compressed TIFF images. Since most programs offer compression as a selectable option, files intended for compatibility with the Discovery Series should be formatted with the compression option turned off.

Close

To close an image or scan, select File > Close. If the file has changed since it was last saved, a message box will ask you if you want to save the changes before closing.

Close All

File > Close All closes all open images. If you have made changes to any of the images, a message box will open for each unsaved image giving you the option of saving those changes.

Save

File > Save will save a new image or an old image to which you have made changes.

In Windows, new images will be given a .1sc extension when they are first saved.

Save As

File > Save As can be used to save a new image, rename an old image, or save a copy of a image in a different directory.

In Windows, new images will be given a .1sc extension when they are first saved.

General Operation

Save All

Save All on the main toolbar or File menu saves all images that are currently open.

In Windows, new images will be given a .1sc extension when they are first saved.

Revert to Saved

File > Revert to Saved will reload the last saved version of the image you are working on. This is a quick way to undo any alterations you may have made to an image since you last saved it.

Any changes you have made since last saving the file will be lost. (Also, all open dialog boxes will be closed.) A message box will warn you before completing the command.

Image Info

File > Image Info displays general information about your image, including the scan date, scan area, number of pixels in the scan, data range, and the size of the scan file. There is also a field where you can type in a file description or comments.

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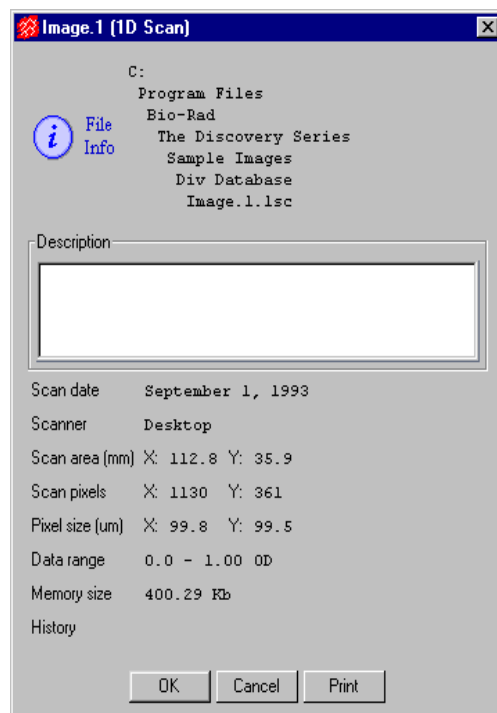


Fig. 2-9. Image Info box.

To print the file info, click on the Print button in the dialog box.

Change the Image Dimensions

You can change the dimensions of certain images using the Image Info dialog box.

Note: This feature is only available for images captured by a camera (such as the Gel Doc or Fluor-S) or imported TIF images in which the dimensions are not already specified.

When you select File > Image Info for these types of images, the Image Info dialog box will include fields for changing the image dimensions.

General Operation

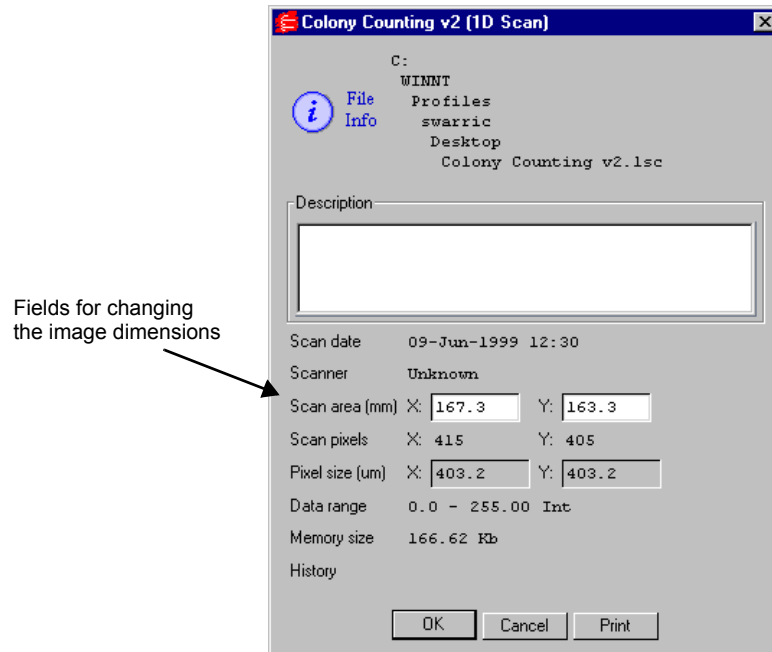


Fig. 2-10. Image Info dialog box with fields for changing the image dimensions.

Enter the new image dimensions (in millimeters) in the appropriate fields. Note that the pixel size in the image (in micrometers) will change to retain the same number of pixels in the image.

Reduce File Size

Image files can be quite large, and computer systems do not have unlimited memory or storage space. If you are having difficulty loading or storing a particular image, you may want to reduce the size of the file by reducing the number of pixels in the image. (You can also trim unneeded parts of an image to reduce its memory size. See section 13.8.a, Cropping Images.)

This function is comparable to scanning at a lower resolution, in that you are increasing the size of the pixels in the image, thereby reducing the total number of pixels and thus memory size.

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Note: Reducing the file size of an image will result in some loss of resolution. In most cases this will not affect quantitation. In general, as long as the pixel size remains less than 10 percent of the size of the objects in your image, changing the pixel size will not affect quantitation.

Select File > Reduce File Size to open the Reduce File Size dialog box.

The Reduce File Size dialog box shows you the size of the pixels in the image (Pixel Size: X by Y microns), the number of pixels in the image (Pixel Count: X by Y pixels), and the memory size of the image.

As you increase the size of the pixels, the pixel count will decrease, as will the memory size. You can increase the pixel size in either dimension (see the following figure for an example).

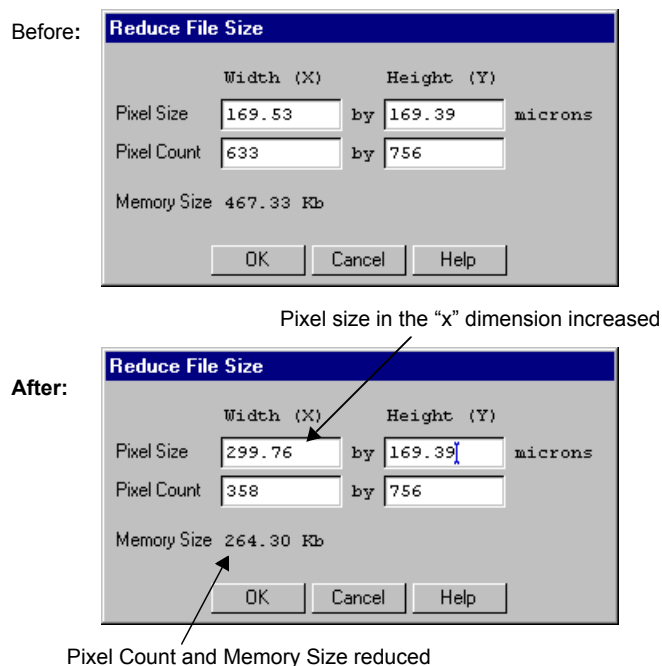


Fig. 2-11. Reduce File Size dialog box, before and after pixel size increase.

General Operation

Note: Since with most 1-D gels you are more concerned with resolving bands in the vertical direction than the horizontal direction, you may want to reduce the file size by making rectangular pixels. That is, keeping the pixel size in the “y” dimension the same, while increasing the size in the “x” dimension. This lets you decrease the total number of pixels and therefore file size without sacrificing detail.

When you are finished, click on the OK button.

A pop-up box will give you the option of reducing the file size of the displayed image or making a copy of the image and then reducing the copy's size.

Reducing the file size is an irreversible process. For that reason, we suggest you make a copy of the image and reduce its file size. That way, if you lose too much resolution, you can simply delete the copy and try again. Once you are happy with the reduced image, don't forget to delete the original. The goal is to save space!

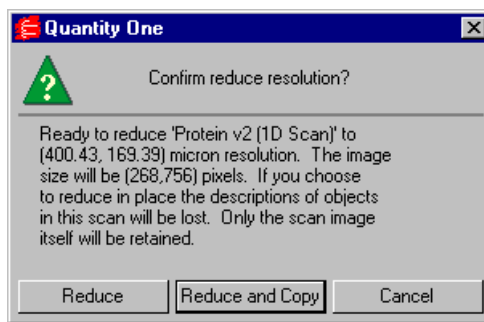


Fig. 2-12. Confirm Reduce File Size pop-up box.

If you choose to make a copy of the image, you will be asked to enter a name for the new copy before the operation is performed.

Imaging Device Acquisition Windows

The File menu contains a list of Bio-Rad imaging devices supported by the Discovery Series software. These are:

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1. Gel Doc 1000/2000
2. Chemi Doc
3. GS-700 Imaging Densitometer
4. GS-710 Imaging Densitometer
5. Fluor-S MultiImager
6. Fluor-S MAX MultiImager
7. Personal Molecular Imager FX
8. Molecular Imager FX

Selecting a name in the File menu will open the acquisition window that allows you to scan using that instrument.

See the individual chapters on the imaging devices for more details.

Exit

File > Exit quits the application. You will be prompted to save any open files that have been changed.

2.5 Preferences

The Preferences dialog box (accessed under the Edit menu) allows you to customize basic features of your system, such as displays and toolbars.

General Operation

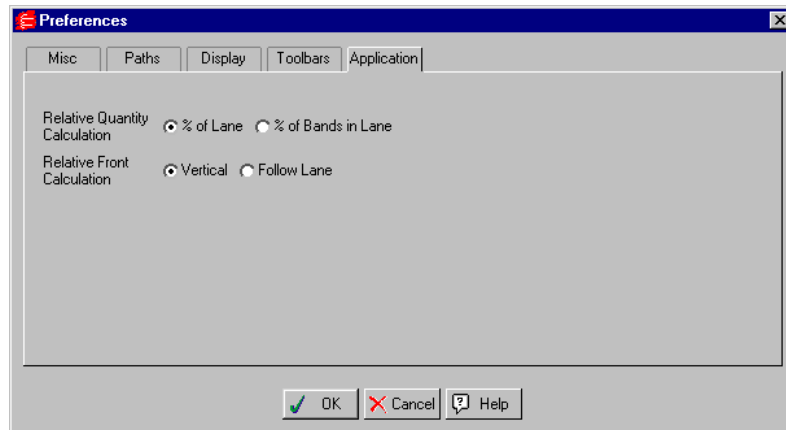


Fig. 2-13. Preferences dialog box.

Click on the appropriate tab to access groups of related preferences. After you have selected your preferences, click on OK to implement them.

2.5.a Misc.

Click on the Misc tab to access the following preferences.

Memory Allowance

The Memory Allowance field allows you to specify the amount of virtual memory allocated for the application at start up. The default value of 512 megabytes is recommended. If you receive a warning message when opening the program that the amount of virtual memory is set too high, you can enter a smaller value in this field. However, this should be considered a temporary fix.

Institute Name

Enter the name of your institution in this field.

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GLP/GMP Mode

The GLP/GMP Mode checkbox allows you to prevent changes to an image that would change the raw image data. In GLP/GMP mode, the software will not allow the following operations to be performed:

- Reduce File Size (File menu)
- Subtract Background (Image menu)
- Custom Rotation (Image menu)
- Noise filtering (Image menu)
- Invert Data (Image menu)

If a user attempts to use any of these functions in GLP/GMP mode, he will receive a message that the function is not available.

To set GLP/GMP mode, click on the checkbox. A dialog box will pop up asking you to enter a password.

After you enter a password and click on OK, another dialog will ask you to reenter the password for confirmation. Retype the password and click on OK again.

To disable GLP/GMP mode, click on the checkbox to deselect it. The dialog box will pop up asking you to enter the password. When you click on OK, GLP/GMP Mode will be disabled.

Start Maximized

In the Windows version, the Start Maximized checkbox determines whether the application occupies the entire computer screen when first opened. If this is unchecked, the menu and status bars will appear across the top of the screen and any toolbars will appear “floating” on the screen.

2.5.b Toolbar

Click on the Toolbar tab to access the following preferences, which determine the behavior and positioning of the secondary toolbars and Quick Guides.

General Operation

Show Volumes Quick Guide

If this checkbox is selected, the Volumes Quick Guide will open automatically when you open the program.

Align Quick Guide with Document

If this checkbox is selected, the Quick Guides will open flush with the edge of your documents. Otherwise, they will appear flush with the edge of the screen.

Quick Guide Placement and Toolbar Placement

These checkboxes determine which side of the screen the Quick Guides and toolbars will first open—left or right.

Placement Behavior

This setting determines whether a Quick Guide or toolbar will always pop up in the same place and format (Always Auto), or whether they will pop up in the last location they were moved to and the last format selected (Save Prior).

Toolbar Orientation

These option buttons specify whether toolbars will first appear in a vertical, horizontal, or expanded format when you open the program.

Guides Always on Top

If this checkbox is selected, Quick Guides will always float on top of images, and never be obscured by them.

Tool Help Delay and Persistence

Tool Help Delay allows you to specify the amount of time (in seconds) the cursor must remain over a toolbar icon before the Tool Help appears. First-time users may want to specify a short delay to learn the names of the toolbar

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functions, while experienced users can specify a longer delay once they are familiar with the icons.

Tool Help Persistence determines how long the Tool Help will linger on the screen after you move the cursor off a toolbar icon.

2.5.c Application

Click on the Application tab to access the following preferences.

Relative Quantity Calculation

The Relative Quantity Calculation option allows you to define how the quantities of defined bands in lanes will be determined for all reports, histograms, and band information functions: either as a percentage of the signal intensity of an entire lane or as a percentage of the signal intensity of the defined bands in a lane.

Selecting % of Lane means that the total intensity in the lane (including bands and the intensity between bands) will equal 100 percent and the band that you select will be reported as a fraction thereof.

Selecting % of Bands in Lane means that the sum of the intensity of the defined bands in a lane will equal 100 percent, and your band will be reported as a fraction of that sum.

If you create, adjust, or remove bands with Relative Quantity defined as % of Bands in Lane, the relative quantities of all the other bands in the lane will update to reflect changes in the total intensity of defined bands.

Relative Front Calculation

The Relative Front Calculation option lets you select the method for calculating the relative positions of bands in lanes. This affects the calculation of both Relative Front and Normalized Rf values.

Relative front is calculated by either:

General Operation

1. Dividing the distance a band has traveled down a lane by the length of the lane (Follow Lane). This is useful if your gel image is curved or slanted.
2. Dividing the vertical distance a band has traveled from the top of a lane by the vertical distance from the top of the lane to the bottom (Vertical Projection).

Note: “Lane” and “band” refer here to lanes and bands as you have defined them on your image. The top of a lane refers to the beginning of the lane line that you draw on the image, not necessarily the actual gel lane.

If a lane is straight and vertical, these methods will give identical results. However, the results will differ if a lane is curved or slanted. Choose your preferred method by clicking on one of the two buttons next to the Relative Front Calculation prompt.

2.5.d Display

Click on the Display tab to access the following preferences.

Zoom %

The Zoom % field allows you to specify the percentage by which an image zooms in or out when you use the Zoom In and Zoom Out functions. This percentage is based on the size of the image.

Pan %

Pan % determines the percentage by which the image moves side to side or up and down when you use the arrow keys. This percentage is based on the size of the image.

Jump Cursor on Alert (Windows only)

When an alert box pops up in the Windows version of the application, you can set your cursor to automatically go to the OK button in the box by selecting Jump Cursor on Alert.

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Band Style

Bands in your gel image can be marked with brackets that define the top and bottom boundaries of the band, or they can be marked with a dash at the center of the band. Indicate your preference by clicking on the Brackets or Lines button next to the Band Style prompt. (This setting can be temporarily changed in the Band Attributes dialog box. However, all newly opened images will use the preferences setting.)

2.5.e Paths

Click on the Paths tab to access the following preference.

Temporary File Location

Temporary image files are normally stored in the TMP directory of your Discovery Series folder. The full path is listed in the field. To change the location of your temporary files, click on Browse and select a new directory. To return to the default TMP directory, click on the Default checkbox.

2.6 User Settings

If Quantity One is on a workstation that has multiple users, each user can have his or her own set of preferences and settings.

In multiple-user situations, the preferences and settings are associated with individual user names. On a PC with Windows 95/98/NT, your user name is the name you use to log onto the computer. On a Macintosh, your user name is the Owner Name under the File Sharing control panel.

Note: If you do not log onto your PC under Windows 95/98 or do not have a Owner Name on your Macintosh, then you do not have a user name and your preferences and settings will be saved in a generic file.

3. Gel Doc



Fig. 3-1. Gel Doc.

Before you can begin acquiring images, the Gel Doc system must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the Gel Doc hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

To use the Gel Doc, you will need to have the Bio-Rad-supplied acquisition board installed in your PC or Macintosh. The drivers for this board will be installed when you install the main software application.

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Make sure that your Gel Doc camera is turned on. If the camera is not turned on, the Gel Doc acquisition window will open but the screen will be black, and you will be unable to Video Print.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the CTRL key and select the name of the device from the File menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

3.1 Gel Doc Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the Gel Doc, go to the File menu and select Gel Doc.... The acquisition window for the instrument will open, displaying a control panel and a video display window.

Gel Doc

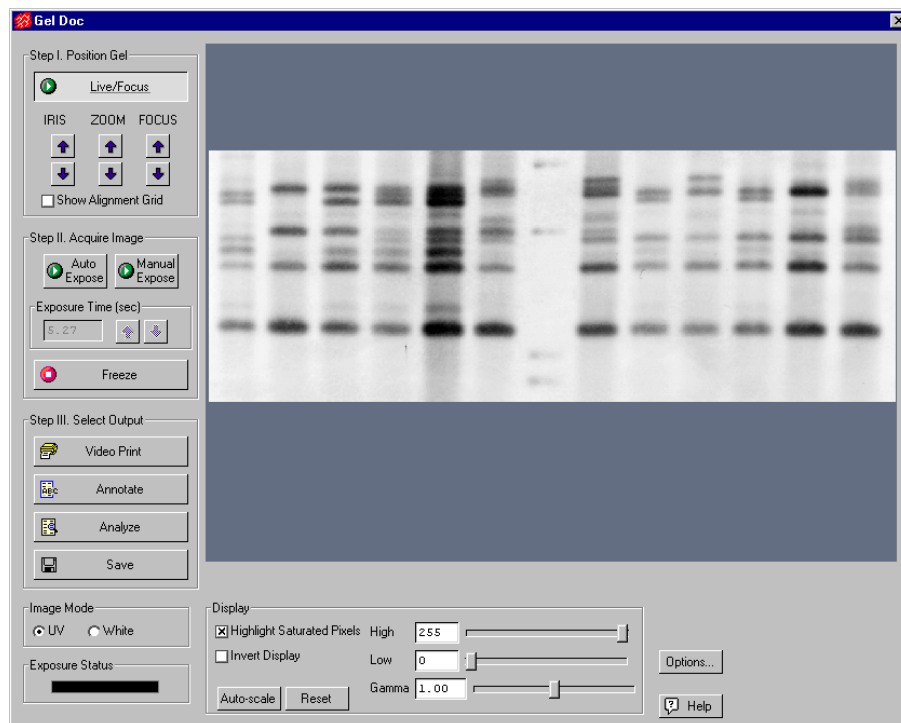


Fig. 3-2. Gel Doc acquisition window

The Gel Doc video display window will open in “live” mode, giving you a live video display of your sample. If no image is visible, make sure the camera is on, check the cable connections, make sure the f-stop on the camera is not closed, and make sure that the protective cap is off the camera lens. Also check to see that the transilluminator is on and working.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are three basic steps to acquiring an image using the Gel Doc:

1. Position and focus the gel or other object to be imaged.
2. Acquire the image.

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3. Select the output.

3.2 Step I. Position Gel

The Gel Doc window will open in “live” mode, giving you a live video display of your sample. In this mode, the Live/Focus button will appear selected, and frames will be captured and displayed at about 10 frames per second, depending on the speed of your computer.

You can use live mode to zoom, focus, and adjust the aperture on the camera, while positioning the sample within the area.

Note: Newer versions of the Gel Doc feature a motorized zoom lens that can be controlled directly from the acquisition window using the Iris, Zoom, and Focus arrow buttons. Click on the Up/Down buttons while viewing your sample in the window to adjust the lens. These buttons will not be visible if you are connected to older versions of the Gel Doc without the motorized zoom lens.

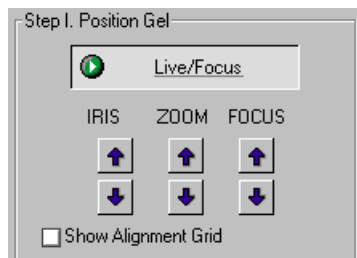


Fig. 3-3. Newer Gel Docs feature camera control buttons in the acquisition window.

You can also select the Show Alignment Grid checkbox to facilitate positioning.

The image should stay in focus while zooming. If focus is not maintained, refer to your Gel Doc hardware manual.

Note: After positioning your sample, you should check the Imaging Area dimensions under Options (see below) to make sure that they conform to

the size of the area you are focusing on. To determine the size of the area you are focusing on, you can place a ruler in the Gel Doc box so that it is visible by the camera.

3.3 Step II. Acquire Image

For many white light applications, you can skip this step and save and print images directly from Live/Focus mode.

For UV light, chemiluminescent applications, or faint samples, you can take an automatic exposure based on the number of saturated pixels in the image or you can enter a specific exposure time.

Note: “Exposure” refers to the integration of the image on the camera CCD over a period of time. The effect is analogous to exposing photographic film to light over a period of time.

Auto Expose

Auto Expose will take an exposure whose time length is determined by the number of saturated pixels in the image. This is useful if you are uncertain of the optimal exposure length.

Note: If you know the approximate exposure time you want (± 3 seconds), you can skip this step and go directly to Manual Expose.

Click on the Auto Expose button to cancel Live/Focus mode and begin an automatic exposure. The Auto Expose button will appear selected throughout the exposure.

During the auto exposure, the image is continuously integrated on the camera CCD until it reaches a certain percentage of saturated pixels. This percentage is set in the Options dialog box. (Default = 0.75 percent. See Options below.)

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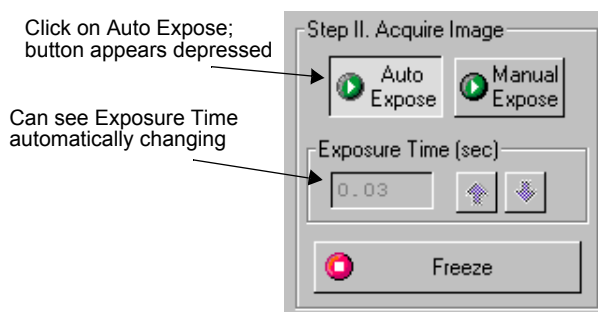


Fig. 3-4. Auto Expose.

Once an image has reached the specified percent of saturated pixels, it is captured and displayed in the video display window, Auto Expose is automatically deactivated, the exposure time appears active in the Exposure Time field, and Manual Expose is activated.

Note: If you are having difficulty auto-exposing your sample, you can use Manual Expose to adjust your exposure time directly. Most non-chemi applications only require an exposure time of a few seconds, which can be quickly adjusted using Manual Expose.

Manual Expose

If you know the approximate exposure time you want, you can click on the Manual Expose button. Manual Expose is automatically activated after Auto Expose has deactivated.

Gel Doc

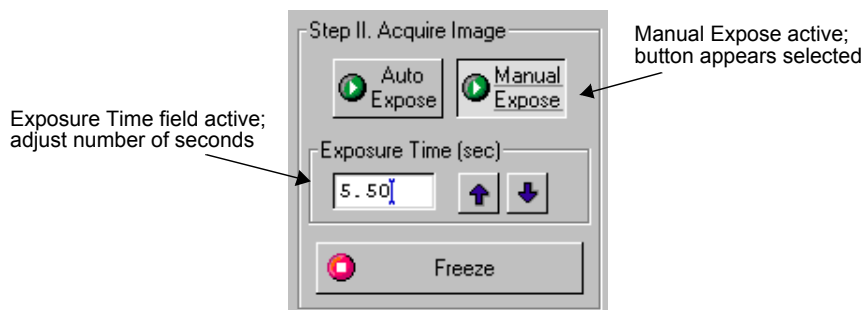


Fig. 3-5. Manual Expose.

With Manual Expose activated, you can adjust the exposure time directly by changing the number of seconds in the Exposure Time field. Type in a number or use the arrow buttons next to the field.

When the specified exposure time is reached, the last captured image will be displayed in the Gel Doc image window. The camera continues to integrate the image on the CCD, updating the display whenever the specified number of seconds is reached.

Once you are satisfied with the quality of the displayed image, click on the Freeze button to stop the exposure process. The last full exposure will be displayed in the image window.

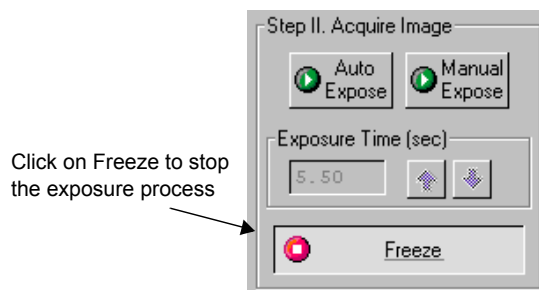


Fig. 3-6. Freezing the exposure.

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Note: Freeze is automatically activated if you adjust any of the subsequent controls (e.g., Video Print, Image Mode, Display controls, etc.).

3.4 Step III. Select Output

The Gel Doc window has several output options.

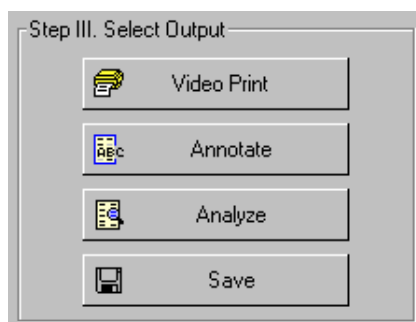


Fig. 3-7. Output options.

Video Print

Clicking on Video Print will automatically send the currently displayed frame (either live or integrated) to a video printer. You can add information about your image to the bottom of the printout by selecting the appropriate checkboxes in the Options dialog box. (See Options, below.)

Annotate

Clicking on Annotate will open a separate image window displaying the captured image. The default name for the image will include the date, time, and user (if known).

The Text Overlay toolbar will also pop up to allow you to annotate your image.

The image will not be saved until you select Save or Save As from the File menu.

Analyze

Clicking on Analyze will open a separate image window displaying the captured image. The default name for the image will include the date, time, and user (if known).

You can then analyze the image using the menu and toolbar functions.

The image will not be saved until you select Save or Save As from the File menu.

Save

Clicking on Save will open a separate image window displaying the captured image. A Save As dialog box will automatically open displaying the default file name for the image, which will include the date, time, and user (if known). You can then change the file name and storage directory.

You can also save your image as a TIFF image for export to other applications.

3.5 Image Mode

The Image Mode option buttons allow you to set the type and scale of your data.

UV

Select this mode for fluorescent and chemiluminescent samples. With this mode selected, the data will be measured in linear intensity units.

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White Light

Select this mode for reflective and transmissive samples. With this mode selected, the data will be measured in uncalibrated optical density (uOD) units.

3.6 Exposure Status

The Exposure Status bar shows the progress of your exposure. If your exposure time is greater than 1 second, the status bar display will give you a graphical representation of the remaining time before exposure is complete.

If the exposure time is less than 1 second, the status bar will not refresh itself for each exposure; it will remain at 100 percent.

3.7 Display

The Display controls are useful for quickly adjusting the appearance of your image for output to a video printer. Adjusting these controls will automatically freeze the video display and allow you to alter the image within the Gel Doc window.

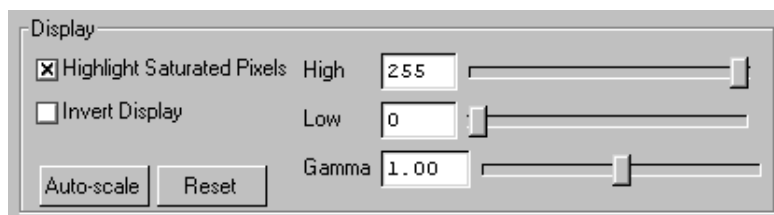


Fig. 3-8. Display controls.

These controls are similar to those in the Transform dialog box.

Note: The Display controls will only change the appearance of the image. They will not change the underlying data.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Image > Transform command.

Invert Display

This checkbox will switch light spots on a dark background to dark spots on a light background, and visa versa. This will only affect how the image is displayed on the screen, not the actual image data.

Auto-scale

Clicking on Auto-scale will adjust your displayed image automatically. The lightest part of the image will be set to the minimum intensity (e.g., white), and the darkest will be set to the maximum intensity (e.g., black). You can then “fine tune” the display using the High, Low, and Gamma sliders described below.

High/Low Sliders

If Auto-scale doesn't give you the appearance you want, you can use the High and Low sliders to redraw the image yourself. Dragging the High slider handle to the left will make weak signals appear darker. Dragging the Low slider handle to the right will reduce background noise.

You can also type specific High and Low values in the text boxes next to the sliders. Clicking anywhere on the slider bars will move the sliders incrementally.

Gamma Slider

Some images may be more effectively visualized if their data are mapped to the computer screen in a nonlinear fashion. Adjusting the Gamma slider handle changes the light and dark contrast nonlinearly.

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Reset

Reset will return the image to its original, unmodified appearance.

3.8 Options

Click on the Options button to open the Options dialog box. Here you can specify certain settings for your Gel Doc system.

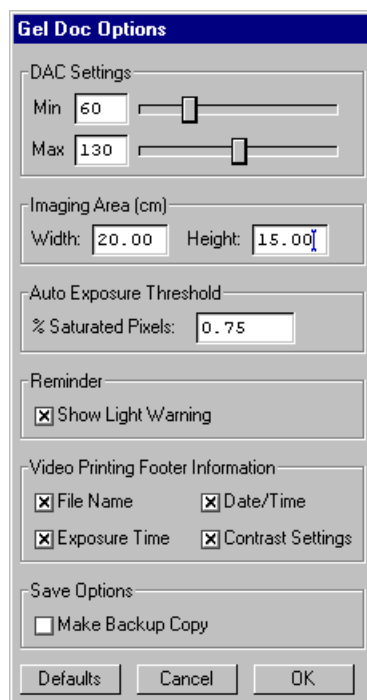


Fig. 3-9. Available options in the Gel Doc acquisition window.

Click on OK to implement any changes you make in this box. Clicking on Defaults restores the settings to the factory defaults.

DAC Settings

Note: The default DAC settings are highly recommended and should be changed with caution.

These sliders may be used to adjust the minimum and maximum voltage settings of your video capture board. The minimum slider defines the pixel value that will appear as white in the image, while the maximum slider defines the pixel value that will appear as black. The slider scale is 0–255, with the defaults set to 60 minimum and 130 maximum.

Imaging Area

These fields are used to specify the size of your imaging area in centimeters, which in turns determines the size of the pixels in your image (i.e., resolution). When you adjust one imaging area dimension, the other dimension will change to maintain the aspect ratio of the camera lens.

Note: Your imaging area settings must be correct if you want to do 1:1 printing. These are also important if you are comparing the size of objects (e.g., using the Volume Tools) between images.

Auto Exposure Threshold

When you click on Auto Expose, the exposure time is determined by the percentage of saturated pixels you want in your image. This field allows you to specify that percentage.

Typically, you will want less than 1 percent of the pixels in your image saturated. Consequently, the default value for this field is 0.75 percent.

Reminder

When this checkbox is selected, the software will warn you to turn off your transilluminator light when you exit the Gel Doc acquisition window or when your system is “idle” for more than 5 minutes.

Note: If you are performing experiments that are longer than 5 minutes (e.g., chemiluminescence), this should be deselected.

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Video Printing Footer Information

The checkboxes in this group allow you to specify the information that will appear at the bottom of your video printer printouts.

Save Options

To automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create, select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an “.sbk” extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word “backup” after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

4. Chemi Doc



Fig. 4-1. Chemi Doc.

Before you can begin acquiring images, the Chemi Doc system must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the Chemi Doc hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

To use the Chemi Doc, you will need to have the Bio-Rad-supplied acquisition board installed in your PC or Macintosh. The drivers for this board will be installed when you install the main software application.

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Make sure that your Chemi Doc camera is turned on. If the camera is not turned on, the Chemi Doc acquisition window will open but the screen will be black, and you will be unable to Video Print.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in "simulation mode." In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create "dummy" images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the CTRL key and select the name of the device from the File menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

4.1 Chemi Doc Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the Chemi Doc, go to the File menu and select Chemi Doc.... The acquisition window for the instrument will open, displaying a control panel and a video display window.

Chemi Doc

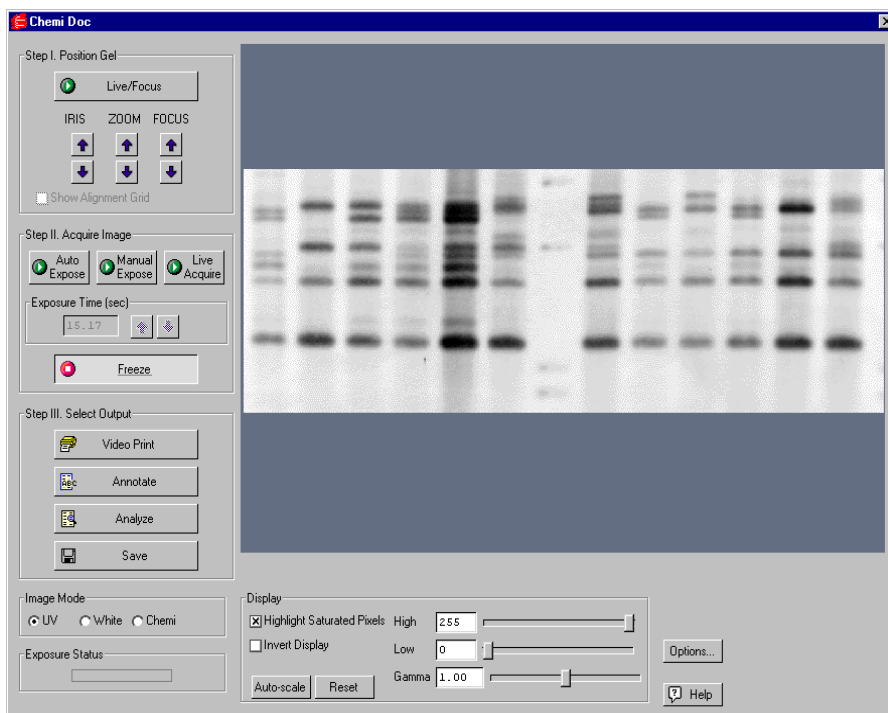


Fig. 4-2. Chemi Doc acquisition window

The Chemi Doc video display window will open in “live” mode, giving you a live video display of your sample. If no image is visible, make sure the camera is on, check the cable connections, make sure the f-stop on the camera is not closed, and make sure that the protective cap is off the camera lens. Also check to see that the transilluminator is on and working.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are three basic steps to acquiring an image using the Chemi Doc:

1. Position and focus the gel or other object to be imaged.
2. Acquire the image.

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3. Select the output.

4.2 Step I. Position Gel

The Chemi Doc window will open in “live” mode, giving you a live video display of your sample. In this mode, the Live/Focus button will appear selected, and frames will be captured and displayed at about 10 frames per second, depending on the speed of your computer.

You can use live mode to zoom, focus, and adjust the aperture on the camera, while positioning the sample within the area.

Note: Newer versions of the Chemi Doc feature a motorized zoom lens that can be controlled directly from the acquisition window using the Iris, Zoom, and Focus arrow buttons. Click on the Up/Down buttons while viewing your sample in the window to adjust the lens. These buttons will not be visible if you are connected to older versions of the Chemi Doc without the motorized zoom lens.

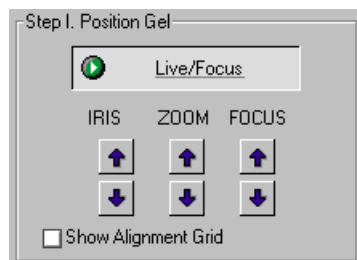


Fig. 4-3. Live/Focus button and camera control buttons.

You can also select the Show Alignment Grid checkbox to facilitate positioning.

Note: After positioning your sample, you should check the Imaging Area dimensions under Options (see below) to make sure that they conform to the size of the area you are focusing on. To determine the size of the area you are focusing on, you can place a ruler in the Chemi Doc box so that it is visible by the camera.

4.3 Step II. Acquire Image

For many white light applications, you can skip this step and save and print images directly from Live/Focus mode.

For UV light, chemiluminescent applications, or faint samples, the Chemi Doc control panel has several methods of creating image exposures. You can take an automatic exposure based on the number of saturated pixels in the image, you can enter a specific exposure time, or you can take a series of exposures and select the best one.

Note: “Exposure” refers to the integration of the image on the camera CCD over a period of time. The effect is analogous to exposing photographic film to light over a period of time.

Auto Expose

Use Auto Expose if you want to take a single exposure but are uncertain of the optimal exposure time.

Note: If you know the approximate exposure time you want (± 3 seconds), you can skip this step and go directly to Manual Expose.

Click on the Auto Expose button to cancel Live/Focus mode and begin an automatic exposure. The Auto Expose button will appear selected throughout the exposure.

During the auto exposure, the image is continuously integrated on the camera CCD until it reaches a certain percentage of saturated pixels. This percentage is set in the Options dialog box. (Default = 0.75 percent. See Options below.)

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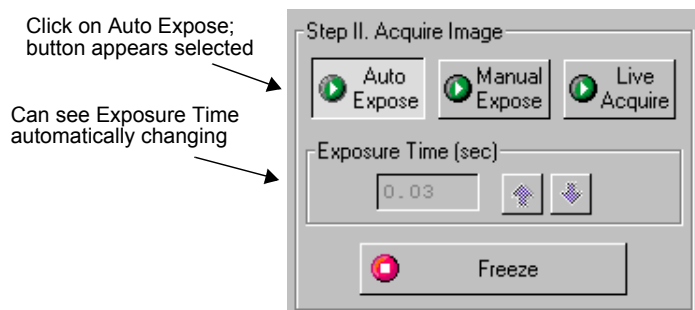


Fig. 4-4. Selecting Auto Expose.

Once an image has reached the specified percentage of saturated pixels, it is captured and displayed in the video display window, Auto Expose is automatically deactivated, and the exposure time appears active in the Exposure Time field.

At this point, if you are in UV or White image mode, Manual Expose will be automatically activated. If you are in Chemi mode, the Freeze button will be automatically activated.

Note: If you are having difficulty auto-exposing your sample, you can use Manual Expose to adjust your exposure time directly. Most non-chemi applications only require an exposure time of a few seconds, which can be quickly adjusted using Manual Expose.

Manual Expose

If you know the approximate exposure time you want, you can click on the Manual Expose button. In UV or White image mode, Manual Expose is automatically activated after Auto Expose is complete.

Chemi Doc

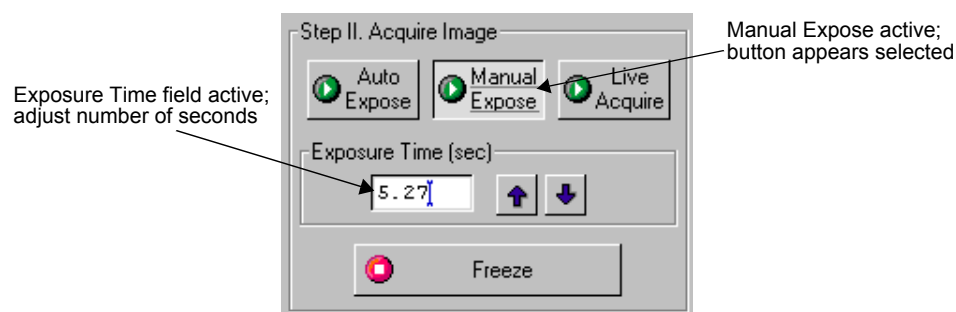


Fig. 4-5. Setting a manual exposure.

With Manual Expose activated, you can adjust the exposure time directly by changing the number of seconds in the Exposure Time field. Type in a number or use the arrow buttons next to the field.

In UV or White image mode, when the specified exposure time is reached, the last captured image will be displayed in the Chemi Doc image window. The camera will continue to integrate the image on the CCD, updating the display whenever the specified number of seconds is reached.

Once you are satisfied with the quality of the displayed image, click on the Freeze button to stop the exposure process. The last full exposure will be displayed in the image window.

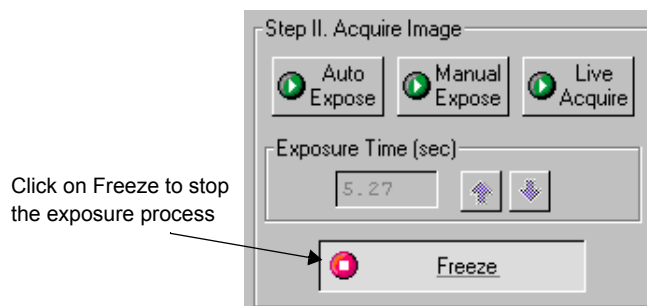


Fig. 4-6. Freezing the manual exposure.

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In Chemi mode, Manual Expose will expose an image over the specified exposure time and then stop automatically.

Note: Freeze is automatically activated if you adjust any of the subsequent controls (e.g., Video Print, Image Mode, Display controls, etc.).

Live Acquire

Live Acquire mode allows you to specify an interval over which a series of progressively longer exposures are taken. All exposures are then displayed on the screen, and you can choose the one that provides the best image.

Click on the Live Acquire button. A settings dialog box will open in which you can specify the total exposure time, starting exposure time, and number of exposures.

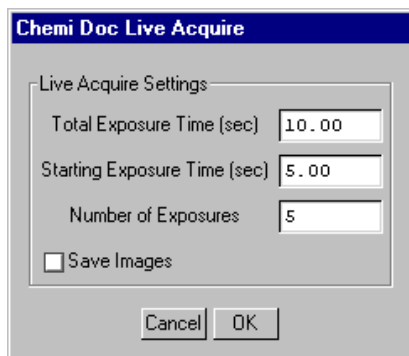


Fig. 4-7. Live Acquire settings.

Note: You should specify no more than 10 exposures in the Live Acquire Settings dialog, to avoid excessive build-up of image background in later exposures. The fewer the exposures, the less background will be added to the image. See the Release Notes for additional instructions on reducing background in images captured using Live Acquire.

Select the Save Images checkbox if you want to automatically save each exposure as it is taken.

Chemi Doc

Click on OK in the settings dialog to begin taking exposures. If you selected Save Images, a Save dialog box will open in which you can specify the base file name and location of the exposure files. When you click on Save, the exposures will be taken.

The specified number of exposures will be taken at equal intervals between the starting exposure time and total exposure time. When each exposure is complete, an image window containing that exposure will open behind the Chemi Doc window. When the full exposure time has lapsed, all the image windows will be tiled in front of the Chemi Doc window.

Note that the first exposure will have the base file name (the default base file name is the computer user name and a time stamp). Each subsequent exposure will have a version number (v2, v3, v4, etc.) appended to the base file name. The highest version number will be the final exposure. If you did not elect to auto-save the exposures as they were created, then each image will be unsaved.

To stop the Live Acquire, click on the Freeze button or adjust any of the subsequent controls (e.g., Video Print, Image Mode, Display controls, etc.).

Note: Exposures captured before freezing will be displayed in image windows.

Study the different images and select the best exposure(s) to keep. You can then proceed to the next step.

4.4 Step III. Select Output

The Chemi Doc window has several output options.

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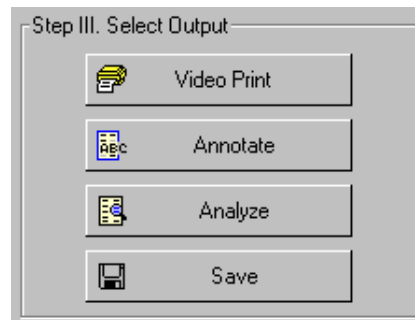


Fig. 4-8. Output options.

Video Print

Clicking on Video Print will automatically send the currently displayed frame (either live or integrated) to a video printer. You can add information about your image to the bottom of the printout by selecting the appropriate checkboxes in the Options dialog box. (See Options, below.)

Annotate

Clicking on Annotate will open a separate image window displaying the captured image. The default name for the image will include the date, time, and user (if known).

The Text Overlay toolbar will also pop up to allow you to annotate your image.

The image will not be saved until you select Save or Save As from the File menu.

Analyze

Clicking on Analyze will open a separate image window displaying the captured image. The default name for the image will include the date, time, and user (if known).

Chemi Doc

You can then analyze the image using the other features in the main application.

The image will not be saved until you select Save or Save As from the File menu.

Save

Clicking on Save will open a separate image window displaying the captured image. A Save As dialog box will automatically open displaying the default file name for the image, which will include the date, time, and user (if known). You can then change the file name and storage directory.

You can also save your image as a TIFF image for export to other applications.

4.5 Image Mode

The Image Mode option buttons change the type and scale of the data, as well as the behavior of the Chemi Doc when acquiring an image.

UV

Select this mode for fluorescent and chemiluminescent samples. With this mode selected, the data will be measured in linear intensity units.

White Light

Select this mode for reflective and transmissive samples. With this mode selected, the data will be measured in uncalibrated optical density (uOD) units.

Chemi

This mode is designed for chemiluminescent samples. With this mode selected, the data is measured in linear intensity units; however, the data is inverted, so that samples will appear dark on a light background.

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Note: This setting will invert the data in your image, so that a pixel with an intensity of 255 will be changed to 0, and visa versa.

Also, Chemi mode changes the behavior of the Auto and Manual Expose functions, as described above.

4.6 Exposure Status

The Exposure Status bar shows the progress of your exposure. If your exposure time is greater than 1 second, the status bar display will give you a graphical representation of the remaining time before exposure is complete.

If the exposure time is less than 1 second, the status bar will not refresh itself for each exposure; it will remain at 100 percent.

4.7 Display

The Display controls are useful for quickly adjusting the appearance of your image for output to a video printer. Adjusting these controls will automatically freeze the video display and allow you to alter the image within the Chemi Doc window.

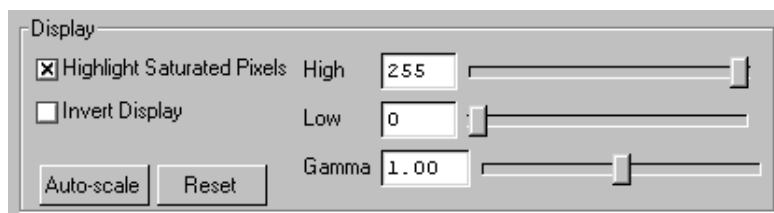


Fig. 4-9. Display controls.

These controls are similar to those in the Transform dialog box.

Note: The Display controls will only change the appearance of the image. They will not change the underlying data.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Image > Transform command.

Invert Display

This checkbox will switch light spots on a dark background to dark spots on a light background, and visa versa.

Note: This will only affect how the image appears on your screen; it will not change the image data.

Auto-scale

Clicking on Auto-scale will adjust your displayed image automatically. The lightest part of the image will be set to the minimum intensity (e.g., white), and the darkest will be set to the maximum intensity (e.g., black). You can then “fine tune” the display using the High, Low, and Gamma sliders described below.

High/Low Sliders

If Auto-scale doesn't give you the appearance you want, you can use the High and Low sliders to redraw the image yourself. Dragging the High slider handle to the left will make weak signals appear darker. Dragging the Low slider handle to the right will reduce background noise.

You can also type specific High and Low values in the text boxes next to the sliders. Clicking anywhere on the slider bars will move the sliders incrementally.

Gamma Slider

Some images may be more effectively visualized if their data are mapped to the computer screen in a nonlinear fashion. Adjusting the Gamma slider handle changes the light and dark contrast nonlinearly.

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Reset

Reset will return the image to its original, unmodified appearance.

4.8 Options

Click on the Options button to open the Options dialog box. Here you can specify certain settings for your Chemi Doc system.



Fig. 4-10. Available options in the Chemi Doc acquisition window.

Click on OK to implement any changes you make in this box. Clicking on Defaults restores the settings to the factory defaults.

DAC Settings

Note: The default DAC settings are highly recommended and should be changed with caution.

These sliders may be used to adjust the minimum and maximum voltage settings of your video capture board. The minimum slider defines the pixel value that will appear as white in the image, while the maximum slider defines the pixel value that will appear as black. The slider scale is 0–255, with the defaults set to 60 minimum and 130 maximum.

Imaging Area

These fields are used to specify the size of your imaging area in centimeters, which in turns determines the size of the pixels in your image (i.e., resolution). When you adjust one imaging area dimension, the other dimension will change to maintain the aspect ratio of the camera lens.

Note: Your imaging area settings must be correct if you want to do 1:1 printing. These are also important if you are comparing the size of objects (e.g., using the Volume Tools) between images.

Auto Exposure Threshold

When you click on Auto Expose, the exposure time is determined by the percentage of saturated pixels you want in your image. This field allows you to specify that percentage.

Typically, you will want less than 1 percent of the pixels in your image saturated. Consequently, the default value for this field is 0.75 percent.

Reminder

When this checkbox is selected, the software will warn you to turn off your transilluminator light when you exit the Chemi Doc acquisition window or when your system is “idle” for more than 5 minutes.

Note: If you are performing experiments that are longer than 5 minutes (e.g., chemiluminescence), this should be deselected.

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Video Printing Footer Information

The checkboxes in this group allow you to specify the information that will appear at the bottom of your video printer printouts.

Save Options

To automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create, select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an “.sbk” extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word “backup” after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

5. GS-700 Imaging Densitometer



Fig. 5-1. GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

Before you can begin scanning images with the GS-700 Imaging Densitometer®, your instrument must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The GS-700 is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the GS-700, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in "simulation mode." In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will

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appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the **Ctrl** key and select the name of the device from the *File* menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

Note: There is no simulated calibration for the densitometers.

5.1 GS-700 Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the GS-700, go to the *File* menu and select **GS-700**. The acquisition window for the densitometer will open, displaying a control panel and a scanning window.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

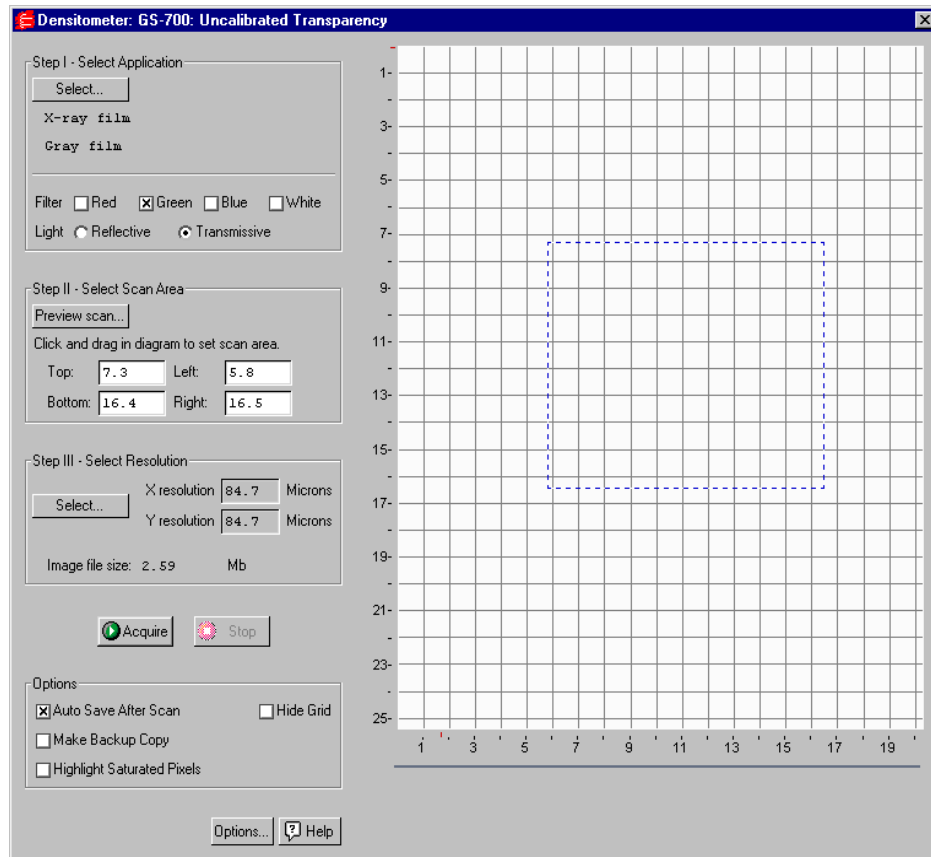


Fig. 5-2. GS-700 acquisition window

The scanning window is marked by grid lines that divide the area into square centimeters. These are numbered 1–35 top to bottom and 1–21 left to right if the light source is uncalibrated reflective, and 1–25 top to bottom and 1–20 left to right if the light source is uncalibrated transmissive (see below for details).

To hide the gridlines, click on the **Hide Grid** checkbox under *Options*.

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The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are four basic steps to scanning an image using the GS-700:

1. Select the application.
2. Select the scan area.
3. Select the resolution of the scan.
4. Acquire the image.

5.2 Step I. Select Application

To set the parameters for your particular scan, you can:

1. Select from a list of possible applications, or
2. Choose your own filter and light source settings.

Selecting from the List of Applications

When you select from the list of applications, the software automatically sets the appropriate filter(s) and other parameters for that particular application.

To select from the list of applications, click on the **Select** button under *Step I. Select Application*.

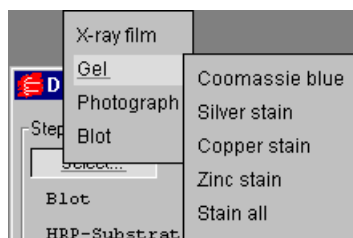


Fig. 5-3. Example of the application tree in the GS-700 dialog box.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

The applications are listed in a tree that expands from left to right. First you select the category of your application, then you select your particular application.

To exit the tree without selecting, press the **Esc** key.

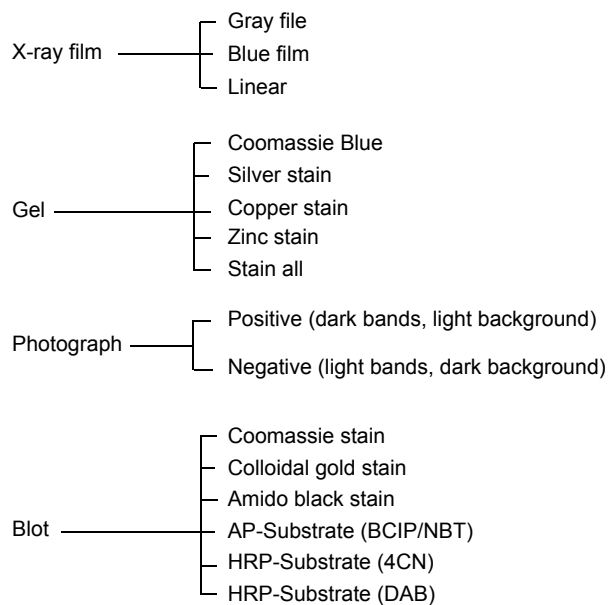


Fig. 5-4. Applications available in the GS-700 acquisition window.

Choosing Your Own Settings

If you know the filter and light source settings you want, or want to experiment with different settings, you can choose them yourself.

Filter ☐ Red ☒ Green ☐ Blue ☐ White
Light ☒ Reflective ☐ Transmissive

Fig. 5-5. GS-700 Custom Application controls.

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Next to *Filter*, click on either the **Red**, **Green**, **Blue**, or **White** checkbox, or a combination of two of the first three (**Red-Green**, **Green-Blue**, **Red-Blue**).

Filter Color	Wavelength	Application Examples
Red	595–750 nm	Coomassie G-250, BCIP/NBT, Fast Green FCF, Methylene Blue
Green	520–570 nm	Coomassie R-250, Basic Fuchsin
Blue	400–530 nm	Crocein Scarlet
Gray Scale	400–750 nm	Silver Stains, Copper Stains, Film

Fig. 5-6. Examples of filter colors and applications.

Next to *Light*, select the appropriate light source.

- Select **Reflective** for scanning opaque mediums such as dried gels on filter paper, arrays, TLC plates, and photographs. The scanning dimensions in this mode are 21 cm x 35 cm (uncalibrated).
- Select **Transmissive** for scanning transparent mediums such as films, gels, and slides. The scanning dimensions in this mode are 20 cm x 25 cm (uncalibrated).

5.3 Step II. Select Scan Area

Preview Scan

Before selecting the particular area to scan, you can preview the entire scanning area to determine the exact position of your sample.

Click on **Preview Scan**. A quick, low-resolution scan of the entire scanning area will appear in the scanning window. Your sample should be visible within a portion of this scan.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

Selecting an Area

Using the preview scan as a guide, select your scan area by dragging your mouse within the scanning window. The border of the scan area you are selecting will be marked by a frame.

Note: The scan area you select must be at least 1 cm wide.

When you release the mouse button, the border changes to a dashed blue line, indicating a selected area.

- To *reposition* the scanning area box you have created, position your cursor inside the box and drag. The entire box will move.
- To *resize* the box, position your cursor on a box side and drag. The side you have selected will move.
- To *redo* the box entirely, position your cursor outside the box and drag. The old box will disappear and a new box will be created.

You can also select the scanning area by entering coordinates in the appropriate fields (*Top, Bottom, Left, Right*). As you enter a coordinate, the position of the scanning area box will change accordingly.

When selecting, be sure to include the entire area of interest, and be generous with borders. You can always crop the image later.

5.4 Step III. Select Resolution

To select from a list of possible scanner resolutions, click on the **Select** button under *Step III. Select Resolution*. This will open the *Select Scan Resolution* dialog box.

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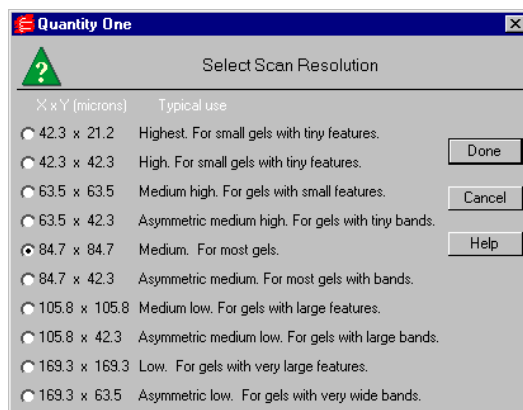


Fig. 5-7. Select Scan Resolution dialog box.

Available resolutions are listed from highest to lowest in terms of the dimensions of the resulting pixels (in microns). Smaller pixels equal higher resolution. Each resolution is listed with its typical use.

In general, the size of your pixels should be one-tenth the height of your smallest object.

Some of the resolutions are asymmetrical, meaning that the resolution is higher in the vertical dimension (i.e., the pixels in the resulting image are larger in the horizontal dimension than in the vertical dimension). This is useful for gels with bands, where you are more interested in resolving in the y dimension to determine the size of bands and the spacing between them.

Specifying Your Own Resolution

If you select **Oversample** in the *Options* dialog box, you can specify your own resolution within the range of 43–169 micrometers. With **Oversample** selected, enter values directly in the fields next to X resolution and Y resolution in the main acquisition window.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

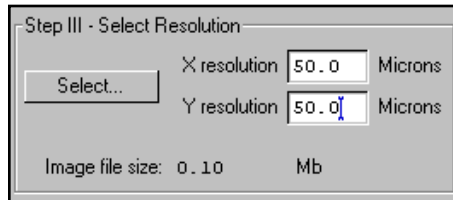


Fig. 5-8. Entering a custom resolution (with **Oversample** selected).

Image File Size

The size of the scan file for the selected resolution is listed next to *Image File Size*. If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to scan. If this happens, select a lower resolution or decrease the size of the area to be scanned. (Macintosh users can also increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

5.5 Acquire the Image

If you want to calibrate your scans, read the following section on calibration before scanning.

To begin to scan, click on the **Acquire** button. The scanned image will begin to appear in the scanning window, line by line.

To interrupt a scan, click on the **Stop** button. A message will ask you to confirm the interrupt, and then you will be asked if you want to keep the partial scan. This feature is useful if you overestimated the size of the area you selected.

After the scan is complete, a window will open displaying the scan image, at which point you can analyze and save it.

Note: The image will open with a default file name that includes the date, time, and (if applicable) user name. However, unless you have selected **Auto**

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Save After Scan, the file will not be saved until you perform a **Save** or **Save As** operation.

5.6 Calibration

If you have installed a calibration overlay, you can automatically calibrate the densities of scanned images to ensure accuracy and reproducibility of results.. (Calibration overlays for the GS-700 can be ordered from Bio-Rad.)

To set the automatic calibration settings, click on the **Options** button in the GS-700 acquisition window. This will open the *Densitometer Options* dialog box.

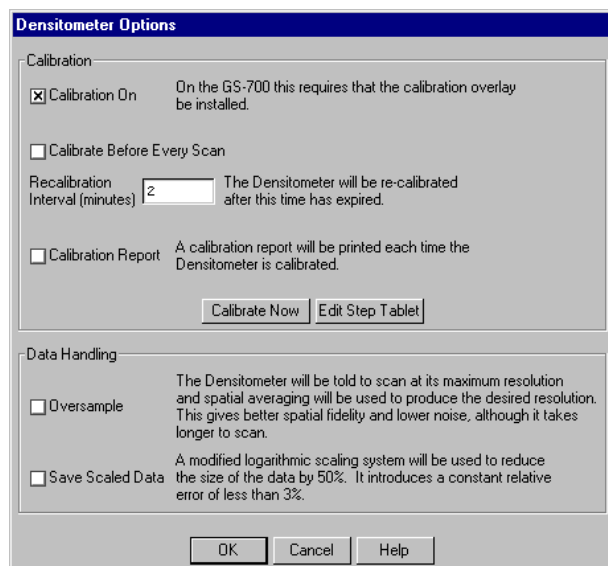


Fig. 5-9. More Options in the GS-700 acquisition window.

To enable automatic calibration, select the **Calibration On** checkbox. With the checkbox selected, the other calibration settings become active.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

Calibration Strip Window

When calibration is turned on, a calibration strip window will appear below the main scanning window and the length of the main scanning window will be reduced to 29 cm reflective and 23 cm transmissive.

Every time the densitometer calibrates, an image of the calibration strip will appear in the calibration strip window.

5.6.a Step Tablet Values

The transmissive and reflective step tablets in the overlay have specific density values. Before scanning for the first time using these step tablets, you must enter the values for the transmissive step tablet into the software. You can use the default values in the software for the reflective step tablet.

Transmissive Step Tablet

To enter the values for the transmissive step tablet, first make sure that the **Transmissive** checkbox is selected in the main acquisition window, then click on the **Options** button. In the *Densitometer Options* dialog, click on the **Edit Step Tablet** button. The *Step Tablet Values for GS-710 Transmissive* dialog box will open.

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Step	Diffuse	Specular	Step	Diffuse	Specular
1.	0.06	0.07	12.	1.72	2.43
2.	0.20	0.28	13.	1.88	2.66
3.	0.36	0.51	14.	2.03	2.87
4.	0.52	0.74	15.	2.18	3.08
5.	0.66	0.93	16.	2.34	3.31
6.	0.81	1.15	17.	2.49	3.52
7.	0.96	1.36	18.	2.64	3.73
8.	1.11	1.57	19.	2.80	3.96
9.	1.27	1.80	20.	2.94	4.16
10.	1.41	1.99	21.	3.08	4.36
11.	1.56	2.21			

Fig. 5-10. Step Tablet dialog box.

In the package with your step tablet overlay, you will find a printout of the diffuse density values for each segment of the transmissive step tablet. These exact density values must be entered into the software to associate a correct density value with each step on the step tablet.

Note: Scanning in transmissive mode with incorrect step tablet values can cause significant errors in the reported densities of your scans.

First, type the serial number for the tablet into the *Tablet Serial Number* field.

Your calibration strip will have a clear plastic cover. If the quantity offset value for the clear cover is included in your calibration strip package, you can enter this number in the *Quantity Offset* field. Otherwise, use a value of **0.045**.

Next, enter the step tablet values into the appropriate fields under the *Diffuse* column. After the step tablet is scanned, the software will associate each density value with its corresponding segment on the step tablet.

The density values do not need to be reentered each time you calibrate. You only need to enter new values if you use a new step tablet.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

When you are finished entering the transmissive step tablet values, click on **OK**.

Diffuse Versus Specular O.D.

In the step tablet form, you enter O.D. as diffuse density, and then the software automatically calculates the specular density.

Specular density is a measure of the light that passes directly through a medium. Diffuse density includes light that is scattered as it passes through the medium. Step tablet values are given in diffuse density, but are measured by the scanner in specular density, and therefore must be converted according to the specular/diffuse O.D. ratio. This conversion does not affect quantitation.

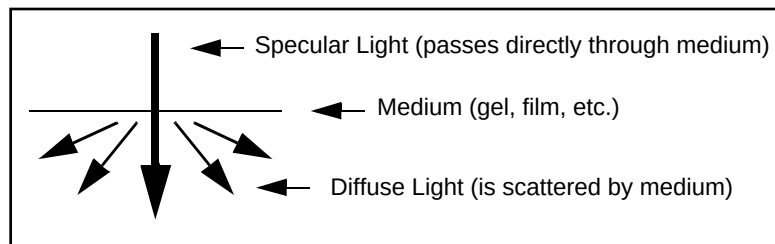


Fig. 5-11. Specular and diffuse density

Diffuse density values are converted to specular optical density units according to the following formula:

$$\text{Specular OD} = 1.4 \diamond \text{Diffuse OD}$$

5.6.b Other Calibration Settings

After you have entered the step tablet values, you can immediately calibrate by clicking on the **Calibrate Now** button (in the *Densitometer Options* dialog box).

You can also specify how often you want the GS-710 to automatically recalibrate. Either click on the **Calibrate Before Every Scan** checkbox or

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specify a period between automatic recalibrations (in minutes) in the *Recalibration Interval* field.

Note: With calibration turned on, the scanner will automatically recalibrate each time you change your filter or your reflective/transmissive setting. (If you select a different application with the same filter and light settings, it will not auto recalibrate.)

To print out a calibration report each time the densitometer calibrates, click on the **Calibration Report** checkbox.

5.7 Other Options

Oversample

This feature allows you to scan at the maximum resolution of the GS-700 (42.3 x 42.3 microns) and then use spatial averaging to create an image with lower resolution. This can result in better images at lower resolution—however, it takes longer to scan.

To turn on oversampling, click on the **Options** button in the acquisition window and click on the **Oversample** checkbox.

With oversampling on, you can specify your own resolution within the range of 43–169 microns by entering values directly in the fields next to X resolution and Y resolution in the main acquisition window.

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any scan you create, click on the **Auto Save After Scan** checkbox.

Note: In PDQUEST, this option is preselected and cannot be turned off. All images must be automatically saved when acquired.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on **Acquire**, a *Save As* dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the **Save** button.

GS-700 Imaging Densitometer

Make Backup Copy

If you have checked **Auto Save After Scan**, you can also automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create.

Click on the **Make Backup Copy** checkbox. With this checkbox selected, when a scan is created and saved, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an **“.sbk”** extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word **“backup”** after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the **Transform** command on the main toolbar.

Hide Grid

To hide the gridlines in the scanning area window, click on the **Hide Grid** checkbox.

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6. GS-710 Imaging Densitometer



Fig. 6-1. GS-710 Imaging Densitometer.

Before you can begin scanning images with the GS-710 Imaging Densitometer[®], your instrument must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The GS-710 is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the GS-710, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will

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appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the **Ctrl** key and select the name of the device from the *File* menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

Note: There is no simulated calibration for the densitometers.

6.1 GS-710 Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the GS-710, go to the *File* menu and select **GS-710**. The acquisition window for the densitometer will open, displaying a control panel and a scanning window.

GS-710 Imaging Densitometer

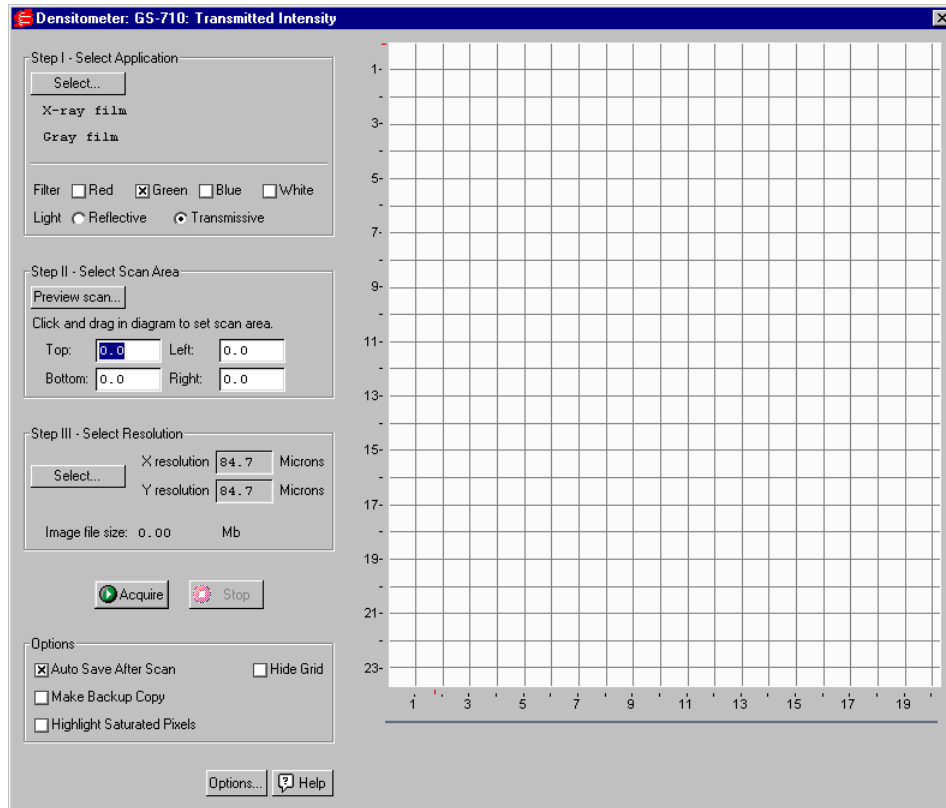


Fig. 6-2. GS-710 acquisition window

The scanning window is marked by grid lines that divide the area into square centimeters. These are numbered 1–29 top to bottom and 1–21 left to right if the light source is reflective, and 1–23 top to bottom and 1–20 left to right if the light source is transmissive (see below).

To hide the gridlines, click on the **Hide Grid** checkbox under *Options*.

Below the main scanning window is the step tablet window. Every time the densitometer calibrates, an image of the step tablet will appear in this window.

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The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are five basic steps to scanning an image using the GS-710:

1. Select the application.
2. Select the scan area.
3. Select the resolution of the scan.
4. Calibrate the instrument. (This is automatic, after you enter the step tablet values before you first scan after installation.)
5. Acquire the image.

6.2 Step I. Select Application

To set the parameters for your particular scan, you can:

1. Select from a list of possible applications, or
2. Choose your own filter and light source settings.

Selecting from the List of Applications

When you select from the list of applications, the software automatically sets the appropriate filter(s) and other parameters for that particular application.

To select from the list of applications, click on the **Select** button under *Step I. Select Application*.

GS-710 Imaging Densitometer

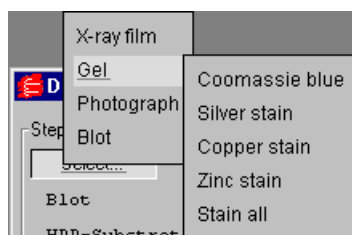


Fig. 6-3. Example of the application tree in the GS-710 dialog box.

The applications are listed in a tree that expands from left to right. First you select the category of your application, then you select your particular application.

To exit the tree without selecting, press the **Esc** key.

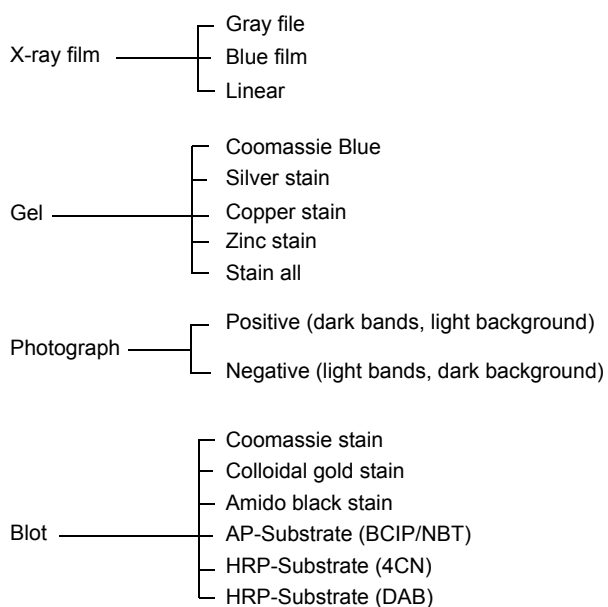


Fig. 6-4. Applications available in the GS-710 acquisition window.

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Choosing Your Own Settings

If you know the filter and light source settings you want, or want to experiment with different settings, you can choose them yourself.



Fig. 6-5. GS-710 Custom Application controls.

Next to *Filter*, click on either the **Red**, **Green**, **Blue**, or **White** checkbox, or a combination of two of the first three (**Red-Green**, **Green-Blue**, **Red-Blue**).

Filter Color	Wavelength	Application Examples
Red	595–750 nm	Coomassie G-250, BCIP/NBT, Fast Green FCF, Methylene Blue
Green	520–570 nm	Coomassie R-250, Basic Fuchsin
Blue	400–530 nm	Crocein Scarlet
Gray Scale	400–750 nm	Silver Stains, Copper Stains, Film

Fig. 6-6. Examples of filter colors and applications.

Next to *Light*, select the appropriate light source.

- Select **Reflective** for scanning opaque mediums such as dried gels on filter paper, arrays, or photographs. The scanning dimensions in this mode are 21 cm x 29 cm.
- Select **Transmissive** for scanning transparent mediums such as films, gels, or slides. The scanning dimensions in this mode are 20 cm x 23 cm.

6.3 Step II. Select Scan Area

Preview Scan

Before selecting the particular area to scan, you can preview the entire scanning area to determine the exact position of your sample.

Click on **Preview Scan**. A quick, low-resolution scan of the entire scanning area will appear in the scanning window. Your sample should be visible within a portion of this scan.

Selecting an Area

Using the preview scan as a guide, select your scan area by dragging your mouse within the scanning window. The border of the scan area you are selecting will be marked by a frame.

Note: The scan area you select must be at least 1 cm wide.

When you release the mouse button, the border changes to a dashed blue line, indicating a selected area.

- To *reposition* the scanning area box you have created, position your cursor inside the box and drag. The entire box will move.
- To *resize* the box, position your cursor on a box side and drag. The side you have selected will move.
- To *redo* the box entirely, position your cursor outside the box and drag. The old box will disappear and a new box will be created.

You can also select the scanning area by entering coordinates in the appropriate fields (*Top, Bottom, Left, Right*). As you enter a coordinate, the position of the scanning area box will change accordingly.

When selecting, be sure to include the entire area of interest, and be generous with borders. You can always crop the image later.

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6.4 Step III. Select Resolution

To select from a list of possible scanner resolutions, click on the **Select** button under *Step III. Select Resolution*. This will open the *Select Scan Resolution* dialog box.

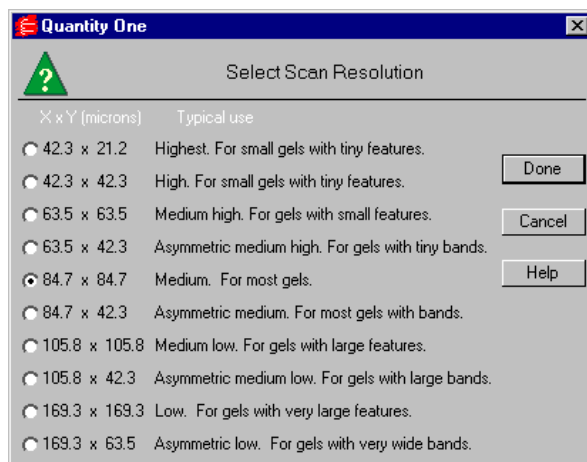


Fig. 6-7. Select Scan Resolution dialog box.

Available resolutions are listed from highest to lowest in terms of the dimensions of the resulting pixels (in microns). Smaller pixels equal higher resolution. Each resolution is listed with its typical use.

In general, the size of your pixels should be one-tenth the height of your smallest object.

Some of the resolutions are asymmetrical, meaning that the resolution is higher in the vertical dimension (i.e., the pixels in the resulting image are larger in the horizontal dimension than in the vertical dimension). This is useful for gels with bands, where you are more interested in resolving in the y dimension to determine the size of bands and the spacing between them.

GS-710 Imaging Densitometer

Specifying Your Own Resolution

If you select **Oversample** in the *Options* dialog box, you can specify your own resolution within the range of 43–169 micrometers. With **Oversample** selected, enter values directly in the fields next to X resolution and Y resolution in the main acquisition window.

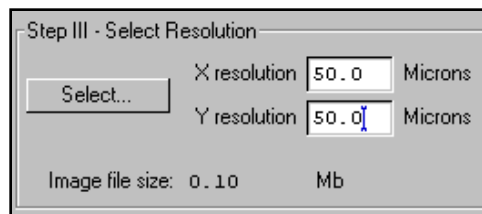


Fig. 6-8. Entering a custom resolution (with **Oversample** selected).

Image File Size

The size of the scan file for the selected resolution is listed next to *Image File Size*. If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to scan. If this happens, select a lower resolution or decrease the size of the area to be scanned. (Macintosh users can also increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

6.5 Calibration

The GS-710 automatically calibrates the densities of scanned images to ensure accuracy and reproducibility of results. The GS-710 has built-in step tablets for both transmissive and reflective scanning.

- The transmissive step tablet calibrates transmissive scans from 0 to 3.0 O.D.
- The reflective step tablet targets reflective scans to approximately 2.0 O.D.

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The first time you use the GS-710, you must select some settings to ensure accurate calibration. Click on the **Options** button in the main acquisition window. This will open the *Densitometer Options* dialog box.

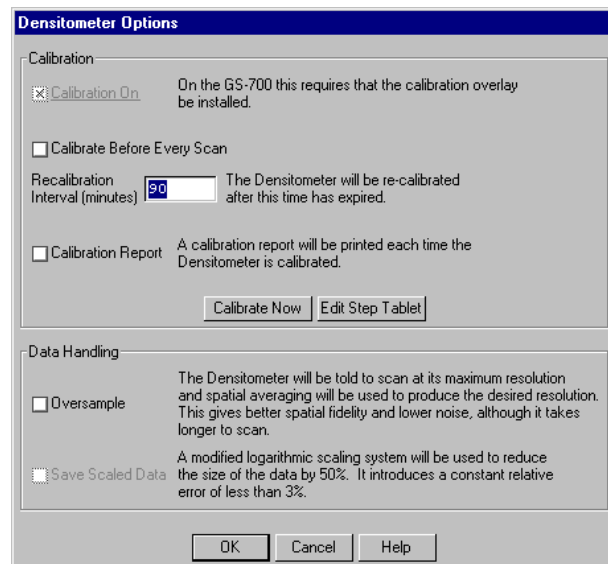


Fig. 6-9. Densitometer Options dialog box.

Note that calibration is always on for the GS-710.

6.5.a Step Tablet Values

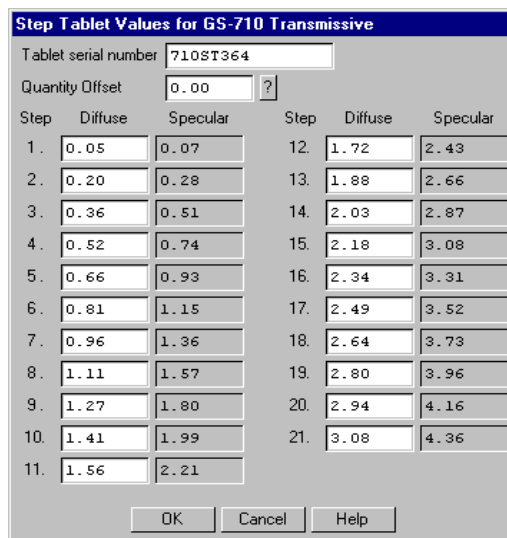
The built-in transmissive and reflective step tablets on your densitometer have specific density values. Before scanning for the first time, you must enter the values for your transmissive step tablet into the software. You can use the default values in the software for the reflective step tablet.

Transmissive Step Tablet

Before you scan in transmissive mode for the first time, you must specify the values for your transmissive step tablet.

GS-710 Imaging Densitometer

First, make sure that the **Transmissive** checkbox is selected in the main acquisition window, then click on the **Options** button. In the *Densitometer Options* dialog, click on the **Edit Step Tablet** button. The *Step Tablet Values for GS-710 Transmissive* dialog box will open.



The dialog box titled "Step Tablet Values for GS-710 Transmissive" contains the following fields and data:

- Tablet serial number: 7108T364
- Quantity Offset: 0.00
- A help icon (?)
- A table with 21 steps, each with Diffuse and Specular density values.
- Buttons: OK, Cancel, Help

Step	Diffuse	Specular	Step	Diffuse	Specular
1.	0.05	0.07	12.	1.72	2.43
2.	0.20	0.28	13.	1.88	2.66
3.	0.36	0.51	14.	2.03	2.87
4.	0.52	0.74	15.	2.18	3.08
5.	0.66	0.93	16.	2.34	3.31
6.	0.81	1.15	17.	2.49	3.52
7.	0.96	1.36	18.	2.64	3.73
8.	1.11	1.57	19.	2.80	3.96
9.	1.27	1.80	20.	2.94	4.16
10.	1.41	1.99	21.	3.08	4.36
11.	1.56	2.21			

Fig. 6-10. Step Tablet dialog box.

Attached to the outside of your GS-710, you will find a copy of the manufacturer's printout of the diffuse density values for each segment of the transmissive step tablet, as well as a serial number for the tablet. These exact density values must be entered into the software to associate a correct density value with each step on the step tablet.

Note: Scanning in transmissive mode with incorrect step tablet values can cause significant errors in the reported densities of your scans.

First, type the serial number for the tablet into the *Tablet Serial Number* field.

The *Quantity Offset* field does not apply in the GS-710 in transmissive mode. This value should remain at zero.

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Next, enter the step tablet values into the appropriate fields under the *Diffuse* column. After the step tablet is scanned, the software will associate each density value with its corresponding segment on the step tablet. The density values do not need to be reentered each time you calibrate.

When you are finished entering the transmissive step tablet values, click on **OK**.

Reflective Step Tablet

For the reflective step tablet, you can use the default target values in the software.

Note: The default values have been preset based on careful testing and review. However, you can edit these values based on your own measurements and testing.

To view or edit the default reflective values, make sure that the **Reflective** checkbox is selected in the main acquisition window, then click on the **Options** button. In the *Densitometer Options* dialog, click on the **Edit Step Tablet** button. The *Step Tablet Values for GS-710 Reflective* dialog box will open.

When you are finished viewing/editing the reflective step tablet values, click on **OK**.

Diffuse Versus Specular O.D.

In the step tablet form, you enter O.D. as diffuse density, and then the software automatically calculates the specular density.

Specular density is a measure of the light that passes directly through a medium. Diffuse density includes light that is scattered as it passes through the medium. Step tablet values are given in diffuse density, but are measured by the scanner in specular density, and therefore must be converted according to the specular/diffuse O.D. ratio. This conversion does not affect quantitation.

GS-710 Imaging Densitometer

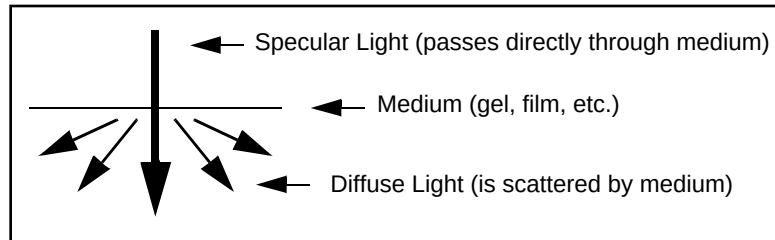


Fig. 6-11. Specular and diffuse density

Diffuse density values are converted to specular optical density units according to the following formula:

$$\text{Specular OD} = 1.4 \diamond \text{Diffuse OD}$$

6.5.b Other Calibration Settings

After you have entered the step tablet values, you can immediately calibrate by clicking on the **Calibrate Now** button (in the *Densitometer Options* dialog box).

You can also specify how often you want the GS-710 to automatically recalibrate. Either click on the **Calibrate Before Every Scan** checkbox or specify a period between automatic recalibrations (in minutes) in the *Recalibration Interval* field.

Note: The scanner will automatically recalibrate each time you change your filter or your reflective/transmissive setting. (If you select a different application with the same filter and light settings, it will not auto recalibrate.)

To print out a calibration report each time the densitometer calibrates, click on the **Calibration Report** checkbox.

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6.6 Acquire the Image

Note: Before scanning in transmissive mode, make sure the white balance region of the scanning area is not covered or obstructed in any way.

To begin to scan, click on the **Acquire** button. The scanned image will begin to appear in the scanning window, line by line.

To interrupt a scan, click on the **Stop** button. A message will ask you to confirm the interrupt, and then you will be asked if you want to keep the partial scan. This feature is useful if you overestimated the size of the area you selected.

After the scan is complete, a window will open displaying the scan image, at which point you can analyze and save it.

Note: The image will open with a default file name that includes the date, time, and (if applicable) user name. However, unless you have selected **Auto Save After Scan**, the file will not be saved until you perform a **Save** or **Save As** operation.

6.7 Other Options

Oversample

This feature allows you to scan at the maximum resolution of the GS-710 (42.3 x 42.3 microns) and then use spatial averaging to create an image with lower resolution. This can result in better images at lower resolution—however, it takes longer to scan.

To turn on oversampling, click on the **Options** button in the acquisition window and select the **Oversample** checkbox in the options dialog.

With oversampling on, you can specify your own resolution within the range of 43–169 microns by entering values directly in the fields next to X resolution and Y resolution in the main acquisition window.

GS-710 Imaging Densitometer

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any scan you create, click on the **Auto Save After Scan** checkbox.

Note: In PDQUEST, this option is preselected and cannot be turned off. All images must be automatically saved when acquired.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on **Acquire**, a **Save As** dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the **Save** button.

Make Backup Copy

If you have selected **Auto Save After Scan**, you can also automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create.

Click on the **Make Backup Copy** checkbox. With this checkbox selected, when a scan is created and saved, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an **“.sbk”** extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word **“backup”** after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the **Transform** command on the main toolbar.

Hide Grid

To hide the gridlines in the scanning area window, click on the **Hide Grid** checkbox.

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7. GS-800 Imaging Densitometer

Before you can begin scanning images with the GS-800 Imaging Densitometer[®], your instrument must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The GS-800 is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the GS-800, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the **Ctrl** key and select the name of the device from the *File* menu. The title of the GS-800 acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

Note: There is no simulated calibration for densitometers.

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7.1 GS-800 Acquisition Window

To begin acquiring images, go to the *File* menu and select **GS-800**. The acquisition window for the densitometer will open, displaying a control panel and a scanning window.

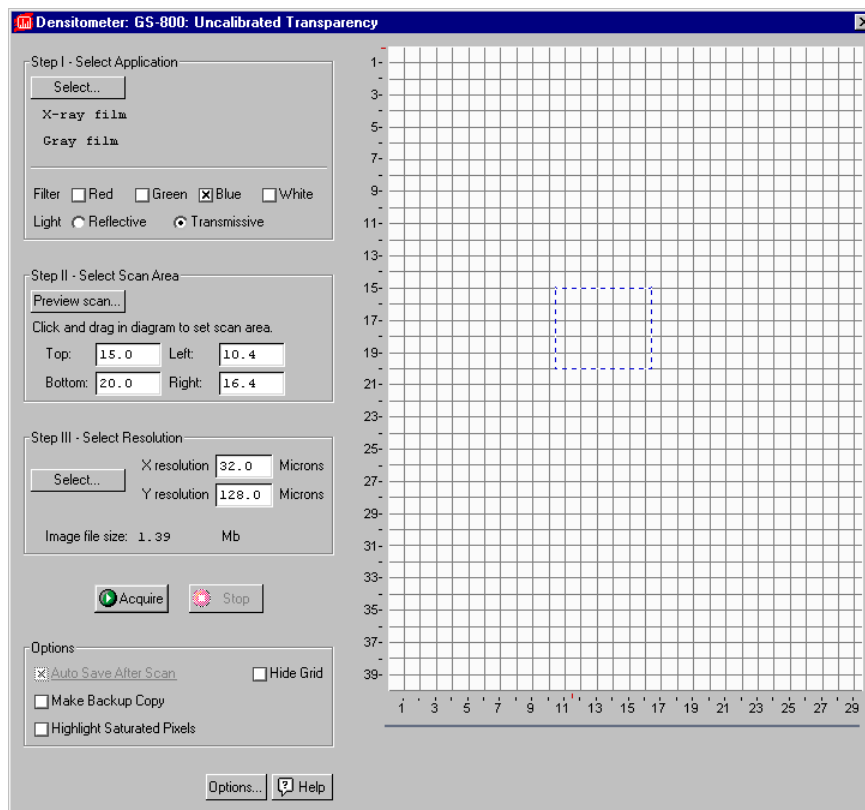


Fig. 7-1. GS-800 acquisition window

The scanning window is marked by grid lines that divide the area into square centimeters. These are numbered 1-40 top to bottom and 1-30 left to right if the light source is reflective, and 1-40 top to bottom and 1-29 left to right if the light source is transmissive.

GS-800 Imaging Densitometer

To hide the gridlines, select the **Hide Grid** checkbox under *Options*.

Below the main scanning window is the step tablet window. Every time the densitometer calibrates, an image of the step tablet will appear in this window.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are five basic steps to scanning an image using the GS-800:

1. Select the application.
2. Select the scan area.
3. Select the resolution of the scan.
4. Calibrate the instrument. (This is automatic, after you enter the step tablet values before you first scan after installation.)
5. Acquire the image.

7.2 Step I. Select Application

To set the parameters for your particular scan, you can:

1. Select from a list of possible applications, or
2. Choose your own filter and light source settings.

Selecting from the List of Applications

When you select from the list of applications, the software automatically sets the appropriate filter(s) and other parameters for that particular application.

To select from the list of applications, click on the **Select** button under *Step I. Select Application*.

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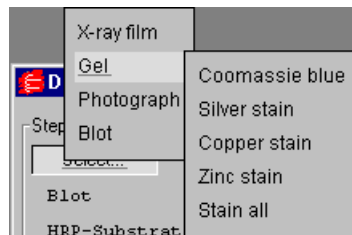


Fig. 7-2. Example of the application tree in the GS-800 dialog box.

The applications are listed in a tree that expands from left to right. First you select the category of your application, then you select your particular application.

To exit the tree without selecting, press the **Esc** key.

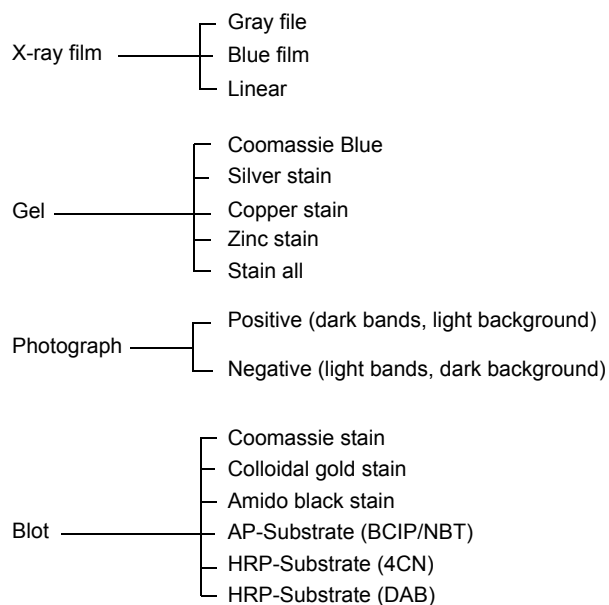


Fig. 7-3. Applications available in the GS-800 acquisition window.

GS-800 Imaging Densitometer

Choosing Your Own Settings

If you know the filter and light source settings you want, or want to experiment with different settings, you can choose them yourself.

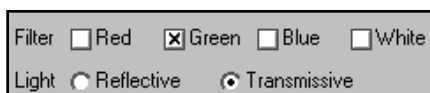


Fig. 7-4. GS-800 Custom Application controls.

Next to *Filter*, click on either the **Red**, **Green**, **Blue**, or **White** checkbox, or a combination of two of the first three (**Red-Green**, **Green-Blue**, **Red-Blue**).

Filter Color	Wavelength	Application Examples
Red	595–750 nm	Coomassie G-250, BCIP/NBT, Fast Green FCF, Methylene Blue
Green	520–570 nm	Coomassie R-250, Basic Fuchsin
Blue	400–530 nm	Crocein Scarlet
Gray Scale	400–750 nm	Silver Stains, Copper Stains, Film

Fig. 7-5. Examples of filter colors and applications.

Next to *Light*, select the appropriate light source.

- Select **Reflective** for scanning opaque mediums such as dried gels on filter paper, arrays, or photographs. The scanning dimensions in this mode are 30 cm x 40 cm.
- Select **Transmissive** for scanning transparent mediums such as films, gels, or slides. The scanning dimensions in this mode are 29 cm x 40 cm.

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7.3 Step II. Select Scan Area

Preview Scan

Before selecting the particular area to scan, you can preview the entire scanning area to determine the exact position of your sample.

Click on **Preview Scan**. A quick, low-resolution scan of the entire scanning area will appear in the scanning window. Your sample should be visible within a portion of this scan.

Selecting an Area

Using the preview scan as a guide, select your scan area by dragging your mouse within the scanning window. The border of the scan area you are selecting will be marked by a frame.

Note: The scan area you select must be at least 1 cm wide.

When you release the mouse button, the border changes to a dashed blue line, indicating a selected area.

- To *reposition* the scanning area box you have created, position your cursor inside the box and drag. The entire box will move.
- To *resize* the box, position your cursor on a box side and drag. The side you have selected will move.
- To *redo* the box entirely, position your cursor outside the box and drag. The old box will disappear and a new box will be created.

You can also select the scanning area by entering coordinates in the appropriate fields (*Top, Bottom, Left, Right*). As you enter a coordinate, the position of the scanning area box will change accordingly.

When selecting, be sure to include the entire area of interest, and be generous with borders. You can always crop the image later.

7.4 Step III. Select Resolution

To select from a list of possible scanner resolutions, click on the **Select** button under *Step III. Select Resolution*. This will open the *Select Scan Resolution* dialog box.

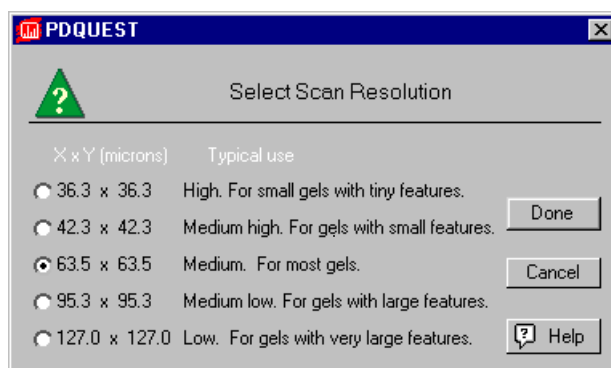


Fig. 7-6. Select Scan Resolution dialog box.

Available resolutions are listed from highest to lowest in terms of the dimensions of the resulting pixels (in micrometers). Smaller pixels equal higher resolution. Each resolution is listed with its typical use.

In general, the size of your pixels should be one-tenth the height of your smallest object.

Specifying Your Own Resolution

If you select **Oversample** in the *Options* dialog box, you can specify your own resolution within the range of 32–169 micrometers. With **Oversample** selected, enter values directly in the fields next to X resolution and Y resolution in the main acquisition window.

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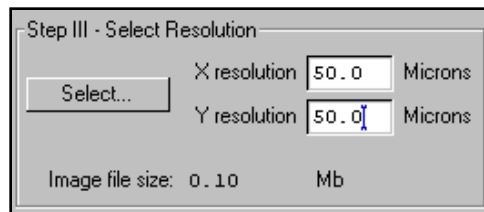


Fig. 7-7. Entering a custom resolution (with **Oversample** selected).

Image File Size

The size of the scan file for the selected resolution is listed next to *Image File Size*. If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to scan. If this happens, select a lower resolution or decrease the size of the area to be scanned. (Macintosh users can also increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

7.5 Calibration

The GS-800 automatically calibrates the densities of scanned images to ensure accuracy and reproducibility of results. The GS-800 has built-in step tablets for both transmissive and reflective scanning.

- The transmissive step tablet calibrates transmissive scans from 0 to 3.0 O.D.
- The reflective step tablet targets reflective scans to approximately 2.0 O.D.

The first time you use the GS-800, you must select some settings to ensure accurate calibration. Click on the **Options** button in the main acquisition window. This will open the *Densitometer Options* dialog box.

GS-800 Imaging Densitometer

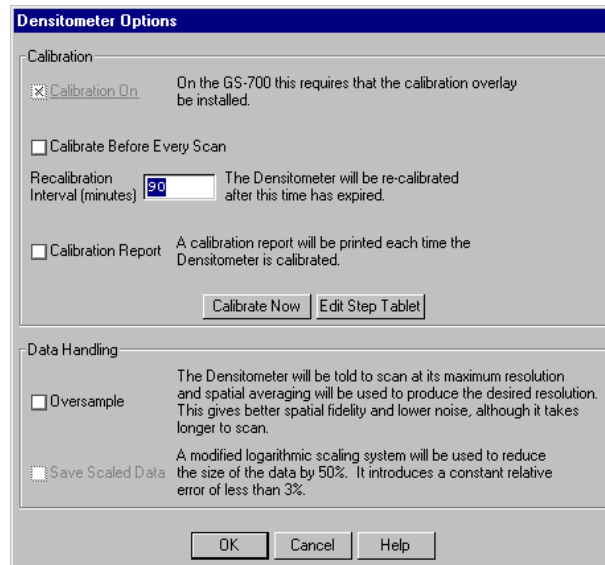


Fig. 7-8. Densitometer Options dialog box.

Note that calibration is always on for the GS-800.

7.5.a Step Tablet Values

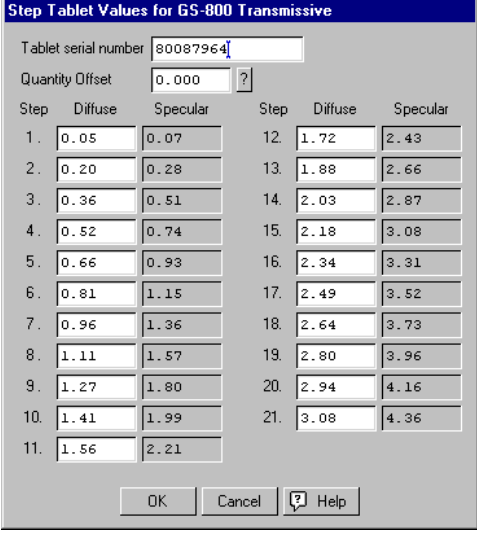
The built-in transmissive and reflective step tablets on your densitometer have specific density values. Before scanning for the first time, you must enter the values for your transmissive step tablet into the software. You can use the default values in the software for the reflective step tablet.

Transmissive Step Tablet

Before you scan in transmissive mode for the first time, you must specify the values for your transmissive step tablet.

First, make sure that the **Transmissive** checkbox is selected in the main acquisition window, then click on the **Options** button. In the *Densitometer Options* dialog, click on the **Edit Step Tablet** button. The *Step Tablet Values for GS-800 Transmissive* dialog box will open.

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The dialog box is titled "Step Tablet Values for GS-800 Transmissive". It contains a "Tablet serial number" field with the value "80087964" and a "Quantity Offset" field with the value "0.000". Below these fields is a table with two columns of data, each with three sub-columns: "Step", "Diffuse", and "Specular". The table contains 21 rows of data. At the bottom of the dialog box are three buttons: "OK", "Cancel", and "Help".

Step	Diffuse	Specular	Step	Diffuse	Specular
1.	0.05	0.07	12.	1.72	2.43
2.	0.20	0.28	13.	1.88	2.66
3.	0.36	0.51	14.	2.03	2.87
4.	0.52	0.74	15.	2.18	3.08
5.	0.66	0.93	16.	2.34	3.31
6.	0.81	1.15	17.	2.49	3.52
7.	0.96	1.36	18.	2.64	3.73
8.	1.11	1.57	19.	2.80	3.96
9.	1.27	1.80	20.	2.94	4.16
10.	1.41	1.99	21.	3.08	4.36
11.	1.56	2.21			

Fig. 7-9. Step Tablet dialog box.

Attached to the outside of your GS-800, you will find a copy of the manufacturer's printout of the diffuse density values for each segment of the transmissive step tablet, as well as a serial number for the tablet. These exact density values must be entered into the software to associate a correct density value with each step on the step tablet.

Note: Scanning in transmissive mode with incorrect step tablet values can cause significant errors in the reported densities of your scans.

First, type the serial number for the tablet into the *Tablet Serial Number* field.

The *Quantity Offset* field does not apply in the GS-800 in transmissive mode. This value should remain at zero.

Next, enter the step tablet values into the appropriate fields under the *Diffuse* column. After the step tablet is scanned, the software will associate each density value with its corresponding segment on the step tablet. The density values do not need to be reentered each time you calibrate.

GS-800 Imaging Densitometer

When you are finished entering the transmissive step tablet values, click on **OK**.

Reflective Step Tablet

For the reflective step tablet, you can use the default target values in the software.

Note: The default values have been preset based on careful testing and review. However, you can edit these values based on your own measurements and testing.

To view or edit the default reflective values, make sure that the **Reflective** checkbox is selected in the main acquisition window, then click on the **Options** button. In the *Densitometer Options* dialog, click on the **Edit Step Tablet** button. The *Step Tablet Values for GS-800 Reflective* dialog box will open.

When you are finished viewing/editing the reflective step tablet values, click on **OK**.

Diffuse Versus Specular O.D.

In the step tablet form, you enter O.D. as diffuse density, and then the software automatically calculates the specular density.

Specular density is a measure of the light that passes directly through a medium. Diffuse density includes light that is scattered as it passes through the medium. Step tablet values are given in diffuse density, but are measured by the scanner in specular density, and therefore must be converted according to the specular/diffuse O.D. ratio. This conversion does not affect quantitation.

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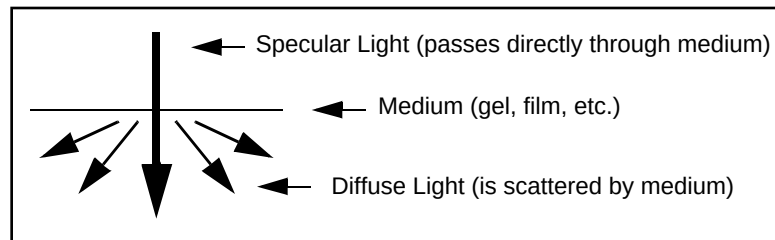


Fig. 7-10. Specular and diffuse density

Diffuse density values are converted to specular optical density units according to the following formula:

$$\text{Specular OD} = 1.4 \diamond \text{Diffuse OD}$$

7.5.b Other Calibration Settings

After you have entered the step tablet values, you can immediately calibrate by clicking on the **Calibrate Now** button (in the *Densitometer Options* dialog box).

You can also specify how often you want the GS-800 to automatically recalibrate. Either click on the **Calibrate Before Every Scan** checkbox or specify a period between automatic recalibrations (in minutes) in the *Recalibration Interval* field.

Note: The scanner will automatically recalibrate each time you change your filter or your reflective/transmissive setting. (If you select a different application with the same filter and light settings, it will not auto recalibrate.)

To print out a calibration report each time the densitometer calibrates, click on the **Calibration Report** checkbox.

7.6 Acquire the Image

Note: Before scanning in transmissive mode, make sure the white balance region of the scanning area is not covered or obstructed in any way.

To begin to scan, click on the **Acquire** button. The scanned image will begin to appear in the scanning window, line by line.

To interrupt a scan, click on the **Stop** button. A message will ask you to confirm the interrupt, and then you will be asked if you want to keep the partial scan. This feature is useful if you overestimated the size of the area you selected.

After the scan is complete, a window will open displaying the scan image, at which point you can analyze and save it.

Note: The image will open with a default file name that includes the date, time, and (if applicable) user name. However, unless you have selected **Auto Save After Scan**, the file will not be saved until you perform a **Save** or **Save As** operation.

7.7 Other Options

Oversample

This feature allows you to scan at the maximum resolution of the scanner and then use spatial averaging to create an image with lower resolution. This can result in better images at lower resolution—however, it takes longer to scan.

To turn on oversampling, click on the **Options** button in the acquisition window and select the **Oversample** checkbox in the options dialog.

With oversampling on, you can specify your own resolution within the range of the densitometer by entering values directly in the fields next to X resolution and Y resolution in the main acquisition window.

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Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any scan you create, select the **Auto Save After Scan** checkbox.

Note: In PDQUEST, this option is preselected and cannot be turned off. All images must be automatically saved when acquired.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on **Acquire**, a *Save As* dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the **Save** button.

Make Backup Copy

If you have selected **Auto Save After Scan**, you can also automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create.

Click on the **Make Backup Copy** checkbox. With this checkbox selected, when a scan is created and saved, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an *“.sbk”* extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word *“backup”* after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the **Transform** command on the main toolbar or *Image* menu.

Hide Grid

To hide the gridlines in the scanning area window, click on the **Hide Grid** checkbox.

8. Fluor-S Multimager



Fig. 8-1. Fluor-S Multimager.

Before you can begin acquiring images using the Fluor-S[®] MultiImager, the imaging system must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the Fluor-S hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

Note: Make sure that the temperature light on the Fluor-S is green before attempting to capture an image. If you are using a PC, the Fluor-S should be turned on and the initialization sequence completed *before* the host computer is turned on. See the hardware manual for more details.

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PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The Fluor-S is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the Fluor-S, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the CTRL key and select the name of the device from the File menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

8.1 Fluor-S Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the Fluor-S, go to the File menu and select Fluor-S.... The acquisition window for the imager will open, displaying a control panel and an image display window.

Fluor-S Multimager



Fig. 8-2. Fluor-S acquisition window

When the Fluor-S window first opens, no image will be displayed.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are four basic steps to acquiring an image using the Fluor-S:

1. Select the application.
2. Position and focus the gel or other object to be imaged.
3. Set the exposure time.
4. Acquire the image.

8.2 Step I. Select Application

To set the appropriate filter and other parameters for the type of object you are imaging, click on the Select button under Select Application. The available applications and their associated settings are listed in a tree that expands from left to right.

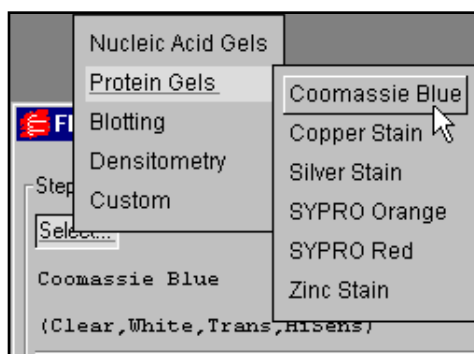


Fig. 8-3. The application tree in the Fluor-S acquisition window.

First select your general application, then select the particular stain or medium you are using. If you select the chemiluminescent application under "Blotting," you also have the option of selecting High Resolution or High Sensitivity (see below).

When you select an application, the software automatically sets the appropriate standard filter (520LP, 530DF60, 610LP, clear, or none), light type (UV, white, or none), and light source (trans, epi, or neither) in the Fluor-S for that particular application.

For applications involving trans illumination, you must also specify a scan dimension (see below).

Your selection will be displayed below the Select button. To exit the tree without selecting, press the ESC key.

Fluor-S Multimager

Custom Applications

If your application is not listed, if you want to use a user-installed filter, or if you want to access High Sensitivity mode (see below), you can create and save your own custom application.

From the application tree, select Custom, then Create. This will open a dialog box in which you can name your application and select your settings.

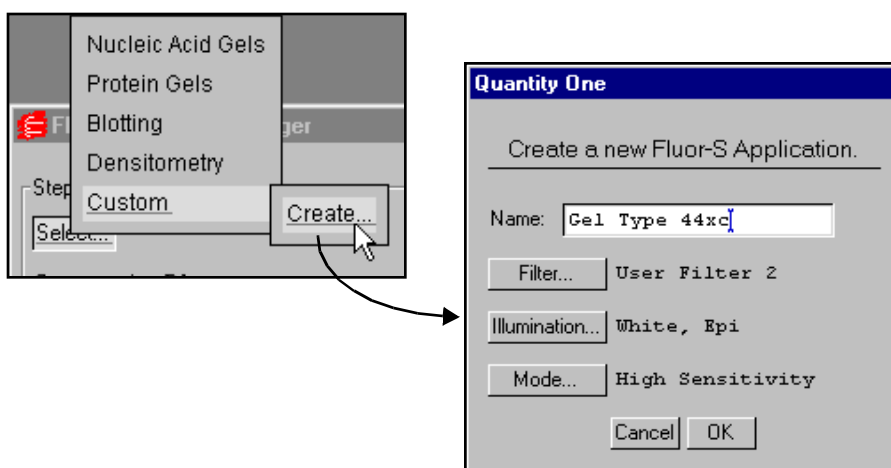


Fig. 8-4. Creating a new custom application.

To select the filter (including user-defined), type of illumination, and camera mode, click on the appropriate buttons and select from the pop-up lists.

Note: Under Illumination, there is a listing for a spare UV light source. This selects the spare UV bulb in the Fluor-S. Select this light source if your main UV bulb fails.

Enter a name for your application in the Name field. Click on OK to implement your changes.

After you have created an application, you can select it from the application tree by selecting Custom and the name you created. You can delete the application by selecting Custom, Delete, and the name of the application.

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Scan Dimension

If an application uses trans illumination, the Scan Dimension buttons become active. The scan dimension is the distance traveled by the transilluminating light source as it scans horizontally across the platen.



Fig. 8-5. Scan dimension settings for trans illumination.

The full scanning range is 300 mm. Select a smaller range if your sample is small and you do not want to wait while the light source travels over the maximum scan width.

High Resolution Versus High Sensitivity

High Resolution and High Sensitivity are mutually exclusive options. High Resolution is the normal operating mode for the Fluor-S. High Sensitivity provides optimal sensitivity for low-light applications. It is the default selection for the chemiluminescence application, and may be selected for a custom application.

In High Resolution mode, images are captured at the maximum resolution of the camera.

In High Sensitivity mode, the pixels in the camera are “binned” (i.e., four pixels are combined into one) to increase the amount of signal per pixel. However, combining the pixels results in a reduction in the resolution of the image.

8.3 Step II. Position/Focus

Note: When you click on the Position or Focus button, the light inside the Fluor-S box automatically turns on. To turn the light off while positioning or focusing, hold down the SHIFT key when clicking on the button.

Fluor-S Multimager

Position

After you have selected your application, you are ready to center your gel or other object within the camera frame. To do so, click on the Position button. The Fluor-S will begin capturing a “live” image and updating it every second.

With the Position button selected, look at the image in the acquisition window while you position your object in the center of the platen. If you have a zoom lens on the camera, you can adjust the magnification while you position.

You can select the Show Alignment Grid checkbox to facilitate positioning.

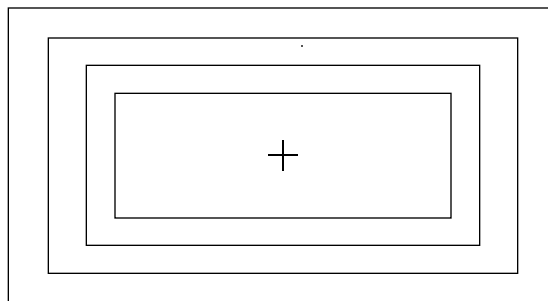


Fig. 8-6. Fluor-S alignment grid.

When you are finished positioning, click on the Stop button.

Focus

Note: Before focusing, you should adjust the f-stop on the camera to the lowest setting (i.e., the maximum aperture). This reduces the depth of field, allowing you to more accurately focus the camera. Then, after focusing, increase the f-stop to the desired setting. (See the following table on recommended f-stops.)

After you have positioned your sample, click on the Focus button and look at the image in the acquisition window while aligning the two focusing arrows on the camera lens. While focusing, the camera will limit its focus to a small

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portion of the sample (this will not affect any zoom lens adjustments you may have made.)

When you are finished focusing, click on the Stop button.

8.4 Step III. Set Exposure Time

When you are ready to capture an image, you will need to select an exposure time. “Exposure” refers to the integration of image captures on the CCD over a set period of time. The effect is analogous to exposing photographic film to light.

The exposure time you select should be based on your application and your “best guess” as to what exposure will give you the best image.

Note: The minimum exposure time in trans illuminated mode is 1 second. The minimum exposure time in epi illuminated mode is 0.1 second.

You can enter an exposure time (in seconds) directly in the field, or use the Arrow buttons to adjust the exposure time in 10 percent increments.

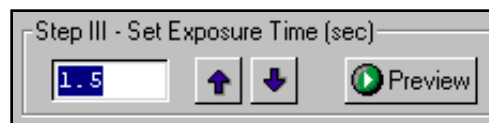


Fig. 8-7. Selecting an exposure time.

The following table provides recommended exposure times for various applications.

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Recommended Exposure Times and Lenses

Sample	Recommended Exposure ¹	Lens & Filter ²	Accessories Used
Fluorescent Stain Gel	3–40 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Fluorescence End-Label Gel	30 sec.–3 min.	Zoom/IR	None
Fluorescent Blot	0.5–5 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Chemifluorescent Blot	0.5–5 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Colorimetric Gel	1–10 sec.	Zoom/IR	White Diffusion Plate
Colorimetric Blot	0.5–20 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
X-ray film	1–10 sec.	Zoom/IR	White Diffusion Plate
Weak Chemiluminescence ³	5–20 min.	50 mm	Chemi Tray (if sample is small)
Strong Chemiluminescence ³	30 sec.–2 min.	50 mm	Chemi Tray (if sample is small)
¹ Increase exposure time two fold for each step increase in f-stop. ² For sharper focusing, close the f-stop down 1–2 stops from full open while focusing. ³ For chemi applications, the 50mm lens is recommended. Always remove the 660 filter.			

For most applications, you can select an exposure time, capture an image, study it, then adjust the exposure time accordingly. Repeat this procedure as many times as necessary to obtain a good image.

For chemiluminescent samples, which degrade over time and emit low levels of light, you can select a high exposure time initially and use Live Acquire mode to save intermediate exposures (see following section).

Preview

For shorter exposures, you can use Preview to test different exposure times. Click on the Preview button create a preview exposure and display it in the acquisition window.

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A preview scan takes only half as long to create as a real scan, because the preview scan does not capture a “dark” image (see the following section on Options). The progress of the exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar at the bottom of the dialog box.

You cannot save preview scans.

If you want to stop a preview scan that is in progress, click on the Stop button.

8.5 Acquire the Image

The Fluor-S gives you the option of simply acquiring and displaying a fully exposed image, or preserving intermediate exposures.

Acquire

To acquire and display a fully exposed image, click on the Acquire button. An exposure will be taken based on the time selected in Step III. This is appropriate for most short exposures.

The progress of the exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar at the bottom of the acquisition window.

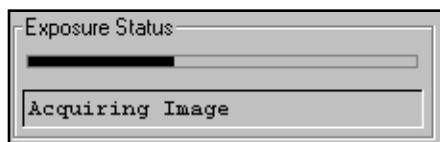


Fig. 8-8. Exposure Status bar when acquiring an image.

Depending on which dark subtraction type you have selected, a dark count may be acquired immediately following image acquisition. See Dark Subtraction Type under Options, below.

If you want to stop a scan that is in progress, click on the Stop button. The acquisition will be terminated.

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After an image has been acquired, a separate window will pop up containing the new image. The window will have a default file name that includes the date, time, and user (if known). To save the image, select Save or Save As from the File menu.

You can then analyze the image using the analysis functions.

Live Acquire

Live Acquire allows you to view and preserve intermediate exposures leading up to a full exposure. This is useful for longer exposure times, such as those required by chemiluminescent samples, where there is the potential for image saturation.

When you click on the Live Acquire button, the exposure time you selected is divided by the number of exposure counts set in the Fluor-S Options dialog box (see Options, below). For example, if you enter an exposure time of 10 minutes and an exposure count of 20, then 20 intermediate exposures will be produced at 30-second intervals. Each intermediate exposure will be displayed in the scan window. The final, full exposure will be displayed in a separate image window.

Note: The first intermediate exposure will take longer than 30 seconds to display if dark subtraction is performed.

You can automatically save your intermediate exposures as separate files for later review using the Auto Save After Scan option. See Options, below.

If you see an intermediate exposure that you like in the scan window, click on the Stop button. Live Acquire mode will end and the last intermediate exposure to be completed will open in a separate image window. You can then save it for analysis.

8.6 Options

Click on the Options button to open the Fluor-S Options dialog box.

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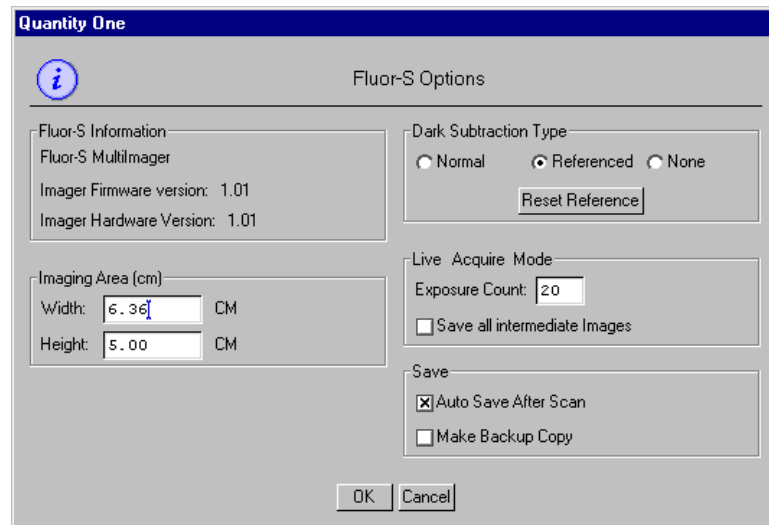


Fig. 8-9. Options dialog box.

8.6.a Dark Subtraction Type

All CCD cameras accumulate electrons that produce a signal that is indistinguishable from light. This “dark count” adds to the noise in your images. In most cases, you will want to subtract this dark count from your images.

Normal

The Normal option button selects the default dark subtraction type. In this mode, after you acquire an image, a “dark” image of the same exposure length will be taken, and this will be subtracted from your image.

The progress of the dark exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar following the regular image exposure.

Note: In Normal mode, a dark image is only acquired the first time you perform a scan with particular application and exposure settings. If you perform subsequent scans with the same settings, no dark exposure will be taken.

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Referenced

If you do not want to perform a dark exposure with each acquisition, you can take a “reference” dark exposure that will be saved and subtracted from all subsequent acquisitions. Click on the Referenced button to activate this feature.

The first time you acquire an image after selecting this option, the Fluor-S will take a 60-second dark exposure that will be saved and used to subtract the dark count from all subsequent acquisitions.

For image exposures of greater or less than 60 seconds, the reference dark will be scaled accordingly and then subtracted. You can change the default reference dark exposure time using the Reset Reference button (see below).

If you deselect the Referenced button and then reselect it, the old reference dark exposure will still be available.

Note: Separate reference dark exposures will be taken for High Resolution mode and High Sensitivity mode. Once you have created a reference dark in each of these modes, each reference dark will be used according to the mode you are in.

Reset Reference

If you would like a reference dark with an exposure time that more closely matches that of your typical scans, click on the Reset Reference button.

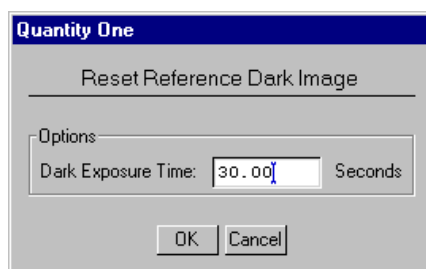


Fig. 8-10. Reset Reference Dark pop-up box.

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A pop-up box will prompt you to enter a new reference dark exposure time in seconds. Click on OK to implement your change. The new reference dark will be created when you acquire your next image.

Note: Because of the high sensitivity of the CCD, fluctuations in background radiation and/or temperature in the room can affect the level of dark count. If you feel that radiation/temperature conditions have changed in the room since your last reference dark was created, use the Reset Reference button to delete your old reference and create a new one under current conditions.

None

If you do not want to perform dark subtraction, select None. No dark exposure will be acquired or subtracted.

8.6.b Live Acquire Mode

Exposure Count

If you are using the Live Acquire function (see previous section), you need to specify how many intermediate exposures you want to view/save during acquisition. Enter this number in the Exposure Count field.

The total exposure time will be divided by the number you enter in the Exposure Count field. If you enter an exposure time of 10 minutes and a count of 10, you will create 10 intermediate exposures at 1 minute intervals.

Note: Do not enter a count that will result in an intermediate exposure time that is less than the minimum exposure time for the mode you are in. The minimum exposure time in trans illuminated mode is 1 second, and the minimum exposure time in epi illuminated mode is 0.1 second. (Example: For a trans illuminated application, an exposure time of 20 seconds and an exposure count of 21 would result in an error.)

Save All Intermediate Images

If Auto Save After Scan is selected (see following section), the Save All Intermediate Images checkbox will become active. If you select this checkbox,

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all your intermediate exposures will be saved as separate files. These files will have the same root name appended by a number indicating the exposure sequence. The final, full exposure will have the root name only, with no exposure number.

8.6.c Save

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any image you create, click on the Auto Save After Scan checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on Acquire or Live Acquire, a Save As dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the Save button.

Note that in Live Acquire mode you can save your intermediate exposures by selecting Auto Save After Scan and then Save All Intermediate Images.

Make Backup Copy

You can automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create. To do so, first select Auto Save After Scan (see above), then select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an “.sbk” extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word “backup” after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

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8.6.d Imaging Area Size

The imaging area is the area of the sample that is captured by the camera and displayed in the scan window. To specify the size of this area, enter a dimension in the appropriate field under Imaging Area.

When you change one imaging area dimension, the other will change to maintain the aspect ratio of the camera lens.

The imaging area will change depending on your zoom factor. For example, if you have zoomed in on a area that is 4.5 x 3.5 cm, then you would enter 4.5 for the width (3.5 for the height would be calculated automatically).

Note: Your imaging area settings must be correct if you want to do 1:1 printing. They must also be correct if you want to compare the quantities of objects (e.g., using the Volume Tools) in different images.

The imaging area dimensions also determine the size of the pixels in your image (i.e., resolution). A smaller imaging area will result in a higher resolution.

8.7 Other Features

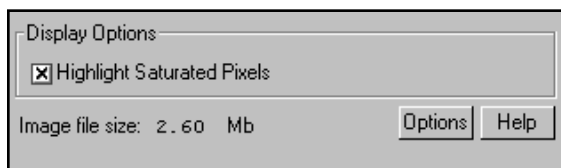


Fig. 8-11. Other Fluor-S acquisition window features.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Image > Transform command.

Fluor-S Multimager

File Size of Images

Image File Size shows the size of the image file you are about to create. This size is determined by whether the image was created in High Resolution or High Sensitivity mode.

If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to acquire an image. (Macintosh users can increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

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9. Fluor-S MAX Multimager



Fig. 9-1. Fluor-S MAX Multimager.

Before you can begin acquiring images using the Fluor-S[®] MAX MultiImager, the imaging system must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the Fluor-S MAX hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

Note: Make sure that the temperature light on the Fluor-S MAX is green before attempting to capture an image. If you are using a PC, the Fluor-S MAX should be turned on and the initialization sequence completed *before* the host computer is turned on. See the hardware manual for more details.

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PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The Fluor-S MAX is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the Fluor-S MAX, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the CTRL key and select the name of the device from the File menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

9.1 Fluor-S MAX Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the Fluor-S MAX, go to the File menu and select Fluor-S MAX.... The acquisition window for the imager will open, displaying a control panel and an image display window.

Fluor-S MAX Multimager

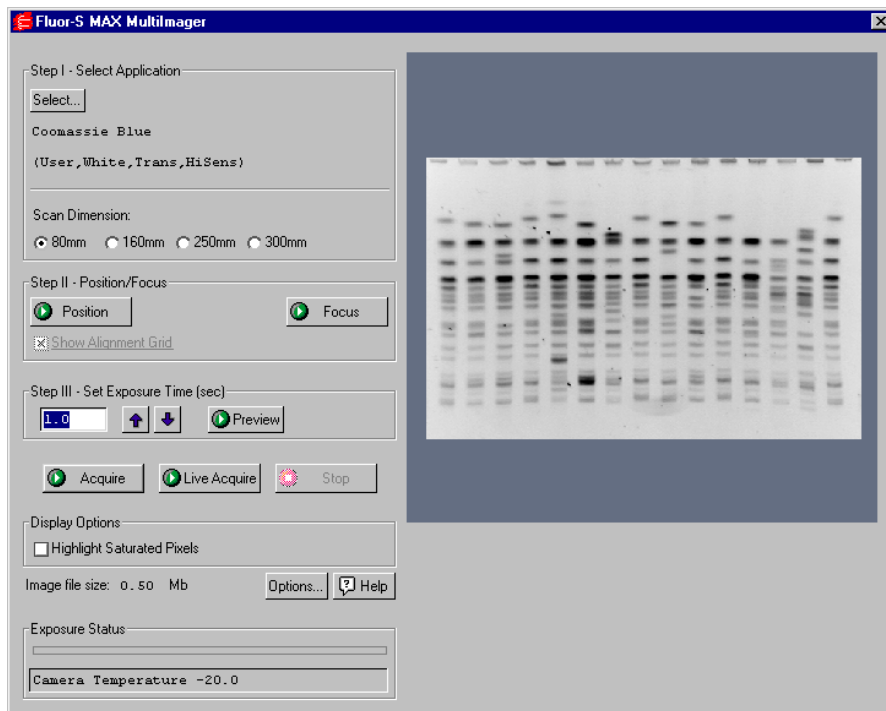


Fig. 9-2. Fluor-S MAX acquisition window.

When the Fluor-S MAX window first opens, no image will be displayed.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are four basic steps to acquiring an image using the Fluor-S MAX:

1. Select the application.
2. Position and focus the gel or other object to be imaged.
3. Set the exposure time.
4. Acquire the image.

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9.2 Step I. Select Application

To set the appropriate filter and other parameters for the type of object you are imaging, click on the Select button under Select Application. The available applications and their associated settings are listed in a tree that expands from left to right.

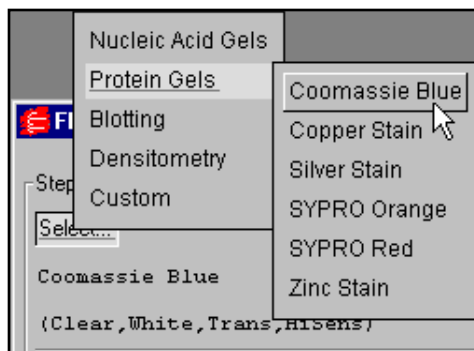


Fig. 9-3. The application tree in the Fluor-S MAX acquisition window.

First select your general application, then select the particular stain or medium you are using. If you select the chemiluminescent application under “Blotting,” you also have the option of selecting High Sensitivity or Ultra Sensitivity (see below).

When you select an application, the software automatically sets the appropriate standard filter (520LP, 530DF60, 610LP, clear, or none), light type (UV, white, or none), and light source (trans, epi, or neither) in the Fluor-S MAX for that particular application.

For applications involving trans illumination, you must also specify a scan dimension (see below).

Your selection will be displayed below the Select button. To exit the tree without selecting, press the ESC key.

Fluor-S MAX Multimager

Custom Applications

If your application is not listed, if you want to use a user-installed filter, or if you want to access Ultra Sensitivity mode (see below), you can create and save your own custom application.

From the application tree, select Custom, then Create. This will open a dialog box in which you can name your application and select your settings.

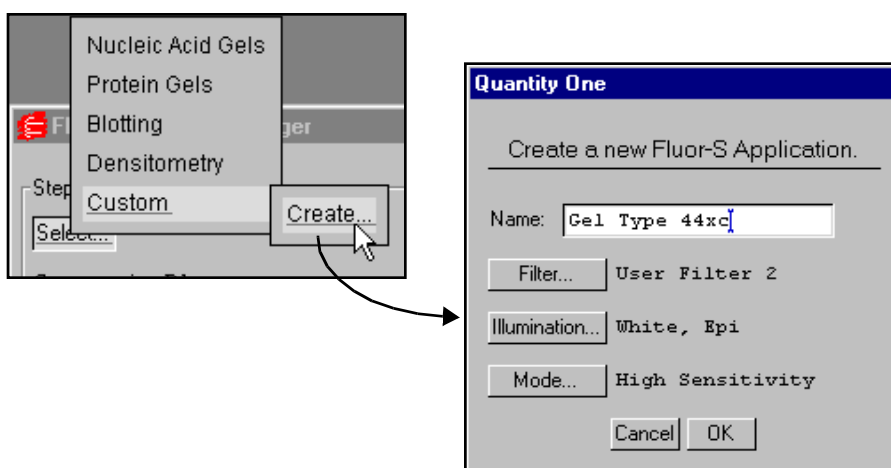


Fig. 9-4. Creating a new custom application.

To select the filter (including user-defined), type of illumination, and camera mode, click on the appropriate buttons.

Note: Under Illumination, there is a listing for a spare UV light source. This selects the spare UV bulb in the Fluor-S MAX. Select this light source if your main UV bulb fails.

Enter a name for your application in the Name field. Click on OK to implement your changes.

After you have created an application, you can select it from the application tree by selecting Custom and the name you created. You can delete the application by selecting Custom, Delete, and the name of the application.

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Scan Dimension

If an application uses trans illumination, the Scan Dimension buttons become active. The scan dimension is the distance traveled by the transilluminating light source as it scans horizontally across the platen.



Fig. 9-5. Scan dimension settings for trans illumination.

The full scanning range is 300 mm. Select a smaller range if your sample is small and you do not want to wait while the light source travels over the maximum scan width.

High Sensitivity and Ultra Sensitivity

High Sensitivity and Ultra Sensitivity are different camera modes. In Ultra Sensitivity mode, the Fluor-S MAX camera is cooled to -35.0 degrees C. In High Sensitivity mode, the camera is cooled to -20.0 degrees C. The current camera temperature is displayed at the bottom of the acquisition window.

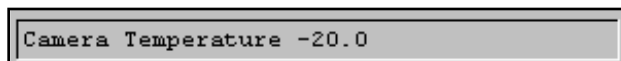


Fig. 9-6. Camera Temperature display.

High Sensitivity is the normal operating mode of the Fluor-S MAX. Ultra Sensitivity provides optimal sensitivity for low-light applications. It is the default selection for the chemiluminescence application, and may be selected for a custom application.

Note: When you change from High to Ultra Sensitivity or visa versa, there will be a delay of several minutes while the Fluor-S MAX camera cools down or warms up. If you attempt to acquire an image during this period, you will be notified of the changing temperature. If you do not want to wait, you can cancel the mode change.

9.3 Step II. Position/Focus

Note: When you click on the Position or Focus button, the light inside the Fluor-S MAX box automatically turns off. This is because if you focus with the camera at maximum aperture (see note below), leaving the light on would make it difficult to view the image. To turn the light on while positioning or focusing, hold down the SHIFT key when clicking on the button.

Position

The next step in acquiring an image is centering your gel or other object within the camera frame. To do this, click on the Position button. The Fluor-S MAX will begin capturing a “live” image and updating it every second.

With the Position button selected, look at the image in the acquisition window while you position your object in the center of the platen. If you have a zoom lens on the camera, you can adjust the magnification while you position.

You can select the Show Alignment Grid checkbox to facilitate positioning.

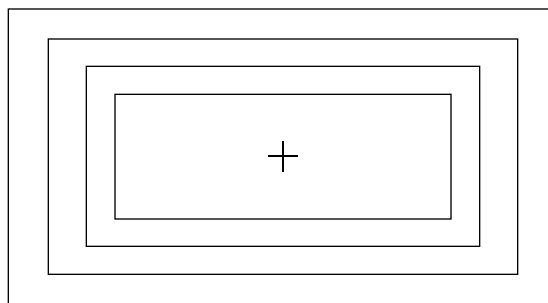


Fig. 9-7. Fluor-S MAX alignment grid.

When you are finished positioning, click on the Stop button.

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Focus

Note: Before focusing, you should adjust the f-stop on the camera to the lowest setting (i.e., the maximum aperture). This reduces the depth of field, allowing you to more accurately focus the camera. Then, after focusing, increase the f-stop to the desired setting.

After you have positioned your sample, click on the Focus button and look at the image in the acquisition window while aligning the two focusing arrows on the camera lens. While focusing, the camera will limit its focus to a small portion of the sample (this will not affect any zoom lens adjustments you may have made.)

When you are finished focusing, click on the Stop button.

9.4 Step III. Set Exposure Time

When you are ready to capture an image, you will need to select an exposure time. “Exposure” refers to the integration of image captures on the CCD over a set period of time. The effect is analogous to exposing photographic film to light.

The exposure time you select should be based on your application and your “best guess” as to what exposure will give you the best image.

Note: The minimum exposure time in trans illuminated mode is 1 second. The minimum exposure time in epi illuminated mode is 0.1 second.

You can enter an exposure time (in seconds) directly in the field, or use the Arrow buttons to adjust the exposure time in 10 percent increments.



Fig. 9-8. Selecting an exposure time.

Fluor-S MAX Multimager

The following table provides recommended exposure times for various applications.

Recommended Exposure Times and Lenses

Sample	Recommended Exposure	Lens & Filter ¹	Accessories Used
Fluorescent Stain Gel	1–20 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Fluorescence End-Label Gel	10 sec.–2 min.	Zoom/IR	None
Fluorescent Blot	0.1–3 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Chemifluorescent Blot	0.1–3 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Colorimetric Gel	1–5 sec.	Zoom/IR	White Diffusion Plate
Colorimetric Blot	0.2–10 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
X-ray film	0.1–5 sec.	Zoom/IR	White Diffusion Plate
Weak Chemiluminescence ²	2–10 min.	50 mm	Chemi Tray (if sample is small)
Strong Chemiluminescence ²	5 sec.–1 min.	50 mm	Chemi Tray (if sample is small)
¹ For sharper focusing, close the f-stop down 1–2 stops from full open while focusing. ² For chemi applications, the 50mm lens is recommended. Always remove the 660 filter.			

For most applications, you can select an exposure time, capture an image, study it, then adjust the exposure time accordingly. Repeat this procedure as many times as necessary to obtain a good image.

For chemiluminescent samples, which degrade over time and emit low levels of light, you can select a high exposure time initially and use Live Acquire mode to save intermediate exposures (see following section).

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Preview

For shorter exposures, you can use Preview to test different exposure times. Click on the Preview button create a preview exposure and display it in the acquisition window.

A preview scan takes only half as long to create as a real scan, because the preview scan does not capture a “dark” image (see below). The progress of the exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar at the bottom of the dialog box.

You cannot save preview scans.

If you want to stop a preview scan that is in progress, click on the Stop button.

9.5 Acquire the Image

The Fluor-S MAX gives you the option of simply acquiring and displaying a fully exposed image, or preserving intermediate exposures.

Acquire

To acquire and display a fully exposed image, click on the Acquire button. An exposure will be taken based on the time selected in Step III. This is appropriate for most short exposures.

The progress of each exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar at the bottom of the acquisition window.

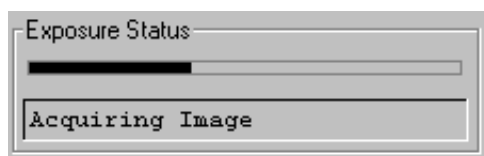


Fig. 9-9. Exposure Status bar when acquiring an image.

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Depending on which dark subtraction type you have selected, a dark count may be acquired immediately following image acquisition. See Dark Subtraction Type under Options, below.

If you want to stop a scan that is in progress, click on the Stop button. The acquisition will be terminated.

After an image has been acquired, a separate window will pop up containing the new image. The window will have a default file name that includes the date, time, and user (if known). To save the image, select Save or Save As from the File menu.

You can then analyze the image using the standard analysis functions.

Live Acquire

Live Acquire allows you to view and preserve intermediate exposures leading up to a full exposure. This is useful for longer exposure times, such as those required by chemiluminescent samples, where there is the potential for image saturation.

When you click on the Live Acquire button, the exposure time you selected is divided by the number of exposure counts set in the Options dialog box (see Options, below). For example, if you enter an Exposure Time of 10 minutes and an Exposure Count of 20, then 20 intermediate exposures will be produced at 30-second intervals. Each intermediate exposure will be displayed in the scan window. The final, full exposure will be displayed in a separate image window.

Note: The first intermediate exposure will take longer than 30 seconds to display if dark subtraction is performed.

You can automatically save your intermediate exposures as separate files for later review using the Auto Save After Scan option. See Options, below.

If you see an intermediate exposure that you like in the scan window, click on the Stop button. Live Acquire will end and the last intermediate exposure to be completed will open in a separate image window. You can then save it for analysis.

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9.6 Options

Click on the Options button to open the Options dialog box.

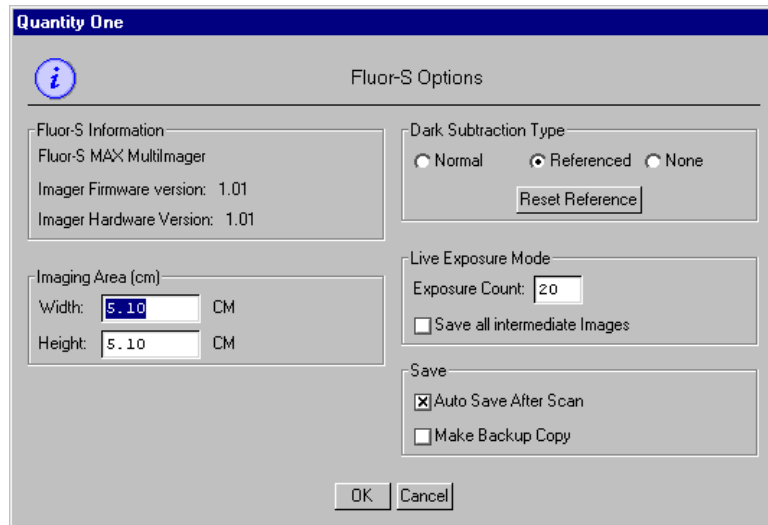


Fig. 9-10. Options dialog box.

9.6.a Dark Subtraction Type

All CCD cameras accumulate electrons that produce a “signal” that is indistinguishable from light. This “dark count” adds to the noise in your images. In most cases, you will want to subtract this dark count from your images.

Normal

The Normal option button selects the default dark subtraction type. In this mode, after you acquire an image, a “dark” image of the same exposure length will be taken, and this will be subtracted from your image.

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The progress of the dark exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar following the regular image exposure.

Note: In Normal mode, a dark image is only acquired the first time you perform a scan with particular application and exposure settings. If you perform subsequent scans with the same settings, no dark exposure will be taken.

Referenced

If you do not want to perform a dark exposure with each acquisition, you can take a “reference” dark exposure that will be saved and subtracted from all subsequent acquisitions. Click on the Referenced button to activate this feature.

The first time you acquire an image after selecting this option, the Fluor-S MAX will take a 300-second dark exposure that will be saved and used to subtract the dark count from all subsequent acquisitions.

For image exposures of greater or less than 300 seconds, the reference dark will be scaled accordingly and then subtracted. You can change the default reference dark exposure time using the Reset Reference button (see below).

If you deselect the Referenced button and then reselect it, the old reference dark exposure will still be available.

Note: Separate reference dark exposures will be taken for High Sensitivity mode and Ultra Sensitivity mode. Once you have created a reference dark in each of these modes, each reference dark will be used according to the mode you are in.

Reset Reference Button

If you would like a reference dark with an exposure time that more closely matches that of your typical scans, click on the Reset Reference button.

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Fig. 9-11. Reset Reference Dark pop-up box.

A pop-up box will prompt you to enter a new reference dark exposure time in seconds. Click on OK to implement your change. The new reference dark will be created when you acquire your next image.

Note: Because of the high sensitivity of the CCD, fluctuations in background radiation and/or temperature in the room can affect the level of dark count. If you feel that radiation/temperature conditions have changed in the room since your last reference dark was created, use the Reset Reference button to delete your old reference and create a new one under current conditions.

None

If you do not want to perform dark subtraction, select None. No dark exposure will be acquired or subtracted.

9.6.b Live Acquire Mode

Exposure Count

If you are using the Live Acquire function (see previous section), you need to specify how many intermediate exposures you want to view/save during acquisition. Enter this number in the Exposure Count field.

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The total exposure time will be divided by the number you enter in the Exposure Count field. If you enter an exposure time of 10 minutes and a count of 10, you will create 10 intermediate exposures at 1 minute intervals.

Note: Do not enter a count that will result in an intermediate exposure time that is less than the minimum exposure time for the mode you are in. The minimum exposure time in trans illuminated mode is 1 second, and the minimum exposure time in epi illuminated mode is 0.1 second. (Example: For a trans illuminated application, an exposure time of 20 seconds and an exposure count of 21 would result in an error.)

Save All Intermediate Images

If Auto Save After Scan is selected (see following section), the Save All Intermediate Images checkbox will become active. If you select this checkbox, all your intermediate exposures will be saved as separate files. These files will have the same root name appended by a number indicating the exposure sequence. The final, full exposure will have the root name only, with no exposure number.

9.6.c Save

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any image you create, click on the Auto Save After Scan checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on Acquire or Live Acquire, a Save As dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the Save button.

Note that in Live Acquire mode you can save your intermediate exposures by selecting Auto Save After Scan and then Save All Intermediate Images.

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Make Backup Copy

You can automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create. To do so, first select Auto Save After Scan (see above), then select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an “.sbk” extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word “backup” after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

9.6.d Imaging Area Size

The imaging area is the area of the sample that is captured by the camera and displayed in the scan window. To specify the size of your imaging area, enter a dimension in the appropriate field. When you change one imaging area dimension, the other will change to maintain the aspect ratio of the camera lens.

The imaging area will change depending on your zoom factor. For example, if you have zoomed in on a area that is 4.5 x 3.5 cm, then you would enter 4.5 for the width (3.5 for the height would be calculated automatically).

Note: Your imaging area settings must be correct if you want to do actual-size printing. They must also be correct if you want to compare the quantities of objects (e.g., using the Volume Tools) in different images.

The imaging area dimensions also determine the size of the pixels in your image (i.e., resolution). A smaller imaging area will result in a higher resolution.

9.7 Other Features

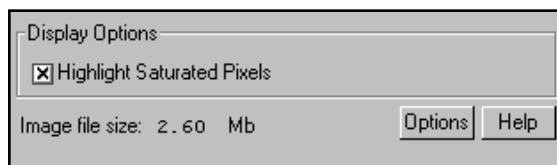


Fig. 9-12. Other Fluor-S MAX acquisition window features.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Image > Transform command.

File Size of Images

Image File Size (below Options) shows the size of the image file you are about to create. This size is determined by whether the image was created in High Sensitivity or Ultra Sensitivity mode.

If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to acquire an image. (Macintosh users can increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

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10. VersaDoc



Fig. 10-1. VersaDoc.

Before you can acquire images using the VersaDoc Imaging System, you need to install the Roper Scientific interface adapter and its associated device drivers in your computer. The driver installation procedures for Windows operating systems include pre-installation and use of the Windows Hardware Wizards.

Note: *Important!* Please read and follow the driver installation procedures contained in the README documents before you install the VersaDoc camera interface adapter. You can find the README documents in the Quality One 4.2.3/VersaDoc Drivers folders on The Discovery Series (TDS) Release 11 CD.

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The Quantity One 4.2.3/VersaDoc Drivers folder on the TDS Release 11 CD also contains Roper Scientific camera interface driver installation instructions for Macintosh computers.

See the VersaDoc hardware manual for further installation, startup, and operating instructions for the VersaDoc Imaging System.

10.1 VersaDoc Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the VersaDoc open Quantity One 4.2.3, go to the File menu and select VersaDoc. The acquisition window opens, displaying a control panel and an image display window.



Fig. 10-2. VersaDoc acquisition window.

When the VersaDoc window first opens, no image will be displayed.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are four basic steps to acquiring an image using the VersaDoc:

1. Select the application.
2. Position and focus the object to be imaged.
3. Set the exposure time.
4. Acquire the image.

10.2 Step 1. Select Application

In Step 1, you select the appropriate filters and other imaging parameters for the type of gel, blot, plate, or other object that you are imaging. Each set of parameters you select is called an “application.”

The VersaDoc supports multichannel sequential imaging. This allows you to automatically image the same object using up to four different applications (e.g., to detect different types of stains on the same gel).

First you select a channel, then you select the application under that channel.

10.2.a Selecting a Channel

Note: Optimize Uniformity will be disabled if you use multiple channels.

The four channels are accessed using the tabs under Step 1. Channel 1 is always enabled—that is, the VersaDoc will always capture an image using the application settings selected under Channel 1 first.

To enable any of the remaining channels, click on a channel tab, then select the Enable Channel checkbox and select the application for that channel as described below.

Enabled channels have a green check mark on their tabs.

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Note: If you use the Optimize Exposure feature, only the application under the selected channel tab will be imaged; other channels, even if enabled, will be ignored.

You do not need to enable Channels 2–4 in sequence. For example, you can set up your four most common applications using the different channels, but only enable Channel 4 for a particular gel. Channel 1 would be scanned first, Channel 4 second.

Enabled channels are imaged sequentially. The separate scans are displayed and saved as separate images. The total imaging time depends on the number and type of enabled applications.

If you have selected Auto Save After Scan, the image created using Channel 1 will have the base file name, and images created using subsequent channels will have the base file name plus a version number. (v. 2, v. 3, v. 4). Note that the image version number does not necessarily correspond to the channel number. For example, if you captured an image using only Channels 1 and 4, the image created using Channel 4 will be saved as version 2 (v. 2).

10.2.b Selecting an Application

To select an application (i.e., the appropriate filter and other parameters for the type of object you are imaging), click on the Select button under a channel tab.

Standard Applications

The standard applications and associated settings are listed in a tree that expands from left to right. When you select an application, the software automatically sets the appropriate filter in the VersaDoc for that particular application.

First select your general application, then select the particular stain or medium you are using. When you select the stain or medium, the software automatically sets the appropriate filter (520LP, 530DF60, 610LP, clear, or none), light type (UV, white, or none), and light source (Trans, Epi, or neither) in the VersaDoc for that particular application.

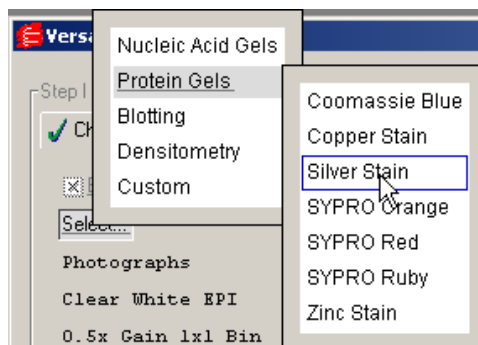


Fig. 10-3. The application tree in the VersaDoc acquisition window.

Note: If you select an application that requires trans white illumination, you will need to install the *white light conversion screen* on the sample stage area.

To exit the tree without selecting, press the Esc key.

Your selection will be displayed below the Select button.

Custom Applications

If your application is not listed, if you want to use a user-installed filter, or if you want to set the gain and bin settings manually, you can create and save your own custom applications.

From the application tree, select Custom, then Create. This will open a dialog box in which you can name your application and select your settings.

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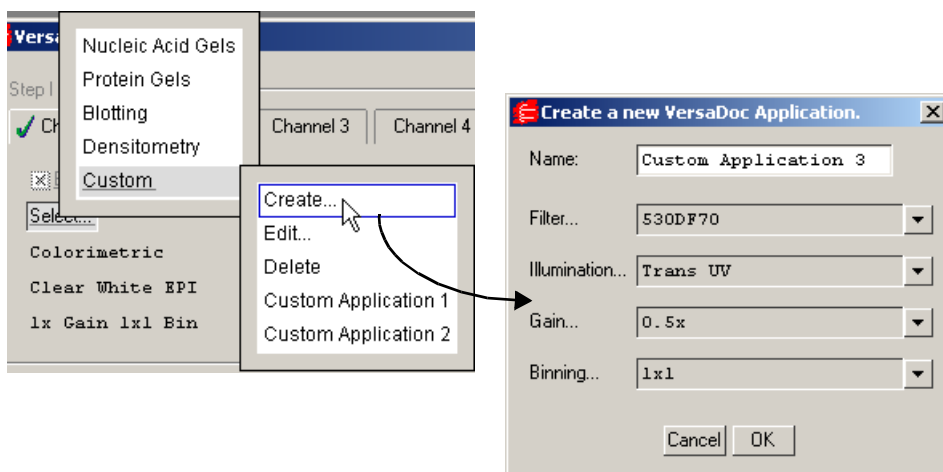


Fig. 10-4. Creating a new custom application.

Enter a name for your application in the Name field.

Next, click on the buttons next to the Filter, Illumination, Gain and Binning fields to change these settings.

Note: Note that if you select trans white illumination, you will need to install the *white light conversion screen* on the sample stage.

A higher Binning setting (2x2, 3x3) provides optimal sensitivity for low-light applications such as chemiluminescence. In this mode, the pixels in the camera are “binned” (e.g., four pixels are combined into one) to increase the amount of signal per pixel without increasing noise. Note that combining the pixels results in a reduction in the resolution of the image.

Selecting a higher Gain (4x) provides higher sensitivity without reduced resolution; however, noise will also increase. This is useful for faint signals (bright spots will saturate). Selecting a lower gain (0.5x) is useful for brighter images that tend to saturate. A gain setting of 1x provides the greatest dynamic range.

Click on OK to implement your changes.

After you have created an application, you can select it from the application tree by selecting Custom and the name you created.

You can edit a custom application by selecting Custom, Edit, and the name of the application. You can also use this feature to create a new custom application from an existing one.

You can delete a custom application by selecting Custom, Delete, and the name of the application.

10.3 Step II. Position/Focus

Before positioning and focusing the image, be careful select the most common application you will be using under Step I. The filter for that application will be used when positioning and focusing.

Note: Note that the optimal position and focus will be different for a filtered image versus an unfiltered one. (All standard applications except Chemiluminescence use a filter.)

Position

After you have selected your application, you are ready to center your gel or other object within the camera frame. To do so, click on the Position button. The VersaDoc will begin capturing a “live” image and updating it every second.

With the Position button selected, study the image in the acquisition window while you position your object in the center of the sample stage. If you have a zoom lens on the camera, you can adjust the magnification while you position. (See the VersaDoc User Manual for details on positioning.)

While you are positioning, you can select the Show Alignment Grid checkbox to display a target grid overlay on the image.

When you click on Position, the light inside the camera box automatically switches on. To turn the light off while positioning, deselect the Light On checkbox.

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When you are finished positioning, click on the Stop button.

Focus

Note: Before focusing, you should adjust the f-stop on the camera to the lowest setting (i.e., the maximum aperture). This reduces the depth of field, allowing you to more accurately focus the camera. Then, after focusing, increase the f-stop to the desired setting. See the table of recommended exposure times.

After you have positioned your sample, click on the Focus button and look at the image in the acquisition window while adjusting the focus on the camera lens. While focusing, the camera will limit its focus to a small portion of the sample (this will not affect any zoom lens adjustments you may have made.) (See the VersaDoc User Manual for details on focusing.)

When you click on Focus, the light inside the camera box automatically switches on. To turn the light off while positioning, deselect the Light On checkbox.

When you are finished focusing, click on the Stop button.

10.4 Step III. Set Exposure Time

The “exposure time” is the period of time an image is integrated on the CCD. The effect is analogous to exposing photographic film to light.

Setting an Exposure Time

Different applications have different optimal exposure times. If you are imaging using multiple channels, you can select a different exposure time for each channel. First select the channel using the tabs, then select the appropriate exposure time for that channel.

See the table of recommended exposure times.

You can enter an exposure time (in seconds) directly in the field, or use the Arrow buttons to adjust the exposure time in 10 percent increments.



Fig. 10-5. Selecting an exposure time.

The following table provides recommended exposure times for various applications.

Recommended Exposure Times and Lenses

Sample	Recommended Exposure	Lens & Filter ¹	Accessories Used
Fluorescent Stain Gel	3–30 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Fluorescence End-Label Gel	30 sec.–5 min.	Zoom/IR	None
Fluorescent Blot	0.5–5 sec.	Zoom/IR	Sample/Chemi Tray
Chemifluorescent Blot	0.5–5 sec.	Zoom/IR	None
Colorimetric Gel	0.1–1 sec.	Zoom/IR	White light conversion screen
Colorimetric Blot	0.1–1 sec.	Zoom/IR	Sample/Chemi Tray
X-ray film	0.1–1 sec.	Zoom/IR	White light conversion screen
Weak Chemiluminescence ²	5–10 min.	50 mm	Sample/Chemi Tray (if sample is small)
Strong Chemiluminescence ²	10 sec.–2 min.	50 mm	Sample/Chemi Tray (if sample is small)
¹ For sharper focusing, close the f-stop down 1–2 stops from full open while focusing.			
² For chemi applications, the 50mm lens is recommended. Always remove the 660 filter.			

Note: For most applications, you can select an exposure time, capture an image, study it, and then adjust the exposure time accordingly. Repeat this

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procedure as many times as necessary to obtain a good image. For chemiluminescent samples, which degrade over time and emit low levels of light, select a high exposure time initially or use the Optimize Exposure command described on page 162.

Preview

For shorter exposures, you can use Preview to test different exposure times. Click on the Preview button create a preview exposure and display it in the acquisition window.

Note: The camera on the VersaDoc must be at the correct operating temperature before capturing images. The temperature adjustment can take several minutes after the camera is turned on, depending on your VersaDoc model and the ambient room temperature. See your hardware manual for details.

A preview scan takes only half as long to create as a real scan, because the preview scan does not capture a “dark” image. The progress of the exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar at the bottom of the dialog box.

You cannot save preview scans.

If you want to stop a preview scan that is in progress, click on the Stop button.

10.5 Acquire the Image

Note: The camera on the VersaDoc must be at the correct operating temperature before capturing images. The temperature adjustment can take several minutes after the camera is turned on, depending on your VersaDoc model and the ambient room temperature. See your hardware manual for details.

You can acquire a single exposure for each channel based on the time selected in Step III (Acquire), or take a series of exposures for a particular channel over a specified interval (Optimize Exposure).

Optimize Uniformity

For applications using the UV or white light transilluminator, you should use the appropriate optimization plate to ensure a uniform intensity in the image. This will compensate for normal variations in image pixel intensity that occur with a transilluminating light source.

To enable this feature, select the Optimize Uniformity checkbox.

Note: Uniformity optimization is only available in single channel, single exposure mode. If you are using multiple channels, or take multiple exposures using the Optimize Exposure feature described below, uniformity optimization will be disabled.

UV optimization: When you first select the Optimize Uniformity checkbox, and then acquire an image using the UV transilluminator, you will be prompted to place the fluorescent reference plate on the VersaDoc sample stage (see the VersaDoc User Manual). An image of the plate will be acquired and saved on your computer hard drive. Then you can replace the plate with your sample and acquire the image.

White light optimization: When you first select the checkbox, and then acquire an image using the white light transilluminator, you will be prompted to place the white light conversion screen on the VersaDoc sample stage (see the VersaDoc User Manual). An image of the plate will be acquired and saved on your computer hard drive. Then you can replace the plate with your sample and acquire the image.

For subsequent UV or white light trans exposures, you will be prompted to either use the appropriate saved optimization image or acquire a new one.

Acquire

Click on the Acquire button to capture a single image for each enabled channel. An exposure will be taken for each enabled channel based on the time selected for that channel in Step III.

The progress of each exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar at the bottom of the acquisition window.

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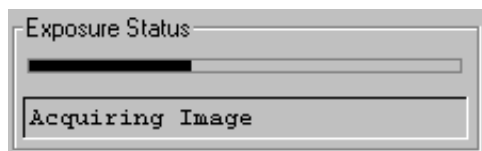


Fig. 10-6. Exposure Status bar when acquiring an image.

Depending on which dark subtraction type you have selected under Options, a dark count may be acquired immediately following image acquisition.

If you want to stop an acquisition that is in progress, click on the Stop button. The current acquisition will be terminated. If multiple channels are selected, you must click on the Stop button once per channel to stop all acquisitions.

After an image has been acquired, a separate window will pop up containing the new image. You can then analyze the image using the analysis functions.

Optimize Exposure

Optimize Exposure allows you to specify an interval over which a series of progressively longer exposures are taken. All exposures are then displayed on the screen, and you can choose the one that provides the best image.

Note: Multiple exposures will be taken for only the selected multichannel tab. Other channels, even if enabled, will not be used. Optimize Uniformity will be disabled if you are using Optimize Exposure.

Click on the Optimize Exposure button. A settings dialog box will open in which you can specify the total exposure time, starting exposure time, and number of exposures. (The specified number of exposures will be taken at regular intervals between the starting exposure time and the total exposure time.)

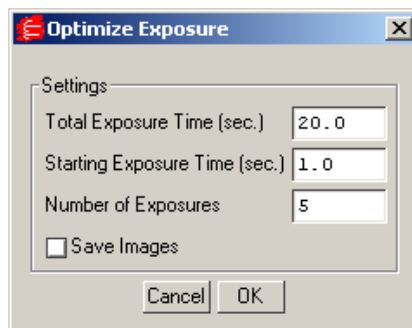


Fig. 10-7. Optimize Exposure dialog.

Note: You should specify no more than 10 exposures in the Optimize Exposure dialog, to avoid excessive build up of image background in later exposures. The fewer the exposures, the less background will be added to the image. See the Release Notes for additional instructions on reducing background in images captured using Optimize Exposure.

Select the Save Images checkbox if you want to automatically save each exposure as it is taken.

Click on OK in the settings dialog to begin taking exposures. If you selected Save Images, a Save dialog box will open in which you can specify the base file name and location of the exposure files. When you click on Save, the exposures will be taken.

The specified number of exposures will be taken at equal intervals between the starting exposure time and total exposure time. The exposure status bar will show the progress of each exposure.

Depending on which dark subtraction type you have selected under Options, a dark count may be acquired immediately following each exposure.

When each exposure is complete, an image window containing that exposure will open in front of the VersaDoc window. Subsequent exposures are tiled in front of the VersaDoc window.

Note that the first exposure will have the base file name; the default base file name is the computer user name and a time stamp. Each subsequent

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exposure will have a version number (v2, v3, v4, etc.) appended to the base file name. (If you are using the default base file name, the time stamp may change in the course of the series of exposures; in this case, the base file name will change and the version numbering will reset for subsequent exposures.)

The highest version number will be the final exposure. If you did not elect to auto-save the exposures as they were created, then each image will be unsaved.

To stop the image acquisitions, click on the Stop button.

Note: Exposures captured before stopping will be displayed in image windows.

Study the different images and select the best exposure(s) to keep.

10.6 Options

Click on the Options button to open the Options dialog box.

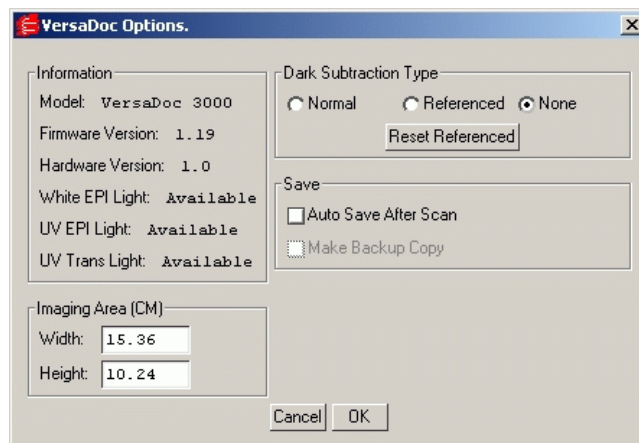


Fig. 10-8. Options dialog box.

10.6.a Dark Subtraction Type

All CCD cameras accumulate electrons that produce a signal that is indistinguishable from light. This “dark count” adds to the noise in your images, particularly for long exposures. In most cases, you will want to subtract this dark count from your images.

The settings for subtracting the dark count are in the Options dialog box. Click on the Options button in the acquisition window to open this dialog.

Normal

The Normal option button selects the default dark subtraction type. In this mode, after you acquire an image, a “dark” image of the same exposure length will be taken, and this will be subtracted from your image.

The progress of the dark exposure will be displayed in the Exposure Status bar following the regular image exposure.

In Normal mode, a dark image is only acquired the first time you perform a scan with particular application and exposure settings. If you perform subsequent scans with the same settings, no dark exposure will be taken.

Reference

If you do not want to perform a dark exposure with each acquisition, you can take a “reference” dark exposure that will be saved and subtracted from all subsequent acquisitions. Click on the Referenced button to activate this feature.

The first time you acquire an image after selecting this option, the VersaDoc will take a dark exposure that will be saved and used to subtract the dark count from all subsequent acquisitions.

Note: The VersaDoc 1000 will take a 60-second reference dark exposure; the VersaDoc 3000 and 5000 will take a 180-second reference dark exposure.

For image exposures that are longer or shorter than the reference dark, the reference dark will be scaled accordingly and then subtracted. You can change

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the default reference dark exposure time using the Reset Reference button (see below).

If you deselect the Referenced button and then reselect it, the old reference dark exposure will still be available.

Separate reference dark exposures will be taken for images that have different levels of binning or gain. Once you have created a reference dark for each level of binning or gain, the appropriate reference dark will be used according to the settings of your selected application.

Reset Reference

If you would like a reference dark with an exposure time that more closely matches that of your typical scans, click on the Reset Reference button.

A pop-up box will prompt you to enter a new dark exposure time in seconds.

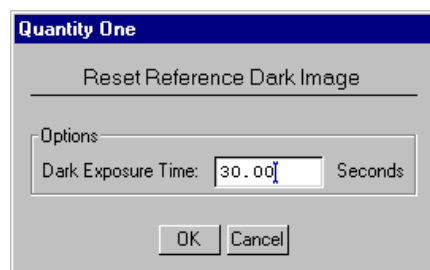


Fig. 10-9. Reset Reference Dark pop-up box.

Click on OK to implement your change. The new reference dark will be created when you acquire your next image.

Because of the high sensitivity of the CCD, fluctuations in background radiation and/or temperature in the room can affect the level of dark count. If you feel that radiation/temperature conditions have changed in the room since your last reference dark was created, use the Reset Reference button to delete your old reference and create a new one under current conditions.

None

If you do not want to perform dark subtraction, select None. No dark exposure will be acquired or subtracted.

10.6.b Save

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any image you acquire using the Acquire button, click on the Auto Save After Scan checkbox in the Options dialog box.

Note: In PDQUEST, this option is preselected and cannot be turned off. All images must be automatically saved when acquired.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on Acquire, a Save As dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the Save button.

Make Backup Copy

You can automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create. To do so, first select Auto Save After Scan, then select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an .sbk extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word backup after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

10.6.c Imaging Area Size

The imaging area is the area of the sample (in centimeters) that is captured by the camera and displayed in the scan window. To specify the size of this area, enter a dimension in the appropriate field under Imaging Area in the Options

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dialog box. Click on the Options button in the acquisition window to open this dialog.

When you change one imaging area dimension, the other will change to maintain the aspect ratio of the camera lens.

The imaging area will change depending on your zoom factor. For example, if you have zoomed in on a area that is 4.5 x 3.5 cm, then you would enter 4.5 for the width (3.5 for the height would be calculated automatically).

Note: Your imaging area settings must be correct if you want to do 1:1 printing. They must also be correct if you want to compare the quantities of objects (e.g., using the Volume Tools) in different images.

The imaging area dimensions also determine the size of the pixels in your image (i.e., resolution). A smaller imaging area will result in a higher resolution.

10.7 Other Features

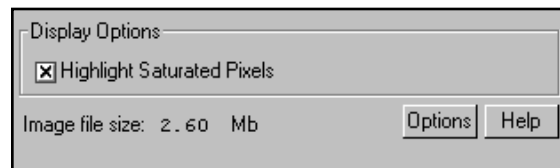


Fig. 10-10. Other VersaDoc acquisition window features.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Transform command.

File Size of Images

Image File Size shows the size of the image file you are about to create. This size is determined by the resolution of the camera and any binning you perform when capturing the image.

If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to acquire an image.

Macintosh users can increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.

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11. Personal Molecular Imager FX

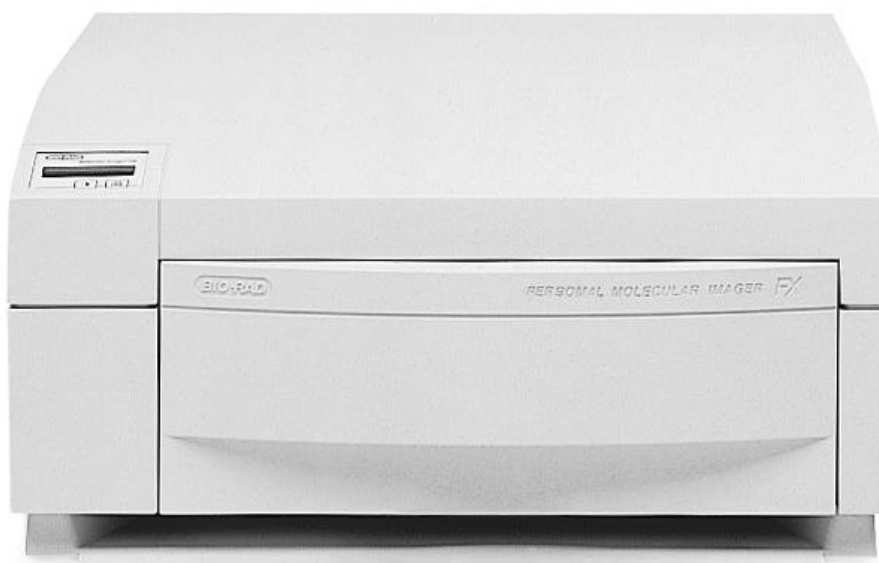


Fig. 11-1. Personal Molecular Imager FX

Before you can begin acquiring images using the Personal Molecular Imager[®] FX, the instrument must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the Personal FX hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

Note: The Personal FX should be turned on and the initialization sequence completed *before* the host computer is turned on (except in the case of certain Power Macintosh configurations). See the hardware manual for more details.

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PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The Personal FX is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the Personal FX, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the CTRL key and select the name of the device from the File menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

11.1 Personal FX Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the Personal FX, go to the File menu and select Personal FX.... The acquisition window for the imager will open, displaying a control panel and the scanning area window.

Personal Molecular Imager FX

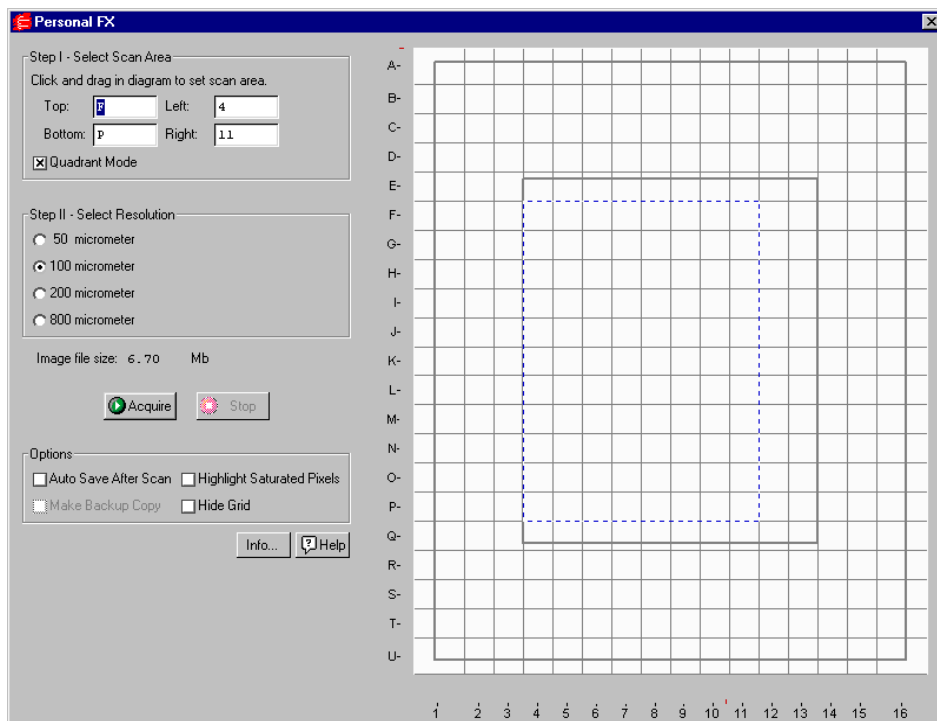


Fig. 11-2. Personal FX acquisition window

The default scanning window is marked by grid lines that divide the area into quadrants. There is also an outer box and inner box marked by thicker lines. This conforms to the sample pad for the standard Bio-Rad Exposure Cassette that is supplied with the Personal FX. The quadrants are numbered 1–16 left to right and lettered A–U top to bottom.

If you prefer a scanning window measured in centimeters, deselect the Quadrant Mode checkbox in the control panel by clicking on it. To hide the gridlines, click on the Hide Grid checkbox under Options.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are three basic steps to scanning an image using the Personal FX:

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1. Select the scan area
2. Select the resolution
3. Acquire the image

11.2 Step I. Select Scan Area

To select a scan area, drag your mouse within the scanning window. (In the scanning window, your cursor appearance will change to a cross.) The border of the scan area you are selecting is marked by a frame.

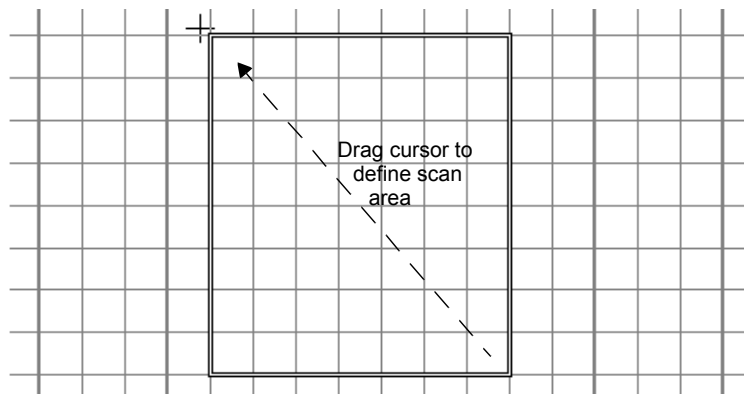


Fig. 11-3. Selecting a scan area.

If you are in quadrant mode, note that the frame “locks” onto the next quadrant as you drag. When you release the mouse button, the border changes to a dashed blue line, indicating a selected area.

- To *reposition* the scanning box you have selected, position your cursor inside the box and drag. The entire box will move.
- To *resize* the box, position your cursor on a box side and drag. The side you have selected will move.
- To *redo* the box entirely, position your cursor outside the box and drag. The old box will disappear and a new box will be created.

Personal Molecular Imager FX

You can also select the scanning area by entering coordinates in the appropriate fields (Top, Bottom, Left, Right). After you enter a coordinate, the position of the scanning area box will change accordingly.

When selecting, be sure to include the entire area of interest, and be generous with borders. You can always crop the image later.

11.3 Step II. Select Resolution

The Personal FX acquisition window allows you to scan at 50, 100, 200, or 800 micrometers. These resolutions are listed as option buttons in the control panel.

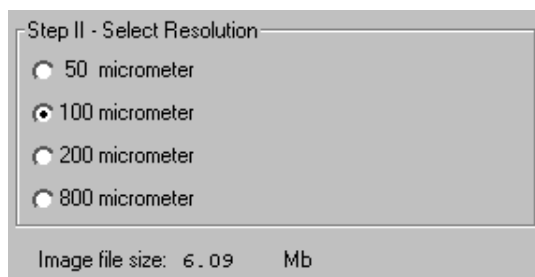


Fig. 11-4. Resolution option buttons.

The resolution you select should be based on the size of the objects (e.g., bands, spots) you are interested in. For example:

- 50 micrometer resolution should be reserved for images requiring the highest level of detail, e.g., high density in situ samples, 1,536-well microplates, high density arrays, samples with very closely spaced bands. Files scanned at 50 micrometers can be very large.
- 100 micrometer resolution should be used for typical gels and arrays.
- 200 micrometer resolution is useful for gels with large bands and dot blots.
- 800 micrometer resolution should be reserved for very large objects, such as CAT assays.

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File Size of Images

Image File Size (below Select Resolution) shows the size of the scan file you are about to create. If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to scan. If this happens, select a lower resolution or decrease the size of the area to be scanned. (Macintosh users can also increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

11.4 Acquire the Image

Once you have selected your scan area and resolution, you ready to acquire an image.

Click on the Acquire button. There may be a short delay while the image laser warms up; then the scanned image will begin to appear in the scanning window, line by line.

To interrupt a scan, click on the Stop button. A message will ask you to confirm the interrupt, and then you will be asked if you want to keep the partial scan. This feature is useful if you overestimated the size of the area you selected.

Note: If the image you are scanning has more than 10 saturated pixels, you will receive a warning message.

Saving the Image

After the scan is complete, a message will appear asking you if you want to keep the scan. If you select Yes, a separate window will pop up containing the new image.

You can then save and analyze the image using the standard menu and toolbar functions.

11.5 Options

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any scan you create, click on the Auto Save After Scan checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on Acquire, a Save As dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the Save button.

Make Backup Copy

You can automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create. To do so, first select Auto Save After Scan (see above), then select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an “.sbk” extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word “backup” after the file name.

This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Image > Transform command.

Hide Grid

To hide the gridlines in the scanning area window, click on the Hide Grid checkbox.

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12. Molecular Imager FX



Fig. 12-1. Molecular Imager FX

Before you can begin acquiring images using the Molecular Imager[®] FX, the instrument must be properly installed and connected with the host computer. See the FX hardware manual for installation, startup, and operating instructions.

Note: The FX should be turned on and the initialization sequence completed *before* the host computer is turned on (except in the case of certain Power Macintosh configurations). See the hardware manual for more details.

PC Only: A Note About SCSI Cards

The FX is connected to your computer by a Small Computer System Interface (SCSI) cable. To use the FX, you must have a SCSI card installed in your PC. If

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you have an older PC, you may also need to load the SCSI and WinASPI drivers that came with your card.

Simulation Mode

Any of the imaging device acquisition windows can be opened in “simulation mode.” In this mode, an acquisition window will open and the controls will appear active, but instead of capturing real images, the window will create “dummy” images of manufactured data.

You do not need to be connected to an imaging device to open a simulated acquisition window. This is useful for demonstration purposes or practice scans.

To enter simulation mode, hold down the CTRL key and select the name of the device from the File menu. The title of the acquisition window will indicate that it is simulated.

12.1 FX Acquisition Window

To acquire images using the FX, go to the File menu and select FX.... The acquisition window for the imager will open, displaying the control panel for the imager and the scanning area window.

Molecular Imager FX

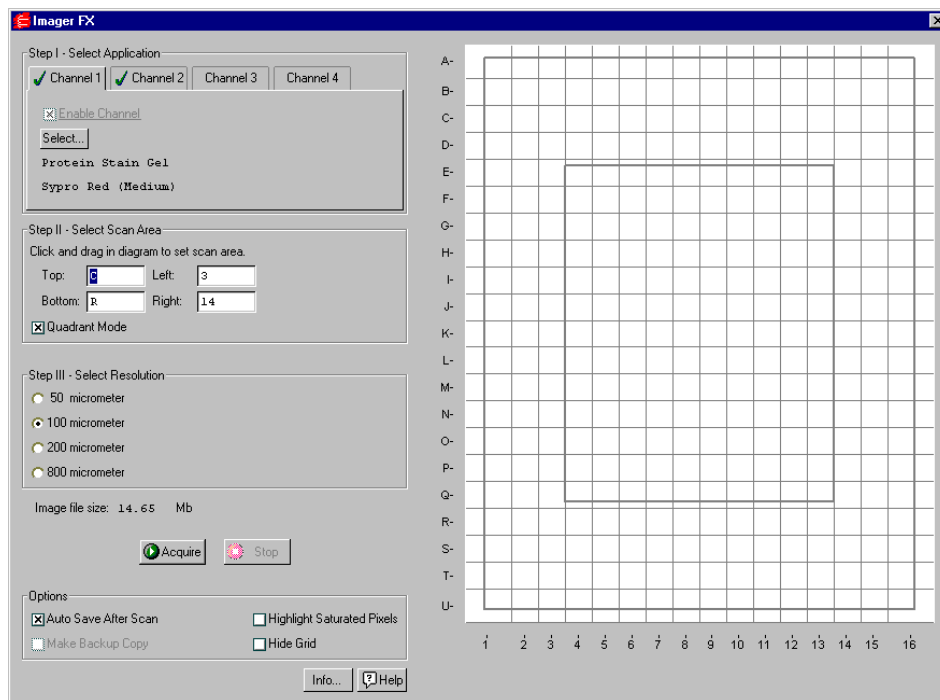


Fig. 12-2. FX acquisition window

The default scanning window is marked by grid lines that divide the area into quadrants. There is also an outer box and inner box marked by thicker lines. This conforms to the sample pad for the standard Bio-Rad Exposure Cassette that is supplied with the FX. The quadrants are numbered 1–16 left to right and lettered A–U top to bottom.

If you prefer a scanning window measured in centimeters, deselect the Quadrant Mode checkbox in the control panel by clicking on it. To hide the gridlines, click on the Hide Grid checkbox under Options.

The control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the acquisition procedure. There are four basic steps to scanning an image using the FX:

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1. Select the application(s).
2. Select the scan area.
3. Select the resolution.
4. Acquire the image.

12.2 Step I. Select Application

In Step 1, you select the appropriate filters and other scanning parameters for the type of gel, blot, plate, or other object that you are imaging. Each set of parameters you select is called an “application.”

The FX now supports multi-channel sequential scanning. This allows you to automatically scan the same object using up to four different applications (e.g., to detect different types of stains on the same gel).

First you select a channel, then you select the application under that channel.

12.2.a Selecting a Channel

The four channels are accessed using the tabs under Step 1. Channel 1 is always enabled—that is, the FX will always scan using the application settings selected under Channel 1 first.

To enable any of the remaining channels, click on a channel tab, then select the Enable Channel checkbox and select the application for that channel as described in the following section.

Molecular Imager FX

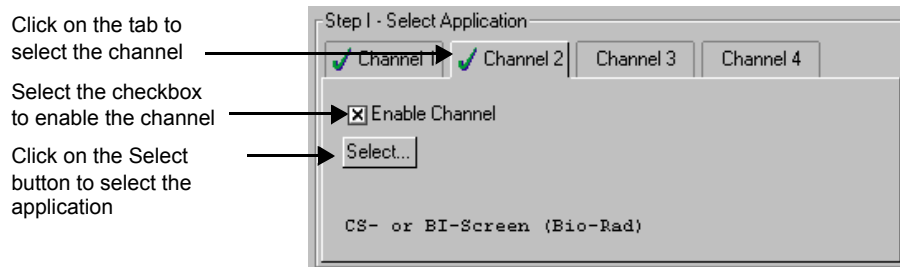


Fig. 12-3. Enabling Channel 2.

Enabled channels have a green check mark on their tabs.

You do not need to enable Channels 2–4 in sequence. For example, you can set up your four most common applications using the different channels, but only enable Channel 4 for a particular gel. Channel 1 would be scanned first, Channel 4 second.

Enabled channels are scanned sequentially. The separate scans are displayed and saved as separate images. The total scanning time depends on the number and type of enabled applications.

If you have selected Auto Save After Scan, the image created using Channel 1 will have the base file name, and images created using subsequent channels will have the base file name plus a version number. (v. 2, v. 3, v. 4). Note that the image version number does not necessarily correspond to the channel number. For example, if you scanned an image using only Channels 1 and 4, the image created using Channel 4 will be saved as version 2 (v. 2).

12.2.b Selecting an Application

To select an application (i.e., the appropriate filter and other parameters for the type of object you are imaging), click on the Select button under a channel tab.

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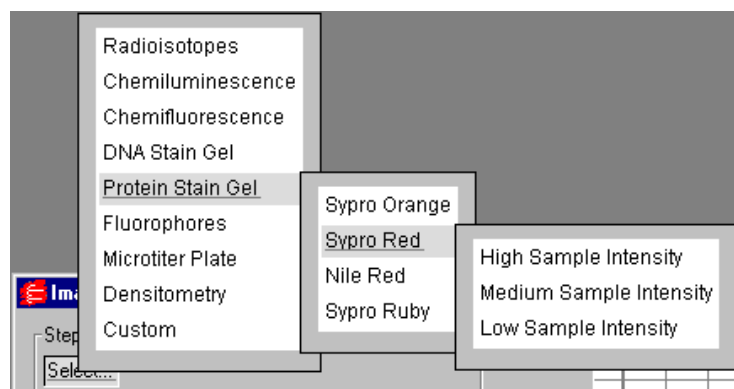


Fig. 12-4. Example of an application tree: Ethidium Bromide gel.

Standard Applications

The standard applications and associated settings are listed in a tree that expands from left to right. When you select a standard application, the software automatically selects the appropriate filter(s) in the FX for that particular application.

Standard FX Applications

Category	Application
Radioisotopes	CS- or BI-Screen (Bio-Rad) K-Screen (Kodak) Fuji-Screen
Chemiluminescence	Chemi-Screen (Bio-Rad)
Chemifluorescence	ECL-Plus Attophos
DNA Stain Gel	Ethidium Bromide Sybr Green I & II Sybr Gold

Molecular Imager FX

Standard FX Applications

Protein Stain Gel	Sypro Orange Sypro Red Nile Red Sypro Ruby
Fluorophores	Alexa 488 Alexa 532 Alexa 546 FITC FAM CY3 HEX R6G Texas Red
Microtiter Plate	DNA (Sybr Green I) Protein (Nano Orange) ssDNA (Oligreen) DNA (Picogreen) B-Gal (FDG) GUS (FDG)
Densitometry	Coomassie Blue Gel/Blot Copper Stain Gel/Blot Silver Stain Gel/Blot X-Ray Film (Grey Type)

First select your general application, next select the particular stain or medium you are using, and finally (if appropriate) select the intensity of your samples.

Note: Some applications require an external laser. If you choose one of these without having an external laser attached, you will receive a warning.

To exit the tree without selecting, press the ESC key.

Your selection will be displayed below the Select button.

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Sample Intensity

Many FX applications require that you select a sample intensity (High, Medium, or Low) from the application tree. This is simply a rough estimate of how much sample is visible in your gel or other object.

If you are unsure of the level of intensity of your sample, you can always select a level, capture an image, then adjust the level and capture another image.

For example, if you select Low Sample Intensity and the resulting image has too many saturated pixels, you will receive a warning message. Simply change the setting to Medium Sample Intensity and rescan. If you select High Sample Intensity and the resulting image is too faint, select Medium or Low and rescan.

Custom Applications

If your application is not listed, if you want to use user-installed filters, or if you want to use an external laser, you can create and save your own custom application.

From the application tree, select Custom, then Create. This will open a dialog box in which you can name your application and select your settings.

Molecular Imager FX

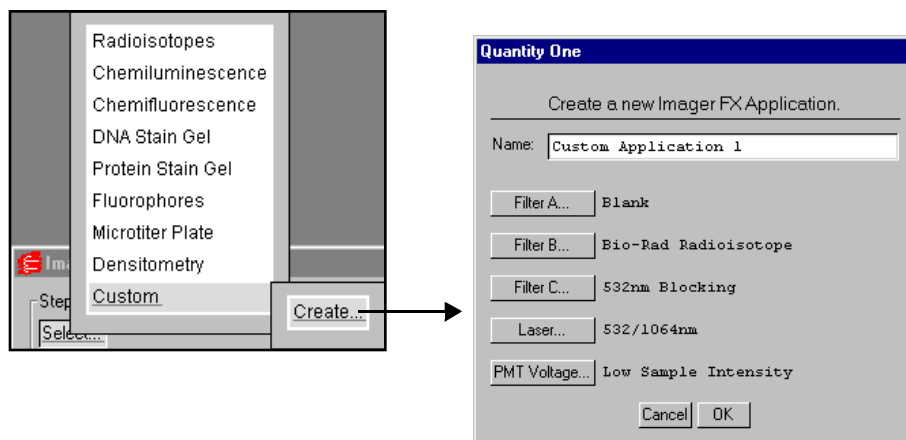


Fig. 12-5. Creating a custom application.

To select a filter (including user-defined) or filter combination, click on the buttons for Filters A, B, and C, and make your choice from each pop-up list.

Note: The user-defined filters (User1, User2, etc.) cannot be renamed in the pop-up list, so be sure to remember which filter you insert into each position in the FX.

To use an external laser, click on the Laser button and select it from the pop-up list. Otherwise, use the default internal laser (532/1064nm).

Click on the PMT Voltage button to select a standard voltage for your custom application or create a custom PMT voltage.

To select a custom voltage, click on the Custom option. In the dialog box, adjust the slider to select a PMT voltage as a percentage of the maximum.

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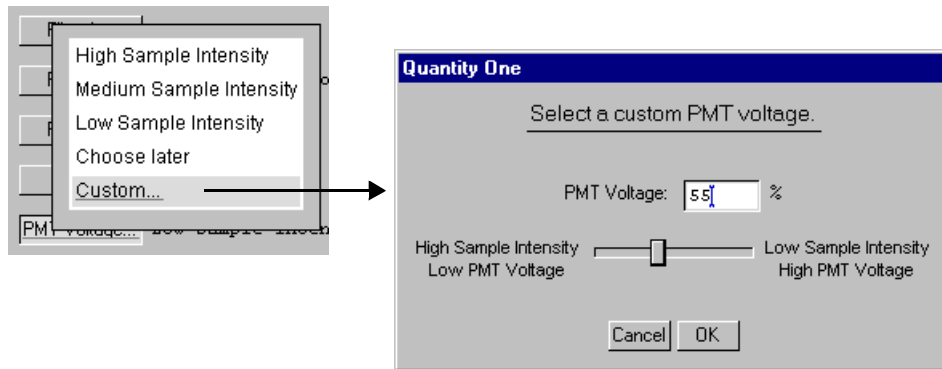


Fig. 12-6. Selecting a custom PMT voltage.

Note: For voltages above 80% of maximum, you will receive a warning message that the high voltage could damage the PMT.

If you select Choose Later from the list of PMT voltages, the choices of sample intensity will be displayed when you select your custom application.

Finally, enter a name for your application in the Name field and click on OK to implement your changes.

After you have created an application, you can select it from the application tree by selecting Custom and the name you created. You can delete the application by selecting Custom, Delete, and the name of the application.

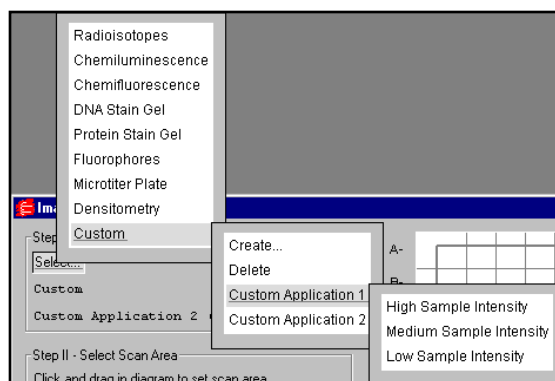


Fig. 12-7. Selecting a custom application.

12.3 Step II. Select Scan Area

To select a scan area, drag your mouse within the scanning window. (In the scanning window, your cursor appearance will change to a cross.) The border of the scan area you are selecting is marked by a frame.

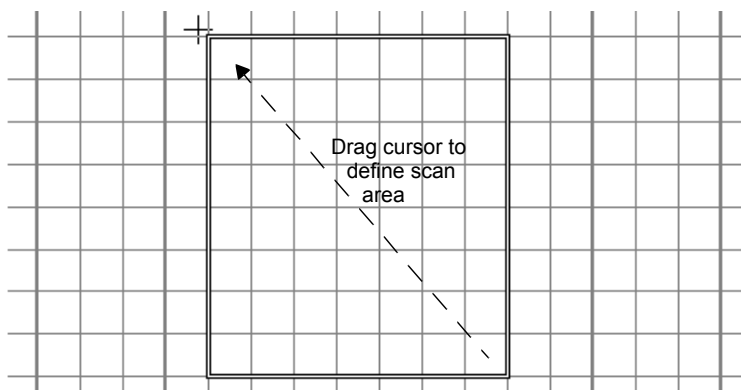


Fig. 12-8. Selecting a scan area.

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If you are in quadrant mode, note that the frame “locks” onto the next quadrant as you drag. When you release the mouse button, the border changes to a dashed blue line, indicating a selected area.

- To *reposition* the scanning box you have selected, position your cursor inside the box and drag. The entire box will move.
- To *resize* the box, position your cursor on a box side and drag. The side you have selected will move.
- To *redo* the box entirely, position your cursor outside the box and drag. The old box will disappear and a new box will be created.

You can also select the scanning area by entering coordinates in the appropriate fields (Top, Bottom, Left, Right). After you enter a coordinate, the position of the scanning area box will change accordingly.

When selecting, be sure to include the entire area of interest, and be generous with borders. You can always crop the image later.

12.4 Step III. Select Resolution

The FX acquisition window allows you to scan at 50, 100, 200, or 800 micrometers. These resolutions are listed as option buttons in the control panel.

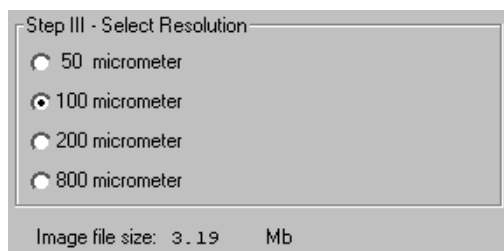


Fig. 12-9. Resolution option buttons.

The resolution you select should be based on the size of the objects (e.g., bands, spots) you are interested in. For example:

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- 50 micrometer resolution should be reserved for images requiring the highest level of detail, e.g., high density in situ samples, 1,536-well microplates, high density arrays, samples with very closely spaced bands. Files scanned at 50 micrometers can be very large.
- 100 micrometer resolution is useful for typical gels and arrays.
- 200 micrometer resolution is useful for gels with large bands and dot blots.
- 800 micrometer resolution should be reserved for very large objects, such as CAT assays.

File Size of Images

Image File Size (below Select Resolution) shows the size of the scan file you are about to create. If you do not have enough computer memory for the specified file size, an error message will appear when you attempt to scan. If this happens, select a lower resolution or decrease the size of the area to be scanned. (Macintosh users can also increase the application memory partition. See your Macintosh computer documentation for guidance.)

12.5 Acquire the Image

Once you have selected your application, scan area, and resolution, you are ready to acquire an image.

Click on the Acquire button. There may be a short delay while the image laser warms up; then the scanned image will begin to appear in the scanning window, line by line.

To interrupt a scan, click on the Stop button. A message will ask you to confirm the interrupt, and then you will be asked if you want to keep the partial scan. This feature is useful if you overestimated the size of the area you selected.

Note: If the image you are scanning has more than 10 saturated pixels, you will receive a warning message. If this happens, you can go back and select a higher sample intensity in the application tree.

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Saving the Image

After the scan is complete, a message will appear asking you if you want to keep the scan. If you select Yes, a separate window will pop up containing the new image.

You can then save and analyze the image using the standard menu and toolbar functions.

12.6 Options

Auto Save After Scan

To automatically save any scan you create, click on the Auto Save After Scan checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you click on Acquire, a Save As dialog box will open asking you to specify a file name and location for the image you are about to create. The scan will begin when you click on the Save button.

If you are scanning using multiple channels, the image created using Channel 1 will be saved using the base file name, and images created using subsequent channels will have the base file name plus a version number. (v. 2, v. 3, v. 4). Note that the image version number does not necessarily correspond to the channel number. For example, if you scanned an image using only Channels 1 and 4, the image created using Channel 4 will still be saved as version 2 (v. 2).

Make Backup Copy

You can automatically create a backup copy of any scan you create. To do so, first select Auto Save After Scan (see above), then select the Make Backup Copy checkbox.

With this checkbox selected, when you save a scan, a backup copy will be placed in the same directory as the scanned image. Windows backup files will have an ".sbk" extension. Macintosh backup files will have the word "backup" after the file name.

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This backup copy will be read-only, which means that you cannot make changes to it. You can open it like a normal file, but you must save it under a different file name before editing the image or performing analysis.

Highlight Saturated Pixels

When this box is checked, any saturated pixels in the image will appear highlighted in red in the scan window and in the pop-up image window. To view/hide saturated pixels in the pop-up image window, use the Image > Transform command.

Hide Grid

To hide the gridlines in the scanning area window, click on the Hide Grid checkbox.

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13. Viewing and Editing Images

This chapter describes the viewing tools for magnifying and optimizing your images. This chapter also describes the tools for cropping, flipping, and rotating images, reducing background intensity and filtering noise, and adding text overlays to images.

These tools are located on the View, Image, and Edit menus.

Note: The following chapters contain instructions for analyzing X-ray films, wet and dry gels, blots, and photographs. For the sake of simplicity, these are all referred to as “gels.”

13.1 Magnifying and Positioning Tools

The magnifying and positioning tools are located on the View menu and Window menu; some of these functions are also found on the main toolbar.

These commands will only change how the image is displayed on your computer screen. *They will not change the underlying data.*

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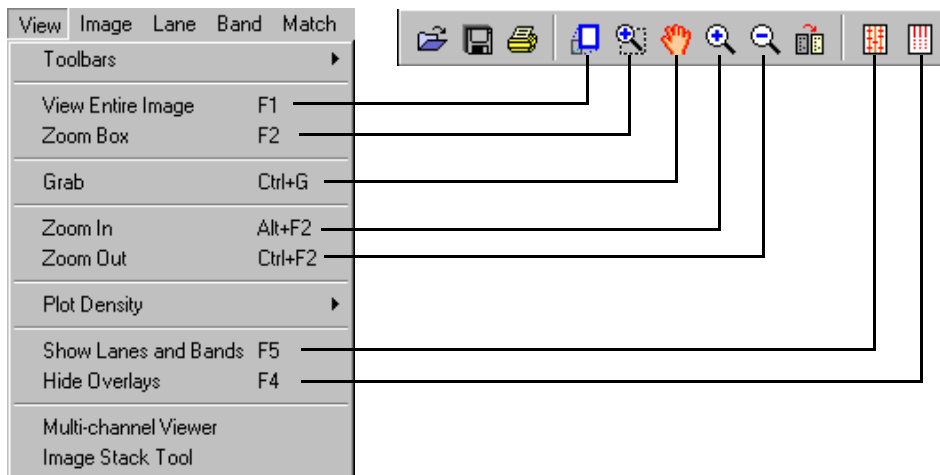


Fig. 13-1. Viewing functions on View menu and main toolbar.

Zoom Box

Zoom Box allows you to select a small area of the image to magnify so that it fills the entire image window.

First, click on the Zoom Box button on your Main toolbar or select View > Zoom Box. Your cursor arrow will change to a cross. Then drag the cursor on the image to enclose the area you want to magnify, and release the mouse button. The area of the image you selected will be magnified to fill the entire window.

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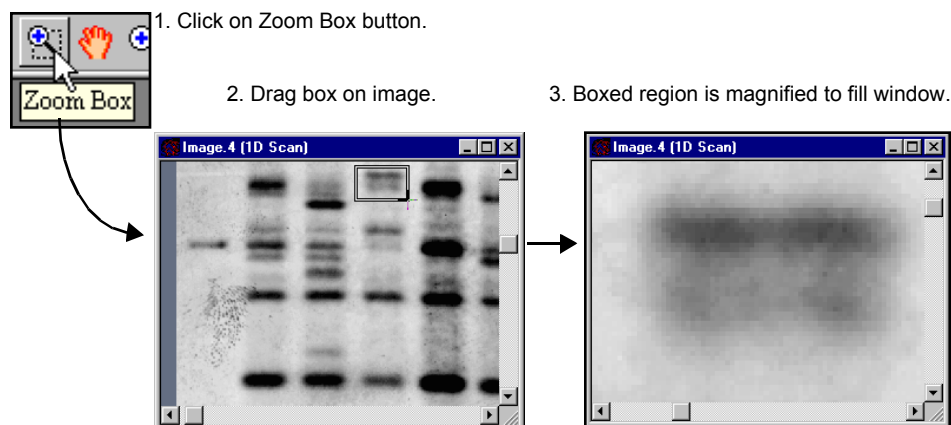


Fig. 13-2. Zoom Box tool.

Zoom In/Zoom Out

These tools work like standard magnifying tools in other applications.

Click on the Zoom In or Zoom Out button on your main toolbar (or select from the View menu). Your cursor will change to a magnifying glass. Click on an area of the image to zoom in or zoom out a defined amount, determined by the setting in the Edit > Preferences dialog box.

Grab

This tool allows you to change the position of your image in the image window. Select View > Grab or click on the Grab button. Your cursor will change to a "hand" symbol. Dragging the Grab symbol on the image will move the image in any direction.

Arrow Keys

You can also move your image inside the image window by using the ARROW keys on your keyboard. Click on an arrow button to shift the image

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incrementally within the window. The amount the image shifts is determined by the Pan % setting in the Preferences dialog box.

View Entire Image

If you have magnified part of an image or moved part of an image out of view, View Entire Image returns to the original, full view of the image.

Centering an Image

You can center the image window on any point in an image quickly and easily using the F3 key command. This is useful if you are comparing the same region on two gel images and want to center both image windows on the same point.

Position your cursor on the point on the image that you want at the center of the image window, then press the F3 key. The image will shift so that point is at the center of the image window.

Imitate Zoom

If you are comparing two or more images and want to zoom in on the same area on all of them, use the Imitate Zoom command.

First zoom in on one of the images. Then, with that image window still selected (the title bar will be blue), select Imitate Zoom from the Window menu.

The zoom factor and region of the selected image will be applied to all the images.

Note: Imitate zoom will only work on comparable images with similar dimensions.

Tiling Windows

If you have more than one image open, the Tile commands on the Window menu allow you to arrange your images neatly on the screen.

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Tile will resize your windows and arrange them on the screen left to right and top to bottom.

Tile Vertical will resize your windows and arrange them side-by-side on the screen.

Tile Horizontal will resize your windows and stack them top-to-bottom on the screen

13.2 Density Tools

The Density Tools (on the View > Plot Density submenu and the Density Tools toolbar) are designed to provide a quick measure of the signal intensity of the data in your image.

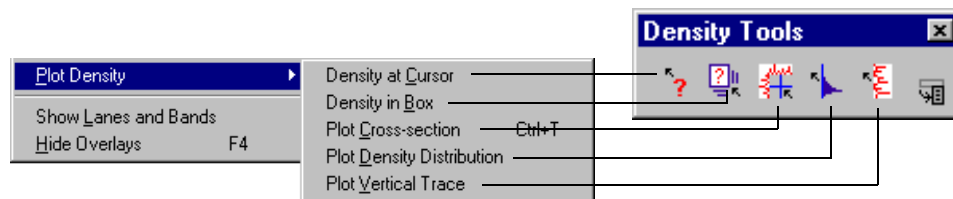


Fig. 13-3. Density tools on the menu and toolbar.

Note: The density traces will appear slightly different than the traces for functions like Plot Lane or Plot Band, because the sampling width for the density traces is only one pixel.

Density at Cursor

Density at Cursor displays the signal intensity of the pixel on the image where you click your mouse. It also shows the average intensity for a 3 x 3 pixel box centered on that point.

To use this tool, click on the Density at Cursor button on the Density toolbar or select View > Plot Density > Density at Cursor. Then click on the point of interest on the image.

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Density in Box

Density in Box displays the average and total intensity within a boxed region on the image. Select Density in Box from the Density toolbar or View menu, then define the region you want to measure by dragging your cursor across the image.

Plot Density Distribution

Plot Density Distribution displays a histogram of the signal intensity distribution for the part of the image displayed in the image window. The average intensity is marked in yellow on the histogram.

The histogram will appear along the right side of the image. Use the Zoom functions to display the histogram for magnified regions of your image.

Plot Cross-section

Plot Cross-section displays an intensity trace of a cross-section of the image centered on the point where you click your mouse. The horizontal trace is displayed along the top of the image, and the vertical trace is displayed along the side of the image.

The intensity at the point you clicked on is displayed, as is the maximum intensity along the lines of the cross-section. Dragging the mouse with this function selected will continuously update the display.

Note: The density traces will appear slightly different than the traces for functions like Plot Lane or Plot Band, because the sampling width for the density traces is only one pixel.

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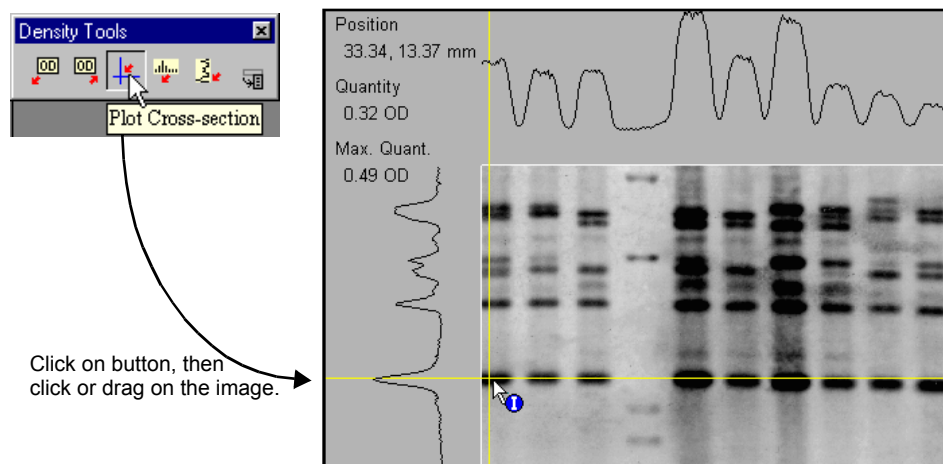


Fig. 13-4. Plot Cross-section tool.

Plot Vertical Trace

Plot Vertical Trace plots an intensity trace of a vertical cross-section of the image centered on the point where you click your mouse. Dragging the mouse with this function selected will continuously update the display.

Note: The density traces will appear slightly different than the traces for functions like Plot Lane or Plot Band, because the sampling width for the density traces is only one pixel.

13.3 Showing and Hiding Overlays

To conceal all plots, traces, info boxes, and overlays on an image, select Hide Overlays from the main toolbar or View menu.

Note: Clicking once on Hide Overlays will conceal the overlays. Clicking twice will deassign any function that has been assigned to the mouse.

To redisplay the lane and band overlays, select Show Lanes and Bands from the View menu or main toolbar.

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13.4 Multi-Channel Viewer

You can use the Multi-Channel Viewer to distinguish different types and levels of fluorescence in a gel that has been imaged at different wavelengths. The Multi-Channel Viewer can be used to merge the information from up to three different images of the same gel.

Note: The Multi-Channel Viewer requires that the images being compared are exactly the size. When capturing the images, you should be careful not to move the gel between exposures. If your images are not exactly the same size, you can use the Crop tool to resize them.

With at least one image open, select Multi-Channel Viewer from the View menu. The topmost open image will be displayed in the viewer window using the Red channel.

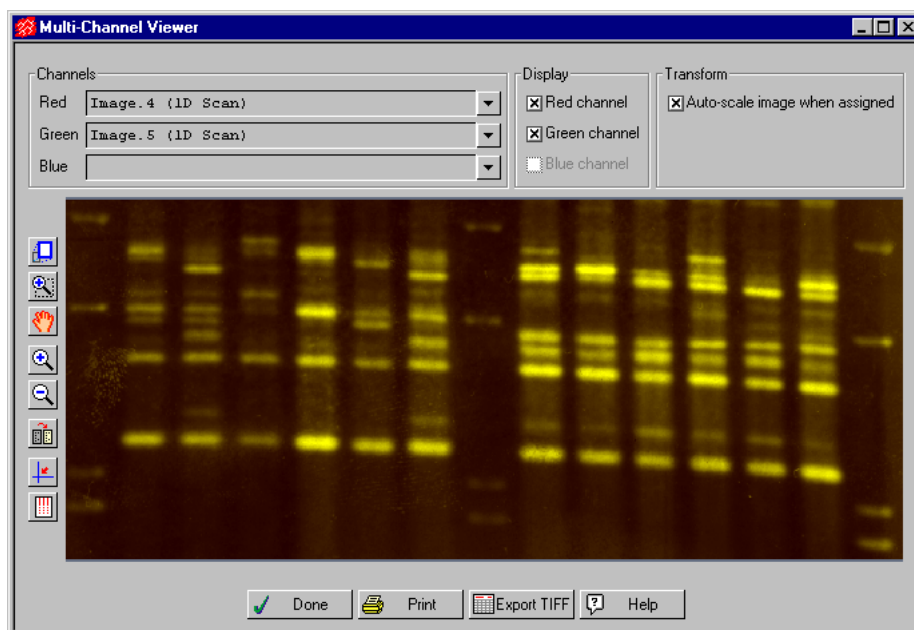


Fig. 13-5. Multi-Channel Viewer.

Viewing and Editing Images

Note: Note that the color channel used to display an image in the viewer has no relation to the filter used when capturing the image. The red, green, and blue channels are simply designed to distinguish different images.

The image name is displayed in the Red name field at the top of the viewer, and the Red channel checkbox will appear selected.

To add another image, make sure the image is open and click on the pulldown button next to the Green or Blue name field. Select the image name from the pulldown list. Add a third image using the same procedure.

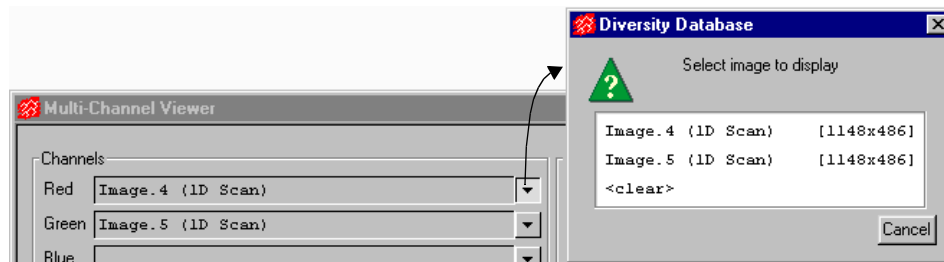


Fig. 13-6. Selecting images to display in the viewer.

You can reassign the different images to different channels using the pulldown buttons to the right of the name fields. Select <clear> from the pulldown list to remove an image from that channel of the viewer.

Viewing Options

To remove a particular color channel from the display, click in the checkbox associated with that channel to deselect it.

Selecting the Auto-Scale Image When Assigned checkbox will automatically adjust the brightness and contrast of each loaded image based on the data range in the image. It invokes the Auto-scale command from the Transform window when an image is first opened in the viewer. Note that this setting affects only how the image is displayed in the viewer, not the actual data.

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Note: If you deselect this checkbox, any images currently displayed will remain auto-scaled. Click on the Transform button in the viewer and click on the Reset button in the Transform window to undo auto-scaling.

Buttons for various viewing tools are included in the Multi-Channel Viewer. Commands such as Zoom Box and Grab will change the display of all the images in the viewer at once.

Note that if you open the Transform window, you can adjust the display of each channel independently, by selecting the appropriate channel option button in the Transform window. Similarly, the Plot Cross-section command will report the intensity of each channel separately.

Exporting and Printing

You can export a 24-bit TIFF image of your merged view by clicking on the Export button. This will open a version of the Export to TIFF dialog. Note that you cannot export image data from the Multi-Channel Viewer—only the current view of the image (designated as Publishing Mode in the Export dialog). The colors in the viewer will be preserved in the exported TIFF image.

You can also print a copy of your merged view to a color or grayscale printer by clicking on the Print button.

13.5 Image Stack Tool

The Image Stack Tool allows you to scroll through a series of related gel images layered on top of one another. Using this tool, you can easily compare bands or other data objects that may appear, disappear, or change size in different gels run under different conditions.

Note: Your images should be close to the same size with bands in the same relative positions to use this tool. You can use the Crop tool to resize images.

With all your images open, select Image Stack Tool from the View menu. The Image Stack Tool window will open.

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Fig. 13-7. Image Stack Tool.

In the Image Stack Tool window, all available gels will be listed in the field to the right of the display window. To select an image to display, click on a gel name. The name will appear highlighted with an arrow and the image will appear in the window.

Click on another gel name to display that image.

Using the controls below the list of names, you can “step” through the images in the stacker. First, highlight some or all of the gel names using standard Shift-Click or Control-Click commands. When multiple names are selected, the Step arrow buttons will become active. Click on the arrow buttons to scroll through the list of selected gels.

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Alternatively, click on the Auto checkbox next to the arrow buttons to begin automatically scrolling through the list. You can adjust the auto-scroll speed using the Slow-Fast slider.

Buttons for various viewing tools are included in the Multi-Channel Viewer. These commands will change the display of all the images in the stacker at once (e.g., zooming in on one image will magnify the same relative area in all the images).

13.6 Colors

Edit > Colors opens a dialog box in which you can adjust the colors of the image, windows, buttons, etc.

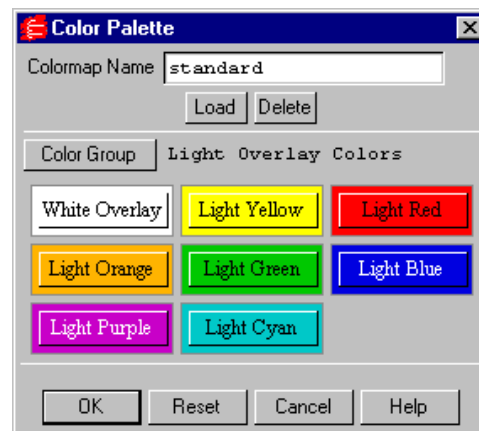


Fig. 13-8. Colors dialog box.

Selecting a Color Group

Within the dialog box, the Color Group button allows you to select the colors of a particular group of objects (e.g., pop-up boxes, image colors, etc.). Click on the button to open the list of objects you can change.

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Fig. 13-9. List of Color Groups.

Click on a color group in the list to select it.

Changing a Color

After you have selected the color group to change, click on the specific color button to change. The Color Edit dialog box will open, allowing you to adjust the red-green-blue (RGB) values of the color you selected.

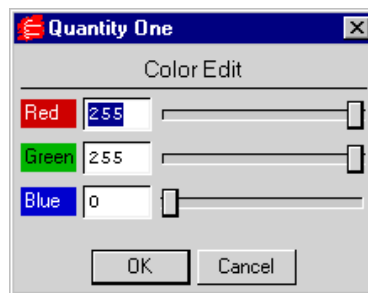


Fig. 13-10. Color Edit dialog box.

Drag the sliders or enter a value in the fields. The color of the button will change with your adjustments.

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Saving/Selecting a Defined Set of Colors

After you have changed the colors within color groups, you can save these settings for future use on other images. The Colormap Name field displays the name of a defined set of colors and color groups. There are several predefined colormaps, or you can create your own.

To select a predefined colormap, click on the Load button.

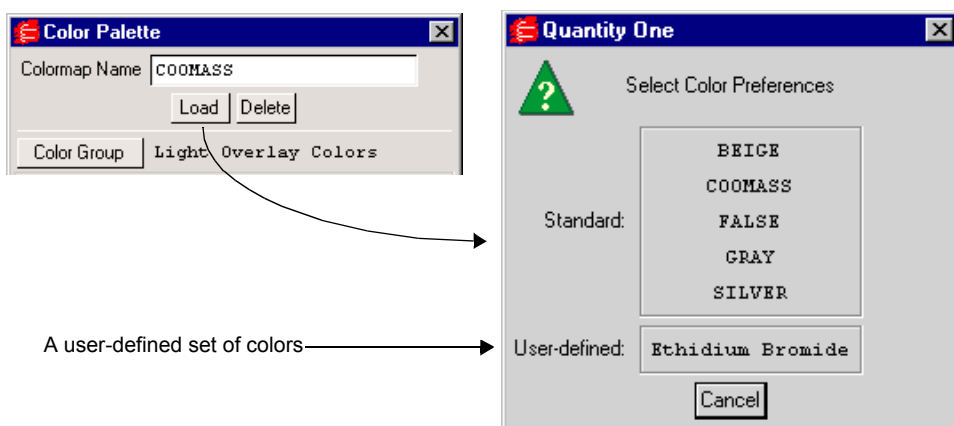


Fig. 13-11. Selecting a Colormap.

From the list displayed, click on the set of colors you want to apply.

To create your own colormap, adjust the colors within the color groups as described above and type in a new colormap name. Click on OK to apply your changes.

To remove a colormap, click on the Delete button. Select the colormap to be deleted from the displayed list. A pop-up box will ask you to confirm the deletion.

If you change your mind about applying any changes you make, click on the Cancel button. If you want to return to the Standard colormap, click on the Reset button. All colors will be returned to their default values.

13.7 Transform

If features in your image are indistinct or fine details appear to be lost in background noise, you can use the Transform functions to optimize your displayed image. To open the Transform dialog box, select Image > Transform, or click on the Transform button on the main toolbar.



Fig. 13-12. Transform command.

The Transform dialog box contains a Preview Window, a Frequency Distribution histogram, a Transform Plot, and three main methods of optimizing your image: Auto-scale, High and Low sliders, and a Gamma slider. You can use these controls to adjust the way the software transforms raw data into visual data.

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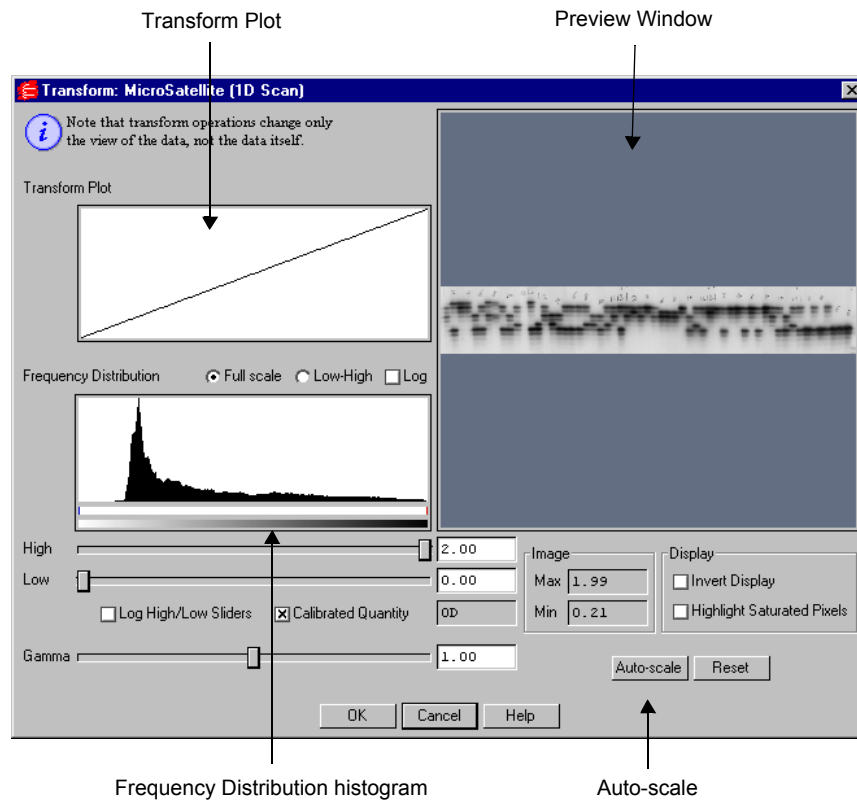


Fig. 13-13. Transform dialog box.

Note: Any changes made with the Transform controls will only affect how the image is displayed on your screen. *They will not affect the underlying data.*

13.7.a Transform Subwindows

Preview Window

The Preview Window in the Transform dialog shows a smaller view of the same image that is displayed in the main image window. Changes in the

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Transform controls are automatically reflected in the Preview Window. They are only applied to the main image when you click on OK.

You can use view tools like Zoom Box and View Entire Image in the Preview Window just as you can in the main image window, to focus on particular regions of interest. You can also use Grab and the ARROW keys to move the image within the Preview Window.

Frequency Distribution Histogram

The Frequency Distribution histogram shows the total data range in the image and the amount of data at each point in the range. In a typical scan, there is a signal spike at the left (“gray”) end of the histogram due to background noise.

Transform Plot

The Transform Plot is a logarithmic representation of how the raw pixel data are mapped to the pixels of your computer screen.

13.7.b Transform Controls

Auto-scale

Clicking on the Auto-scale button will optimize your image automatically. The lightest part of the image will be set to the minimum intensity (e.g., white), and the darkest will be set to the maximum intensity (e.g., black). This enhances minor variations in the image, making fine details easier to see. You can then “fine-tune” the display using the High, Low, and Gamma sliders described below.

High/Low Sliders

If Auto-scale doesn’t give you the appearance you want, you can use the High and Low sliders to redraw the image yourself. Dragging the High slider handle to the left will make weak signals appear darker. Dragging the Low slider handle to the right will reduce background noise.

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As you drag the sliders, the slider markers on the Frequency Distribution histogram will move. Everything to the left of the Low marker will be remapped to minimum intensity, while everything to the right of the High marker will be remapped to maximum intensity. Using the histogram, you can position the markers at either end of the data range in your image, and use the low slider to cut off the “spike” of background noise.

You can also type specific High and Low values in the text boxes next to the sliders. Clicking anywhere on the slider bars will move the sliders incrementally.

Log High/Low Sliders changes the feedback from the slider handles, so that when you drag them, the slider markers move a shorter distance in the histogram. This allows for finer adjustments when your data is in a narrow range.

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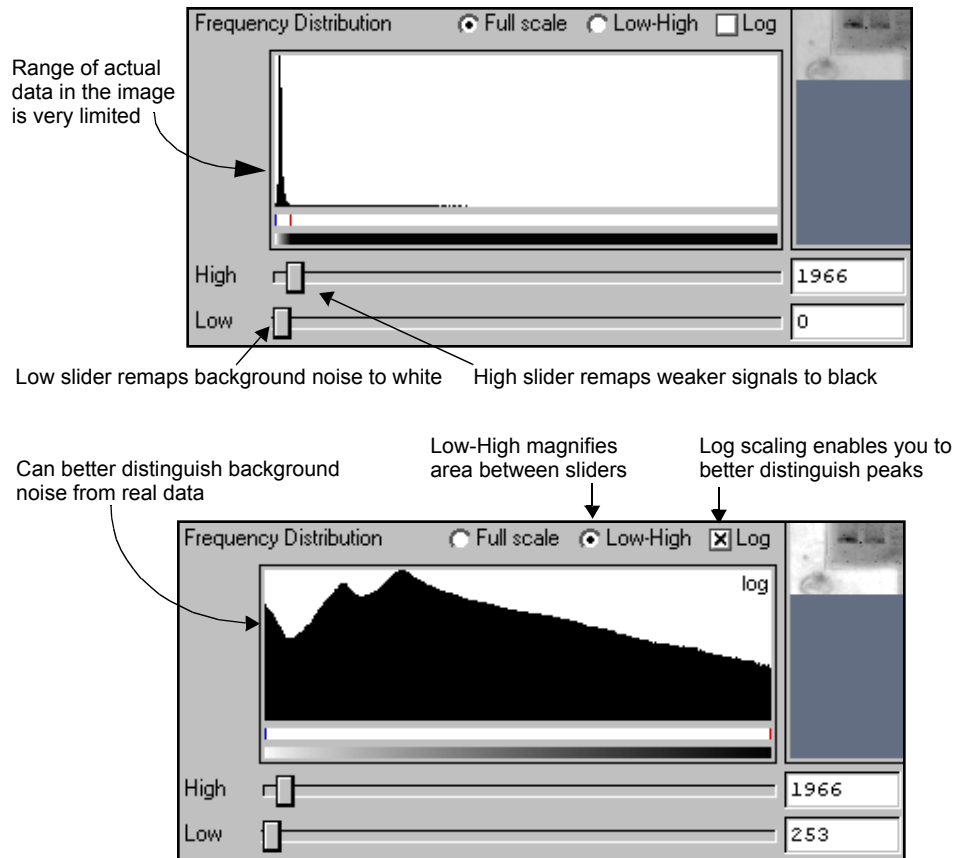


Fig. 13-14. Two views of the Frequency Distribution histogram.

Gamma Slider

Some images may be more effectively visualized if their data are mapped to the computer screen in a nonlinear fashion. Adjusting the Gamma slider handle expands or compresses the contrast range at the dark or light end of the range, and this is reflected in the Transform Plot and Preview Window.

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13.7.c Other Features

Full Scale/Low-High

The Full Scale/Low-High option buttons adjust how the range of data in the image is displayed in the Frequency Distribution histogram and Transform Plot. They do not change how the data is displayed in the image window.

Selecting Full Scale adjusts the Frequency Distribution and Transform Plot displays so they show the full intensity range of the image.

Selecting From Low to High magnifies the range between the Low and High sliders. This makes it easier to view your data if it does not occupy the full intensity range of the image.

Log

The Log checkbox changes the way the data is displayed in the histogram so you can better discern subtle changes in signal intensity.

Image Max/Min and Units

Image Max and Min display the range of signal intensity in the image.

The image units are determined by the type of scanner used to create the image. For images measured in O.D.s, you can display the max and min O.D values in the image by selecting the Calibrated Quantity checkbox. If this box is unselected, the max and min numeric pixel values are displayed.

Invert Display

The Invert Display checkbox flips light bands on a dark background to dark bands on a light background, and visa versa. Once, again, the actual data will not change—only the image.

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Highlight Saturated Pixels

When the Highlight Saturated Pixels checkbox is selected, areas of the image with saturated signal intensity are highlighted in red.

Reset

If at any time you want to return to an unmodified view of the scan data, click on Reset.

13.8 Resizing and Reorienting Images

Frequently, your images will require some editing prior to analysis. This section describes the features that allow you to change the size and orientation of your images.

The image editing tools are located on the Image menu and the Image toolbar.

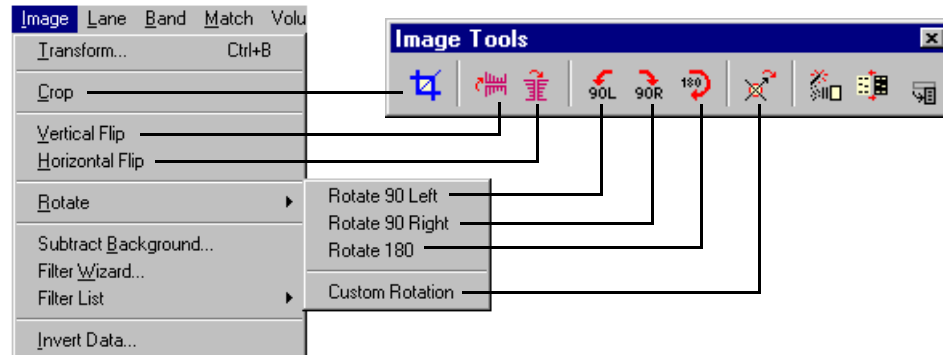


Fig. 13-15. Resizing and reorienting tools.

Note: Many of these image editing commands are irreversible. A pop-up alert box will ask you to confirm each edit that will change your image irreversibly.

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13.8.a Cropping Images

To eliminate unwanted parts of an image, you can use the Crop tool. This is also an easy way to reduce the file size of an image.

To crop, click on the Crop button on the Image toolbar or select Image > Crop. Your cursor appearance will change to a Crop symbol.

Define the region to be cropped by dragging the cursor across the image, creating a box. Everything outside the box will be deleted.

Information about the physical dimensions of the crop area (given in millimeters and number of pixels) is listed at the bottom of the crop box, as is information about the memory size of the image inside the crop area.

1. To *reposition* the crop box, position your cursor at the center of the box. The cursor appearance will change to a multidirectional arrow symbol. You can then drag the box to a new position.
2. To *resize* the box, position your cursor on a box border or corner. The cursor appearance will change to a bidirectional arrow. You can then drag that border or corner in or out, resizing the box.
3. To *redraw* the box, position your cursor outside the box. The cursor appearance will change back to the Crop tool, and you can draw another box, replacing the one you just drew.

Once you are satisfied with your crop box, position your cursor within the box slightly off-center. The cursor appearance will change to a scissors symbol. You can then click on the mouse to perform the crop.

A pop-up box will ask you whether you want to: (1) crop the original image, (2) save a copy of the area inside the crop box as a separate image, keeping the original image intact, or (3) cancel out of the cropping operation.

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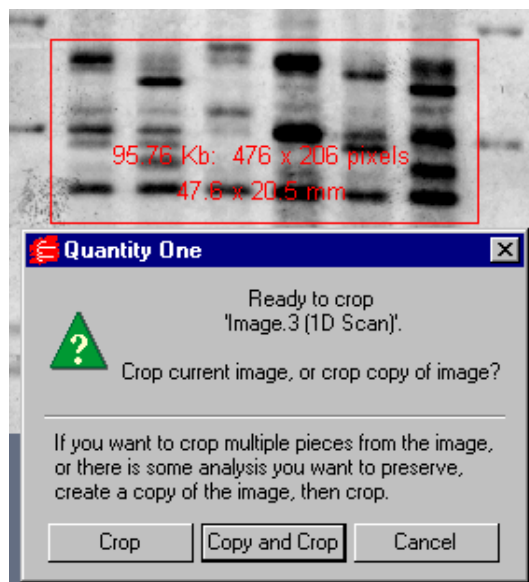


Fig. 13-16. Crop box and pop-up Crop dialog.

If you select the Copy and Crop button, a dialog box will be displayed in which you can enter the name of the cropped image and its version number. Click on the OK button once you have finished.

13.8.b Flipping and Rotating Images

If your image is not properly oriented, you can flip and/or rotate the image.

Note: These actions will erase any overlays you have created or analysis you have performed on an image. You will be asked to confirm the flip/rotation before the command is executed.

Flipping

To flip the image right-to-left, select Horizontal Flip from the Image menu or toolbar. To flip the image top-to-bottom, select Vertical Flip.

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90° Rotations

Select Rotate 90 Left, Rotate 90 Right, or Rotate 180 from the Image > Rotate menu or Image toolbar to perform the specified rotation. You will be asked to confirm your choice before the command is executed.

Custom Rotation

If you need to rotate your image in increments other than 90°, you can use the Custom Rotation command.

Select Custom Rotation from the Image > Rotate menu or Image toolbar. A green “plus” sign will appear next to your cursor. Click on the image you want to rotate and a circular overlay with an orange arrow will appear. A small dialog box also will open, indicating the angle of rotation in degrees and radians.

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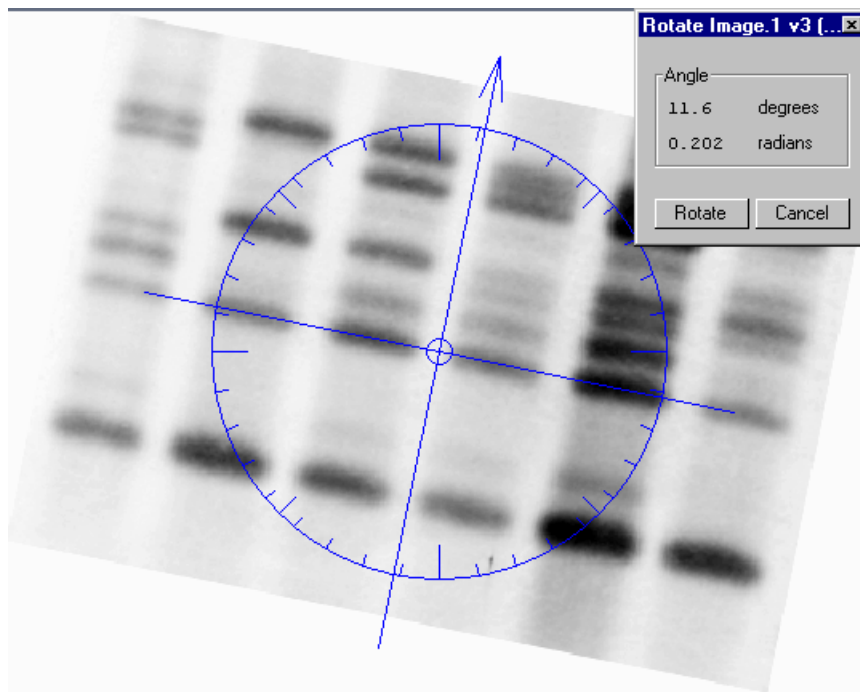


Fig. 13-17. Custom rotation; the arrow points in the direction of the new top of the image.

To perform the rotation, position your cursor on the arrowhead and drag. As you drag, the arrow will rotate and the angle in the dialog box will change. Position the arrow so that it points in the direction of the new top of the image. You can “fine-tune” your rotation as much as you like.

Note: If you want to center your arrow on a particular point on the image (e.g., to align along a particular lane), you can use the F3 key command. Position your cursor on the point on the image you want to center on, and press the F3 key. The image will move so that the center of the arrow and your cursor point are aligned.

To complete the rotation, click on the Rotate button in the small dialog box. Another, smaller image window will open containing the rotated image. You

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will then have the option of renaming your new image and changing the version number.

If you are not satisfied with your rotated image, simply delete it and start over.

Note: Because an image is composed of square or rectangular pixels, Custom Rotation has to perform some minor smoothing on the image to turn it at a non-90° angle. In addition, any analysis performed on the image cannot be rotated and will be lost.

13.9 Subtracting Background from Entire Images

There are a number of tools for subtracting background intensity from images to improve the clarity of your data. This section describes background subtraction for the entire image.

You can also subtract background from individual lanes (see Chapter 14) and volumes (see Chapter 17).

Whole-image background subtraction is useful for reducing background resulting from the opacity of the carrier medium (film, gel matrix, or blot matrix) or film fogging.

Note: Whole-image background subtraction is an irreversible process. You will be asked if you want to make a copy of the image before completing the operation.

To open the dialog box for performing whole-image background subtraction, select Image > Subtract Background.

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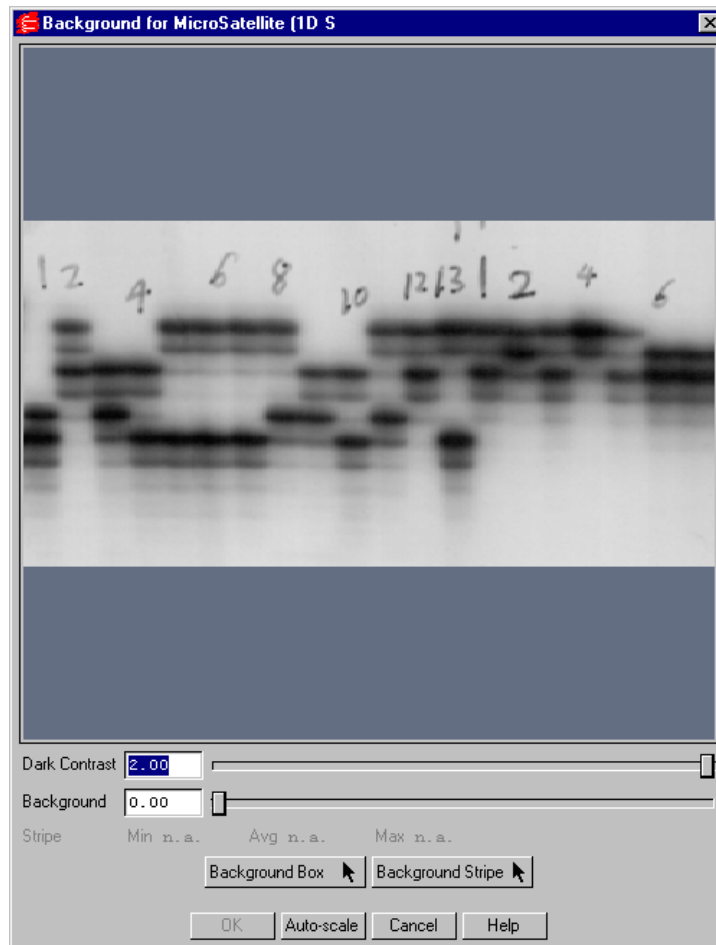


Fig. 13-18. Subtract Background dialog box.

The Subtract Background dialog box has a Preview Window, which contains a smaller view of the same image that is displayed in the main image window. Changes in the subtract background controls are automatically reflected in the Preview Window. They are only applied to the main image when you click on OK.

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You can use view tools like Zoom Box and View Entire Image in the Preview Window just as you can in the main image window, to focus on particular regions of interest. You can also use the ARROW keys to move the image within the Preview Window.

A description of each of the available features in the Subtract Background dialog is given below.

Auto-scale

Clicking on the Auto-scale button will automatically adjust your Dark Contrast and Background settings to optimal levels. You can then “fine tune” these settings using the other controls.

Dark Contrast Slider

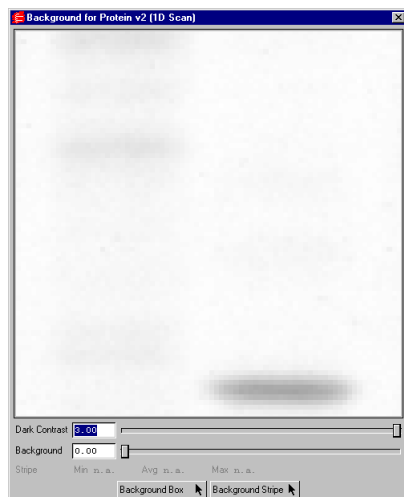
Adjusting the Dark Contrast prior to background subtraction allows you to make fine distinctions in the amount of background present in your image. Faint artifacts that may not be obvious to the unaided eye are revealed by lowering the Dark Contrast level to close to the subtraction levels.

The Dark Contrast slider is similar to the High slider in the Transform dialog box. Dragging the slider handle to the left will make faint signals appear stronger. You can also move the slider incrementally by clicking on the slider bar, or you can type a value into the field next to the slider.

Note: Adjusting the Dark Contrast slider by itself does not eliminate background intensity; therefore, the OK button will not activate if you only adjust this slider. If you only want to adjust the display contrast, and *not* subtract background, use the Image > Transform function.

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Example A: without adjustment



Example B: with adjustment

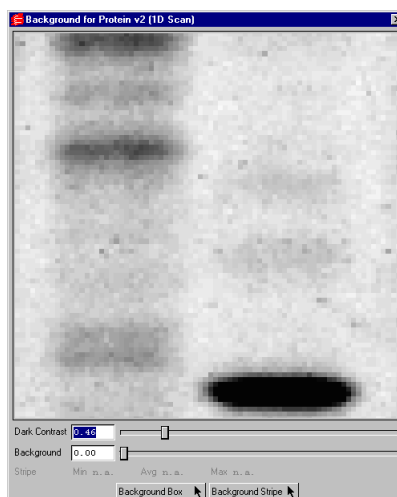


Fig. 13-19. Images without and with Dark Contrast adjustment. Note that in Example A, with no Dark Contrast adjustment (3.00 O.D.), the surrounding medium appears free of background and image artifacts, but in Example B, with adjustment (0.46 O.D.), artifacts in the image become immediately obvious, indicating that the subtraction levels were not sufficient to remove all background artifacts from the gel image.

Background Slider

To manually adjust the background subtraction level for your image, drag the Background slider to the right. You can also move the slider incrementally by clicking on the slider bar, or you can type a specific background value into the field next to the bar.

Objects with signal intensities lower than the subtraction level will be eliminated from the image when you click on OK.

Background Box

This method of subtraction is best suited for images with uniform backgrounds.

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Click on the Background Box button, then drag on the image, defining an area that is representative of the background for your entire gel image. The average intensity of the pixels within the box will be used as the background level to be subtracted from your image.

Background Stripe

This function is useful when the image background is horizontally uniform but changes from the top to the bottom of the image, such as on a gradient gel.

To subtract a background gradient, click on Background Stripe, then drag on a background region to create a lane-like box down the length of the image. The average intensity of the pixels in every horizontal pixel row within the stripe will be subtracted from that entire pixel row. This way, if your image has more background at the bottom than at the top, more background will be removed from the lower regions of the image.

Note: Make sure that your background stripe box stretches down the entire length of the part of the image you are interested in. If your background stripe is shorter than your image length, the software will take the last background value at top end of the stripe and subtract it from the upper part of the image, and take the last background value at the bottom of the stripe and subtract it from the lower part of the image.

When you draw a stripe, the minimum and maximum intensities in the stripe are displayed next to the Min and Max labels in the box. Also, the average intensity value for the entire stripe is displayed next to Avg.

Completing the Subtraction

When you are happy with the background subtraction shown in the preview image, click on the OK button at the bottom of the dialog box.

Because whole-image background subtraction is an irreversible process, a pop-up box will give you the option of subtracting from the original image, creating a copy of the image to subtract from, or cancelling out of this operation.

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If you choose to copy and subtract, you will be asked to enter a new name and/or version number for the new copy before the operation is performed. Once this information has been entered, the background subtraction will be performed.

13.10 Filtering Images

Filtering is a process that removes small noise features on an image while leaving larger features (like data) relatively unaffected. A wide range of filters are available for removing different types of noise from images. Depending on the nature of your data, you will probably need to use only one or two of the available filters. However, you should experiment with several different filters before selecting the ones that work best for your images.

The filtering commands are located on the Image menu and toolbar.

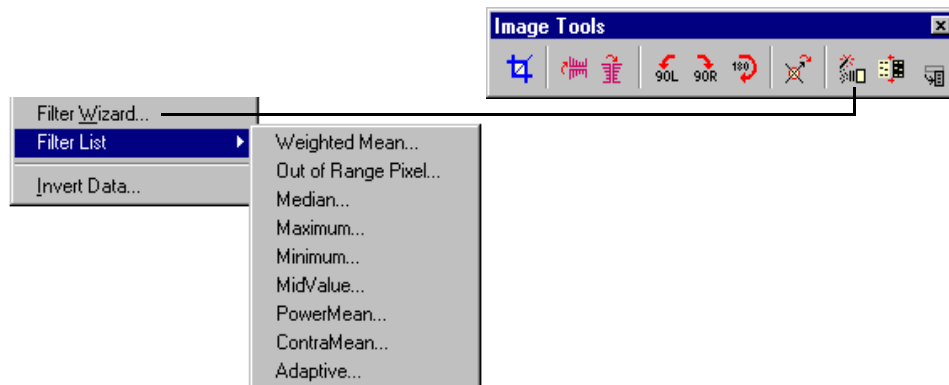


Fig. 13-20. Filtering commands.

Note: Since filtering is an irreversible process, you will be asked if you want to create a copy of the original image before you filter. If you are experimenting with various filters, you should create copies of your image and compare them side-by-side. If you filter the original image and save it, *you cannot return to the original, unfiltered state.*

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13.10.aFilter Wizard

The Filter Wizard is designed to guide you through the filter selection process. First, you identify the type of noise in your image. Next, select the size of the filter to use on that noise. Finally, filter the image.

To open the Wizard, select Image > Filter Wizard or click on the Filter Wizard button on the Image Tools toolbar.

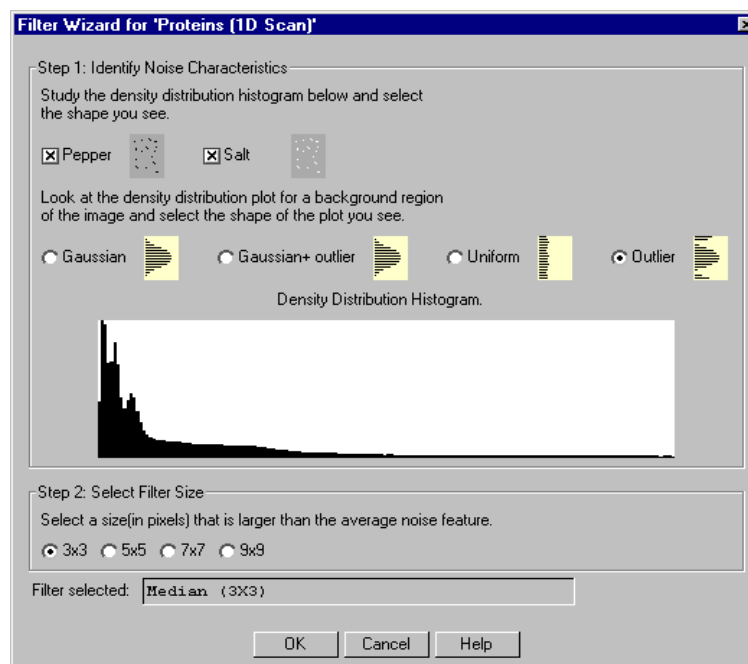


Fig. 13-21. Filter Wizard dialog box.

The Wizard contains settings for identifying the different types of noise in the image. It also includes a density distribution histogram of the noise in the image to aid in filter selection.

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Step 1: Identify Noise Characteristics

The first step in the Wizard is to identify the type of noise in your image. Examine both the image and the density distribution histogram, then select one, both, or neither of the following checkboxes:

- **Salt.** This type of noise appears as specks that are lighter than the surrounding background. The density distribution histogram of this type of noise displays noise peaks at the high end of the range (right end of the plot). This type of noise is common in electronic cameras with malfunctioning pixels. It can also be caused by dust or lint in the imaging optics or scratches on photographic film. Salt is a type of outlier noise (see below).
- **Pepper.** This type of noise appears as specks that are darker than the surrounding background. The distribution histogram of this type of noise displays noise peaks at the low end of the range (left end of the plot). Its causes are similar to those of salt noise. Pepper is a type of outlier noise (see below).

Next, select one of the following option buttons to describe additional features of your noise.

- **Gaussian.** The distribution histogram of this type of noise has a Gaussian profile, usually at the bottom of the data range. This type of noise is usually an electronic artifact created by cameras and sensors, or by a combination of independent unknown noise sources.
- **Uniform noise.** This type of noise appears in the histogram as a uniform layer of noise across the data range of the image.
- **Outlier noise.** This category of noise includes salt and pepper noise (see above). The distribution histogram of this type of noise displays noise peaks at the high and low ends of the range.

After you have identified the type of noise, go to Step 2.

Step 2: Select Filter Size

Image noise is filtered by means of a filtering window (or kernel), which is measured in pixels. This filtering window slides across the image, processing the pixels within it.

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The available filter dimensions range from 3 x 3 pixels to 9 x 9 pixels. To select an appropriate size, magnify a background region of your image so that you can see the individual pixels. The filter size you select should be larger than the average noise feature but smaller than your data features.

Note: A smaller filter will alter your image less than a larger filter. Large filters can result in better suppression of noise, but can also blur desirable features in the image.

Step 3: Begin Filtering

After you have completed your selections, the filter name and size will be displayed at the bottom of the Filter Wizard dialog box.

To begin filtering, click on the OK button. Because filtering is an irreversible process, a pop-up box will give you the option of filtering the original image, creating a copy of the image to filter, or cancelling out of this operation.

If you choose to Copy and Filter, you will be asked to enter a new name and/or version number for the new copy before the operation is performed. Once this information has been entered, the filtering operation will be performed.

13.10.bSelecting a Filter Directly

If you already know the type and size of filter you want, you can select it directly by selecting Image > Filter List. The submenu includes all the available filters.

The types of filters are:

- **Weighted Mean.** This filter is useful for reducing Gaussian noise. It calculates the weighted mean of the pixels within the filtering window and uses it to replace the value of the pixel being processed.
- **Out of Range Pixel.** This filter is useful for suppressing salt-and-pepper noise; its effect on Gaussian noise is minimal. This filter calculates the mean of the pixel values in the filtering window, including the pixel being processed. If the difference between the mean and the individual pixel value is above a certain threshold, then the individual value is replaced by the mean.

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- **Median.** Also useful for suppressing salt-and-pepper noise, this filter calculates the median value of the pixels within the filtering window and uses it to replace the value of the pixel being processed. The median filter produces very little blurring if a small-sized window is selected.
- **Maximum.** This filter is useful for eliminating pepper noise in an image (it worsens the effect of salt noise). It replaces the value of the pixel being processed with the maximum value of the pixels within the filtering window.
- **Minimum.** This filter replaces the value of the pixel being processed with the minimum pixel value within the filtering window. This filter is useful for eliminating salt noise in an image (it worsens the effect of pepper).
- **MidValue.** This filter is useful for suppressing uniform noise within an image; however, it worsens the effect of pepper and salt. This filter replaces the value of the pixel being processed with the mean of the maximum and minimum pixel values within the filtering window.
- **PowerMean.** This filter is useful for suppressing salt and Gaussian noise within an image (it worsens the effect of pepper noise). It replaces the value of the pixel being processed with the power mean of the pixel values within the filtering window.
- **ContraMean.** This filter is useful for suppressing pepper and Gaussian noise within an image (it worsens the effect of salt). It replaces the value of the pixel being processed with the contra-harmonic mean of the pixel values within the filtering window.
- **Adaptive.** This filter is useful for suppressing Gaussian noise and salt and/or pepper within an image. If your image contains a mix of salt and pepper, select this filter.

To begin filtering, select a filter type from the pull-down list. A pop-up box will ask you to select a filter size.

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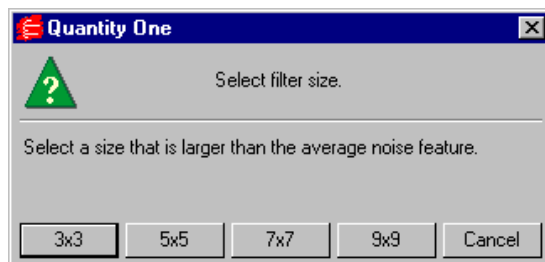


Fig. 13-22. Selecting a filter size.

The available filter dimensions range from 3 x 3 pixels to 9 x 9 pixels. (See the previous section for guidance on selecting a size.)

Because filtering is an irreversible process, a pop-up box will give you the option of filtering the original image, creating a copy of the image to filter, or cancelling out of this operation.

If you choose to copy and filter, you will be asked to enter a new name and/or version number for the new copy before the operation is performed. Once this information has been entered, the filtering operation will be performed.

13.11 Invert Data

The Invert checkbox in the Transform dialog box (section 4.6.b) inverts only the appearance of the image. In some cases, however, you may want to invert the actual image data.

If your image has light bands or spots on a dark background (i.e., the signal intensity of the background is greater than the signal intensity of the sample), you will need to use the Invert Data function before you can analyze the image.

This function is reversible, so if you change your mind, you can always switch it back.

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To invert your image data, select Image > Invert Data or select Invert Data from the Image Tools. You may need to use the Transform function to adjust the appearance of your inverted image.

13.12 Text Overlays

If you want to create and display textual notes directly on your image, select Text Overlay Tools from the Edit menu or main toolbar. This will open the Text Overlay Tools toolbar.

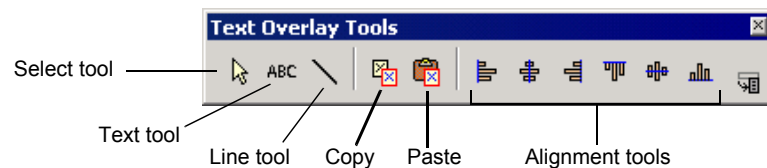


Fig. 13-23. Text Overlay Tools toolbar.

Creating a Text Overlay

To create a text overlay, click on the Text Tool, then click on the image at the spot where you want the text to appear. This opens the Text Overlay Properties dialog box.

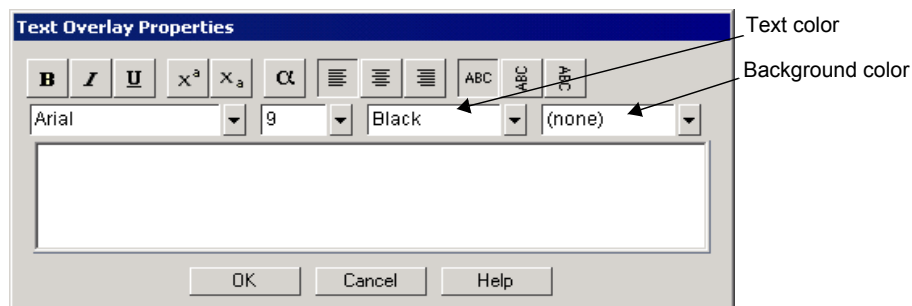


Fig. 13-24. Text Overlay Properties dialog box.

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To enter your text, simply begin typing in the main field. The buttons in the dialog allow you to select the properties of your text, including format, alignment, and justification.

The pull-down boxes (from left to right) allow you to select the font style, font size, color of the text, and color of the background within the text box.

Once you have typed your text, click on OK.

When you exit the Text Overlay Properties dialog by clicking OK, the text you typed will appear on the image at the spot where you originally clicked.

You can create as many textual overlays as you want.

Editing a Text Overlay

To edit a text overlay, make sure the Text Tool or Select Tool is assigned to your mouse, then double-click on the overlay to open the Properties dialog. The existing text will be displayed and can be edited.

Line Tool

You can use the Line Tool on the Text Overlay toolbar to draw a line between text and an image feature, or between any two points of interest on your image.

Click on the Line Tool button, then drag on your image to create the line. You can create as many lines as you want.

To resize or adjust a line, make sure the Line Tool or Select Tool is assigned to your mouse, then position your cursor on one end of the line (marked by a circle) and drag.

To add arrowheads to a line, make sure the Line Tool or Select Tool is assigned to your mouse, then double-click on the middle of the line. A dialog box will pop up with options to add arrowheads to one or both ends of the line.

Moving and Copying Text Overlays and Lines

You can move, copy, or delete a single overlay/line or a group of overlays/lines within an image. You can also copy and paste between images.

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First, you must select the object(s). Click on the Select Tool button on the Text Overlay toolbar. To select a single overlay or line, click on it. To select multiple objects, either drag a box around them or hold down the **SHIFT** key while you click on them one at a time. When dragging to select a group of objects, make sure that you completely surround all the objects to be selected.

Each selected overlay / line will have a green border.

- To move the selected object(s), position your cursor over the selection and drag.
- To copy within an image, hold down the **CTRL** key while dragging the selected object(s). The copy will be created and dragged to the new position.
- To delete the selected object(s), press the **DELETE** key.
- To copy between images, click on the Copy to Clipboard button on the Text Overlay toolbar, then open or select the image you want to copy to and click on the Paste from Clipboard button. The copied object(s) will be pasted into the new image in the same relative position they were copied from.

Note: If you are pasting into an image with a different pixel size (i.e., resolution), you will receive a message that the placement of the copy may not be exact. Click on **OK** to complete the paste, then position the pasted objects manually.

Viewing Previously Created Text Overlays/Lines

To display previously created text overlays and / or lines after opening an image, click on the Text Overlay Tools button on the main toolbar.

If you have concealed all your overlays using Hide Overlays, clicking on any of the buttons on the Text Overlay Tools toolbar will display the hidden text.

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13.13 Erasing All Analysis from an Image

If you want to delete all analysis that has been performed on an image (including lanes, bands, volumes, text overlays, etc.), you can use the Clear Analysis command.

Select Clear Analysis from the Edit menu. Since this process is irreversible, you will be prompted to confirm your selection.

13.14 Sort and Recalculate

If the numbering of your lanes or bands (see the following chapters) is incorrect because of an addition or deletion, you can renumber them using the Sort and Recalculate function. It will also perform other update and recalculate functions on your lanes and bands.

Select Sort and Recalculate from the Edit menu. The lanes and bands in your image will be displayed, correctly numbered and labeled.

14. Lanes

Before you can use many of the analysis functions, you must first define lanes and bands on your gel image. This chapter describes the tools for defining lanes.

Note: If you want to eventually compare bands across lanes (e.g., using standards or band matching), your lane lines should be approximately the same length, with their starting points aligned across the top of the image. This is important for calculating the relative mobility of the bands. If wells are visible on your gel image, you should center the start points of your lane lines on the wells and position the ends of the lanes slightly below the last band for best results.

14.1 Defining Lanes

You can define lanes individually or as part of a frame. The functions for doing this are under the Lane menu and on the Lane toolbar.

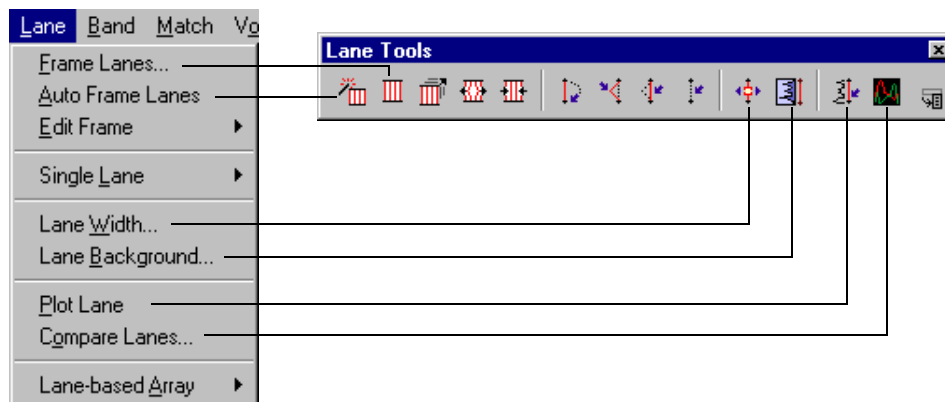


Fig. 14-1. Lane menu and toolbar.

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14.1.a Creating a Lane Frame

The fastest way to define all of the lanes in your image is to create a lane frame using the Auto Frame Lanes command. If Auto Frame Lanes does not work well on your images, you can create and place a lane frame manually.

Auto Frame Lanes

Note: Auto Frame Lanes works best with images with large numbers of clearly defined lanes and bands. Also, the lanes should be reasonably vertical and contain approximately the same amounts of sample.

Select Lane > Auto Frame Lanes or click on the button on the Lane Tools toolbar. The lane-finding program will automatically detect the lanes in your image and place a frame over them.

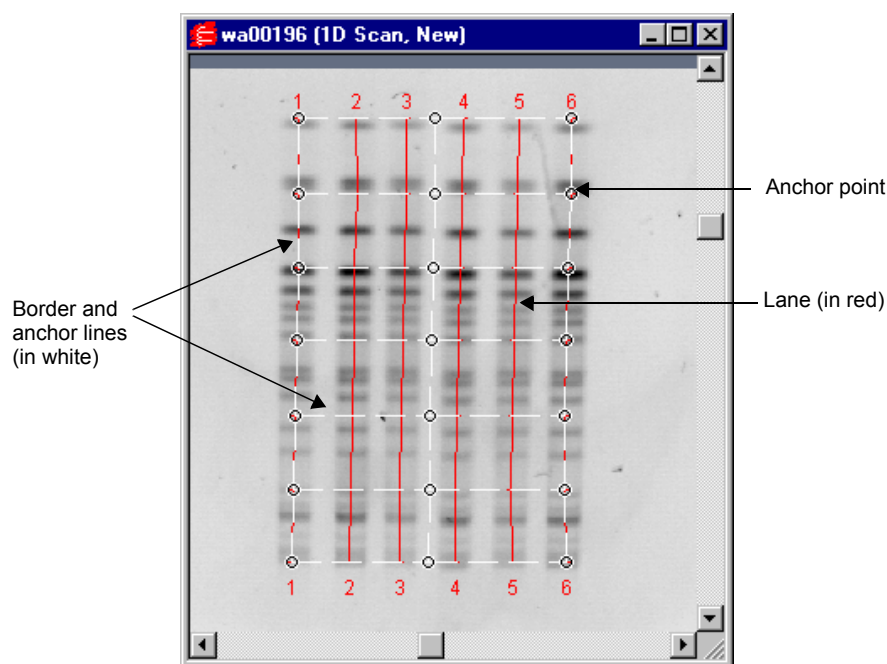


Fig. 14-2. Features of a lane frame.

Lanes

The lane frame contains individual lanes numbered sequentially from left to right. The border and anchor lines of the frame are marked with dashed white lines, the lanes are solid red lines, and each anchor point (interior and corner) is marked with a circle.

The top and bottom of the frame are parallel with the top and bottom of the image. However, the interior anchor points and lines will “bend” the frame in an attempt to follow the actual lanes in your image, thereby compensating for any curvature or distortion in the gel.

If Auto Frame Lanes detects too few or too many lanes, you can add or delete lanes using the single lane commands described below.

If Auto Frame Lanes does not work on the image, you will be prompted to create a lane frame manually.

If you are not satisfied with the frame created by Auto Frame Lanes, select Edit > Clear Analysis and use the manual Frame Lanes command.

Manual Frame Lanes

If Auto Frame Lanes does not work with your images, you can frame your lanes manually. Lane > Frame Lanes opens a dialog box in which you can type in the number of lanes in your gel.

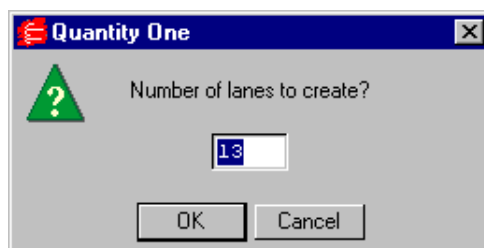


Fig. 14-3. Frame Lanes dialog box.

Click on the OK button to complete the action.

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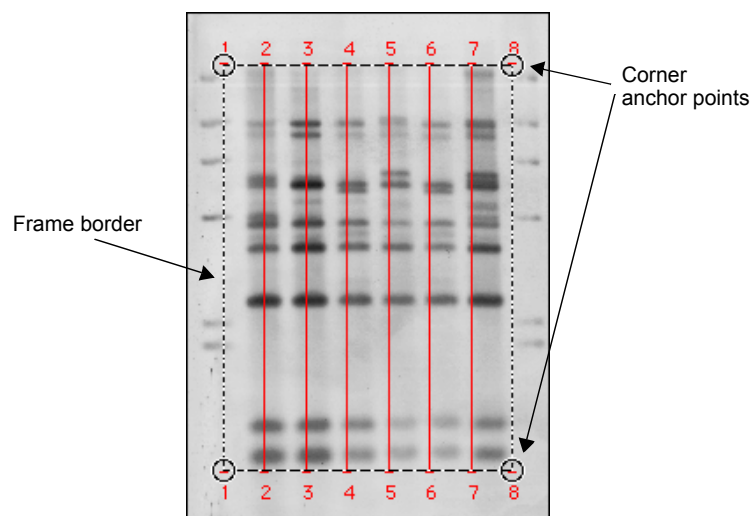


Fig. 14-4. Lane frame created using the Frame Lanes command.

The lane frame overlay contains individual lanes numbered sequentially from left to right. The borders of the frame are marked with dashed lines, the interior lanes are solid red lines, and each corner anchor point is marked with a circle.

14.1.b Editing the Frame

If your frame is too large or small, or does not follow the lanes on your image, you can adjust it using the frame editing commands.

Lanes

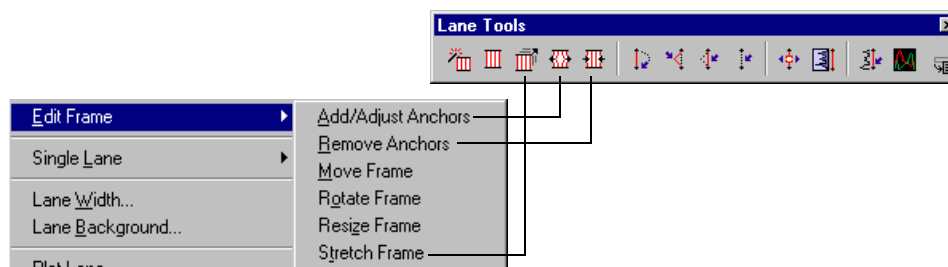


Fig. 14-5. Edit Frame tools.

Adjusting the Entire Frame

The following commands are located on the Lane > Edit Frame submenu:

- To stretch the frame (e.g., if you want to include additional bands at the top or bottom of the image), select Stretch Frame from the submenu and drag an anchor point in or out. The opposite anchor point will remain fixed while the frame expands or contracts.
- To move the entire frame to a new position, select Move Frame from the Lane > Edit Frame submenu and drag an anchor point. The entire frame will move.
- To rotate the frame, select Rotate Frame from the submenu and drag an anchor point. The entire frame will rotate.
- To resize the frame, select Resize Frame from the submenu and drag an anchor point in or out. The frame will expand or contract from the center.

Adding and Adjusting Anchors

After you have created a frame, the Add/ Adjust Anchors function will automatically be assigned to your mouse.

To adjust an individual corner anchor point of a frame, select Add/ Adjust Anchors (if it is not already assigned to your mouse) and drag the anchor point. This will move both the anchor point and attached frame lines.

If the lanes are not straight or if the dye front smiles, you can create additional anchor points within the frame to change the shapes of individual lines.

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Still using Add/Adjust Anchors, click anywhere on the dashed lines of the frame border. This creates additional anchor points, both where you clicked and on the other side of the frame. This also creates another dashed line across the frame

You can then drag the new anchor points just as you did the corner anchor points, thereby “bending” the frame. Other internal anchor points can be placed along the new dashed line if further adjustments to the lane frame are required.

You can create as many additional anchors as necessary for the lines of the frame to correspond to the lanes on the gel image. If you change your mind about the position of an anchor, you can reposition it by simply dragging it.

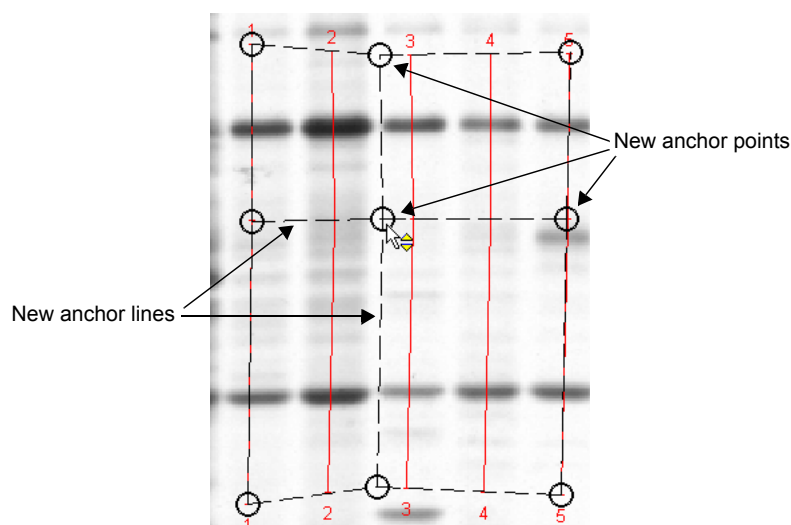


Fig. 14-6. Adjusting the anchor points of the lane frame.

Removing/Unadjusting Anchor Points

If you decide to remove an anchor point, select Unadjust Anchors from the Edit Frame submenu or toolbar and click on the anchor you want to remove. The anchor will disappear and the lanes will “unadjust,” reflecting the removal of the anchor.

14.1.c Defining a Single Lane

You can define individual lanes using the single lane functions. These are located on the Single Lane submenu of the Lane menu or on the Lane Tools toolbar.

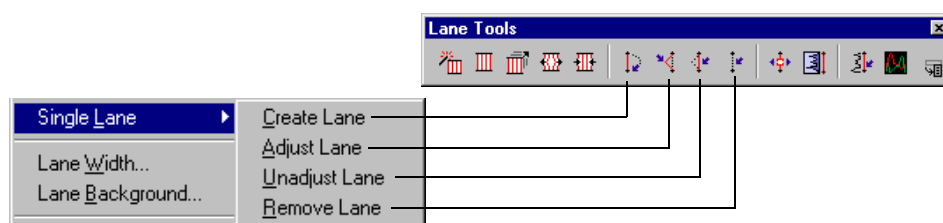


Fig. 14-7. Single Lane tools.

Note: You can use the single lane commands on lanes within a frame; however, the lane will be detached from the frame before the command is executed.

To mark an individual lane, select Create Lane, then drag a line from the top to the bottom of the desired lane.

Repeat this procedure to manually mark all the lanes you want to identify on your gel image.

Note: If while defining lanes your lane numbering gets out of sequence, click on Edit > Sort and Recalculate to renumber the lanes.

14.1.d Adjusting Single Lanes

You can adjust the position of any individual lane line you create by using the Adjust Lane command.

Select Adjust Lane, then either drag one of the existing anchor points or click anywhere on the lane to create a new anchor point and drag it to the desired position. Repeat this procedure as many times as necessary until the lane line accurately follows the lane on the gel image.

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14.1.e Unadjusting Single Lanes

You can undo any of your lane adjustments with the Unadjust Lane command. Select Unadjust Lane from the menu or toolbar, then click on an anchor point you created to remove it. If you remove the anchor points at either end of the lane line, you will delete the line from the image.

14.1.f Deleting Lanes

You can delete both single lane lines and lanes from a lane frame.

Select Remove Lane from the Lane menu or toolbar and click on the lane you want to remove. A pop-up box will ask you to confirm the deletion.

Note: If you delete a lane from a group of lanes or a frame, click on Edit > Sort and Recalculate to renumber the remaining lanes.

14.1.g Lane Width

The Lane Width command allows you to adjust the width of a single lane. Only the pixels within the sampling width are used for lane profiling and data quantitation purposes.

Select Lane Width from the Lane menu or toolbar, then click on a lane. This will open the Sample Width dialog box, displaying the current width of the lane you clicked on.

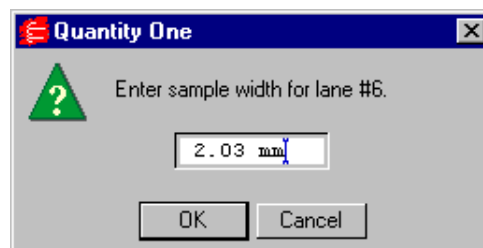


Fig. 14-8. Sampling Width dialog box.

Enter a new width in millimeters and click on the OK button.

Lanes

When detecting bands, you should select a Lane Width that is slightly wider than the actual lanes in your gel.

Note: You must eliminate background intensity from your lanes using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244) before detecting bands.

You can adjust the sampling width of all the lanes in your image from within the Detect Bands dialog box (page 259). See page 256 for a full discussion of the effect of sampling width on band quantitation.

14.1.h Creating a Lane Profile

After you have defined a lane, you can create an intensity profile of that lane using the Plot Lane function. A lane profile provides a quick visualization of the intensity of your sample data, and is also useful for determining the amount of background noise in your image.

Select Plot Lane from the Lane menu or toolbar, then click on a lane. A profile window will pop up.

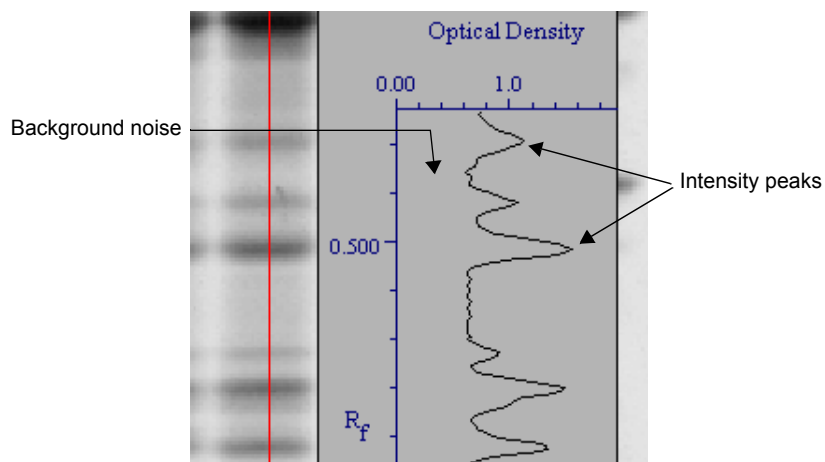


Fig. 14-9. Profile of a defined lane.

To profile another lane, simply click on the lane with the Plot Lane command still assigned to the mouse.

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The profile is generated by calculating the average intensity of the pixels in every horizontal scan line along the defined lane.

The profile shows the data objects in the image, represented by the intensity peaks in the profile, as well as the background noise in the image, represented by the region underneath the intensity peaks. The number of pixels used in this calculation depends on the lane width (see previous section).

To close the lane profile window, click on Hide Overlays on the main toolbar.

14.2 Lane-Based Background Subtraction

After defining your lanes, we strongly recommend that you perform lane-based background subtraction. This is the best method for removing background noise from your lanes.

Select Lane Background from the Lane menu or toolbar. When you click on a lane, a lane profile will be displayed and the Lane Background dialog box will open.

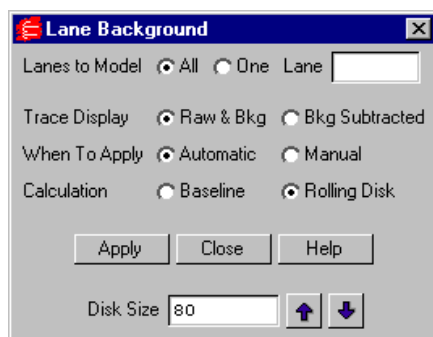


Fig. 14-10. Lane Background dialog box.

The following information can be specified in the dialog.

Lanes

Lanes to Model

If you want to apply the background subtraction to all the lanes of your image, click on the All button. Otherwise, select One and enter the number of the lane you want to perform the operation on.

Trace Display

The profile trace of the lane can be displayed in one of two ways. Selecting the Raw & Bkg option (with the functions Automatic and Rolling Disk activated) will display the original “raw” trace of the lane in white with an orange line representing the background noise beneath the peaks of the trace.

Clicking on the Bkg Subtracted button will display the lane trace as if all the background noise were actually removed. This display better enables you to visually compare the relative intensities of the bands in the lane.

When to Apply

As you change either the calculation method or the rolling disk size, the new settings can be applied to the image automatically every time a change is made by selecting the Automatic option.

Alternatively, you can apply each new setting manually by selecting the Manual option and clicking on the Apply button whenever the settings are changed.

Calculation Method

If you select None, background noise will not be subtracted from your lanes. Select Rolling Disk to perform background subtraction.

“Rolling disk” refers to a hypothetical disk that follows the contour of the lane’s profile trace, removing different intensities along the length of the lane.

The size of the disk determines how much background will be subtracted. A large disk will follow the profile trace less closely, touching fewer points along the trace and identifying less background. A smaller disk will more closely follow the profile trace, thus identifying more background.

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If you select Rolling Disk, the dialog box will expand to reveal a field showing the size of the rolling disk. The Disk Size is the disk radius in pixels.

You can type in a numerical value for the disk size or you can use the arrows to change the value in 10 percent increments.

A disk radius that is too large will result in slow execution and poor removal of background. A disk radius that is too small may subtract nonbackground intensity. Typical values range from 50 to 150.

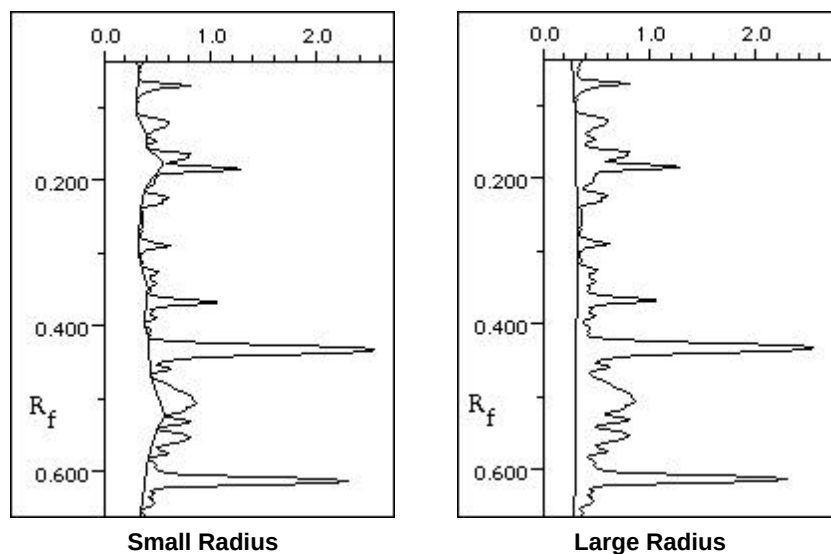


Fig. 14-11. Examples of the background trace for small and large rolling disks. The small disk follows the profile trace more closely, resulting in more background subtraction.

Try different disk sizes to find the one that gives you the desired background noise trace.

When you apply the Rolling Disk background subtraction, the lane trace display will change but the image will not reflect the change in background intensity.

14.3 Compare Lanes

The Compare Lanes graph allows you to superimpose the intensity profiles of any number of lanes from any number of open images.

Select Compare Lanes from either the Lane menu or toolbar, then click on the first lane you want to display. The Compare Lanes window will open.

Note: Your image must have defined lanes for this command to work.

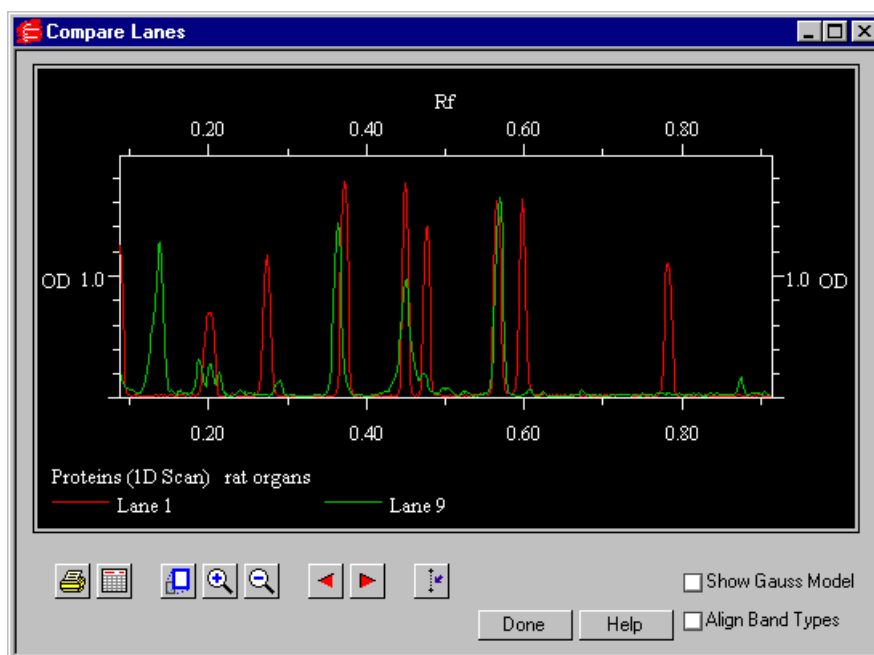


Fig. 14-12. The Compare Lanes dialog box.

The X axis of the graph is the Rf value and the Y axis is the pixel intensity value at each point along the lane. Compare Lanes automatically “best fits” lanes within the display window to maximize the range of intensity values included in the graph. Rf values are displayed from 0.0 to 1.0.

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Adding and Removing Lanes from the Graph

To add a lane to the graph, click directly on the lane in the image. The plot of the lane will appear in the graph.

Each lane you add will be displayed in one of eight colors, and will be identified by color in a legend underneath the graph. If you add more than eight lanes, the colors will repeat, but each lane will still be identified underneath the trace display. There is no limit to the number of lanes that can be displayed simultaneously.

To remove a lane profile, click on the Remove Lane button. A pop-up box will prompt you to select the lane to remove. If you remove a lane, the colors of the remaining lanes will change. Check the lane legend for an updated color code.

Magnifying the Graph

The Zoom In and Zoom Out buttons in the dialog can be used to magnify regions of interest in the profiles. Click on the appropriate button to zoom in or out.

Alternatively, you can drag the cursor horizontally across the graph and release the mouse button to magnify the range you defined by dragging.

Note: The magnifying functions in Compare Lanes only magnify the profile in the direction of the X axis. Therefore, the profile will appear to “stretch” without increasing in height.

The Full View button returns the graph to its complete, unadjusted appearance.

If you have zoomed in on part of the graph, the Left and Right scroll buttons in the dialog can be used to pan left or right.

Show Gaussian Modeling

The Show Gauss Model checkbox will become active if any of the lanes being profiled includes Gaussian modeling (page 275). If you click in this checkbox, the Gaussian-fitted profile(s) will be superimposed on the regular lane profile(s). The Gaussian profiles are displayed in white.

Align Band Types

The Align Band Types checkbox will become active if any of the lanes being profiled includes defined band types (see Chapter 16).

If this checkbox is selected, the profiles of all bands that have been identified as the same band type will be stretched and superimposed on one another, so their peaks align. This is useful if the same band appears as peaks in slightly different positions in different lanes, and you want to align the peaks to confirm that they are all the same band type.

Note: This command only changes the lane profiles as they are displayed in the Compare Lanes dialog, and will not affect image data in any way.

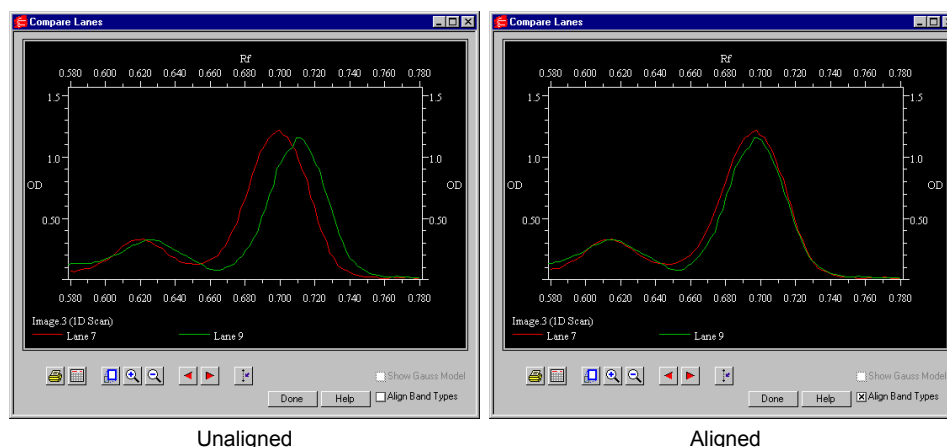


Fig. 14-13. Two band types as they appear in two lanes, before alignment and after.

Note that this function will not align band types from different band sets (e.g., Band Type 1 in Band Set A and Band Type 1 in Band Set B will not be aligned). However, the same band types from different images will be aligned.

Note: The Rf values in the X axis will no longer be accurate if Align Band Types is selected, since some band profiles will be stretched and their peaks shifted.

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Printing and Exporting

Click on the Print button to print a copy of the Compare Lanes display.

Click on the Export button to export the data points in your graph to a spreadsheet. This will open the Compare Lanes Export dialog box.

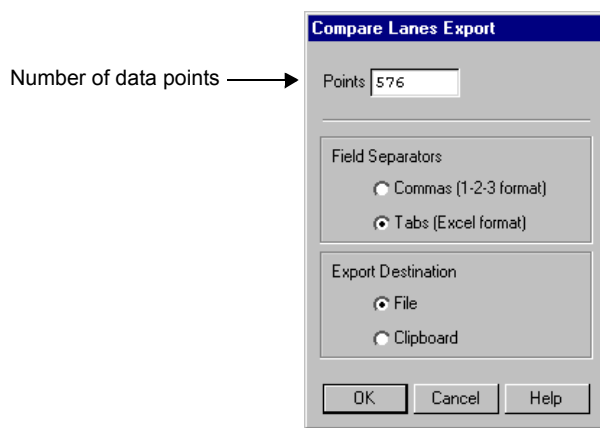


Fig. 14-14. Compare Lanes Export dialog box.

This Export dialog box includes a field for the number of data points to be taken along the length of each lane. The default value in this field is the maximum number of data points that are available for the lanes you are comparing.

Select the export format (tab or comma delimited) and destination (file or clipboard), then click on OK.

Note: The exported data will be different depending on whether you have checked Align Band Types, Show Gauss Model, or neither. If the Show Gauss Model checkbox is selected, each lane that has been Gaussian fitted will have two columns of data: one for the Gaussian-fitted profile and one for the regular profile. If the Align Band Types checkbox is selected, the exported values will reflect the stretched and shifted profiles of those lanes that have been aligned.

14.4 Lane-based Arrays

The lane-based array functions allow you to create a lane frame for the cells in your array. You can then specify the cell dimensions and quantitate them using the Quantity Standards function (page 307).

Note: You can quantitate your arrays outside of lanes using volume arrays (see Chapter 17).

Open the image of your array.

The first step in defining an array is specifying the number of columns and rows in the array and creating an array frame.

Got to the Lane menu, open the Lane-based Array submenu, and select Frame Array.

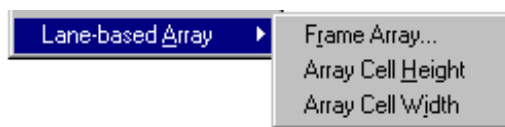


Fig. 14-15. Lane-based Array tools.

A pop-up box will ask you to enter the number of columns in the array. Enter the number of columns and click on OK.

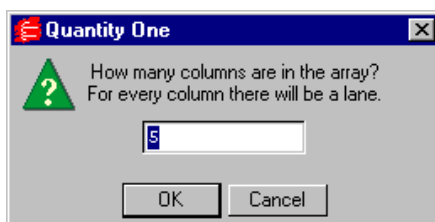


Fig. 14-16. Setting number of array columns.

In the next box, enter the number of rows and click on OK.

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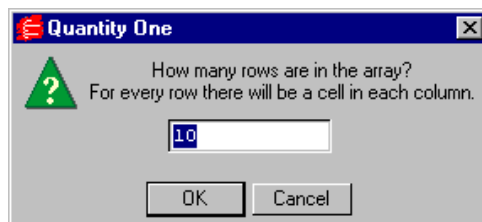


Fig. 14-17. Setting the number of array rows.

The array matrix will appear on the image. Each column will be marked by a red line, and each cell will be marked by top and bottom brackets.

Note: If the cells appear marked by lines instead of brackets, select Band > Band Attributes and select Brackets in the dialog box.

When you first create the array matrix, it will probably not be centered on the columns and cells in the actual image. In the next step, you will adjust the position of the matrix.

Adjusting the Array Matrix

The Add/ Adjust Anchors tool will be automatically assigned to your mouse after you create the frame (otherwise, select it from the Lane > Edit Frame submenu). Position your cursor on the corner points of the frame and drag them into position so that the red lines run down the middle of the array columns and the top and bottom brackets are centered on the array cells (see page 241 for guidance on adjusting frames).

If necessary, the Adjust Lane (page 241) and Adjust Band (page 267) commands can be used to “fine-tune” the placement of columns and cells within the frame.

Reducing Background in the Array

After you have positioned the array, you should reduce lane background using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244). Lane background will affect quantitation of the cells.

Setting Array Cell Height and Width

Now you should adjust the cell brackets so that they completely enclose the cells in the array.

Select Array Cell Height from the Lane > Lane-based Arrays submenu and enter the height in millimeters of the array cells.

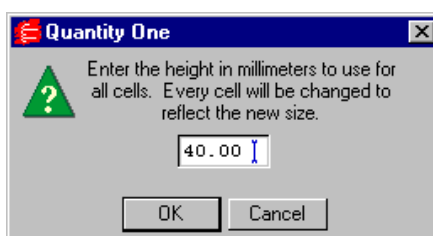


Fig. 14-18. Setting the array cell height.

When you click on OK, the cell brackets will adjust to the specified height. If you aren't sure of the exact height, you can experiment with different values.

Select Array Cell Width and enter the width in millimeters of all the cells in the array.

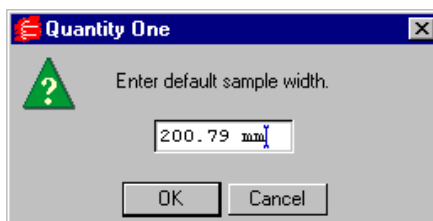


Fig. 14-19. Setting the array cell width.

When you click on OK, the cell brackets will adjust to the specified width. If you aren't sure of the exact width, you can experiment with different values.

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Analyzing Array Data

When the brackets fully enclose each cell in the array, you are ready to analyze the data. You can display various measures of cell quantity on the image using the Band > Band Attributes command. With the Band Attributes dialog open, select from Peak Density, Average Density, Trace Quantity, Relative Quantity, and other measures. You can also report these values by selecting Lane Reports from the Reports menu.

To use known quantities to calculate unknowns, you can use the Quantity Standards function (page 307).

15. Bands

Once you have defined the lanes on your gel image, you can automatically identify and quantitate the bands in those lanes using a set of adjustable parameters.

Note: You can also quantitate bands outside of lanes using the Volume Tools. See Chapter 17 for details.

The tools for band detection are located on the Band menu and on the Band Tools toolbar.

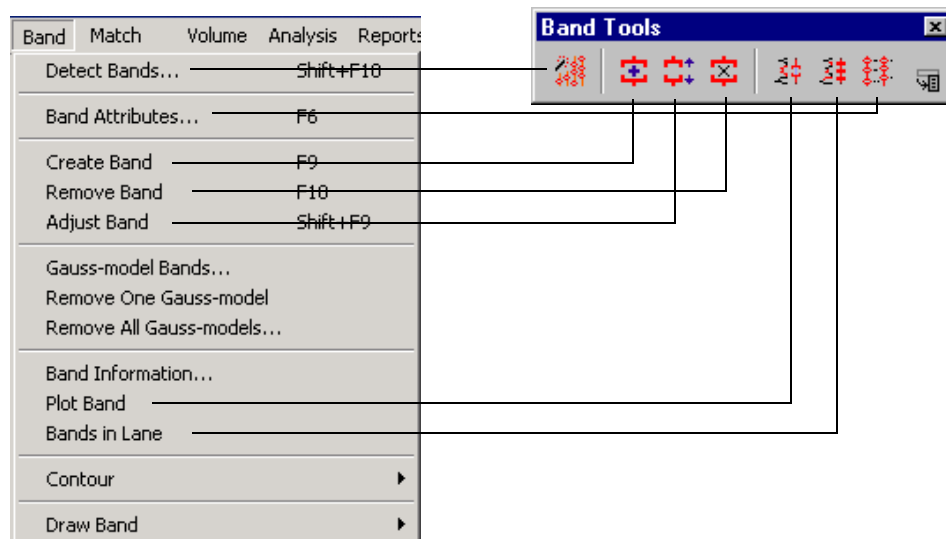


Fig. 15-1. Band menu and Band Tools toolbar.

Note: Before detecting bands, you should always subtract lane background using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244).

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15.1 How Bands Are Identified and Quantified

You can automatically identify all the bands in your image using the Detect Bands command, or you can mark them individually using the Create Band command.

Each identified band is defined by brackets above and below the band. You can see these if you select the Brackets option button in the Band Attributes dialog box. (Select Band > Band Attributes.) These brackets mark the boundaries of the band.

The width of each set of brackets is set by you before the bands are detected. This is the lane sampling width. The height of each set of brackets is determined automatically, using a band-finding formula together with parameters that you select.

When a band is quantitated, the average intensity value of each horizontal row of pixels within the brackets is calculated. Next, the number of pixel rows between the top and bottom brackets is determined. Taken together, these result in an intensity profile for the band.

Finally, the area under the profile curve to the baseline is integrated, resulting in units of intensity x millimeters. This is the “trace quantity” of the band.

Note: Because the profile of an ideal band conforms to the shape of a Gaussian curve, band profiles can be “fitted” to a Gaussian model. The band quantity can then be quantitated from the area under the Gaussian curve. This is the best to resolve overlapping or closely spaced bands in your images. See section 15.7, below.

Bands

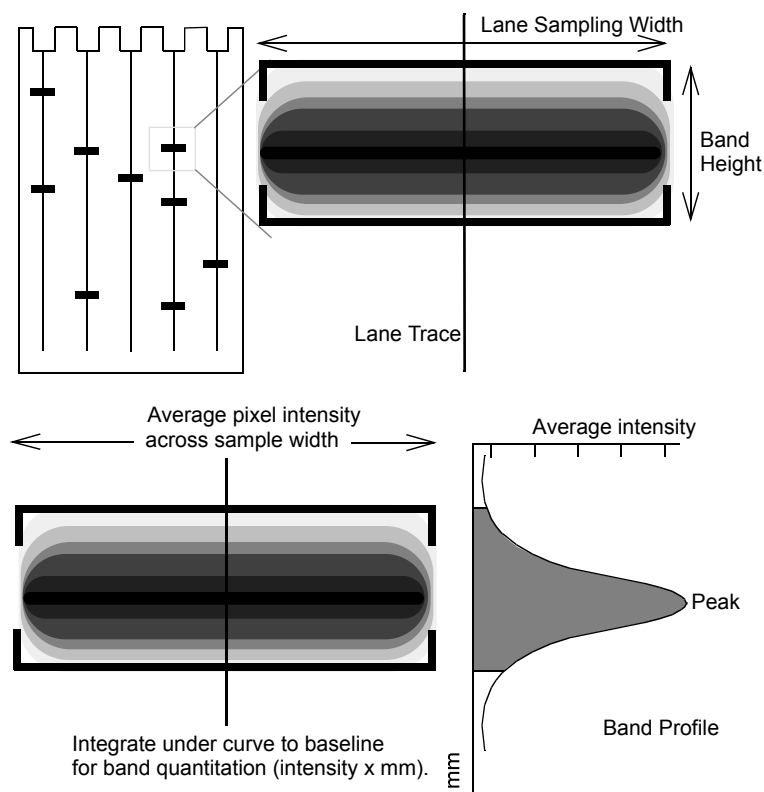


Fig. 15-2. Illustration of bracket quantitation.

15.2 Band Detection

The Detect Bands function will find all of the bands in your defined lanes, based on parameters that you select.

Note: Before detecting bands, you should always subtract lane background using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244).

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Select Band > Detect Bands or click on the button on the Band toolbar to open the Detect Bands dialog box.

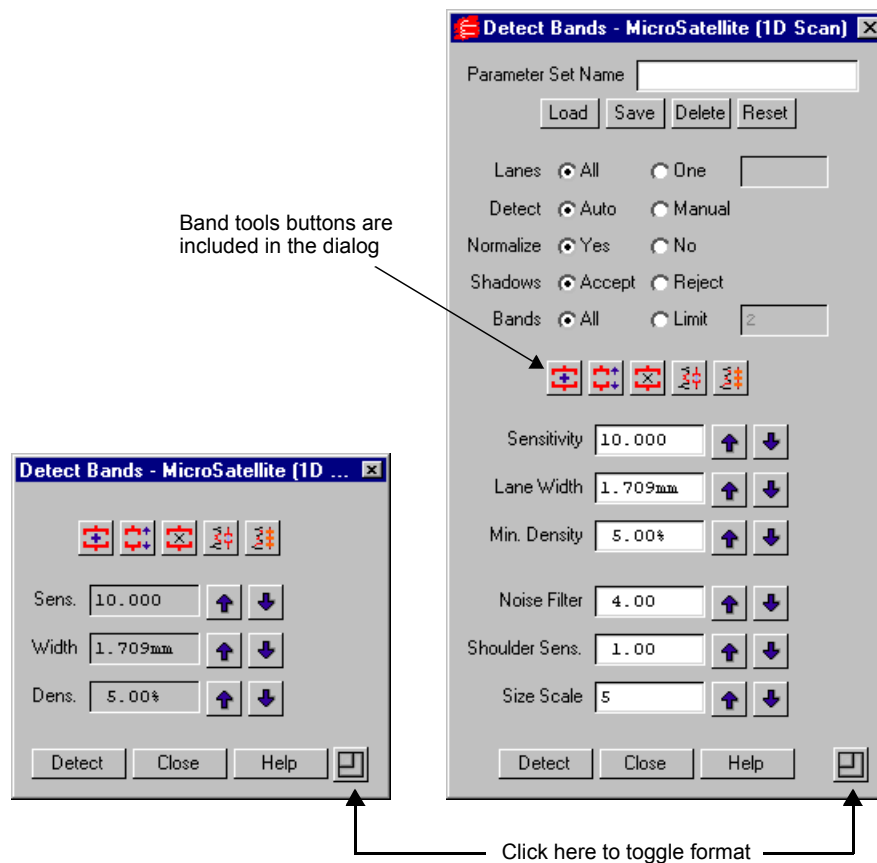


Fig. 15-3. Detect Bands dialog box, short and expanded formats, with default values.

Note: If you have already manually identified bands (using Create Band, Adjust Band, etc.), the Detect Bands function will overwrite your manual detection. For this reason, you should use Detect Bands first, and then manually add, adjust, or remove bands as needed.

Bands

The Detect Bands dialog box has both a short format and an expanded format, which you can toggle between by clicking the toggle box in the lower right corner of the dialog.

To change any of the parameter settings, you can either type in a new value or use the arrows to increase or decrease the setting by 10 percent. You should experiment with various settings to find those best suited to your images.

15.2.a Detection Parameters

Lanes to Detect

You can specify whether you want to detect the bands in all the lanes or in a single lane by selecting All or One next to the Lanes prompt. If you choose One, type the lane number in the field next to the One button.

Note: It may be necessary to detect one lane individually if the detection parameters applied to the whole image are not optimal for that lane (e.g., faint bands are not being detected or high background in that lane is being detected as bands). You can use the Detect Bands function to redetect bands in that lane using a different set of detection parameters.

When to Detect

If you select Auto next to the Detect prompt, band detection will occur immediately each time you change a detection parameter. You will not need to click on the Detect button located at the bottom of the form.

If you want to change more than one parameter before detecting, choose Manual. With the Manual option, you can change parameter settings first, and then apply them by clicking the Detect button.

Normalization

Normalization is a way for band detection to compensate for differences in the darkness of the lanes on a gel image. *It does not normalize for band quantitation.*

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If you select the No button next to the Normalize prompt, the band detection parameters are taken as absolute values and are applied in the same way to every lane on the image.

If you select Yes, the parameters are automatically adjusted according to the darkness of the lane. The darkness of the lane is determined by the darkest band in the lane. For example, suppose that all but one of the lanes on an image contain bands with an intensity of up to 50,000 counts. In the one light lane, the darkest band is only 25,000 counts. If normalization is turned on, band detection will be twice as sensitive when processing the light lane, improving the detection of faint bands.

Shadow Rejection

“Shadow bands” are common gel artifacts. Shadow bands are spaced at tandem repeat intervals and decrease in intensity as they progress further from a real band. The Shadows parameter is designed to limit the detection of shadow bands (see also Band Limit, below).

If you select Reject next to the Shadows prompt, the Detect Bands function will only find a band if it is darker than the one above it or if it is spaced further than one tandem repeat unit from the previous band. This greatly reduces the number of shadows identified as real bands.

If you select Accept next to the Shadows prompt, Detect Bands will not filter for shadows.

Band Limit

If you know that all the lanes in your gel contain a specific number of bands, you can click on the Limit button next to the Bands prompt and type in the number of bands that you know are present. Only that number of bands will be detected in each lane, reducing the need for later editing.

Sensitivity

The Sensitivity setting determines the minimum signal intensity in the image that will be defined as a band. The higher the sensitivity value, the more bands will be detected.

Bands

If the sensitivity is set too high, background noise will be erroneously detected as bands. If the setting is too low, real bands may be missed.

The default sensitivity setting is 10.00. If your gel image has faint bands (e.g., O.D. < 0.05, counts < 2,000), you may want to increase this value to 20.00.

Lane Width

The Lane Width determines the width along the lane lines that will be sampled for band detection and quantitation.

When a band is detected, an average intensity value for each horizontal row of pixels within the band brackets is calculated. You determine the number pixels in a row when you enter the Lane Width. The wider you set the Lane Width, the more pixels are included in the intensity average.

You should select a Lane Width that is slightly wider than the bands in your gel. You can adjust the lane width in the Detect Bands dialog until the band overlays are slightly wider than the bands in the image.

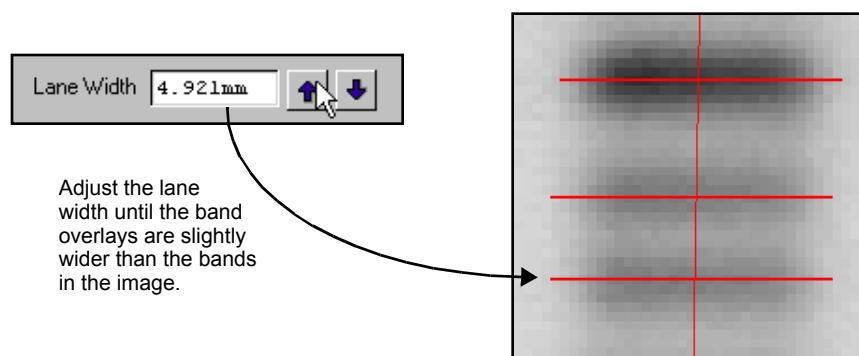


Fig. 15-4. Adjusting the lane width.

Note: You should always eliminate background intensity from your lanes using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244) before detecting bands.

You can also change the lanes widths for individual lanes using the Lane > Lane Width command (page 242).

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Minimum Density

When Normalization is turned off, this is the lowest signal intensity value that will be counted as a band.

Before entering a value for Min. Density, use the Lane > Plot Lane command to plot a trace of a lane that includes some faint bands. Then enter a value that is lower than the intensity of the peak of a faint band but is still above the background.

If faint bands are still being missed after applying this parameter, double-check the intensity of faint bands on the lane trace and/or consider increasing the Sensitivity setting.

If Normalize is turned on, Min. Density is converted from an absolute value to a percentage. This percentage is the fraction of the signal intensity of the darkest band in the lane that will be detected as a band. For example, if the darkest band in a lane is 50,000 counts and the Min. Density is set to 25,000 counts, when you turn on Normalize, the Min. Density will switch to 50%. In other words, for a band to be detected it must be at least half as dark as the darkest band in the lane.

Noise Filter

The Noise Filter can be used to minimize the number of small fluctuations in the image (i.e., noise) that are called bands while still recognizing larger features (i.e., real bands). This distinction becomes increasingly critical the higher the Sensitivity parameter is set.

The Noise Filter value refers to the size of the filter in pixels (e.g., a value of 2.50 equals a filter size of 2.50 x 2.50 pixels). Features smaller than the filter size will not be recognized as bands. Entering a noise filter size of zero turns it off completely. The default value is 4.00.

If band detection calls a doublet a single band, decrease the Noise Filter setting and/or increase the Sensitivity.

You can also try decreasing the Size Scale parameter instead of the Noise Filter to improve the detection of closely-spaced bands. Be wary of decreasing both the Noise Filter and the Size Scale, as this may result in the fuzziness around bands being mistakenly detected as separate bands.

Bands

Shoulder Sensitivity

Normally, band detection tries to distinguish shoulders as separate bands. When looking at a lane trace, these bands appear as flat or gently sloping abutments to darker, better-defined bands (i.e., there is no dip on the trace between the two bands).

Increasing the Shoulder Sensitivity value will result in more shoulders being detected as bands. Changing this setting to zero will result in no shoulders being recognized as separate bands.

If band detection calls a doublet a single band, check the lane trace to see if there is a dip between the peaks of the two bands. If there is no dip, increasing the Shoulder Sensitivity value will help resolve the two bands.

Size Scale

The Size Scale field helps distinguish between trends in signal intensity and random intensity fluctuations. It is the number of pixels in a vertical column that are taken together to determine whether a band is present.

The Size Scale parameter is similar to the Noise Filter in that it uses the size of objects in the image to determine the nature of those objects. The default Size Scale setting of 5 pixels is optimal for most gel images. It can be set to any whole number greater than or equal to 3.

If a gel image has high levels of background noise, a larger Size Scale may be preferable. When noise permits, small values are preferred so that small features will be detected.

You may also choose to increase the Size Scale if your gel only has a small number of thick bands and it is scanned at high resolution.

15.2.b Band Detection Parameter Sets

Saving Parameters

Once you have found a set of parameters that are optimal for detecting bands in your image, you can save them for future use on similar images. The Save button at the top of the Detect Bands dialog box allows you to do so.

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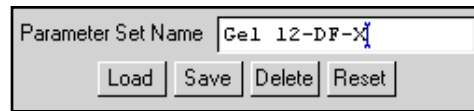


Fig. 15-5. Parameter set controls in the Detect Bands dialog box.

If you have not already entered a name for your parameter set in the Parameter Set Name field, you will be prompted to do so.

Loading Parameters

To load a previously saved set of parameters, click on the Load button.

Select the parameter set that you wish to load from the list. The values of that parameter set will be displayed in the Detect Bands form.

Deleting Parameters

To remove a set of parameters from your list, first load it, then press the Delete button. A dialog box will ask you to confirm the deletion.

Resetting Parameters

To return all detection parameters to their default values, click on the Reset button at the top of the form. Saved detection parameter files are not affected by this action, and can be reloaded at any time.

15.3 Identifying and Editing Individual Bands

To manually identify and edit individual bands in your image, you can use the Create, Adjust, and Remove Band commands on the Band menu and Band Tools toolbar. (These are also available as buttons in the middle of the Detect Bands dialog box.)

Bands



Fig. 15-6. Create, Adjust, and Remove Bands buttons.

Note: When editing individual bands, it is useful to display your bands as brackets using Band > Band Attributes (see above). When you edit bands in brackets mode, a pop-up lane trace will be displayed to help you determine band boundaries.

15.3.a Identifying Individual Bands

In Brackets Mode

With your bands displayed as brackets, first select Create Band from the menu or toolbar, then click on either the top or bottom boundary of the band of interest. An intensity trace of the lane will pop up next to the band.

Drag the cursor until the area of the band that you want to define—represented by a peak on the intensity trace—has been completely enclosed. As you drag, lines extending from the band boundaries on the image to the corresponding boundaries on the intensity trace will appear.

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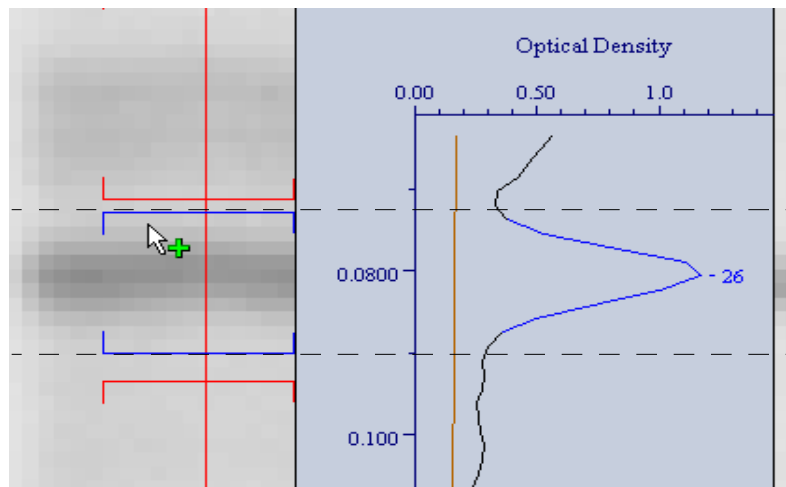


Fig. 15-7. Creating a band in brackets mode.

When you release the mouse button, brackets will appear enclosing the region that you have called a band on the image. The corresponding section of the intensity trace will be highlighted.

In Lines Mode

With your bands displayed as lines, first select Create Band from the menu or toolbar, then click on the center of the band of interest. A line will appear at the center of the band at that point on the lane.

Bands

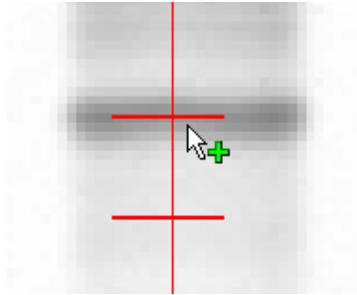


Fig. 15-8. Creating a band in lines mode.

In lines mode, no intensity trace will pop up when you click on the image.

Note: After identifying several bands, be sure to renumber the bands in your image by selecting Sort and Recalculate from the Edit menu.

15.3.b Adjusting Bands

After you identify the bands on your image—either automatically or manually—you may want to go back and change the placement of the band boundaries.

To reposition a band's boundaries, select Adjust Band from the menu or toolbar.

If you are in brackets mode, click and drag the upper or lower bracket of the band that you want to adjust. If you are in lines mode, click and drag near the upper or lower boundary of the band that you want to adjust.

When you click and drag the mouse, a pop-up lane trace will appear. The band being adjusted will be highlighted, and lines extending from the band boundaries on the image to the corresponding boundaries on the intensity trace will appear.

Drag the band boundary to the desired location, then release the mouse button.

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15.3.c Deleting Bands

You can use Remove Band to delete bands from lanes.

Select Remove Band from the menu or toolbar, point the cursor at the unwanted band, and click the mouse button.

If your bands are displayed as brackets, a trace of the band will be displayed and a pop-up box will ask you to confirm removal of the band. Click on Yes to delete the band or No to cancel the procedure.

If your bands are displayed as lines, the band will simply be deleted.

Note: If your bands are displayed as lines, you can delete more than one band at a time. With Remove Band assigned to your mouse, drag a box around the bands to be removed. The bands in the box will be deleted when you release the mouse button.

If you delete a band, the region will no longer be counted as a band, but its intensity will still contribute to the total lane intensity.

Note: After removing bands, be sure to renumber the bands in your image by selecting Sort and Recalculate from the Edit menu.

15.4 Plotting Traces of Bands

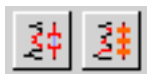


Fig. 15-9. Plot Band and Bands in Lane buttons.

Band > Plot Band (also on the Band Tools toolbar) displays an intensity trace of any band that you select on the image. First select the command, then click on the band of interest.

Band > Bands in Lane (also on the Band Tools toolbar) displays an intensity trace of any lane you select and highlights all the defined bands in that lane. First select the command, then click on the lane of interest.

Bands

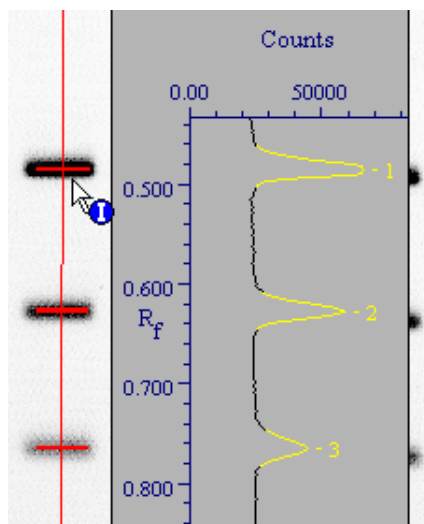


Fig. 15-10. Bands in Lane command.

15.5 Band Attributes

Once you have identified bands in your image, you can display information about them using the Band Attributes command.

Select Band > Band Attributes to open the dialog box.

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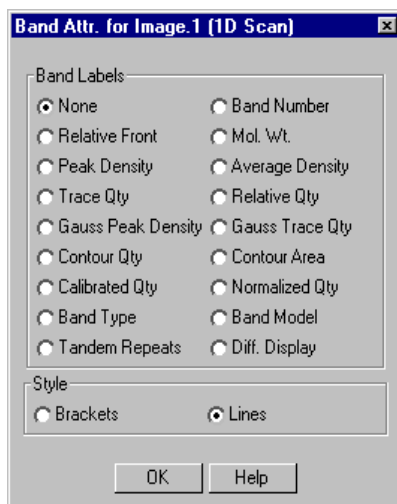


Fig. 15-11. Band Attributes dialog box.

Click on any of the buttons in the Band Labels group to display that particular attribute next to each defined band on your image.

15.5.a Summary of Band Attributes

Each band attribute is summarized below.

- **None**—No attribute is displayed.
- **Band number**—The sequential number of a band in lane, as counted from the top of the lane.
- **Relative front**—The distance of a band from the top of a defined lane to the bottom, divided by the total length of the lane. This distance can be determined either by measuring a vertical line from the top of the lane to bottom or (if the lane is curved) by measuring along the length of the lane. Select Edit > Preferences to set the preferred measuring method.

Note: Note that Normalized Rf is derived from Relative Front; however, Normalized Rf is calculated only for bands that have been modeled using standards or band sets, and can change based on the modeling.

Bands

- **Molecular weight/Isoelectric Point/Base Pairs/other units**—This value is determined by the type of standards defined for the gel, the band's position in the lane, and any modeling performed on the gel (via band matching or multiple lanes of standards) to compensate for gel distortion or smiling.
- **Peak density**—The intensity value of a band's peak.
- **Average density**—The total intensity of the rows of pixels used to generate the profile of a band, divided by the number of rows.
- **Trace qty**—The quantity of a band as measured by the area under its intensity profile curve. Units are intensity x mm.
- **Relative qty**—The quantity of a particular band in a lane expressed as a percentage of either (1) the total quantity of all the bands in the lane or (2) the total intensity data in the lane. The calculation method (% of Lane / % of Bands in Lane) is set in Application Preferences under Edit > Preferences.
- **Gauss Peak Density**—The intensity value of a band's Gaussian peak (after Gaussian modeling).
- **Gaussian Trace Quantity**—The quantity of a band as measured by the area under its Gaussian-fitted profile.
- **Contour qty**—The quantity of a band that has been identified using the Contour or Draw Band tools. It is the sum of the intensities of all the pixels within the band boundary multiplied by the area of each pixel. Units are intensity x mm².
- **Contour area**—The area (in mm²) inside the boundary of a band that has been identified using the Contour or Draw Band tools.
- **Calibrated qty**—The quantity of a band as calculated from the trace quantity and quantity standards. (Note that this is different than quantity determined using volumes.) Units are user-defined (e.g., micrograms).
- **Normalized qty**—The trace quantity of a particular band expressed as a percentage of the quantity of a selected band type that is present in the same lane.
- **Band type**—The band type number of a band that has been matched and placed in a band set.
- **Band model**—Displays the modeling lines across the gel that are

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generated by band matching, standards, or both. These lines are used to compensate for gel distortion or smiling.

- **Tandem repeats**—The number of repeated base-pair units in a band that has been analyzed using the VNTR Calculations function.
- **Differential Display**—If your band types have been normalized, this displays trends in increasing or decreasing expression of a band type across a gel based on its normalized quantity.

15.5.b Displaying Bands as Brackets or Lines

The options in the Style group of the Band Attributes dialog allow you to choose how your defined bands are marked—as brackets surrounding each band, or as a single line at the center of each band.

Lines are usually easier to read than brackets in images with closely packed bands, while brackets are better for displaying the boundaries of bands.

15.6 Displaying Band Information

You can display and enter information about individual bands using the Band Information dialog box. To open this dialog, select Band Information from the Band menu and click on a band of interest.

An intensity profile of the band's lane will be displayed, the selected band will be highlighted, and the dialog box will be displayed.

Bands

Band Information for MA00396 (1D Scan).

Lane Band Set _____ Name #5

Band Band Type _____

Rel. Front 0.808

Mol. Wt. _____ KDa _____ Status Unknown

Peak 45.6 CNT Average 31.6 CNT

Trace 152 CNT x mm

Gauss Model Peak 40.6 CNT

Gauss Model Trace 179 CNT x mm

Contour N.A.

Relative Qty. 3.51% Norm. Qty. N.A.

Quantity/Units / Status Unknown

Not Calibrated

Fig. 15-12. Band Information dialog box.

The Lane and Band number of the band you clicked on are listed at the top of the dialog. Enter new numbers in these fields to display information and a trace overlay for a different band.

If the band is part of a band set and is of a known band type, this will be noted in the form.

The following information is listed for each band:

- **Relative front**—The distance of a band from the top of a defined lane to the bottom, divided by the total length of the lane. This distance can be determined either by measuring a vertical line from the top of the lane to bottom or (if the lane is curved) by measuring along the length of the lane. Select Edit > Preferences to set the preferred measuring method.

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Note: Note that Normalized Rf is derived from Relative Front; however, Normalized Rf is calculated only for bands that have been modeled using standards or band sets, and can change based on the modeling.

- **Molecular weight/Isoelectric Point/Base Pairs/other units**—This value is determined by the type of standards defined for the gel, the band's position in the lane, and any modeling performed on the gel (via band matching or multiple lanes of standards) to compensate for gel distortion or smiling.
- **Peak density**—The intensity value of a band's peak.
- **Average density**—The total intensity of the rows of pixels used to generate the profile of a band, divided by the number of rows.
- **Trace qty**—The quantity of a band as measured by the area under its intensity profile curve. Units are intensity x mm.
- **Gauss Peak Density**—The intensity value of a band's Gaussian peak (after Gaussian modeling).
- **Gaussian Trace Quantity**—The quantity of a band as measured by the area under its Gaussian-fitted profile.
- **Contour qty**—The quantity of a band that has been identified using the Contour or Draw Band tools. It is the sum of the intensities of all the pixels within the band boundary multiplied by the area of each pixel. Units are intensity x mm².
- **Relative qty**—The quantity of a particular band in a lane expressed as a percentage of either (1) the total quantity of all the bands in the lane or (2) the total intensity data in the lane. The calculation method (% of Lane / % of Bands in Lane) is set in Application Preferences under Edit > Preferences.
- **Normalized qty**—The trace quantity of a particular band expressed as a percentage of the quantity of a selected band type that is present in the same lane.

If the quantity of the band you have selected is known, you can enter the quantity and units next to the Quantity / Units prompt.

If you want to calibrate that band against known quantities, you can do so by clicking on the Calibration button. You will be asked to select the calibration curve you want to use. (See page 305 for information on calibration curves.)

15.7 Gauss-Modeling Bands

If your bands are closely spaced or overlapping, Gaussian modeling can provide more accurate quantitation than regular band detection.

Gaussian modeling will “fit” a Gaussian curve to each band profile, then calculate band quantity from the area under the curve. Since the profile of a well-resolved, distinct band conforms to the shape of a Gaussian curve, this “fitting” will create a band profile that is as close to ideal as possible. For a band that overlaps with an adjacent band, Gaussian fitting provides the best way to resolve the area that overlaps. (This quantity would be lost with conventional band detection.)

Note: Gaussian modeling requires that your lanes have little or no background noise. You should subtract background from your lanes using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244) prior to modeling. Also, high-resolution images will require significantly more time to model. You may want to reduce image resolution using the File > Reduce File Size command (page 29).

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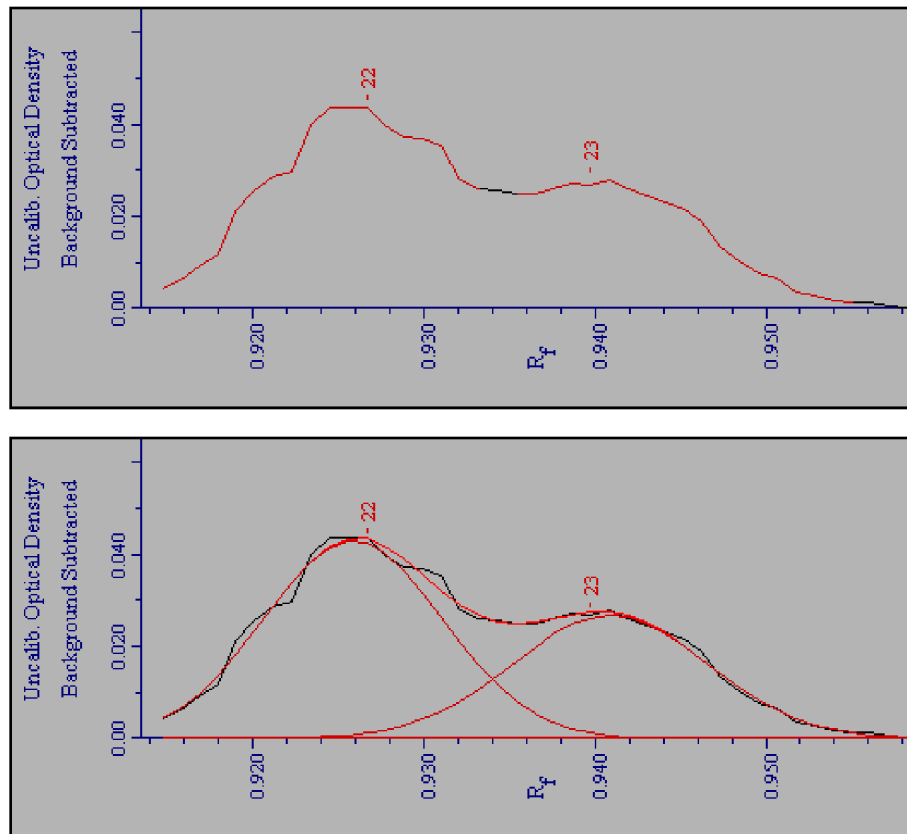


Fig.0-1. Profiles of two overlapping bands, without Gaussian modeling (top) and with Gaussian modeling (bottom). Note how modeling better resolves the individual quantities of the bands.

To model your bands using Gaussian fitting, first detect your bands as you would normally, then select Gauss-model Bands from the Band menu.

Note: Gaussian modeling will not create bands nor will it eliminate detected bands. It will simply apply a Gaussian curve to the profiles of the bands you have already identified.

Bands

A small dialog box will open prompting you to select all your lanes or one of your lanes to model.

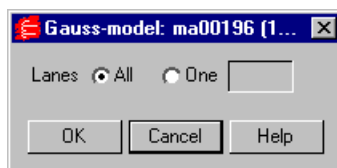


Fig. 15-13. Gauss-model Bands dialog box.

If you select One, type the number of the lane you want to model into the field.

Click on OK to begin modeling. A status box will display the progress of the modeling.

Reviewing the Results of Gaussian Modeling

Bands that have been Gauss-modeled will appear as normal bands in the image. To view the results of Gaussian fitting, magnify a few bands in a modeled lane using the Zoom Box tool, then select the Bands in Lane or Plot Band command from the Band menu and click on the lane.

The Plot Band command will show you the Gaussian curve superimposed on the profile of the individual band you clicked on. Bands in Lane will show you the Gaussian profiles of all the bands in the lane, superimposed on their intensity profiles (see Fig.0-1. for an example).

Band > Band Information will display information about the Gaussian peak and trace quantity for modeled bands that you click on. You can compare the Gaussian values to the values displayed for regular band detection.

These quantities can also be displayed in the Lane Report and All Lanes Report under the Report menu ().

Note: The quantities determined by Gaussian fitting cannot be used to in conjunction with Quantity Standards (page 307). However, you can continue to use the original trace quantities in calculating Quantity Standards after you have Gauss-modeled your bands.

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Adjusting Bands in a Gauss-modeled Lane

If you use any of the individual band commands—Create Band, Delete Band, Adjust Band—in a lane that has been Gauss-modeled, the modeling will be automatically removed from that lane. This is because the Gaussian models in a lane are interdependent: changing a single band will invalidate the modeling.

After you have made your band changes, you can always remodel the lane you have changed.

Incorrect Modeling

The Gauss-model Bands command will attempt to model all the bands in the lane(s) you select. You should carefully review the results of modeling using the Plot Band, Bands in Lane, and Band Information commands as described above.

If the Gaussian curve does not adequately conform to the profile of a band, or if the Gaussian peak and trace quantities differ greatly from the normal peak and trace quantities in the Band Information dialog, it may be because there is too much lane background. Try using the Lane > Lane Background command (page 244) with a smaller rolling disk size to remove more background, then remodel your lane.

If Gaussian modeling isn't working well with the bands in your image, you can always remove the modeling. To remove the modeling from a particular lane, select Remove One Gauss-model from the Band menu and click on the lane.

To remove the modeling from all lanes, select Remove All Gauss-models. You will be prompted to complete the action.

Removing Gaussian modeling will not affect any band detection or creation you may have done.

15.8 Irregularly Shaped Bands in Lanes

If the bands in your lanes are irregularly shaped, you can use the contour or drawing features to define them. These functions give you more control over defining your bands than either Detect Bands or Create Bands.

Note: These tools are similar to the Volume Contour Tool and the Volume Freehand Tool on the Volume menu, except that they are lane-dependent. If you want to quantify objects without defining lanes first, see Chapter 17.

Contoured or hand-drawn bands are quantitated based on the signal intensity of all the pixels within the band boundary, using the following formula:

$$\text{Quantity} = \text{Sum of (intensity of pixel} \times \text{pixel size) for all the pixels in the boundary.}$$

The intensity of a pixel is multiplied by the area of the pixel. This is done for all the pixels that are within the contour or drawn boundary. The area of the pixel is determined by the scan resolution of the image.

The resulting values have units of intensity $\times$ mm².

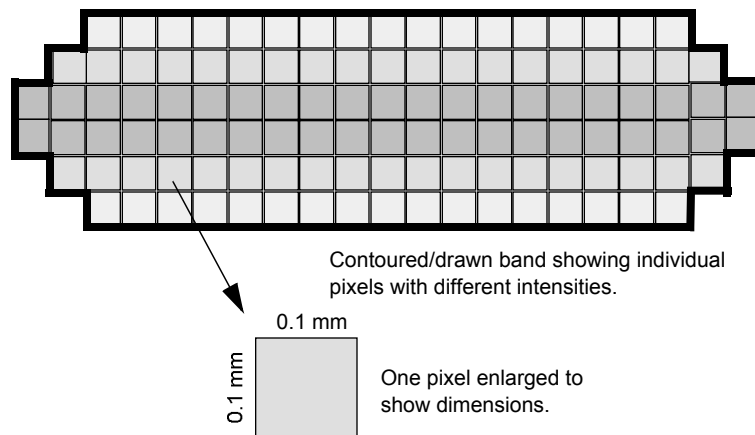


Fig. 15-14. A contoured/drawn band scanned at 100 x 100 microns (micrometers).

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The functions needed to contour and draw bands are found on the Contour and Draw Band submenus of the Band menu, as well as on the Contour Tools toolbar.

Before using any of these functions, we suggest that you magnify the image so that the individual pixels in the band are clearly visible. This allows you to position the cursor more accurately.

15.8.a Contouring Bands

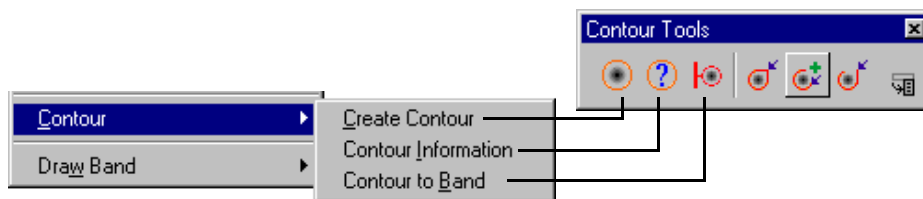


Fig. 15-15. Contour tools.

Creating Contours

Select Create Contour from the Band > Contour submenu or Contour Tools toolbar and click on a pixel at the edge of the band. This will display a contour that encloses pixels whose intensity is equal to or greater than that of the pixel at the cursor.

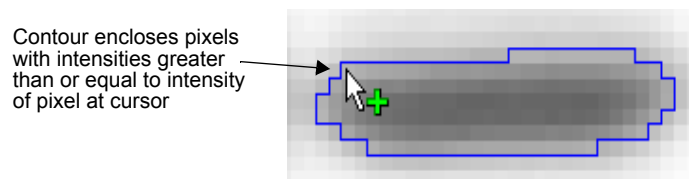


Fig. 15-16. Creating a Contour

If the contour does not encircle the band, reposition the cursor and click again. A new contour will be drawn in place of the old.

Bands

Contour Information

To display information about the contour, select Contour Information while the contour is highlighted. A pop-up box will display the area, total intensity, and average intensity of the contour.

Converting a Contour into a Band

When you are satisfied with the contour, you can redefine the contour as a band with the function Contour to Band.

Note: Before you can convert a contour into a band, you must define at least one lane on your gel image. You can define a lane using the Create Lane tool while the contour is currently displayed.

Selecting Contour to Band from the menu or toolbar converts any currently displayed contour into a band and assigns that band to the nearest lane. The contour boundary will change color from yellow to red, and a band line will appear on the nearest lane.

Note: You cannot perform Gaussian modeling on contoured bands, nor can you use the Plot Band command.

The areas and quantities of contoured bands can be displayed in reports if you select the Contour Area and Contour Qty formatting options. They can also be displayed on the image using Band > Band Attributes and selecting Contour Area and Contour Qty.

15.8.b Drawing Tools

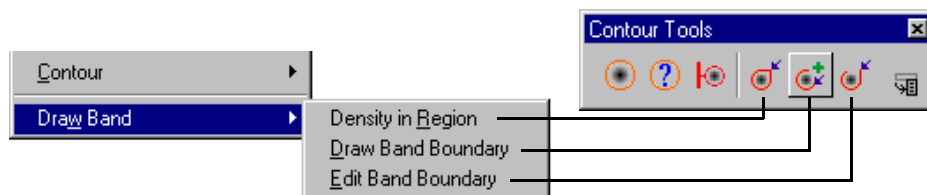


Fig. 15-17. Drawing tools.

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Density in Region

Use Density in Region to get intensity and area information about any region on an image.

Select Density in Region from the Band > Draw Band menu or Contour Tools toolbar. The cursor will change to an "information cursor." Drag the cursor as if it were a pen to enclose a region of interest.

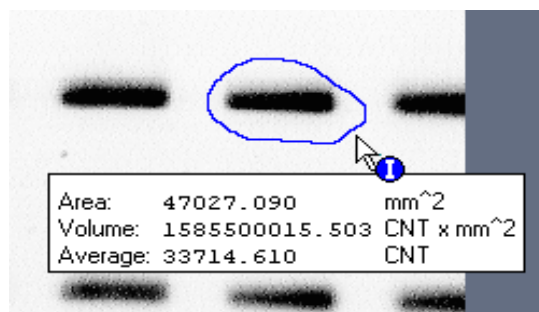


Fig. 15-18. Density in Region tool.

When you close the border, it will change color and a pop-up box with information about the enclosed area will be displayed.

For very small regions, you will have to magnify the region before using this command.

Drawing Band Boundaries

Note: You must have a lane defined on your image before using the drawing tools. The drawing tools work best if you first magnify the region you want to draw in using Zoom Box.

If you want to draw the boundary of a band manually, you can do so using Draw Band Boundary.

Select Draw Band Boundary from the Band > Draw Band menu or Contour toolbar. Your cursor will change to a pencil symbol.

Bands

Drag the cursor around the perimeter of the region you want to define as a band. A line will appear, defining the boundary.

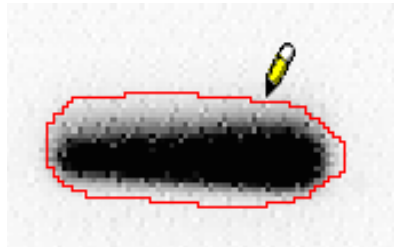


Fig. 15-19. Draw Band Boundary tool.

If you make a mistake and need to retrace part of the band boundary, simply backtrack with the cursor; the previous path will be erased and you can redraw it.

Note: It is important to magnify the image before drawing a boundary. If you try to draw a very small boundary, the software will think that you are backtracking and erase the boundary.

When the cursor crosses over the line you are drawing, the drawn band is complete and the color of the line will change to indicate that it is a boundary. A band line will appear on the nearest lane.

If you keep drawing, each time the line crosses itself a new band will be created, replacing the old band.

Note: You cannot perform Gaussian modeling on drawn bands, nor can you use the Plot Band command.

The areas and quantities of drawn bands can be displayed in reports if you select the Contour Area and Contour Qty formatting options. They can also be displayed on the image using Band > Band Attributes and selecting Contour Area and Contour Qty.

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Editing Band Boundaries

If your drawn band needs minor adjustments, you can fix it using Edit Band Boundary.

Select Edit Band Boundary from the Band > Draw Band menu or Contour toolbar. Your cursor will change to a pencil symbol.

Drag the cursor across the previously defined boundary; a line will appear. When you recross the old boundary, the line will change colors and the new boundary will be created.

16. Standards and Band Matching

After you have defined the lanes and bands in your image, you can define the molecular weight, base pair, or other standards and determine the values of the experimental bands using those standards. You can also match your experimental bands across lanes for comparisons of lane similarity.

Finally, you can identify bands of known quantity in your lanes and use these to generate a calibration curve for absolute quantitation of your unknown bands.

These tools are found on the Match menu and Match Tools toolbar.

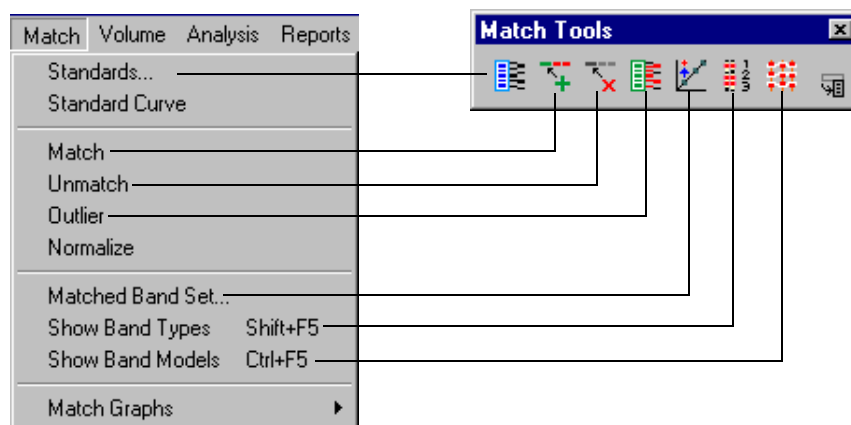


Fig. 16-1. Standards and matching tools.

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16.1 Defining and Applying Standards

If you are using molecular weight, isoelectric point, base pair, or other mobility standards on your gels (including predefined Bio-Rad standards), this section will describe how to define them on your images and automatically calculate the values of unknown bands.

Note: Multiple standard lanes in your gels will facilitate the band matching process outlined in the following sections. However, they are not required.

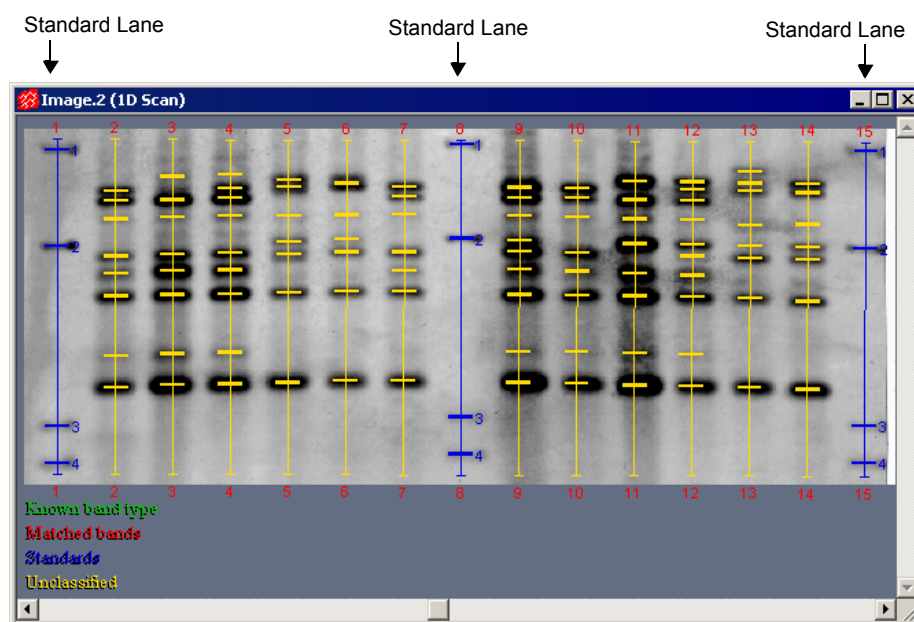


Fig. 16-2. Standard and experimental lanes and bands.

With your image open and lanes and bands defined, select Standards from the Match menu or Match Tools toolbar.

Standards and Band Matching

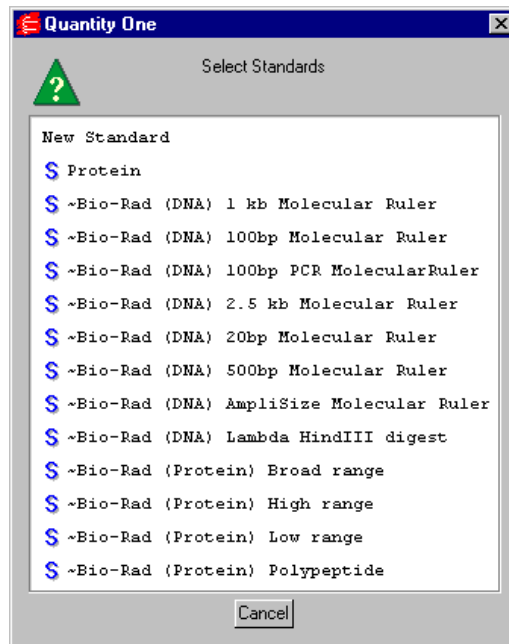


Fig. 16-3. Selecting a set of standards.

A list will open, prompting you to select new standards, previously created standards (if any), or predefined Bio-Rad standards. Sets of Bio-Rad molecular weight and base pair standards are included in your software installation.

Selecting Predefined Standards

If you are using Bio-Rad or other predefined standards, select them from the pop-up list. The Standards form will open, displaying the values of the standards.

Creating New Standards

To create a new set of standards, select New Standards. A dialog box will pop up in which you can specify the units.

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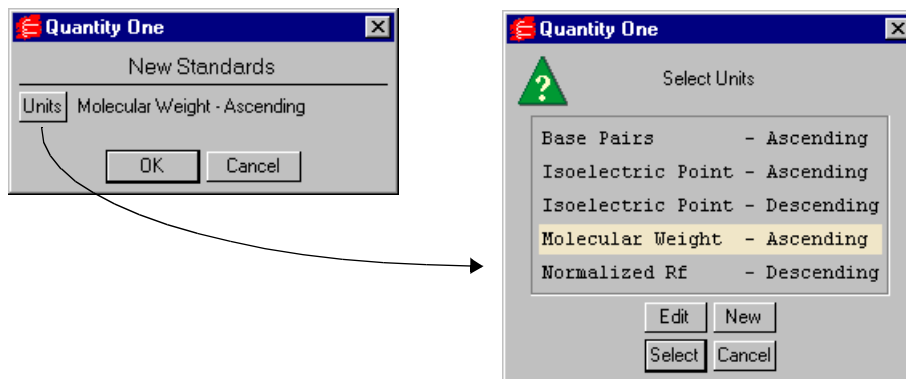


Fig. 16-4. Specifying units.

Click on the Units button to specify your units. This opens a dialog box in which you can select from a list that includes Base Pairs, Isoelectric Point, Molecular Weight, and Normalized Rf.

Note: Rf (relative front) expresses the distance a band has traveled down a lane as a fraction of either the total length of the lane or the vertical distance from the top of the lane to the bottom (the calculation method can be specified in Preferences). This provides a generic measure of the positions of bands in lanes. Normalized Rf is derived from relative front, and includes the results of modeling across the gel that comes when multiple lanes of standards are defined on the image. Such modeling is designed to take into account any distortion or smiling across a gel.

To specify a set of units not on the list, click on the New button, and define your new units in the dialog box. If you have already defined a new set of units, you can edit them by highlighting them and clicking on Edit.

Note: “Ascending” means that bands of higher molecular weight or isoelectric point are at the top of the gel image, and bands of lower molecular weight or isoelectric point are at the bottom of the gel image.

Click on the units you want and click on Select, then click on OK. The Standards form will open. Here you can enter values for your standards, apply them to the bands on your image, and save them as a set for future use.

Standards and Band Matching

16.1.a Standards Form

Standard: Protein

Comment: Pen mark standards.

Type: Standard

Units: Molecular Weight - Ascending

Enzyme: Primer:

Category: Probe:

Type	Name	KDa
1		200.000
2		116.500
3		94.000*
4		68.000*
5		57.000*
6		54.000*
7		45.000*
8		43.000*
9		30.000*
10		21.000*

Delete Close Archive Help

Fig. 16-5. Standards form.

The Standards form contains the values of your standards, and includes tools for applying them to the appropriate lanes in the image and displaying and adjusting the standards regression curve.

The form will open with a default name for the standards. For new standards, this will be a generic name (e.g., Standards 1); for Bio-Rad standards, this will

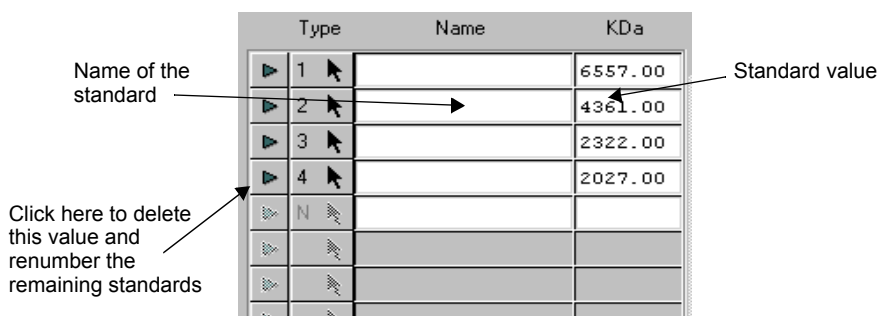
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be the descriptive name of the standards. You can change the name by typing in the text box next to the Standards prompt.

You can enter additional information next to the Comment prompt. The <category> buttons and fields can be used to further define your standards.

Entering Standard Values

If you are creating new standards, you must enter the values of your standard bands in the table in the middle of the form. Predefined standards will already have these values entered.



The screenshot shows a table with three columns: Type, Name, and KDa. The table contains four rows of standard values. Annotations with arrows point to specific parts of the table:

- "Name of the standard" points to the Name column header.
- "Standard value" points to the KDa column header.
- "Click here to delete this value and renumber the remaining standards" points to a delete icon in the Type column of the fifth row.

Type	Name	KDa
1		6557.00
2		4361.00
3		2322.00
4		2027.00
N		

Fig. 16-6. Entering the values of your standards.

The table has three columns, labeled Type, Name, and the units you previously selected (e.g., KDa, pI, Rf). In the units column, type a value for the first standard band and press the Return key. The cursor will skip to the field below, and you can enter a value for the second standard band. Repeat this process until all your standard values have been entered.

Note: The values do not need to be entered sequentially. They will automatically sort themselves in ascending or descending order, depending on how you specified the units.

You can enter a name for each standard band in the Name column. This will appear in subsequent reports and printouts.

Standards and Band Matching

To remove a standard value, click on the triangle button at the beginning of the row and select Delete from the pop-up box. The remaining standards will be renumbered.

Applying Standard Values to Lanes

To apply the values to the standard lanes on your image, click on the Apply to Lane button, then click on a lane.

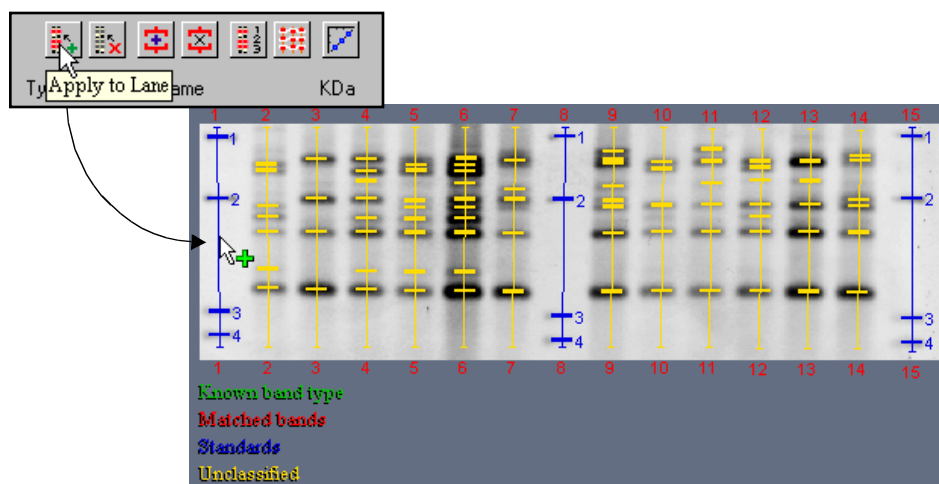


Fig. 16-7. Click on the Apply to Lane button, then click on the lanes containing standards.

The values will be applied to the bands in the lane you select. Click on any remaining standard lanes to apply the same values to them.

Note: Generally, the more evenly spaced standard lanes in your gels, the greater the accuracy of the calculated band values. We recommend a minimum of two standard lanes per gel. Modeling lines that connect the standard bands in different lanes are used to compensate for any smiling or distortion across the gel.

You can also click on the numbered button next to a band value to apply that value to a particular band in a lane on your image. Click on the button, then

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click on the band to be assigned the standard value. The subsequent bands in the lane will be numbered sequentially based on the initial assignment.

Click here to apply this standard value to a particular band on your image

Type	Name	KDa
▶ 1 ▶		6557.00
▶ 2 ▶		4361.00
▶ 3 ▶		2322.00
▶ 4 ▶		2027.00
▶ N ▶		

Fig. 16-8. Applying standard values.

After you have applied the standard values to a lane, the bands in that lane will change color to blue, indicating that they are now standards.

You are now ready to select the standards regression curve to use for calculating your unknowns.

Removing Standard Values from Lanes

The Clear from Lane button removes all the standard values from the lane(s) you select. Click on the button, then click on the lane or lanes from which you want to delete the standard values.

Showing the Modeling Lines

After you have applied the standard values, you can show the modeling lines for the standards by clicking on the Show Modeling Lines button. Bands that fall along these lines will have the same values as the standards.

To redisplay only the band numbers with no modeling lines, click on the Show Band Types button.

16.1.b Standards Regression Curve

After you have applied the standard values to the image, you are ready to select the regression model to use to calculate the values of your unknown

Standards and Band Matching

bands. (Note: You must apply the values to a lane before you can view and adjust the regression curve.)

Click on the Standard Curve button in the Standards form, then click on a lane. A graph of the standards regression curve is displayed on the image, and the Standard Curve Options dialog is displayed as well.

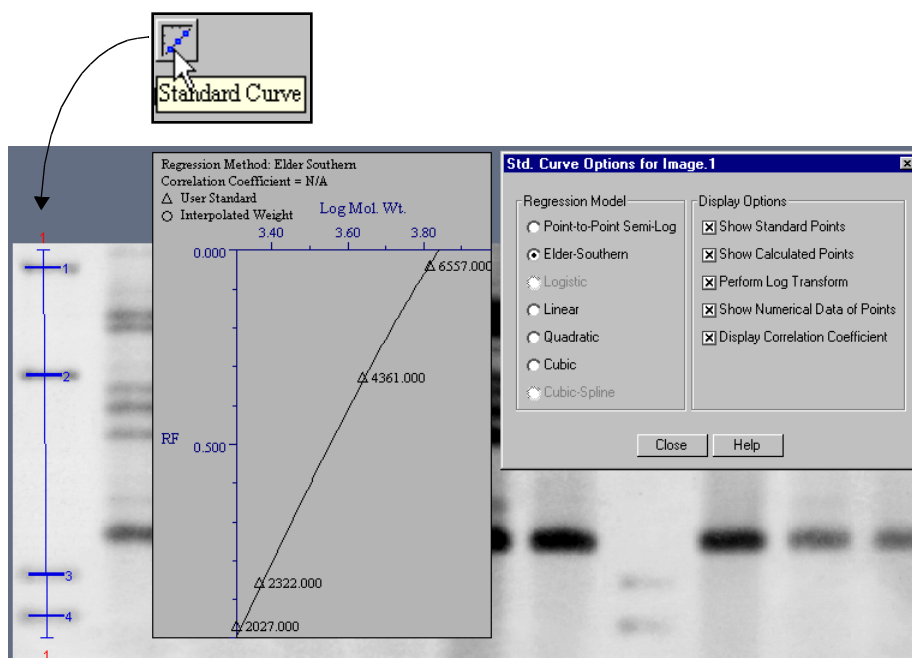


Fig. 16-9. Displaying the standard curve and options dialog box.

As you click on different lanes, the curve is displayed for each lane in turn.

The X axis is the standard value or log thereof and the Y axis is the Rf value.

Use the options dialog to change the regression model for the curve, as well as various display options.

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Standards Regression Models

Select different regression models in the options dialog box while you study the standard curve with the standard points displayed (see display options below). Then choose a curve that best fits the data points. (The correlation coefficient—see below—provides another measure of curve fit.)

Note: Note that point-to-point semi-log is the only method available if you perform band matching on your image, because band matching adjusts the positional values of bands in localized areas based on your identification. Point-to-point semi-log is appropriate for this kind of localized variation, whereas the other methods are not. Therefore, you should select point-to-point semi-log if you intend to perform band matching (required for similarity analysis) on your gel.

Point-to-point semi-log. This and the Elder-Southern method are especially useful for describing band migration in static-field electrophoresis gels. Note that this is the only method available if you perform band matching on your image (see above).

Elder-Southern. This and the point-to-point semi-log method are especially useful for describing band migration in static-field electrophoresis gels. At least three standard points are required to use this method.

Linear. This method of least-squares polynomial fits is useful for modeling pulsed-field electrophoresis gels.

Quadratic. At least three standard points are required to use this method of least-squares polynomial fits.

Cubic. At least four standard points are required to use this method of least-squares polynomial fits.

Logistic. At least five standard points are required to use this method of nonlinear least-squares curve fitting.

Cubic-Spline. At least five standard points are required to use this beta-cubic-spline method.

Standards and Band Matching

Display Options

The following options will change how the curve graph is displayed:

Show Standard Points displays the standard data points on the graph. The standard points in that lane will be marked on the graph as triangles. Note that known band types will appear marked as standards.

Show Calculated Points displays the calculated points on the graph. The calculated points in the lane will be marked on the graph as circles.

Perform Log Transform changes the shape of the curve from linear to log. This will not change the calculated values.

Show Numerical Data of Points displays the value of each band on the graph next to its corresponding point.

Display Correlation Coefficient displays the correlation coefficient for the linear, quadratic, and cubic regression models.

Note: The correlation coefficient is a measure of how well the regression model fits the data. It is the square root of the proportion of total variation that can be explained by the regression model. A correlation coefficient of 1.000 would indicate 100 percent certainty of fit.

16.1.c Displaying Calculated Values

To view the calculated values of all the bands in your gel image, select Band Attributes from the Band menu, then select the value to be displayed (molecular weights, base pairs, etc.).

Values can be displayed and printed in report format using the lane and match reports (page 355).

16.1.d Saving, Opening, and Deleting Standards

Standards are saved with the image; you can also save copies of them in a separate archive that is available to all images.

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To save the standard values with the image, click on the Close button to close the Standards form, then save the image. When you open the image again, the standards will be available when you select Standards.

If you want to save these standards for use on other images, click on the Archive button. The standards will be saved in an archive file separately from the image.

To use a set of archived standards, open any image, then choose Standards from the menu or toolbar and select the archived standards. They will be imported into the image.

To delete a set of standards you have created, open them, then click on the Delete button at the bottom of the form. A pop-up box will ask you to confirm that you want to proceed with the deletion before completing the action. This will delete the standards from both the image and the archive.

To modify a set of standards you have created, open them, make your changes, then save the image and (if desired) archive the new standards.

Read-Only Standards

You can make your archived standards read-only (i.e., they cannot be deleted from or modified in the archive using the methods described above; they can still be deleted from or modified in the image).

Simply insert a tilde character (~) in front of the name of the standards, then click on the Archive button. These standards will always be available under that name in the list of standards.

All Bio-Rad standards are read-only.

Disabling/Deleting the Archive

If you do not want to have access to the archived standards (including Bio-Rad standards), simply remove the ONEDPREFS.DBS database from the FIXED.PRM folder on your hard drive. Under Windows, this folder is located in the Bio-Rad/Program Files/The Discovery Series directory. On the Macintosh, this file is located in The Discovery Series folder in the Preferences folder in your System Folder.

Standards and Band Matching

After you remove this file, a new, empty ONEDPREFS.DBS database will be automatically created the next time you open an image. You can use this to begin a new archive.

16.2 Band Matching

To compare the similarity of the lanes in your image (using the phylogenetic tree, similarity matrix, etc.), you must first identify all the bands in the gel and match identical bands in different lanes. The functions for doing this are located on the Match menu and toolbar.

Note: If you have run standards on your gels, you should define them before proceeding. Multiple lanes of standards will facilitate the band matching program; however, they are not required.

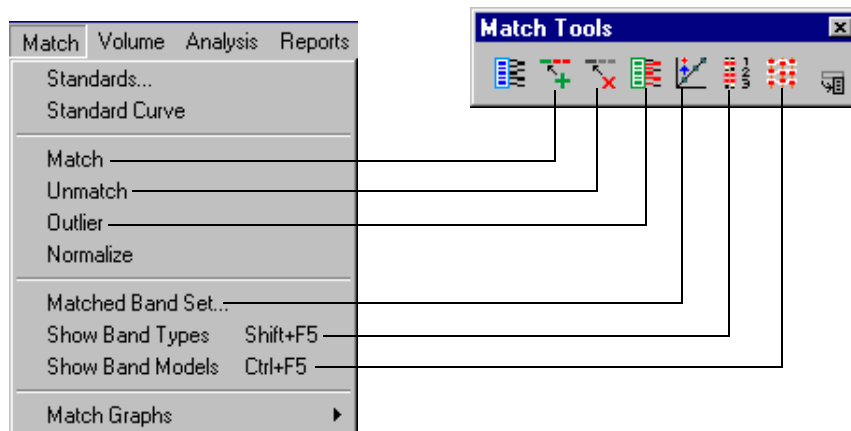


Fig. 16-10. Matching tools.

Select Match from the menu or toolbar, then click on a representative experimental lane in your gel image. This may be a lane that contains most or all of the bands that you are interested in, and /or a lane in which the bands are particularly well-resolved. Each band in this lane will be designated as a different "band type."

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If you have defined standards in the gel, a pop-up box will warn you that the regression model for calculating band values will be restricted to point-to-point semi-log. If you selected a different regression model when defining standards, it will be changed.

The first time you click on an experimental lane with the Match command, a pop-up box will prompt you to specify the matching tolerance.



Fig. 16-11. Query box: Apply matching to the whole lane?

Note: Tolerance is the minimum spacing that the matching model expects to find between unique bands. It is expressed as a percent of lane height. You can enter a value between 0.2 and 10 percent. If your bands are very close together, enter a tolerance of 2.5 percent or less.

After you select a tolerance, click on Yes to automatically match all the bands in the image. (Click on No to match only the specific band you clicked on.)

When you click on Yes, the bands in the lane you selected will change to green, indicating that they are known band types that have been identified by you. A band type number will appear next to each band.

The automatic matching mechanism will attempt to match the bands in your image to the known band types. Matched bands are labeled in red, with the number of the band type appearing next to each band. These matched bands are connected by modeling lines.

Standards and Band Matching

Yellow bands are bands that the software cannot accurately match. The matching algorithm is deliberately conservative to avoid incorrect labeling, so a number of yellow bands may appear on the image.

Your next step will be to identify the yellow bands as either new band types, or existing band types that could not be automatched.

To summarize:

- **Green bands** are known band types, based on your identification.
- **Red bands** are bands that have been automatically matched with the known band types.
- **Yellow bands** are bands that have not been matched and are unclassified.

Displaying Band Types and Modeling Lines

To display the band type numbers on the image, select Show Band Types from the Match menu or toolbar.

Band type modeling lines reveal the path along the gel image that the software uses to match bands of the same type in different lanes. These lines are based on the positions of the known (green) bands and any standards you may have defined.

To display the band type modeling lines, select Show Band Models from the Match menu or toolbar. The currently assigned band types will appear, as will the modeling lines connecting the band types.

16.2.a Editing the Results of Band Matching

After you have matched the bands in your gel image automatically, you can manually match the remaining yellow bands using the match tools on the Match menu and toolbar.

You can use these tools to manually change the band type of a band, create new band types, unmatch bands, or identify bands as outliers from your band set.

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Note: Band types should only be added to areas of the gel image that are modeled well. The modeling lines are designed to give you guidance on adding new band types.

- To create a new band type from an unknown (yellow) band, select Match and click on the unknown band.
- To change a band to a particular band type, select Match and first click on the red or green band with the desired band type. This band type will be assigned to your mouse. Then click on the red or yellow band you want to change. The band will appear green (known) and the modeling line will change to reflect the assignment of the band type.
- To change the status of a matched (red) band to known (green), select Match from the menu or toolbar and double-click on the red band.
- To create a new band type from a matched (red) band, select Match, hold down the SHIFT key, and click on the red band.
- To change a band type to unknown (yellow), select Unmatch and click on that band.
- To not include a green band in band type modeling, select Outlier and click on that band. An X will appear through the band, indicating that the software is ignoring it when modeling band types across the gel image.

You should perform manual matching until all the bands in your image are assigned to band types. Your gel should have no yellow (unknown) bands visible.

On well-modeled gels, the modeling lines (see above) will intersect at or near the middle of both red and green bands across the gel. If your gel contains serious distortions, and the modeling lines are not even, you should consider using a different gel from which to build your band set. Poor modeling on your first gel will influence the modeling on all the subsequent gels in your database, so take your time while creating the band set, and choose the best possible gel on which to base the modeling.

16.2.b Band Set Form

The Band Set form contains the values of all the bands in your band set, a toolbar with the functions needed for manual band matching, and other information.

Standards and Band Matching

To open the form, select Matched Band Set from the Match menu or toolbar, then click anywhere on the image.

Proteins - Band Set

Band Set: Band Set 3

Comment:

Type: Experimental

Units: Molecular Weight - Ascending

Tolerance: 3.00%

Normalization: Band Type 23

Enzyme: <category>

<category> <category>

Type	Name	KDa
▶ 1		289.310
▶ 2		277.593
▶ 3		251.421
▶ 4		241.160
▶ 5		225.754
▶ 6		206.128
▶ 7		183.106
▶ 8		163.527
▶ 9		154.097
▶ 10		148.081

First Lane Delete Close Help

Fig. 16-12. Band Set form.

The form will open with a default name for the band set (e.g., Band Set 1). You can type a new name in the Band Set field at the top of the form, and add any comments or category/attribute information you want to associate with the band set.

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List of Band Types

The values of the individual band types are listed within the dialog box in a table format. These values reflect any standards you have defined (e.g., molecular weight, base pairs, etc.). If you have not defined standards, Normalized Rf units are used.

Type	Name	KDa
▶ 1		289.310
▶ 2		277.593
▶ 3		251.421
▶ 4		241.160
▶ 5		225.754
▶ 6		206.128
▶ 7		183.106
▶ 8		163.527
▶ 9		154.097
▶ 10		148.081

Fig. 16-13. Applying and editing band type values.

If you change any of the band type values in the list, that will be reflected in the band type modeling on your image.

You can assign a particular band type to a band on your image. Click on the numbered arrow button in the Type column to assign that band type to the mouse, then click on a band on your image to change that band to the assigned band type.

You can enter names for your band types in the Name column. These will appear in subsequent reports and print-outs.

To remove a band type from the set, click on the triangle icon associated with the particular band type. A pop-up box will ask for confirmation, and the remaining band types will be renumbered.

Standards and Band Matching

Band Set Toolbar

The toolbar in the Band Set form contains all the commands needed for matching.

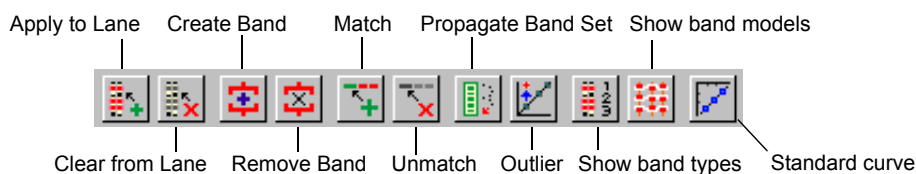


Fig. 16-14. Band set toolbar.

Apply to Lane applies the band set to any lane in your gel image. Click on the button, then click on the lane. The bands in that lane that can be matched will change to red.

Clear from Lane removes the band set modeling from any lane in your gel image. Click on the button, then click on the lane to be cleared. The bands in the lane will change to yellow.

Create Band and Remove Band are standard band commands that have been included in the toolbar for convenience.

Match is used to define a band as a new band type. Click on the button, then click on the unknown (yellow) band to create a new band type. Note that if you click on a lane that has not been included in a band set, you will be prompted to create a new band type for every band in the lane.

Unmatch will change a band's definition from matched or known to unknown. Click on this button, then click on the matched (red) or known (green) band to change it to unknown.

Propagate Band Set applies all the known band types to the bands in a lane, based on a few manually-assigned bands and the band set model. Click on this button, then click on the lane. The bands in that lane that can be matched will change to green to indicate their known status.

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Outlier excludes a known (green) band from the band set model. However, the band will still be marked as known.

Show Band Types displays all the red, green, and yellow bands on the image, with the band type numbers next to the matched bands.

Show Band Models displays the band set modeling lines across the gel image.

Standard Curve displays the Standards Regression Curve (see section 16.1.b). Click on the button, then click on any lane in the image.

Other Band Set Form Functions

The band set units are displayed in the top half of the form, as is the matching tolerance used. Tolerance is the minimum spacing between band types that you specified when you created the band set.

The Normalization button allows you to pick a specific band type to normalize the relative quantities of your other bands against (see section 12.2, Differential Display, for more information).

Click on the resize button in the lower right corner to reconfigure the form to its smaller, palette version, which displays only the tool buttons and band type buttons.

To delete the band set, click on the Delete button.

To close the band set, click on OK.

Note that the band set is saved when you save the image.

16.2.c Tips for Gels Without Standards

Ideally, if you are not using standards in your gels, you will have more than one lane containing a reference sample in your gel. After you've used this reference sample to create a band set, you should apply that band set to other reference sample lanes using the Propagate Band Set button (in the Band Set form).

Standards and Band Matching

Propagate Band Set is a feature that not only simplifies assigning band types, it allows the software to do some optimizations that will significantly speed up modeling.

Choose a reference sample lane that you want to apply the band set to. Start by assigning one or two band types in the lane that are easy to identify, then click on the Propagate Band Set button and click on the lane to assign the remaining band types to the lane.

Propagate Band Set assigns the band types one at a time. The command will assign a type to a band only if it is very sure that it is the correct assignment.

Once your reference sample lanes have been modeled, add any unknown band types to the gel using the methods outlined in section 16.2.a above.

16.2.d Normalizing for Quantity

You can normalize the quantities of the bands in your image to the quantity of a particular matched band that appears in all lanes. This is useful if you have loaded different amounts of sample in each lane.

Note: Quantity normalization is required for calculating Differential Display.

Select Normalize from the Match menu and click on a matched band that appears in every lane. (If the band is not present in a lane, the normalized quantity for that lane will be zero.) The quantity of that band will be set to 100 in each lane, and the quantities of the other bands will be normalized to that band.

You can view the normalized quantities using the Band > Band Attributes command.

16.2.e Graphs of Match Data

You can display graphs of different kinds of data associated with your matched bands. The commands for displaying these are located on the Match > Match Graphs submenu.

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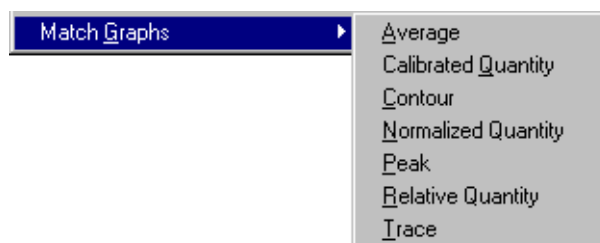


Fig. 16-15. Match Graphs submenu.

From the Match Graphs submenu, select the match graph you want to display, then click on a matched band. The bands in the matched group will be displayed, as will the histogram that you chose.

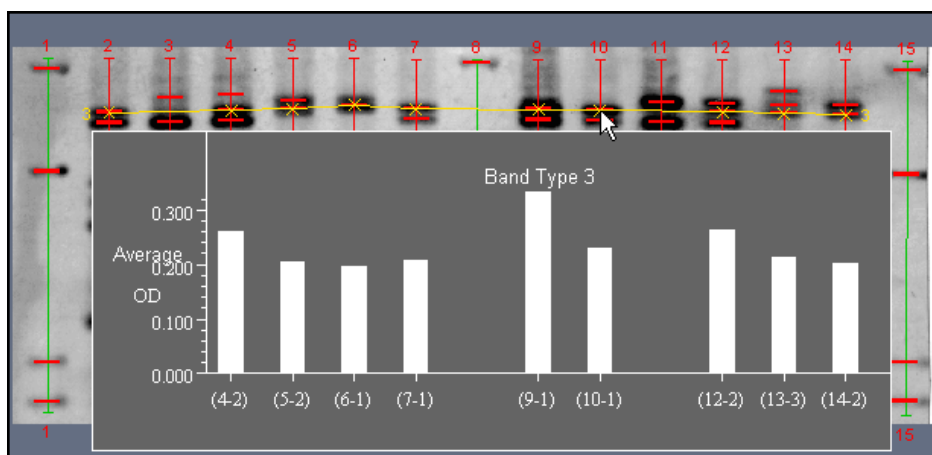


Fig. 16-16. Example of a match graph.

- **Average** displays a histogram of the average densities of the bands in a band type.
- **Calibrated Quantity** displays a histogram of the absolute quantities of the bands in a band type based on a calibration curve (for more information on calculating absolute band quantities, refer to section 16.3).
- **Contour** displays a histogram of the density of each contoured band in a

Standards and Band Matching

band type. This function only works with contoured bands.

- **Normalized Quantity** displays a histogram of the normalized quantities of the bands in a band type. See section 16.2.d for instructions on how to normalize for quantity.
- **Peak** displays a histogram of the peak densities of the bands in a band type.
- **Relative Quantity** displays a histogram in which each bar represents the quantity of the band in a band type as a percentage of either (1) the total intensity data in the band's lane, or (2) the total intensity of all the bands in the band's lane. The calculation method (% of Lane / % of Bands in Lane) may be selected in Edit > Preferences.
- **Trace** displays a histogram of the integrated densities of the bracketed bands in a band type.

Each bar of the histogram will be labeled on the X axis with the lane number, and (where space permits) the band number. The Y axis is labeled with quantitative values.

The histogram display reserves space on the left side to label the Y axis and show its units. If the bands in the match group span the entire window from the left edge to the right, the histogram will not include bars for the bands in the left-most lanes because of the space required for labeling the axis.

To avoid this problem, decrease the magnification of the image using Zoom Out until there is blank space between the left side of the window and the first band of the match group.

Redisplay the histogram. If one or more bars are still not included, continue decreasing the magnification until you can see a bar lining up with each lane that contains a band in the match group in which you are interested.

16.3 Quantity Standards

From bands of known quantity, you can generate a calibration curve for determining the absolute quantities of all the bands in your lanes or cells in your lane-based arrays. (To quantitate bands outside of lanes, see Chapter 17.)

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Note: Relative quantity expresses the quantity of each band as a percentage of either all the bands in a lane or the total intensity of a lane (depending on the setting in Preferences). This can tell you that there is twice as much of Band X than Band Y; however, it does not tell you how many micrograms there are of Band X in the gel. Absolute quantity is calculated based on the relative quantity, standards, and a calibration curve that you create.

First the software calculates the relative quantity of each band from the area under the intensity profile peak. Using the Quantity Standards function, you then identify standards of known quantity and use these to generate a calibration curve. You can apply this curve to unknown bands in the current image as well as other images.

To create a calibration curve, the absolute quantities of at least two bands must be known. The greater the number of known bands and the wider the range of their values, the more accurate the calibration curve will be.

Note: The quantities calculated by Gaussian fitting (page 275) cannot be used to in conjunction with Quantity Standards. However, you can continue to use the original trace quantities in calculating Quantity Standards after you have Gauss-modeled your bands.

16.3.a Creating and Applying a Set of Quantity Standards

Choose Quantity Standards from the Match menu. A pop-up box will appear, asking you to create a new curve or load a previously defined calibration curve (if any has been saved).

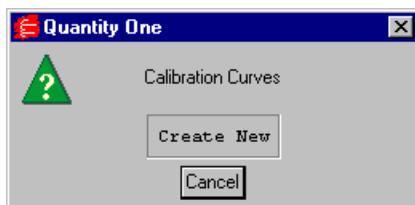


Fig. 16-17. Loading a quantity calibration curve.

Selecting Create New will open the Quantity Standards dialog box.

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Quantity Standards for Proteins (1D ScaQty Stds)

Name: Cal 1 Units: Origin:

Description:

Measure Trace Units OD x mm

Select: Band Match Lane

Calibrate: Band Match Lane Gel

Un-Calibrate: Band Match Lane Gel

Interpolation: ☒ Point to Point ☐ Linear Regression

Extrapolation: ☒ Yes ☐ No

Band	Trace OD x mm	Quantity	Dilution Factor	Status	Rel. Dev.
6-12	4.042	0.60		Known	4%
10-13	3.705	0.53		Known	4%
11-13	2.061	0.30		Known	3%
8- 8	1.561	0.22		Known	2%
12- 8	1.059	0.15		Known	1%
8- 7	0.2204	0.03		Known	10%

Show Curve Import Curve OK Delete Help

Fig. 16-18. Quantity Standards dialog box.

The dialog box will open with a default name for the quantity standards (e.g., Cal 1). Enter a new name and specify the quantity value units (e.g., mg).

You can enter descriptive information next to the Description prompt.

The calibration curve is generated by plotting the known quantity values you provide against the intensity-based quantitation. There are several intensity-derived values that can be used for the Y axis of the plot. Click on the button labeled Measure to display a list from which to make your choice.

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Selecting Bands of Known Quantity

The dialog box includes three buttons that are used to select bands on the gel image with which to generate the calibration curve. These buttons are located next to the Select prompt.



Fig. 16-19. Buttons for selecting bands of known quantity.

- To select bands one at a time, click on the Band button, then click on each band of known quantity. Each band will be highlighted.
- If all of the bands are the same band type, click on the Match button, then click on one of the bands in the matched group. The group will be highlighted.
- If all of the bands are in one lane, click on the Lane button, then click on the lane with the known quantities. The entire lane will be highlighted.

In the lower part of the Quantity Standards dialog box, the lane and band numbers of the selected bands will appear in the Band column. The values derived from their signal intensities are also displayed.

Entering the Quantity Standards

After selecting the bands to be used as quantity standards, enter their quantities in the appropriate fields in the Quantity column.

After you have entered each quantity, the band status in the Status column changes from Unknown to Known.

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Band	Trace	Quantity		Dilution		Rel. Dev.	
	OD x mm			Factor	Status		
6-12	4.042	0.60			Known	2%	
10-13	3.705	0.53			Known	2%	
11-13	2.061	0.30			Known	1%	
8- 8	1.561	0.22			Known	2%	
12- 8	1.059	0.15			Known	0%	
8- 7	0.2204	0.03			Known	11%	

Fig. 16-20. Entering the known quantities.

After you have entered a few quantities, the status of the remaining bands in the list may change to O.R., meaning that the remaining bands are out of the current range of values (based on their intensity and what you have already entered).

Alternatively, the software may automatically calculate an unknown quantity (if it is between two known quantities) and enter a value for it; in this case the Status column will indicate that the quantity has been calculated (Calc.)

In either case, you can type a quantity directly into the Quantity column and the status will change to Known.

Relative Deviation of Known Quantities

After three values have been entered, relative deviations are automatically calculated and displayed in the Rel. Dev. column. These values are based on the difference between the known value that you entered and the values that would have been calculated from the calibration curve.

If the deviation value is too high, you may want to exclude a band from the calibration curve. Click on the arrow button next to the problem band. A pop-up box offers several different band status options from which to choose.

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To remove a band from the quantity standards and omit it from calibration curve calculations, click on the Remove option. All the information regarding that band will be deleted from the quantity standards file.

Alternatively, you can select Outlier from the pop-up list. This retains the information about the band in the calibration file but does not include it when calculating the calibration curve.

16.3.b The Calibration Curve

Calibration Curve Settings

In the Quantity Standards dialog box, select the method with which the calibration curve should be calculated. Next to the Interpolation prompt, choose either Point to Point or Linear Regression.

- **Point to Point** produces a curve in which each point is connected to the next, regardless of the shape of the resulting curve.
- **Linear Regression** (using the method of Least Squares) produces a curve which is the “best fit” of the values you provided.

Next, indicate whether the curve should be extrapolated. If you choose not to extrapolate, the highest and lowest values you entered will be the ends of the curve and you will be unable to calculate the estimated quantity for any bands that lie outside that range. If you want to extrapolate, you can calculate a quantity value for any band on the gel. But bands whose quantities are calculated from the extrapolated region of the curve may be less accurate.

Displaying the Calibration Curve

To display the calibration curve, click on the Show Curve button at the bottom of the Quantity Standards dialog box. A graph of known quantity versus measured density will be displayed in a separate window.

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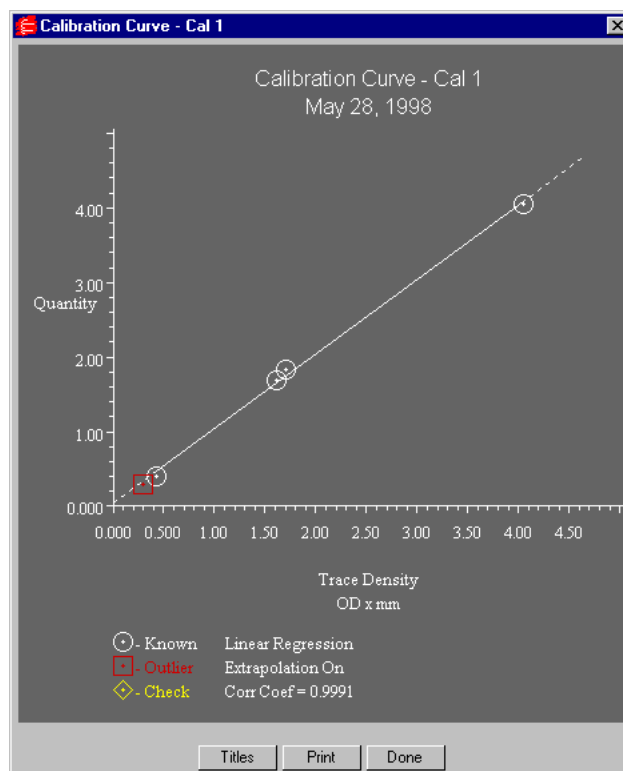


Fig. 16-21. Calibration curve with titles displayed, linear regression, and extrapolation.

Points used to calculate the curve are enclosed in circles. Points that you identify as Outliers are enclosed in squares.

- To change the status of a point on the graph, click on it. The status will toggle between Known and Outlier.
- To see the legend for the different types of points on the graph, click on the Titles button.
- To print this graph, click on the Print button.
- To close the window displaying the graph, click on the Done button.

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16.3.c Applying the Calibration Curve

Once you have selected known bands and entered values for them, you are ready to choose the bands whose quantities you want to calculate with the calibration curve. This is done using the buttons found next to the Calibrate prompt.

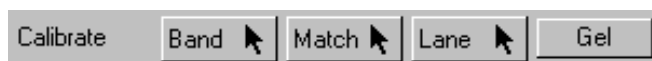


Fig. 16-22. Buttons for calibrating bands of unknown quantity.

- To quantitate individual bands, click on Band, then click on the band of interest.
- To quantitate all the bands in a matched group, click on Match, then click on any of the bands in the matched group.
- To quantitate all the bands in a lane, click on Lane, then click on a lane of interest.
- To quantitate all the bands in the image, click on Gel.

Calibrated bands are highlighted after they are selected.

Unapplying the Calibration Curve

To undo the calibration of a band, match, lane, or gel, use the corresponding command next to the Un-Calibrate prompt.

16.3.d Generating Standard Bands via a Dilution Series

One way to get a set of bands of known quantity is by starting with a stock solution and making several dilutions from it. A different dilution can be loaded onto each lane of a gel, resulting in a group of bands whose quantities can be calculated from the known quantity used to make up the stock solution and the dilution factor.

Quantity One will perform these calculations for you if you provide it with the known quantity and the dilution factor (e.g., for a solution that has been diluted to 10 times the volume, type 1/10 or 0.1).

Standards and Band Matching

In the Quantity Standards dialog box, next to the band that came from the undiluted stock solution, enter the known quantity.

In the Dilution Factor column, type “stock.”

Next to each of the other bands in the dialog box, enter the dilution factor in the Dilution Factor column.

Band	Trace	Quantity	Dilution	Status	Rel. Dev.
	OD x mm		Factor		
6-12	4.042	0.60	Stock	Known	3%
10-13	3.705	0.48	.8	Known	12%
11-13	2.061	0.36	.6	Known	13%
8- 8	1.561	0.24	.4	Known	3%
12- 8	1.059	0.18	.3	Known	1%
8- 7	0.2204	0.06	.1	Known	9%

Fig. 16-23. Entering a dilution series.

The quantity of each band will be automatically calculated.

16.3.e Importing a Calibration Curve

A calibration curve created on one gel image can be applied to bands on other images.

Make sure that both the image you want to quantitate and the image with the calibration curve are currently open.

Click on the image you want to quantitate. Select Match > Quantity Standards and click on “create new.”

In the Quantity Standards dialog box, click on the Import Curve button. From the list displayed, choose the calibration curve you want to use to quantitate bands on the image.

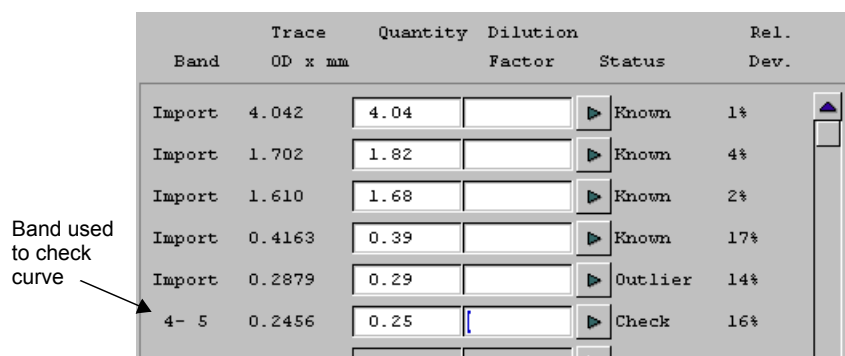
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When you make your selection, the values associated with it will be displayed in the Quantity Standards dialog box. Each standard value will be labeled "Import" in the Band column.

Checking the Imported Curve

If the quantity of one or more bands in the image is known, you can use this information to double-check the imported calibration curve to ensure that it accurately quantifies the bands on this image.

To check these known bands against the calibration curve, go to the Select prompt, click on Band, then click on the known band. Its lane number, band number, and intensity will be displayed in one of the standard values fields.



Band	Trace OD x mm	Quantity	Dilution Factor	Status	Rel. Dev.
Import	4.042	4.04		Known	1%
Import	1.702	1.82		Known	4%
Import	1.610	1.68		Known	2%
Import	0.4163	0.39		Known	17%
Import	0.2879	0.29		Outlier	14%
4- 5	0.2456	0.25		Check	16%

Fig. 16-24. Checking an imported calibration curve.

When you enter the band's value, its status will change to Check. This indicates that it is a check point and is not included in the calculation of the calibration curve.

If you display the graph by clicking on the Show Curve button, these check points are enclosed in diamonds. These check points should fall on or very near the calibration curve. If that is not the case, we recommend that you *do not use* the imported standards, since the selected calibration curve will probably not give you accurate quantity data for this gel image.

17. Volume Tools

You can use the Volume tools to quantitate bands, spots, arrays, and other image data.

What is a Volume?

A volume is the intensity data inside a defined boundary drawn on your image.

Volume = $\frac{\text{Sum of the intensities of the pixels within the volume}}{\text{boundary} \times \text{pixel area}}$

Volume units = intensity units $\times \text{mm}^2$

Volumes are similar to band contours (page 280), except that they are not dependent on lanes and bands.

To measure the amount of a particular object in an image, you draw a volume rectangle, contour, freehand, or circle around the object and compare the intensity data inside the boundary with the data of other objects or a standard using the Volume Analysis Report and Volume Regression Curve.

Note: The Volume Analysis Report and Volume Regression Curve are described in Chapter 20.

17.1 Creating a Volume Object

To create a volume, open the Volume Tools by clicking on the Volume Overlay Tools button on the main toolbar, or selecting Volume Overlay Tools from the Edit menu. (These commands are also located on the Volume menu.)

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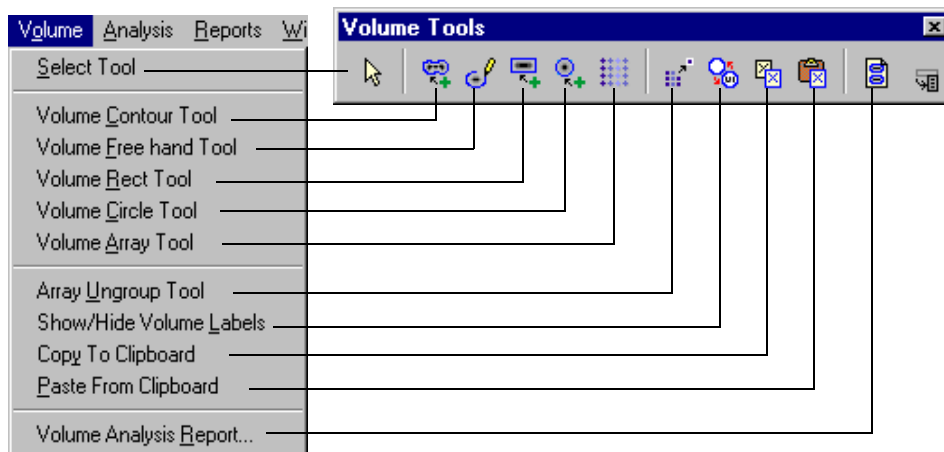


Fig. 17-1. Volume tools.

Note: When using any of the following tools, be careful to completely surround the data you want to quantitate. You should also adjust for background intensity (see section 17.4 below). You may want to experiment with several different volumes drawn around the same object before selecting the one that gives you the best quantitation data.

Volume Contour Tool

The Volume Contour tool will quickly create a volume boundary that follows the outer edge of the object you want to quantify. To use this tool, first magnify the object using the Zoom tools, then click on the Volume Contour button.

- If you click on a pixel at the edge of the object, you will create a contour that encloses pixels whose intensity is equal to or greater than that of the pixel at the cursor.
- If you click and drag the mouse when creating a contour, the shape of the contour will change as you move over pixels of different intensity. Drag from inside the object outward until the contour follows the outer edge of the object. When you release the mouse button, the volume is created.

Volume Tools

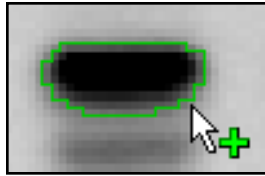


Fig. 17-2. Volume contour.

The contour should completely surround the data you want to quantify.

To edit the contour, position your cursor on the border. Your cursor will change to a pencil tool. Drag across the line; a new white line will appear. When you recross the old line, a new contour will be created.

Volume Freehand Tool

This tool allows you to draw your own volume boundary. First magnify the object you want to quantify using the Zoom tools (you must be able to see the individual pixels in the image). Then click on the Volume Freehand button, and use your cursor to draw a line around the object. When your line crosses itself, a freehand volume is created.

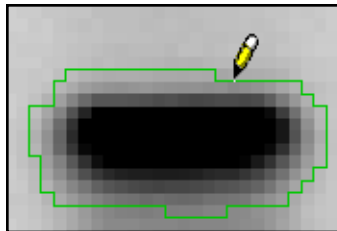


Fig. 17-3. Volume freehand.

If you make a mistake while drawing, simply backtrack with the mouse. The line you draw should completely surround the data you want to quantify.

To edit the volume, position your cursor on the border and drag across the line; a new white line will appear. When you recross the old line, a new freehand volume will be created.

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Volume Rect Tool

Volume Rectangle Tool will create a volume box around an object. To use this tool, click on the Volume Rect button, then drag a box around the object to be quantified. When you release the mouse button, the volume is created.

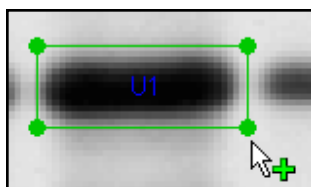


Fig. 17-4. Volume rectangle.

To resize the box, click on it to select it, then position your cursor on one of the corner anchor points and drag.

To rotate the box, click on it to select it, then hold down the SHIFT key while dragging an anchor point. The volume will pivot around its center. This is useful if the data object in your image is lying at an angle--for example, if your gel is smiling.

Volume Circle Tool

Use the Volume Circle Tool to create a circular boundary around an object (such as a spot). To use this tool, click on the Volume Circle button, then position your cursor at the center of the object to be quantified and drag outward. As you drag, a circle will appear. When you release the mouse button, the volume is created.

Volume Tools

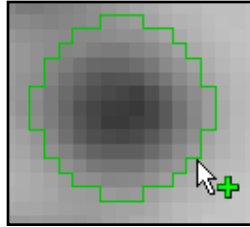


Fig. 17-5. Volume circle.

The volume circle should completely surround the data you want to quantify.

To resize the circle, click on it to select it, then position your cursor on the circle border and drag.

Volume Labels

When you first create your volumes, they will appear unlabeled. You can display the volume labels using the Show/Hide Volume Labels command on the Volume menu or toolbar.

Your volumes will have default labels U1, U2, U3, etc. The “U” stands for unknown, as distinguished from standard and background volumes (see below). The number indicates the sequence in which it was created.

Note: If you change a volume’s type (e.g., change an unknown to a standard), any subsequent volumes of the original type will be renumbered. For example, if you create volumes U1 and U2, and then designate U1 as a background volume, U2 will be renumbered U1.

You can rename a volume by double-clicking on it and entering a new name in the pop-up box.

Other General Features of Volumes

The volume you create will initially have a green border, which indicates that the volume is selected. If you click elsewhere on the image, the border will change to blue, indicating that the volume is deselected.

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To reselect the volume, click on it again. If you move your cursor over the volume—selected or unselected—the border will change to gold.

You can create as many volumes on an image as you want.

After you create a volume, you can view your data (area, density, etc.) by selecting the Volume Analysis Report from the Reports menu.

Tips

The volume you draw should completely surround the data you want to quantitate. You should also adjust for background intensity

You may want to experiment with several different volumes drawn around the same object before selecting the one that gives you the best quantitation data.

Displaying Volumes

To display previously created volumes after opening an image, select Volume Overlay Tools from the Edit menu or main toolbar.

If you have concealed all your overlays using Hide Overlays, clicking on any of the buttons on the Volume Overlay Tools toolbar will display the hidden volumes.

17.2 Moving, Copying, and Deleting Volumes

You can move, copy, or delete a single volume or group of volumes within an image. You can also copy and paste volumes between images.

First, you must select the volume(s). Click on the Select Tool button on the Volume toolbar. To select a single volume, click on it. To select multiple volumes, either drag a box around them or hold down the SHIFT key while you click on them one at a time. When dragging to select a group of objects, make sure that you completely surround all the objects to be selected.

Volume Tools

Each selected volume will have a green border.

- To move the selected volume or volumes, position your cursor over the selection and drag.
- To copy within an image, hold down the CTRL key while dragging the selected volume or volumes. The copy will be created and dragged to the new position.
- To delete the selected volume or volumes, press the DELETE key.
- To copy between images, click on the Copy to Clipboard button on the Volume toolbar, then open or select the image you want to copy to and click on the Paste from Clipboard button. The copied volume(s) will be pasted into the new image in the same relative position it was copied from.

Note: If you are copying to an image with a different pixel size (i.e., resolution), you will receive a message that the placement of the copy may not be exact. Click on OK to complete the paste, then position the pasted objects manually.

17.3 Volume Standards

If you have drawn your volume around an object of known concentration, you can use it to calculate the concentrations of your unknown volumes.

To classify a particular volume as a standard, double-click on it. This will open the Volume Properties box.

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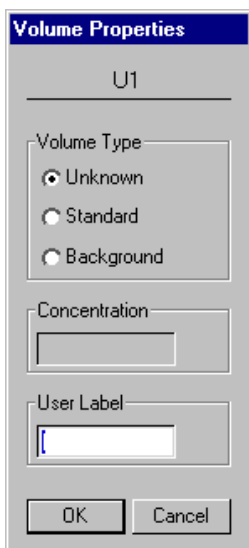


Fig. 17-6. Volume Properties dialog box.

Select the Standard option button, then enter the concentration in the Concentration field. (Do not include units.) Click on OK to close the dialog box.

Your standard volumes will have default names S1, S2, S3... etc., based on their creation sequence. You can display/hide volume names using the Show/Hide Volume Labels command (see previous section for more about volume labels).

After you have identified two or more standards, you can use the Volume Regression Curve (page 372) under the Reports menu to calculate the concentrations of your unknown volumes.

To change a standard back to an unknown, double-click on it, then select the Unknown button.

17.4 Volume Background Subtraction

When you draw a volume, you will probably include some non-data background pixels inside the volume. These background pixels will usually have an intensity value that you do not want to include in your volume quantitation. There are two ways of calculating this background intensity for your volumes: local and global.

The background subtraction method is selected in the Volume Report Options dialog box (page 370).

Local Background Subtraction

Local background subtraction calculates a separate background intensity for each unknown and standard volume you create. For each volume, the intensities of the pixels in a 1-pixel border around the volume are added together and divided by the total number of border pixels. This gives an average intensity for the background around each volume, which is then subtracted from the intensity of each pixel inside the volume.

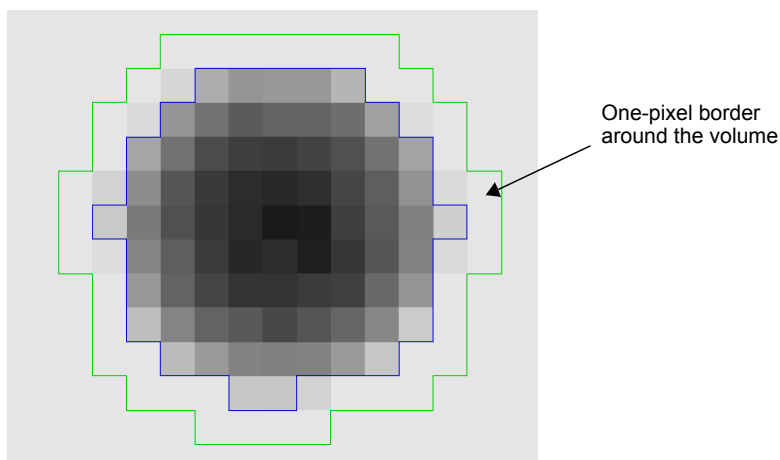


Fig. 17-7. Local background is calculated from a one-pixel border around the volume

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Any pixels inside the volume that have the same intensity as the background pixels will be reduced to zero, thereby eliminating them from the quantitation.

Global Background Subtraction

Note: If you select Global Background Subtraction in the Volume Report Options dialog, but do not define a background volume as outlined below, you will effectively select no background subtraction.

Global background subtraction calculates a single background intensity for the entire gel. This average background intensity is then subtracted from all the volumes in the gel. The steps for calculating global background subtraction are:

1. Create a volume using one of the volume tools in a representative background region of your image (i.e., a region where there is no data and where the average pixel intensity appears to be the same as the background intensity surrounding your data).
2. Double-click on the volume. This will open the Volume Properties dialog box. Select the Background option button.

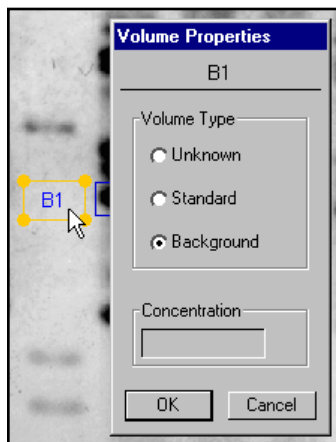


Fig. 17-8. Defining a background volume object.

Volume Tools

The average intensity of the pixels in that background volume will be calculated and subtracted from each pixel in all standard and unknown volumes. Any pixels inside the volumes that have the same intensity as the average background will be reduced to zero, thereby eliminating them from the quantitation.

If you create more than one background volume, all the pixels in those background volumes will be used to calculate the average background.

Your background volume(s) will have default names B1, B2... etc., based on their creation sequence. You can display/hide volume names using the Show/Hide Volume Labels command.

Note: If the region you identified as background has a higher average intensity value than your data object, then you will obtain a negative value for your adjusted volume in the Volume Analysis Report. If this happens, select a new background region that has less intensity than your data object.

Displaying the Results of Background Subtraction

The Volume Analysis Report (page 369) will display both the unadjusted volume and the volume with background subtracted (adjusted volume) of your standards and unknowns, so you can see exactly how much intensity was subtracted.

17.5 Volume Arrays

The Volume Array Tool on the Volume menu and toolbar can be used for quantitating dot blots, slot blots, and other arrays.

Note: You cannot create a volume array in an image with asymmetric pixels (i.e., different dimensions in x and y). If you are trying to create a volume array in such an image, select Reduce File Size from the File menu and change the image's pixel dimensions in the pop-up dialog box.

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What Is a Volume Array?

A volume array is a matrix of volume circles or rectangles that can be sized / positioned as a group and overlaid on images of blots, wells, or cells for easy quantitation. The individual cells in the array have the same functionality as standard volumes. You can define cells as background volumes, standards, and/or unknowns, as described in the sections above.

You report your array data as you would standard volumes, using the Volume Analysis Report.

Creating a Volume Array

On the Volume menu or toolbar, select the Volume Array Tool. This will open the Build Volume Array dialog box.

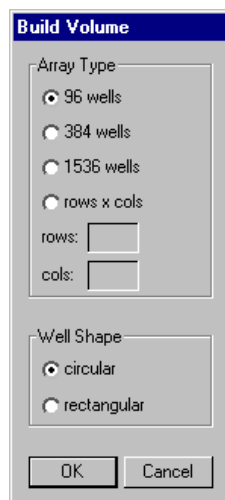


Fig. 17-9. Build Volume Array dialog box.

In the dialog, you can select from standard microtiter plate dimensions (96 wells, 384 wells, or 1536 wells) or specify your own array by selecting Rows x Cols and entering the number of rows and columns in your array in the appropriate fields.

Volume Tools

Select the shape of the wells/cells (Circular or Rectangular) and click on OK.

The array overlay will be created and displayed on the image.

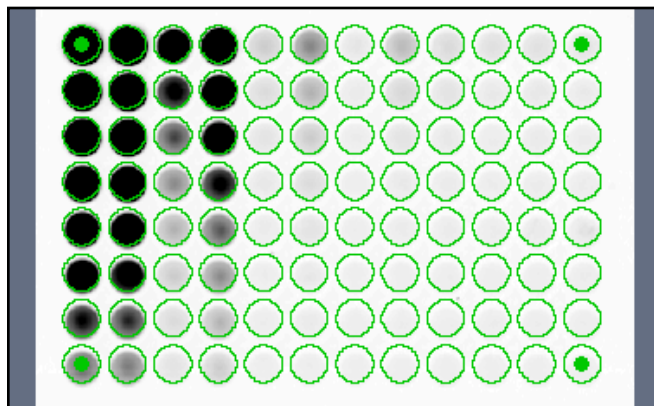


Fig. 17-10. Array overlay.

Like regular volumes, array volumes are initially displayed without labels. To show the labels of the individual wells/cells, click on the Show/Hide Volume Labels button on the toolbar. Like regular volumes, array volumes are initially labeled U1, U2, U3, etc.

Note: If large volume arrays are slow to display or edit on your computer and the volume labels are showing, try hiding the volume labels using the Show/Hide Volume Labels command. This will increase the processing speed considerably.

When you create an array overlay, it is automatically selected (the cells will be displayed with green borders) and the Select tool is assigned to your mouse. You can then move your array overlay so that it is properly centered on the image, resize the cells so they fit the blots/wells in your image, and resize the overlay so the four corners fit over the four corners of the array on your image.

To delete the entire array overlay, click on the DELETE button.

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Moving an Array

To reposition an array overlay, move your cursor over any individual cell until the cursor changes to a multidirectional arrow and the cell border turns yellow. Then hold down the cursor and drag the entire array to a new position.

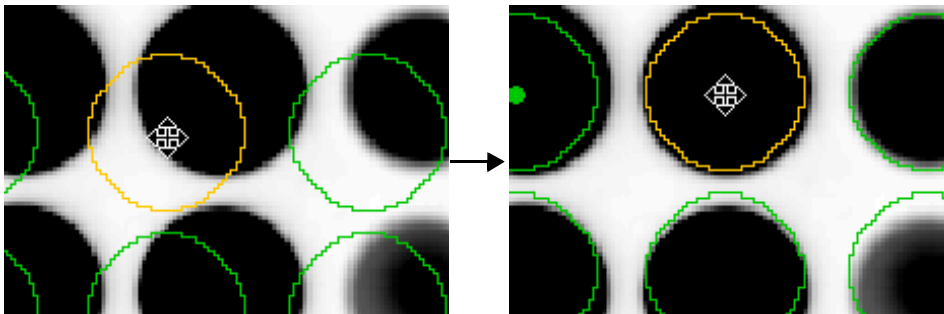


Fig. 17-11. Moving an array.

Resizing an Array

To resize an array overlay, make sure it is selected, then position your cursor over the dot at the center of one of the corner cells. Green lines will appear connecting the array frame at the four corners. Then hold down the cursor and drag the corner dot to a new position.

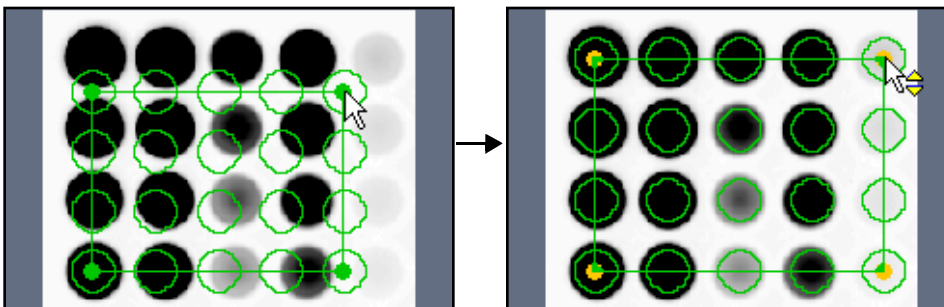


Fig. 17-12. Resizing an array.

Volume Tools

Hold down your mouse button and drag the array frame in or out to compress/expand the array.

Resizing the Array Cells

To resize the individual cells in the array, zoom in on any individual cell and move your cursor over the cell border (or corner anchor point, in the case of rectangles) until it changes to a cursor with an adjustment symbol. Hold down the mouse button and drag to move the border in or out. All the cells in the array will be resized accordingly.

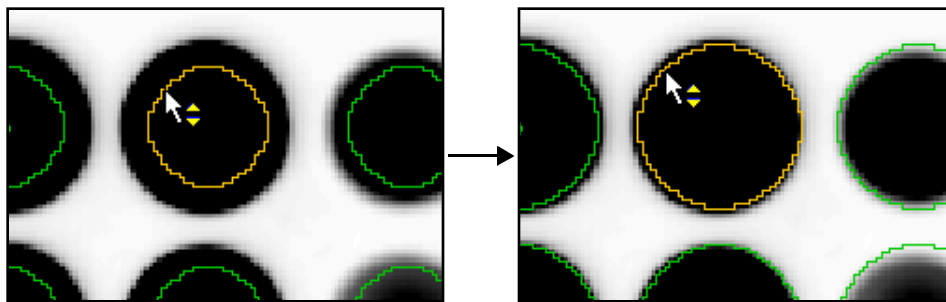


Fig. 17-13. Resizing an array cell.

Copying an Array

To copy an array within the same image, select it, then hold down the CTRL key while dragging it. The copy will be created and dragged to the new position.

To copy an array between images, select it, then click on the Copy to Clipboard button on the Volume toolbar. Open or select the image you want to copy to and click on the Paste from Clipboard button. The copied array will be pasted into the new image in the same relative position it was copied from.

Note: If you are copying to an image with a different pixel size (i.e., resolution), you will receive a message that the placement of the copy may not be exact. Click on OK to complete the paste, then position the pasted array manually.

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Ungrouping an Array

You can ungroup the individual cells in an array, so they behave like normal, stand-alone volumes.

With the array selected, select the Array Ungroup command from the menu or toolbar. This command cannot be undone, and you will be warned before the operation is completed.

When your array has been ungrouped, it will appear deselected (i.e., as blue volumes). You can then move the cells individually, and perform all normal volume operations on the individual cells.

18. Colony Counting

You can use Quantity One to automatically count the number of white, blue, or plaque colonies in a Petri dish image.

Note: For best results, when capturing the image of a Petri dish with an imaging device, the dish should fill the imaging window. Also, images with colonies should not have asymmetric pixels. (Asymmetric pixels can be generated by densitometers and the Reduce File Size command.) The colony counting function will not work properly on images with asymmetric pixels.

Select Colony Counting from the Analysis menu to open the Colony Counting control panel.

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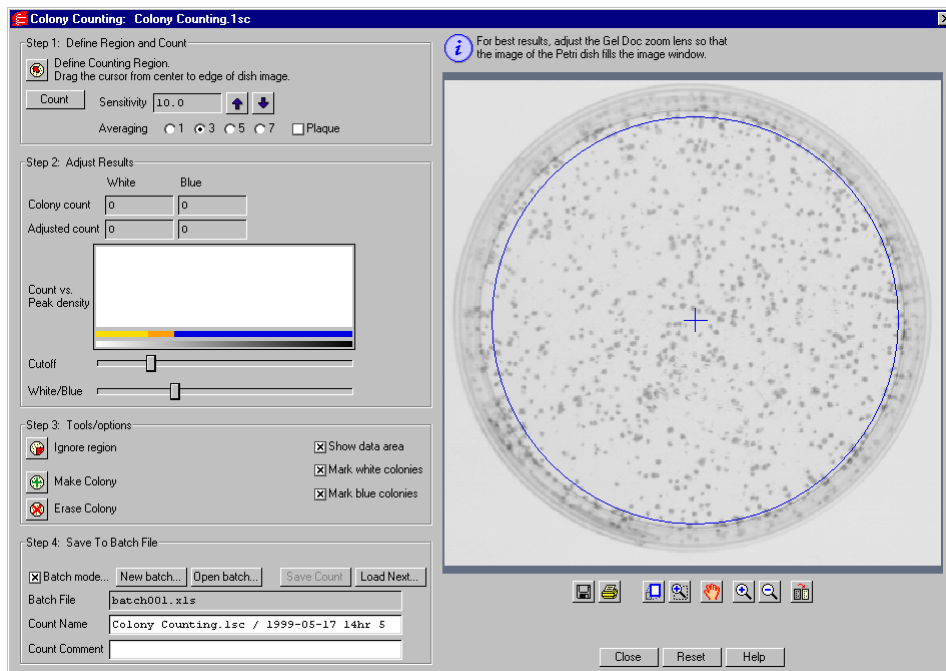


Fig. 18-1. Colony Counting control panel.

The Colony Counting control panel has been arranged from top to bottom to guide you through the procedure.

18.1 Defining the Counting Region

First, you must define the region you want to count in the Petri dish image.

Click on the Define Counting Region button in the dialog box and position your cursor at the center of dish image. Drag the cursor outward. As you drag, a blue circle will expand on the image—this defines the border of the counting region.

Colony Counting

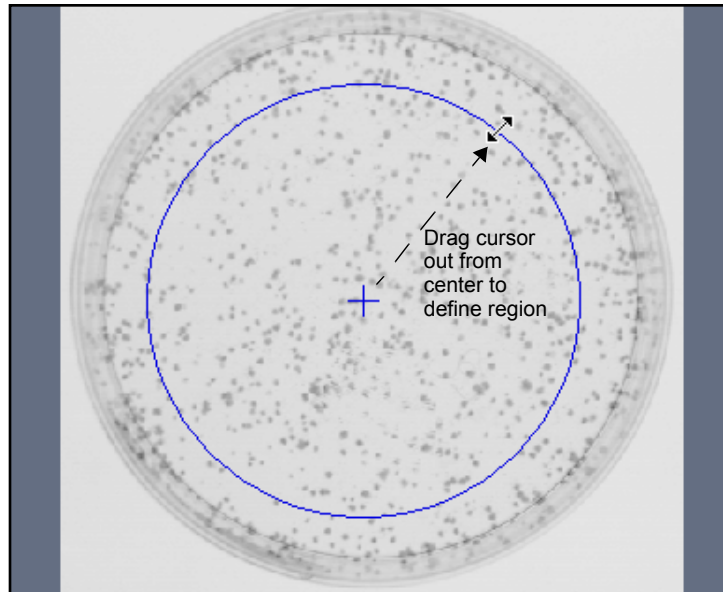


Fig. 18-2. Defining a counting region.

If you make a mistake in defining your counting region, click on the Reset button at the bottom of the dialog box to start over.

Position the blue border until it is just inside the interior edge of the Petri dish.

Note: If your border disappears when you release the mouse button after dragging, check to make sure that the Show Data Area checkbox is checked. This checkbox is located at the bottom of the dialog box.

If your circle is slightly off-center, you can reposition it by positioning your cursor on the center “target” of the circle. The cursor will change to a multidirectional arrow, and you can drag the entire circle.

To resize your counting region circle, position your cursor on the outer edge of the circle. The cursor will change to a bidirectional arrow and you can drag the border in or out.

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18.2 Counting the Colonies

After you have positioned the circle, you are ready to detect colonies.

If you are counting plaques, click on the Plaque checkbox. (Because plaques appear as clear circles on a darker background, this checkbox must be selected for proper detection.)

Before counting, you may want to adjust the Sensitivity and Averaging parameters described below.

When you are ready to count, click on the Count button.

Sensitivity

The sensitivity setting determines the minimum signal intensity in the image that will be counted as a colony. (This is based on the slope of the signal's peak.) The higher the sensitivity, the more colonies will be detected.

If the sensitivity is set too high, background noise will be erroneously detected as colonies. If the setting is too low, real colonies may be missed.

The default sensitivity setting is 10.00. If your image has faint colonies (e.g., O.D. < 0.05, counts < 2,000), you may want to increase this value to 20.00.

Averaging

Averaging is designed to prevent random signal noise (such as salt or pepper) in the image from being detected as colonies. If your image is noisy, you should select the highest value that still results in good separation of colonies (default = 3).

A low averaging value may result in noise being detected as colonies. A high averaging value may result in two closely spaced colonies being counted as one.

18.3 Displaying the Results

After you click on Count, the number of detected colonies will appear in the Results section of the dialog box in the White column.

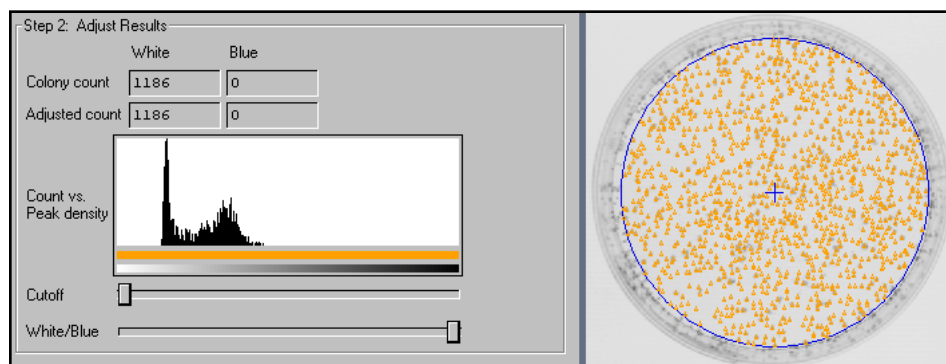


Fig. 18-3. Example of a dish with white colonies.

The colonies will also appear marked as gold triangles on the image itself.

Note: If your colonies are not marked on the image, check to make sure that the Mark White Colonies checkbox at the bottom of the dialog is checked.

A text box on the image will indicate how many colonies were detected on the image.

Doing a Recount

If you want to recount using different parameters, simply change the Sensitivity and/or Averaging settings. This will erase your old count. Then click on Count again to recount.

Redrawing the counting region circle or clicking on the Reset button will also erase the count.

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18.4 Making and Erasing Individual Colonies

If automatic colony detection has missed or erroneously detected some colonies, you can manually mark or unmark them directly on the image using the buttons under Tools/Options.

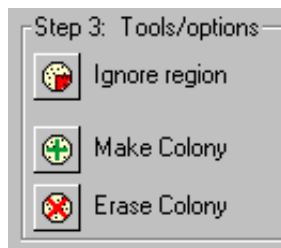


Fig. 18-4. Colony counting tools.

To mark a colony, click on the Make Colony button, then click on the spot on the image that you want to identify as a colony.

To unmark a colony, click on the Erase Colony button, then click on the colony on the image that you want to unmark.

Your colony count will change accordingly.

18.5 Using the Histogram to Distinguish Colonies

The histogram in the Colony Counting dialog box is a graphical representation of the signal data in the image. You can use the histogram and associated sliders to reduce the number of incorrectly identified colonies and/or distinguish between white and blue colonies in the image.

Colony Counting

Colonies Versus Background Noise

If there is a clear peak on the left end of the colony counting histogram, it is probably due to background noise in the image. (For information on subtracting background from entire images, see page 220; for information on filtering noise from images, see page 225.)

If this background noise is being detected as colonies, you can use the histogram and Cutoff slider to correct this.

Drag the Cutoff slider to the right until it is centered on the right edge of the background peak.

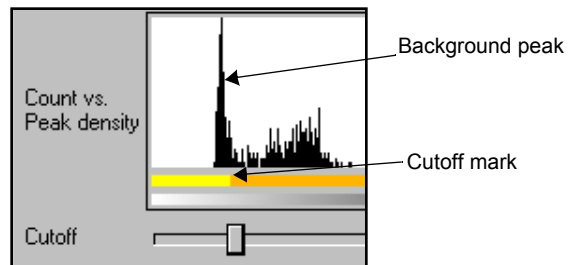


Fig. 18-5. Using the Cutoff slider.

The yellow portion of the bar beneath the histogram marks the range of image data has been designated as background noise, and is not being considered for colony counting purposes. The gold portion of the bar marks white colony data range.

The colony count displayed in the dialog box and on the image should decrease. On the image, you should also see the incorrectly identified colonies disappear as you drag the slider.

White and Blue Colonies

If you know you have white and blue colonies in your image, and there are two clear peaks on the histogram to the right of the background peak, you can use the histogram to distinguish between these types of colonies.

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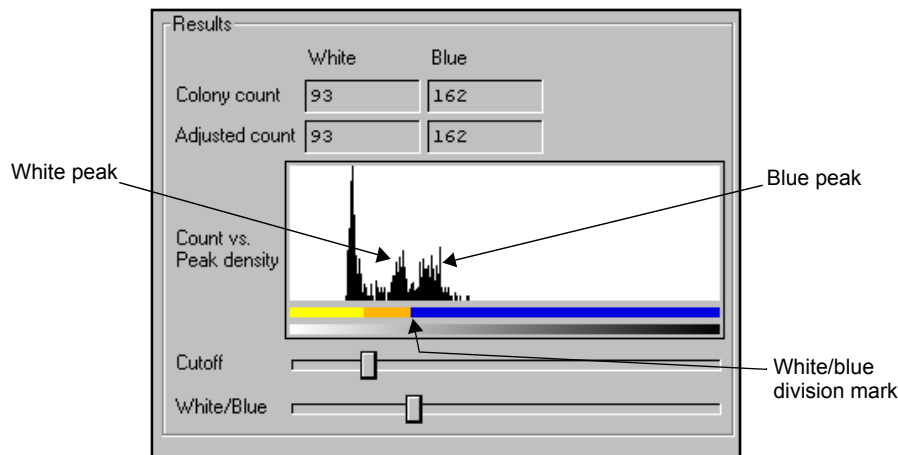


Fig. 18-6. Using the White/Blue slider.

Drag the White/Blue slider to the left until it is positioned between the two peaks. The white colony data range is indicated by gold on the bar beneath the histogram, and the blue colony data range is marked with blue.

As you drag the slider, the numbers of white and blue colonies will change in the dialog box and in the text box on the image. Also on the image, you should see the marked white colonies (gold triangles) change to blue colonies (blue squares).

Note: If your blue colonies are not marked on the image, check to make sure that the Mark Blue Colonies checkbox at the bottom of the dialog is checked.

18.6 Ignoring a Region of the Dish

If a particular region of your Petri dish is damaged and you do not want to consider the colonies (if any) that appear there in your final count, you can use the Ignore Region function.

Colony Counting

Click on the Ignore Region button, then position your cursor on one edge of the region you want to ignore. Drag your cursor on the image, defining the full region you want to ignore.

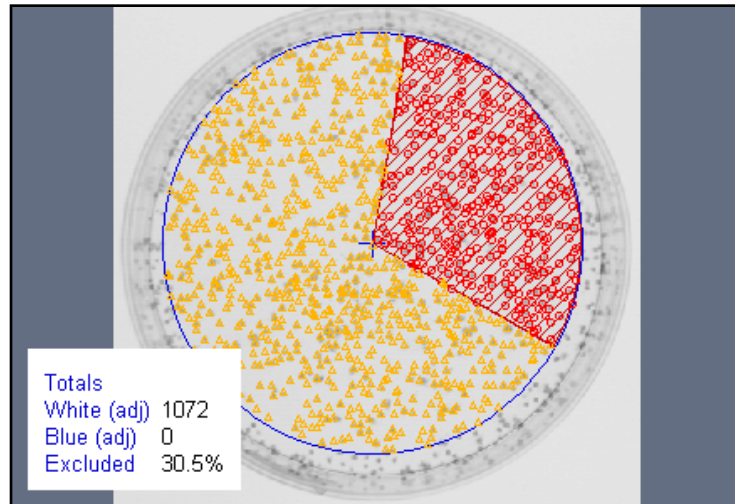


Fig. 18-7. Marking a region to ignore.

As you drag, you will create a “pie slice” marked with red cross-hatching. Any colonies in this region will not be considered in the final count.

When you have defined the region, release the mouse button. If you want to change the size of the ignored region, position your cursor on the edge of the pie slice near the rim of the blue circle. Your cursor will change to a bidirectional arrow, and you can drag the edge of the pie slice.

Colony Count and Adjusted Count

After you have defined a region to ignore, two different counts will appear in the dialog box: the colony count and the adjusted count.

The colony count is the number of colonies that appear in the defined circle minus those in the ignored region.

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The adjusted count is an estimate of the total colony count in the Petri dish; it uses the known colonies to extrapolate the number of colonies that might have appeared in the ignored region if it had not been damaged. The adjusted count is calculated based on the area of the ignored region and the density distribution of colonies in the rest of the circle.

18.7 Saving/Resetting Your Count

A colony count can be saved to the image and/or a separate spreadsheet file.

Saving to the Image

Any count you perform is automatically stored with the image. To save the count with the image, exit the Colony Counting control panel by clicking on the Close button, and use the Save commands under the File menu to save the image.

To view your count data again, simply open the image and open the Colony Counting control panel.

To save a count or multiple counts to a spreadsheet file, see the following section.

Resetting the Count

The Reset button will clear the Colony Counting dialog box and any changes you have made to the image. This command cannot be undone.

18.8 Saving to a Spreadsheet

The Batch File controls allow you to export colony data from an image or multiple images to a Microsoft Excel[®] spreadsheet for review and comparison. To activate these controls, click on the Batch Mode checkbox.

Colony Counting

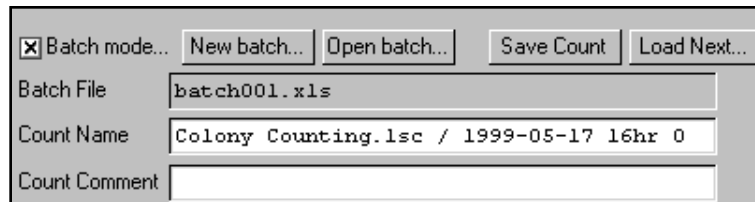


Fig. 18-8. Batch Mode controls.

Creating/Opening a Batch File

To create a new batch file, click on the New Batch button. This will open a dialog box in which you can specify the name and location of the spreadsheet you want to create.

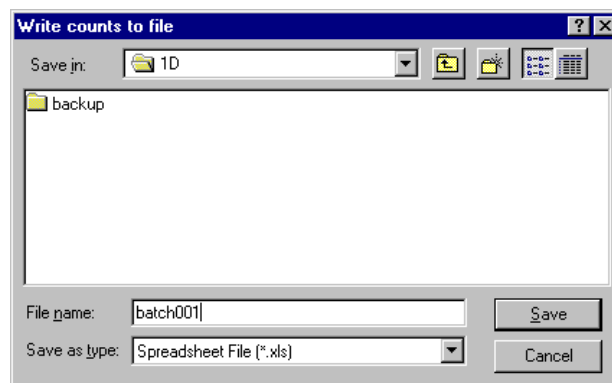


Fig. 18-9. Creating a batch file.

When you click on Save, the new batch file name will be displayed in the Colony Counting control panel.

To open an existing batch file, click on the Open Batch button. This will open a similar dialog box. Select the Excel file you want to open from the appropriate directory.

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Naming/Saving a Count

Enter a name for the count you want to save in the Count Name field, or use the default name (the file name plus a time stamp). Enter any comments in the Count Comment field. This data will be included in the spreadsheet.

To save the currently displayed count to the batch file, click on the Save Count button. The number of colonies, as well as associated count settings, will be added to the spreadsheet. After you have saved the current count, the Save Count button will become deactivated. If you adjust the count in any way, the button will become active again and you can add your adjusted count to the spreadsheet.

Loading Another Image

After you have saved the count(s) for the current image, you can open another dish image by clicking on the Load Next button. This will open a standard Open dialog box from which you can select the image.

The new image will be loaded into the Colony Counting control panel.

Note: The image will only be loaded into the Colony Counting control panel; it will not open in a separate image window in Quantity One.

After you have saved the count(s) for the new image to the batch file, you can either load another image using the Load Next command or click on Close to close the Colony Counting control panel.

19. Differential Display and VNTRs

This chapter describes the tools in Quantity One for studying sequence expression in PCR gels and counting VNTRs or other repeated elements in 1-D gels.

These analysis functions are located on the Analysis menu.

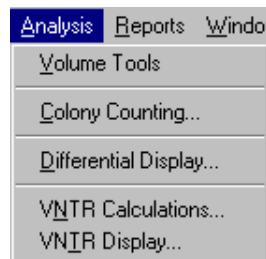


Fig. 19-1. Analysis menu.

19.1 Differential Display

Differential Display is a technique using mRNA and PCR amplification to study gene expression.

Note: You must match the bands in your gel image before using this function. See Chapter 16 for more information.

Differential display gels are analyzed like other gels, with one important distinction. Each gel image must be normalized for quantity to a specific band type that is present in all of your lanes.

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Normalization

To assign a normalized band type, select Normalize from the Match menu and then click on a matched band that appears in every lane of your gel. The quantity of that band in each lane will be set to 100, and the quantities of the other bands in the lane will be normalized to that band. (If the band is not present in a lane, the normalized quantity for that lane is zero.)

See page 305 for more information on normalization.

19.1.a Differential Display Searches

After you have assigned a normalized band type, select Differential Display from the Analysis menu. A box will open in which you can specify your search parameters.

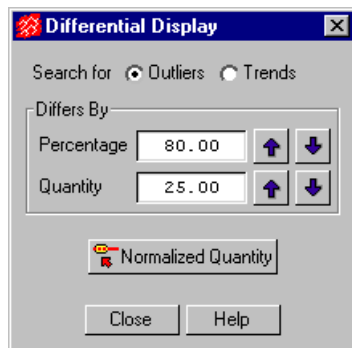


Fig. 19-2. The Differential Display dialog box.

You can perform two types of searches on bands across a differential display gel: an Outlier search or a Trend search. Both are determined by the Percentage and Quantity values that you specify in the Differs By field.

Select the Outlier button to search across each band type for bands with a normalized quantity that differs from the mean normalized quantity for that band type. An outlier is defined as a band with normalized quantity (n_q) that satisfies one of the following criteria:

Differential Display and VNTRs

1. $n_q > \text{ratio} \times \text{mean}$ and
 $n_q > \text{mean} + \text{quantity}$
2. $n_q < (1/\text{ratio}) \times \text{mean}$ and
 $n_q < \text{mean} - \text{difference}$

$$\text{ratio} = 1.0 + (\text{percentage}/100)$$

Select the Trend button to search for increasing or decreasing gene expression, represented by trends in normalized quantity across a band type. In Trend mode, a linear regression of (n_q) versus lane # is computed for each band type. The leftmost and rightmost lanes containing that band type are determined. The normalized quantities for these lanes are calculated from the regression model. If:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{abs}(\text{leftmost}_{n_q} - \text{rightmost}_{n_q}) \geq \text{difference} \text{ and} \\ &\text{Max}(\text{leftmost}_{n_q}, \text{rightmost}_{n_q}) / \text{Min}(\text{leftmost}_{n_q}, \text{rightmost}_{n_q}) \geq \text{ratio} \end{aligned}$$

then the band type is flagged as a trend.

Displaying the Results

Bands identified either as outliers or as belonging to a trend are displayed in white.

If a lane does not have a band assigned to a band type that is flagged as an outlier or a trend, an empty box will be drawn at the expected location of the band.

The Normalized Quantity command can be used to display a histogram of normalized quantities and the mean for any matched band that you select. Click on the button, then click on the matched band. A graph will appear on the image with the normalized quantities of that matched band across the entire gel.

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19.2 Variable Number Tandem Repeats

If your experiments involve the use of microsatellites, VNTRs, or other repeated elements, you can calculate the number of times a repeated element occurs in a band.

Note: You must define the standards in the image before you can use this function (see Chapter 16).

To calculate the VNTRs on your gel image, select VNTR Calculations from the Analysis menu. (You can also select the VNTR Quick Guide from the Help menu for guidance on analyzing gels with VNTRs.)

The Tandem Repeat Calculation dialog box will open.

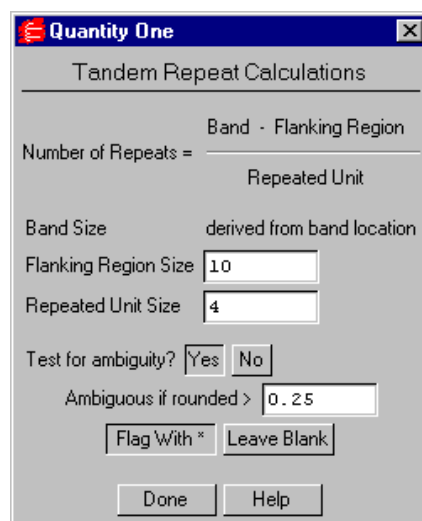


Fig. 19-3. Tandem Repeat Calculations dialog box.

At the top of the dialog box is the equation used to calculate the number of times an element is repeated in a band.

The band size is determined by the position of the band on the gel image.

Differential Display and VNTRs

In the text box next to the Flanking Region Size prompt, enter the size (in base pairs or other repeated units) of the part of the fragment that does not include any repeated elements. This would include primer length and the length of any sequences that fall between the end of the primer region and the beginning of the stretch of repeats.

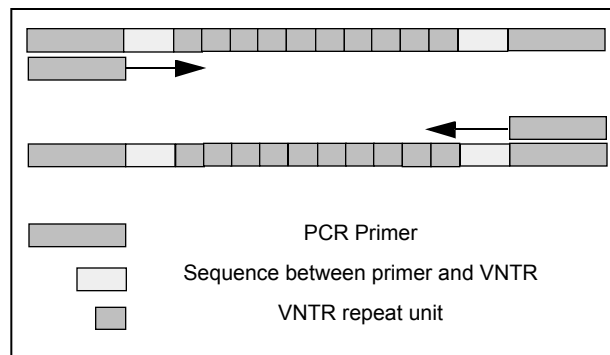


Fig. 19-4. Diagram of components of a DNA fragment.

Next to the Repeated Unit Size prompt, enter the size in base pairs of the repeated element (e.g., if you are working with (CA) repeats, enter "2").

Testing for Ambiguity

The number of repeats calculated by the software may not be a whole number, due to the limitations of exact band size determination. Since the number of times an element is repeated must be a whole number, the calculated value is rounded to the nearest whole number.

In the dialog box, you have the option to "flag" those numbers that deviate from the nearest whole number. These values may warrant further review.

The Test for ambiguity? prompt allows you to flag values that deviate from a whole number. If you select Yes, you must specify what constitutes ambiguity. Next to the "Ambiguous if rounded >" prompt, specify how much the calculated value must deviate from the nearest whole number for it to be flagged.

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Finally, specify whether the tandem repeat numbers that meet the ambiguity criteria should be marked with an asterisk (*) or left unmarked.

When you have entered all the information in the dialog box, click on the Done button. The number of tandem repeats will be displayed next to the bands.

If the numbers have been concealed (e.g., by the Hide Overlays command), you can redisplay them by selecting VNTR Display.

20. Reports

Quantity One can display and print a variety of different analysis reports. You can format the reports to include different kinds of data.

The reporting features are located under the Reports menu.



Fig. 20-1. Reports Menu.

20.1 The Report Window

All of the reports except Phylogenetic Tree share the same basic report window.

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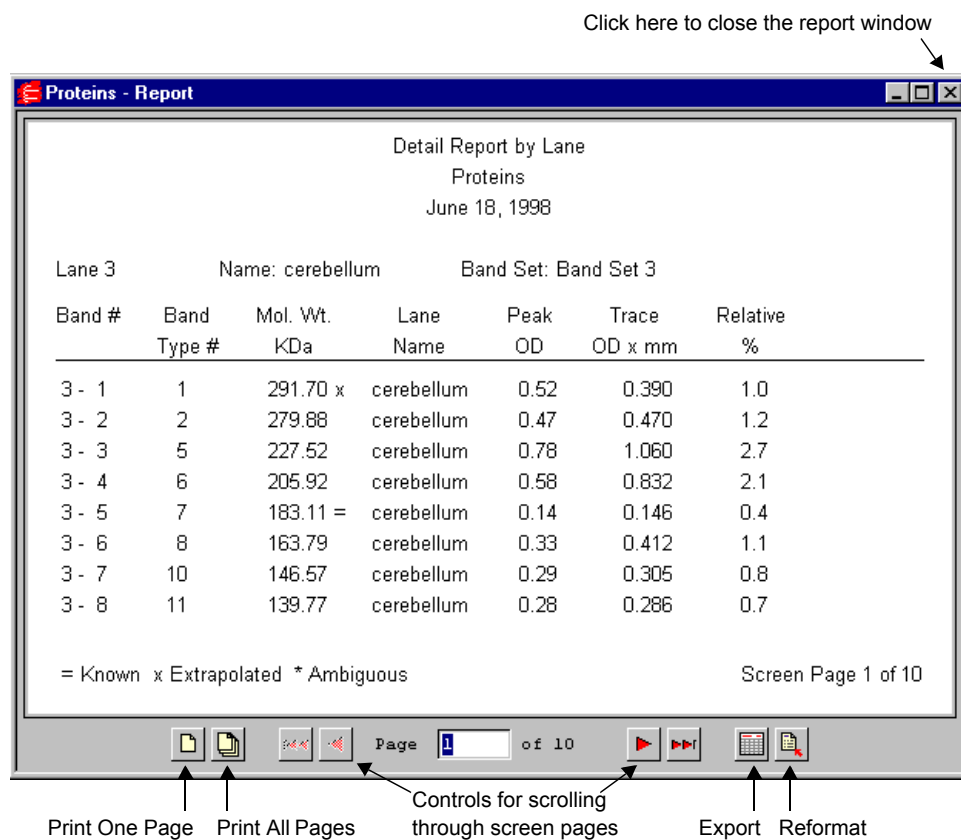


Fig. 20-2. Example of a report window.

The standard report window has buttons for printing the report, scrolling through the screen pages of the report, and exporting the report to a spreadsheet application. Some report windows also have a Reformat button for displaying different report data.

To close a report window, click on the Close box in the upper right corner of the window.

Reports

Scrolling Through the Screen Pages

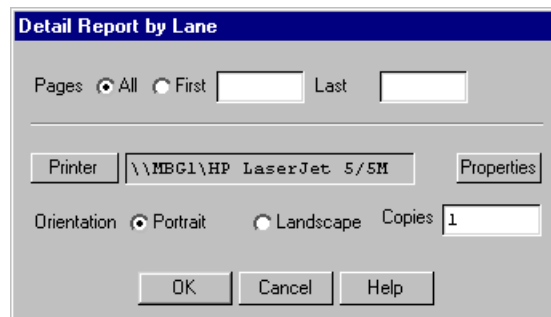
If your report has multiple screen pages, the scroll buttons in the report window will become active. You can use them to scroll to the next page, previous page, first page, or last page of the report. You can also enter a specific page number in the text field.

Printing Your Report

You can print your report using the Print One Page or Print All Pages commands in the report window.

Clicking on either of these buttons will open a smaller version of the standard print dialog (described in the next chapter).

Windows version:



Macintosh version:



Fig. 20-3. Print Report dialog box.

Print One Page sends only the current screen page to the printer. Print All Pages sends all the pages in the report to the printer.

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Note: If you select Print All Pages, the number of pages printed may be less than the number of screen pages listed in the report window. This is because the print command reformats the data to make maximum use of the paper size.

Exporting Your Report Data

You can export your data to spreadsheet applications for further computation and analysis.

Click on the Export button to open the Export Report dialog box.



Fig. 20-4. Export Report dialog box.

Your exported data may be separated by either commas or tabs, depending on the requirements of your spreadsheet application.

You can save your data to a text file or to the clipboard by selecting the appropriate option button.

Click on the OK button to export the data.

Reformatting Your Data

If you change your mind about the data to display in your report window, click on the Reformat button (not available in all reports). This will reopen the options dialog box for your particular report.

20.2 Lane and Match Reports

There are four different lane and match reports: Lane Report, All Lanes Report, Match Report, and All Matches Report.

Lane Report generates a report on any you lane you select. First select Lane Report from the Reports menu, then click on the particular lane.

All Lanes Report generates a report on all the lanes in the current gel image.

Match Report generates a report on any band type that you select. First select Match Report from the menu, then click on a matched band.

All Matches Report generates a report on all the band types in the current gel image.

Selecting any of these commands will open the Report Options dialog box, where you can specify the type of data to be displayed in the report.

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Diversity Database - Lane Report

Report Options

Locations ☒ Relative Front ☒ Mol. Wt.

Measurements ☒ Peak Density ☒ Average Density
☒ Trace Qty ☒ Relative Qty
☒ Gauss Peak Density ☒ Gauss Trace Qty
☒ Contour Area ☒ Contour Qty
☒ Calibrated Qty ☒ Tandem Repeats
☒ Normalized Qty

Database

Band Set ☒ Name

Band Type ☒ Number ☒ Name

Sample ☒ Name

Font Size: ▼

Column Spacing: ▼

Line Spacing: ▼

Fig. 20-5. Report Options form.

Select the data you want to display in the report by clicking on the appropriate checkboxes.

Note: If you change your mind about the data to display, you can change the report options from within the report itself by clicking on the Reformat button.

Select the Font Size, Column Spacing, and Line Spacing settings to be used in the report by clicking on the button next to each field and selecting from the list of options.

To save your report options, click on the Modify Report Settings button at the bottom of the dialog box. In the pop-up dialog, enter a name for your report settings in the field.

Reports

To load or delete previously saved settings, click on the button next to the Settings to Load or Delete field and select from the list of saved settings. Then click on the Load button to load them, or the Delete button to delete them.

To display the selected data, click on the Report button.

The report will be displayed in a standard report window (see section 20.1 above for information about standard report window options).

20.3 1-D Analysis Report

The 1-D Analysis Report will display all the advanced analysis data (including band types, normalized quantities, amount of sample loaded, etc.) for all the lanes on your gel image. The lanes will also be ranked in similarity to the lane you initially select to generate the report.

Note: You must match the bands in your gel image before you can generate this report (see Chapter 16 for more information).

Select 1-D Analysis Report from the Reports menu, then click on any experimental lane in your gel image. A dialog box will pop up, allowing you to select the report data to display.

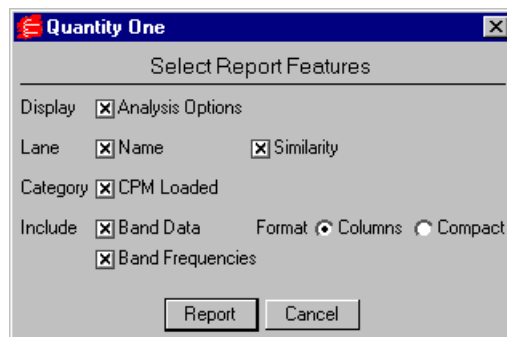


Fig. 20-6. 1-D Analysis Report options.

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Note: If you change your mind about the data to display, you can change the report options from within the report itself by clicking on the Reformat button.

To display the selected data, click on the Report button.

The report will be displayed in a standard report window (see section 20.1 above for information about standard report window options).

20.4 Similarity Comparison Reports

Quantity One has three reports that provide different ways of comparing the similarity of the lane-based samples in your gel image: Compare Lane Images, Phylogenetic Tree, and Similarity Matrix.

Note: You must match the bands in your gel image before you can generate these reports (see Chapter 16 for more information).

Comparison Options

Before opening any of these reports, select Comparison Options from the Reports menu to specify some settings for your reports.

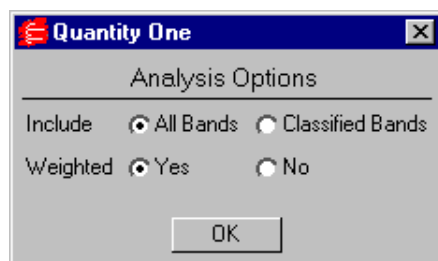


Fig. 20-7. Comparison Options dialog box.

In the Comparison Options dialog box, select All Bands to include every band in your gel image, or selected Classified Bands to include only the matched bands in your gel image.

Reports

Band Weighting means that band intensity as well as position will be used when comparing the similarity of your samples. Select Yes to use band weighting when generating the report.

Select No to use only band position as the basis for comparing lane similarity.

Comparison Method

The method for computing similarity in Quantity One is the Dice Coefficient. The formula for the Dice Coefficient is:

$$sim = 200 \times \frac{\sum_{i=1}^B \hat{A} \min(s_i, t_i)}{\sum_{i=1}^B \hat{A} (s_i + t_i)}$$

$$dist = 100 - sim$$

where S and T are vectors representing two lanes in the same band set that are being compared.

To compute similarity, a vector is constructed that represents the bands identified in the lane. The vector depends on the comparison options (see above) selected. If the search was done on classified (matched) bands only, then the vector S contains B elements ($S = (s_1, s_2, s_3 \dots s_B)$), where B is the number of band types in the lane's band set. The values for $s_1, s_2, s_3 \dots s_B$ have the following values:

Weighting Off Search

$s_i = 1$ if the i'th band type is found in the lane.

$s_i = 0$ if it is not found.

Weighting On Search

If the band set has a normalizing band type, then:

s_i = The normalized density of the band assigned to the i'th band type.

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$s_i = 0$ if the lane does not have a band assigned to the i 'th type.

Otherwise:

s_i = The quantity of the band assigned to the i 'th band type.

$s_i = 0$ if the lane does not have a band assigned to the i 'th type.

20.4.a Compare Lane Images

The Compare Lane Images command displays the lanes of your gel image in decreasing order of similarity to a lane that you select.

Select Compare Lane Images from the Reports menu, then click on the lane that you want to compare your other lanes to. A dialog box will pop up, in which you can select your report features.

:

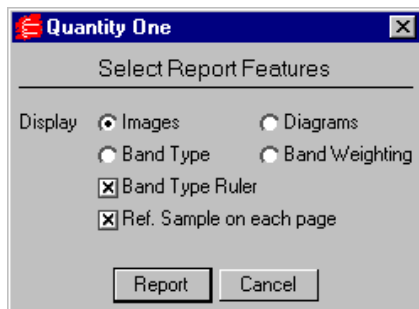


Fig. 20-8. Compare Lane Images options.

If you select the Images option button, the lanes of your gel will be displayed as images. If you select Diagrams, schematic representations of the lanes will be displayed.

Select the data you want to display in the report by clicking on the appropriate checkboxes.

To display the selected data, click on the Report button.

Reports

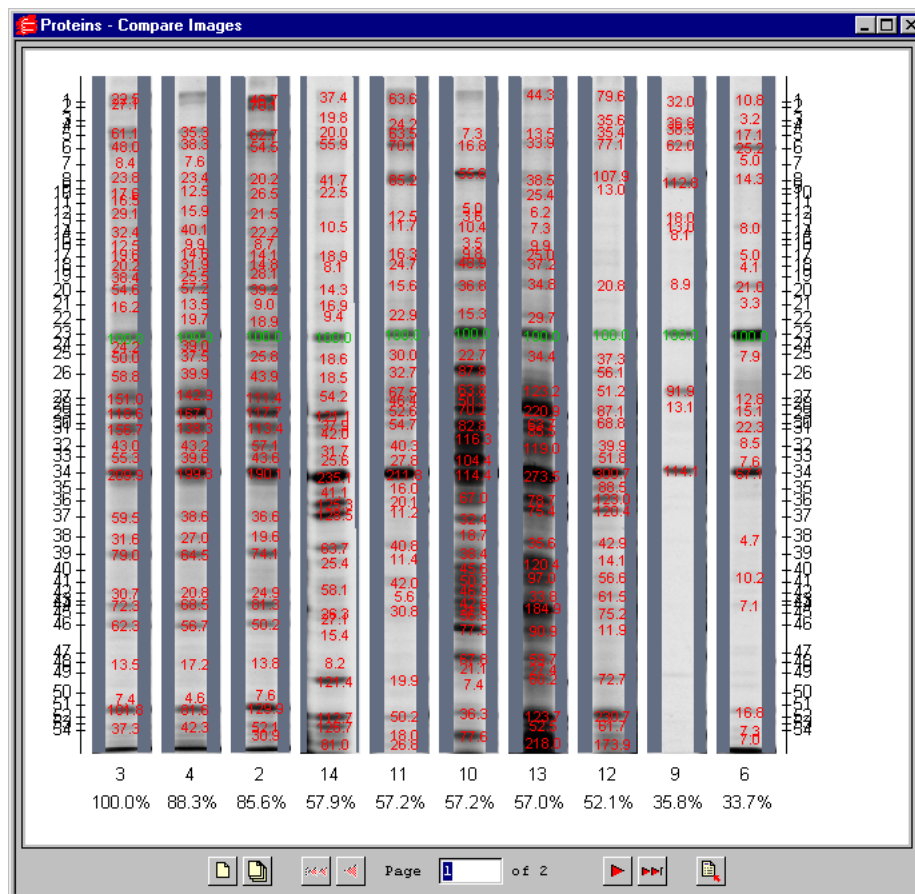


Fig. 20-9. Compare Lane Images report window.

The Compare Lane Images report will be displayed in a standard report window (see section 20.1 above for information about report window options).

You can change the report options from within the report itself by clicking on the Reformat button.

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The Print Report dialog for this report contains special fields for entering a title for your report.

20.4.b Phylogenetic Tree

Phylogenetic trees are schematic representations of lane similarity. To compare the similarity of your lanes in a phylogenetic tree format, select Phylogenetic Tree from the Reports menu. (You can also use the Phylogenetic Tree Quick Guide under the Help menu to analyze your gel image.)

A dialog box will pop up displaying the different cluster methods for creating the tree.

Select a method to open the report window. See below for information about the different methods.

Reports

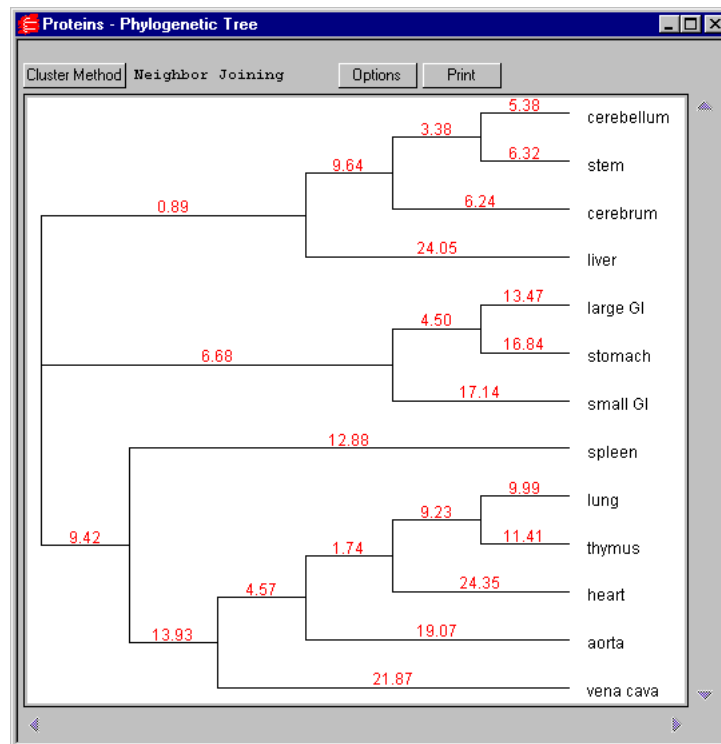


Fig. 20-10. The Phylogenetic Tree report window.

The report window for phylogenetic trees is slightly different than the standard report window. The tree appears in one window with scroll bars for moving up and down and left and right.

To print the tree, click on the Print button. This will open the standard Print Report dialog box.

To close the window, click on the Close box in the upper right corner of the window.

Clicking on the Cluster Method button allows you to select a different clustering method for displaying the tree. This will automatically reconfigure the tree displayed in the window.

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Neighbor Joining

This type of phylogenetic tree is computed is based on minimizing the total branch length at each stage of clustering. The method also finds branch lengths between nodes. The approximate distance between any two samples in this tree can be found by adding the branch lengths that connect the samples.

Other Methods^{1, 2}

The following methods are based on the algorithm below:

1. Begin with n clusters—one cluster for each sample.
2. Compute the similarity matrix for the samples.
3. Convert the similarity matrix into a distance matrix d using the appropriate distance formula.
4. Join the two clusters with the minimum distance into one cluster. Compute the similarity value for this cluster.
5. Recompute the distance matrix d using the cluster that was formed in Step 4.

Steps 4 and 5 are repeated until there is only one cluster. The difference between the methods below is based on the definition of minimum distance in Step 4, and on the method of computing the new distance matrix in step 5. In the discussion that follows, let:

p, q be indices indicating two clusters that are to be joined into a single cluster.

k be the index of the cluster formed by joining clusters p and q .

i be the index of any remaining clusters other than cluster p, q , or k .

1. For a complete explanation of the calculations and assumptions used to generate these dendrograms, please refer to Sneath and Sokal. *Numerical Taxonomy*, San Francisco: W. H. Freeman & Company, 1973.

2. Vogt and Nagel, *Clinical Chemistry* **38** (2): 182-198, (1992).

Reports

n_p the number of samples in the p'th cluster.

n_q the number of clusters in the q'th cluster.

n the number of clusters in the k'th cluster formed by joining the p'th and q'th cluster. $n = n_p + n_q$

d_{pq} the distance between cluster p and cluster q.

Single Linkage

This is also called Nearest Neighbor or Minimum Method.

$$d_{ki} = \min(d_{pi}, d_{qi})$$

Complete Linkage

This is also called the Furthest Neighbor or Maximum Method.

$$d_{ki} = \max(d_{pi}, d_{qi})$$

Single and Complete linkage are good algorithms for indicating outlier clusters.

UPGAMA

Unweighted pair group method using arithmetic averages. This is also called Weighted Average Linkage.

$$d_{ki} = \frac{\sum_{p \in P} d_{pi}}{\sum_{p \in P} 1} + \frac{\sum_{q \in Q} d_{qi}}{\sum_{q \in Q} 1}$$

WPGAMA

Weighted pair group method using arithmetic averages. This is also called Average Linkage.

$$d_{ki} = 0.5 d_{pi} + 0.5 d_{qi}$$

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WPGAMA is a special case of UPGAMA that favors the most recent member clusters in forming new clusters.

Centroid

$$d_{ki} = \frac{n_p}{n} d_{pi} + \frac{n_q}{n} d_{qi} - \frac{(n_p \wedge n_q)}{n^2 d_{pq}}$$

Median

$$d_{ki} = 0.5 \wedge d_{pi} + 0.5 \wedge d_{qi} - 0.25 \wedge d_{pq}$$

Centroid and Median are similar to UPGAMA and WPGAMA, respectively, but the distance formula contains an additional third term. Centroid and Median methods are not monatomic hierarchical clustering algorithms. In other words, the similarity value between cluster k and any other cluster may be greater than the similarity between cluster p and cluster q. This condition occurs if the centroids (or medians) of the different clusters have approximately the same distance as the distances between the samples that make up the cluster.

Ward's

This method attempts to minimize the information by describing a set of N samples using a fewer number of clusters.

$$d_{ki} = \frac{n_p + n_i}{n + n_i} d_{pi} + \frac{n_q + n_i}{n + n_i} d_{qi} - \frac{n_i}{n + n_i} d_{pq}$$

From our experience, we have found that Ward's method, UPGAMA, and WPGAMA give the most plausible clusters and are affected the least by samples that are outliers.

Options

Clicking on the Options button in the Phylogenetic Tree window will open the Options dialog box.

Reports

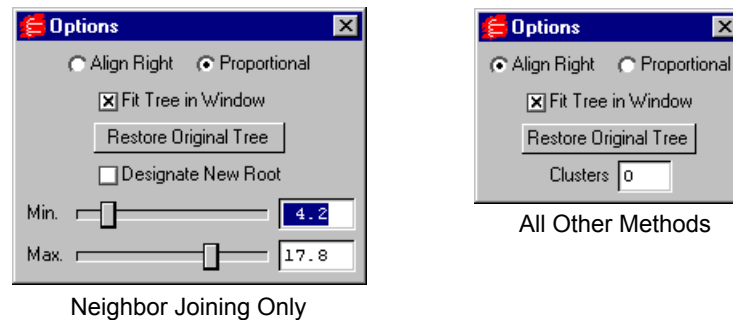


Fig. 20-11. Two forms of the Options dialog box.

The box on the left has controls that are specific for the Neighbor Joining method. The box on the right is applicable to all other tree methods. Both boxes share certain features.

Each allows you to choose between aligning the tree to the right or proportionally aligning it. Right alignment uses a fixed branch length for displaying the distance between nodes; proportional alignment differs for Neighbor Joining and other tree modes.

In Neighbor Joining mode, proportional alignment shows branch length sizes proportional to the min./max. values (see below) set in the Options form. Other modes plot the nodes at locations determined by their similarity values.

The Fit Tree in Window option scales the tree so that the entire tree will fit onto a single printed page. With Fit Tree in Window turned off, the entire tree will appear with the correct distances between nodes preserved, and the printed tree can be tiled across multiple sheets of paper.

The Neighbor Joining Options form allows you to designate a new root node (the node at the very top of the tree), enabling you to look at the relationships between lanes from a different perspective. You do so by clicking on the Designate New Root button. This will highlight all the nodes of the tree on-screen. Choose the one you want to serve as the new root by clicking on it. The rearranged dendrogram will then be displayed. If you wish to return to the original form of the tree, click on the Restore Original Tree button.

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The Min. and Max. sliders are active only for proportionally aligned Neighbor Joined trees. They allow you to adjust the Minimum and Maximum distance values between nodes on branches, so that you can adjust the display of your tree to highlight specific regions of data. Distances below the Min. or above the Max. values will be collapsed to fit on the form.

The Clusters option allows you to define the number of clusters (0 to 18) that will be identified in your tree for any non-Nighbor Joined tree. Entering a value greater than zero in this field will cause the tree to redisplay into separate clusters, identified by letters.

20.4.c Similarity Matrix

The Similarity Matrix contains the similarity values of all of the lanes in a gel. If there are N lanes in the gel, then the similarity matrix is an N by N matrix that is computed using the Dice Coefficient as described at the beginning of this section.

The matrix has the following properties:

- The diagonal elements always have values of 100. This is because a lane is always 100 percent similar to itself.
- The matrix is symmetrical ($M_{ij} = M_{ji}$).

Select Similarity Matrix from the Reports menu to open this report.

Reports

Band #	Name	KDa	Band Frequency	
			Unweighted %	Weighted %
1		5945.99	16.7	5.3
2		5687.71	50.0	22.7
3		5477.17	79.2	39.6
4		5243.58	58.3	29.7
5		4838.65	70.8	16.6
6		4640.99	8.3	1.3
7		4520.08	0.0	0.0
8		4352.12	58.3	22.6
9		4179.56	83.3	37.6
10		3943.85	54.2	27.1
11		3628.10	100.0	66.7
12		2950.30	45.8	12.7
13		2655.65	100.0	100.0

Fig. 20-12. Similarity Matrix report.

The Similarity Matrix report will be displayed in a standard report window (see section 20.1 for information about standard report window options).

20.5 Volume Analysis Report

The Volume Analysis Report displays your volume data.

To open this report, select Volume Analysis Report from the Reports menu or Volume toolbar. The Volume Report Options dialog box will pop up, allowing you to specify the information that will appear in your report.

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When you have selected your report options, click on the OK button.

The report will be displayed in a standard report window (see section 20.1) above for information about standard report window options).

20.5.a Volume Report Options

These settings appear when you first open the Volume Analysis Report. They can also be accessed from within the report itself by clicking on the Reformat button.

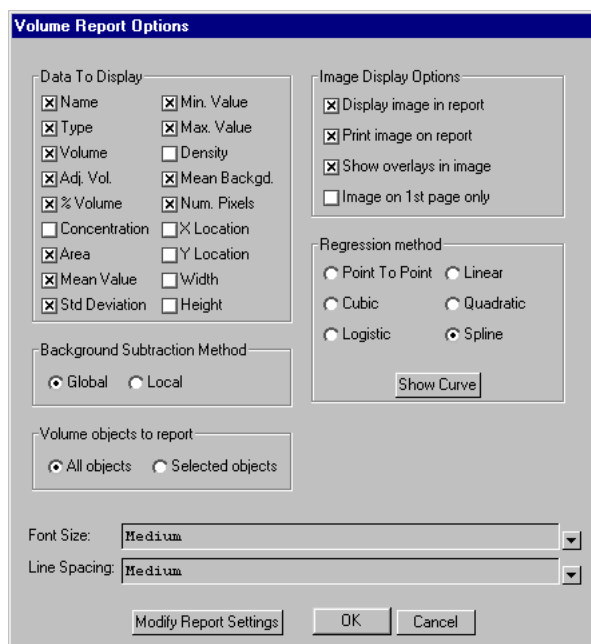


Fig. 20-13. Volume Report Options dialog box.

Data to Display

- Name—The name that is automatically assigned to the volume based on its type (U=Unknown, Std=Standard, B=Background) and order in which it was created.

Reports

- Type—Unknown, standard, or background.
- Volume—Sum of the intensities of the pixels inside the volume boundary x area of a single pixel (in mm^2).
- Adj. Vol.—Volume minus the background volume; if there is no background volume, this is simply the volume.
- % Volume—The volume expressed as a percentage of all the volumes in the image.
- Concentration—The quantity as calculated from the standards and the regression method. If you have not defined standards, this is not calculated.
- Area—The total area of the volume box you have drawn in mm^2 .
- Mean value—The mean intensity of the pixels inside the volume boundary.
- Std. Deviation—The standard deviation from the mean intensity.
- Min. Value—The value of the lowest intensity pixel in the volume.
- Max. Value—The value of the highest intensity pixel in the volume.
- Density—The total intensity of all the pixels in the volume divided by the area of the volume.
- Mean Background—The mean intensity of the pixels in the background volume.
- Num. Pixels—The number of pixels inside the volume.
- X location—The distance in mm from the left edge of the image to the center of the volume.
- Y location—The distance in mm from the top edge of the image to the center of the volume.
- Width—The width of the volume in mm.
- Height—The height of the volume in mm.

Background Subtraction Method

Specify the preferred Background Subtraction Method (Global or Local).

Note: If you select Global and have not defined a background volume, you will have no background subtraction for the image.

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Other Options

The Image Display Options affect how the image is displayed and/or printed on the report.

You can choose whether to report on all your volume objects (All objects) or only those objects you have selected (Selected objects)

Select the regression method for calculating the Volume Regression Curve (section 20.6). To display the curve, click on the Show Curve button.

Select the Font Size and Line Spacing settings to be used in the report by clicking on the button next to each field and selecting from the list of options.

Saving the Report Options

To save your report options, click on the Modify Report Settings button at the bottom of the dialog box. In the pop-up dialog, enter a name for your report settings in the field.

To load or delete previously saved settings, click on the button next to the Settings to Load or Delete field and select from the list of saved settings. Then click on the Load button to load them, or the Delete button to delete them.

20.6 Volume Regression Curve

If you have defined at least two standard volumes on your image, you can display a regression curve for your volumes.

Select Volume Regression Curve from the Reports menu. This will open the Volume Regression Curve window.

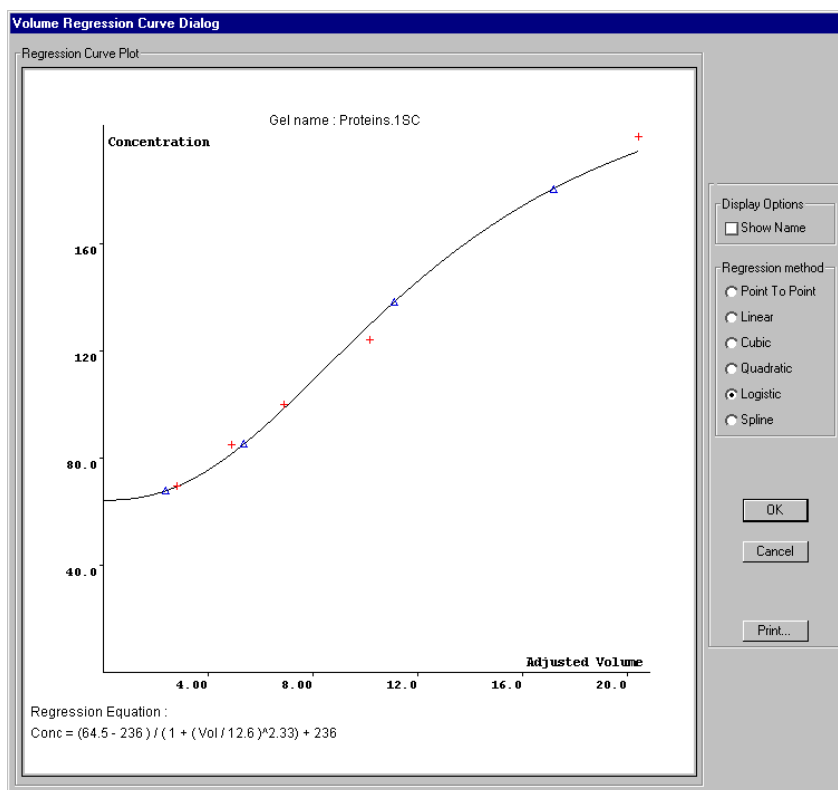


Fig. 20-14. Volume Regression Curve window.

Each standard volume is marked by a red X and each unknown is marked by a blue triangle.

The X axis is the adjusted volume and the Y axis is the concentration, based on the standards you have marked on the image.

To display the numbers and names (if any) of your volumes, click on the Show Name checkbox.

Select your preferred regression method from the list of option buttons. The regression equation for the selected method is displayed in the lower left of the window.

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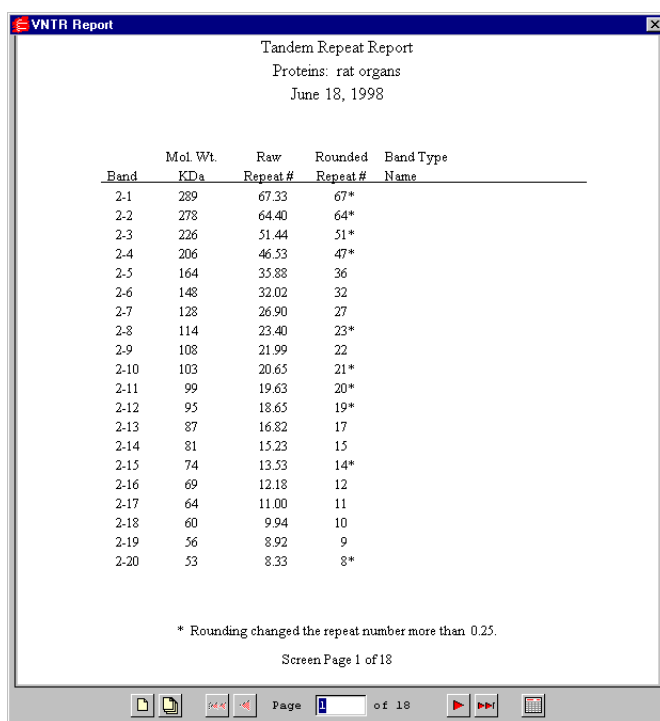
To print your curve, click on the Print button. This will open the standard Print Report dialog box.

To close the Volume Regression Curve window, click on the OK button.

20.7 VNTR Report

The VNTR Report displays your VNTR data.

Select VNTR Report from the Reports menu. A pop-up box will ask if you want to display the gel image in the report.



Tandem Repeat Report
Proteins: rat organs
June 18, 1998

Band	Mol. Wt. KDa	Raw Repeat #	Rounded Repeat #	Band Type Name
2-1	289	67.33	67*	
2-2	278	64.40	64*	
2-3	226	51.44	51*	
2-4	206	46.53	47*	
2-5	164	35.88	36	
2-6	148	32.02	32	
2-7	128	26.90	27	
2-8	114	23.40	23*	
2-9	108	21.99	22	
2-10	103	20.65	21*	
2-11	99	19.63	20*	
2-12	95	18.65	19*	
2-13	87	16.82	17	
2-14	81	15.23	15	
2-15	74	13.53	14*	
2-16	69	12.18	12	
2-17	64	11.00	11	
2-18	60	9.94	10	
2-19	56	8.92	9	
2-20	53	8.33	8*	

* Rounding changed the repeat number more than 0.25.

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Fig. 20-15. Example of a VNTR Report.

Reports

The report is displayed in a standard report window (see section 20.1 above for information about standard report window options).

The report displays the molecular weight, the raw repeat number, and the rounded repeat number for each band in the gel image.

The raw repeat number is the number of repeats calculated using the information that you provided in the Tandem Repeat Calculation dialog box, and is likely to include fractional values. The rounded repeat number is the raw repeat number rounded to the nearest whole number.

An asterisk (*) will appear next to some of the rounded repeat numbers if you selected Test for Ambiguity and Flag with * in the Tandem Repeat Calculations dialog box. The asterisk will appear next to those numbers that vary from the raw repeat number by more than the ambiguity value that you specified.

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21. Printing and Exporting

The commands for printing and exporting images are located on the File menu.

Reports (Volumes, VNTR, Phylogenetic Tree, etc.) are printed from within the individual report windows.

21.1 Printing

There are four different printing options under File > Print:

1. Print Image prints a copy of the image and any overlays that are currently displayed.
2. Print Actual Size prints an actual-size copy of the image.
3. Scan Report prints the image and information about its scan history, number of pixels, data range, etc.
4. Video Print prints images and reports to a video printer.*

*Video printing requires installation of the video board and cable that come with the Gel Doc and Chemi Doc systems. The video board and cable can also be ordered separately.

Macintosh Only

On the Macintosh, specify your printer settings—including paper size, page orientation, etc.—using the File > Print > Page Setup command. This will open the standard Macintosh Page Setup dialog box.

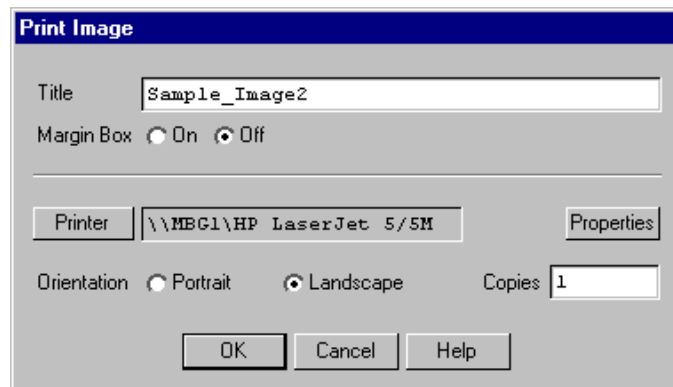
21.1.a Printing Images

Print Image prints a copy of the active image window and any image overlays that are displayed.

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File > Print > Print Image opens the Print Image dialog box.

Windows version:



Macintosh version:

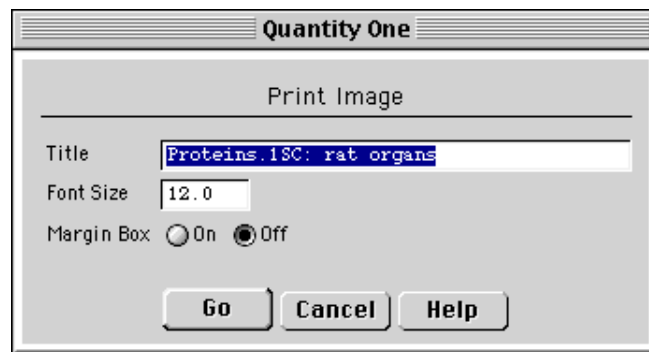


Fig. 21-1. Print Image dialog box.

At the top of the dialog box, enter the title that you want to appear above the image when you print.

Choose whether a margin border should appear around the edge of the image by clicking either the On or Off button next to the Margin Box prompt.

Printing and Exporting

Print Settings: Windows Only

Click on Printer to display a list of your available printers. After you have selected a printer, you can click on Properties to select the standard Windows print settings for that printer.

Note: If you are using Windows 95 with certain printer drivers, you may experience difficulty printing some overlays and overlay symbols on images. While there is no single solution to this problem, you should try adjusting some settings in the Printer Properties dialog box, under the Graphics and Advanced tabs—specifically, the Dithering, DPI, Rasterizing, and RET settings.

Select the paper orientation by clicking on Portrait or Landscape next to the Layout prompt. (This can also be set in the Properties dialog box.)

Indicate how many copies should be printed in the text box next to the Copies prompt.

When you are satisfied with all the print parameters, click on the OK button to send the image to the printer.

Print Settings: Macintosh Only

Specify a font size for the image title in the text box next to the Font Size prompt. You can use font sizes ranging from 6 to 64, but we recommend you use the default setting of 12.0.

Click on the Go button to send the image to the printer.

21.1.b Print Actual Size

You can print your images at their actual size using the Print Actual Size command.

Note: If you are using the Gel Doc, Chemi Doc, Fluor-S, or Fluor-S MAX, you must specify the correct image area size when capturing your images to ensure accurate 1:1 printing. You can specify the image area size in the acquisition window for the instrument. See the chapter on each imaging device for more information.

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Select Print Actual Size from the File > Print menu. The standard Print Image dialog box will open (see previous section).

21.1.c Printing the Scan Report

Scan Report allows you to print out a single-page report of an image and its associated information. The format of the report is designed to provide a concise yet thorough summary of the most relevant features of an image for documentation purposes.

The report includes the following information:

- The image.
- The report date.
- The image title and a brief description.
- The directory location.
- The date the image was scanned.
- The type of imaging device.
- The imaging area and number of pixels.
- Pixel size.
- The intensity range, image color, and memory size.
- Image background information.
- Relevant lane and band information.

To print a scan report of a particular gel, select Scan Report from the File > Print submenu. This will open a smaller version of the standard print dialog box (see Print Image, above).

Note: TIFF images do not contain all the tagged information that would normally be included in an image file (for example, imaging device, scan date, image color, etc.). For this reason, the Scan Report may list this information as “Unknown” for imported TIFF files.

Printing and Exporting

21.1.d Video Printing

The Video Print command allows you to print images and reports on a video printer. To create a video printout of the active window, select Video Print from the File > Print submenu.

Note: Video printing requires installation of the video board and cable that come with the Gel Doc 1000/2000 and Chemi Doc gel documentation systems. The video board and cable can also be ordered separately.

Settings for the Mitsubishi P90W/P91W Video Printer

There are three settings for the Mitsubishi P90W/P91W video printer. Set Contrast to zero, Brightness to zero, and Gamma to 5.

The dip switches should stay in the orientation in which they are shipped: Pin 1 is up (on), and Pins 2–10 are down (off).

21.2 Exporting an Image in TIFF Format

You can export your image in TIFF format for analysis and publishing using other applications.

File > Export to TIFF Image opens a dialog box in which you can specify your export parameters.

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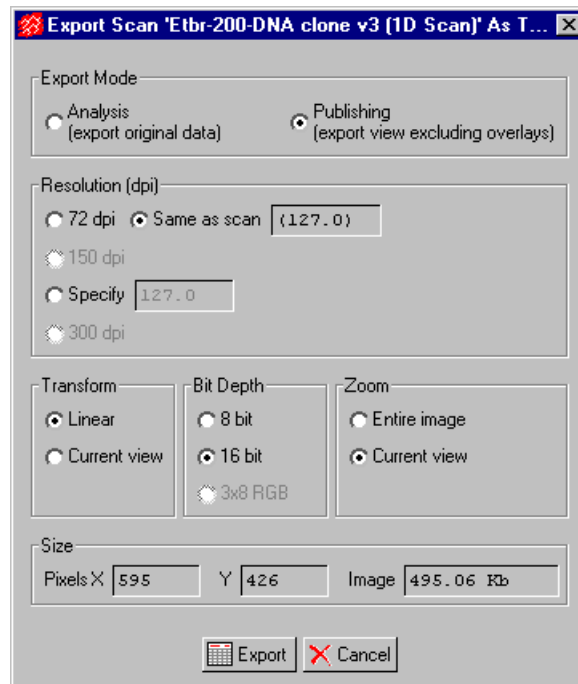


Fig. 21-2. Export to TIFF Image dialog box.

Analysis Export Mode

Analysis mode exports the scan data, unmodified by any viewing adjustments you may have made (such as Transform or Zoom).

If you select Analysis mode, the other controls in this dialog box will become inactive.

Publishing Export Mode

Publishing mode exports a TIFF image that looks like the image as it is currently displayed on the screen.

Printing and Exporting

Note: This is the only mode available if you are exporting from the Multi-channel Viewer.

In Publishing mode, you can specify a resolution for the TIFF image by selecting 72 dpi (typical computer screen resolution), 150 or 300 dpi (standard printing resolutions), Same As Scan, or any resolution you Specify (up to the resolution of the scan).

If you have log transformed the image, you can specify a linear transform, or preserve the current view.

If your image is 16 bits, you can compress it to 8 bits for export to TIFF.

Note: TIFF images are exported from the Multi-channel Viewer in 3x8 RGB mode to preserve the colors displayed in the viewer.

Finally, if you are only displaying part of the image due to magnification or repositioning, you can preserve the current view or export the entire image.

Exporting the Image

The size of the pixels in the image and the file size of the image are listed at the bottom of the dialog. When you are ready to export, click on the Export button.

A Save As dialog box will open. The default file name will have a .tif extension, and the file type will indicate that this is a TIFF image. You can change the file name or select a different directory to save in.

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Appendix A.

Cross-Platform File Exchange

It is possible to move image data between Discovery Series software applications on different platforms. There are different protocols depending on the platform (PC or Macintosh) you are transferring from and to.

A.1 Macintosh to PC

To transfer a file from a Discovery Series application running on a Macintosh to a Discovery Series application running on a PC, you need to tag the file name with the suffix appropriate to the image file type (e.g., 1-D scan).

For 1-D gels (Diversity Database, Quantity One) use the suffix: .1sc

For DNA Scans (DNA Code) use the suffix: .dsc

A.2 PC to Macintosh

PC versions of Discovery Series files can be read directly by Macintosh applications, with no required modifications.

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Appendix B. Other Features

The following features are available in Quantity One, but have more utility in its more powerful companion application, Diversity Database. You can examine your gel images in Quantity One and then database them using Diversity Database.

B.1 Categories and Attributes

User-defined <category> buttons are available in the Standards dialog box, Matched Band Set dialog box, and Gel Layout dialog box. They allow you to categorize the characteristics of your particular gel or any related gel to which you might apply the same set of standards.

To define a new category, click on one of the <category> buttons. A dialog will pop up in which you can select from a list of categories or create a new one.

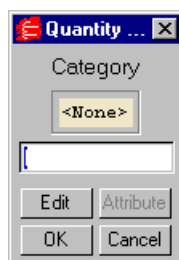


Fig. 0-1. Category pop-up box.

To create a new category, click on the Edit button. This will open another pop-up box in which you can enter the name of your new category.

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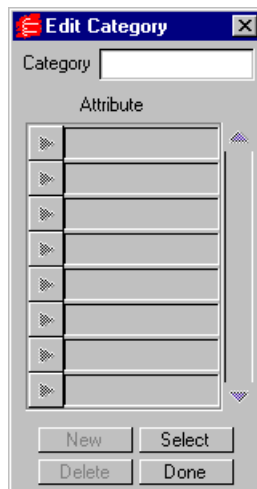


Fig. 0-2. Edit Category dialog box.

Type the name of the new category (e.g., "Color") next to the Category prompt and list attributes of that category in the Attribute fields (e.g., "Red," "Green," "Blue," etc.). The form will automatically sort your attributes alphabetically within the Attribute fields. Categories and attributes can be defined for any characteristics of your gel that would be useful to sort by. Typical categories might be "Enzyme," "Primer," "Probe," "Type," "Who," etc.

Once you've created a category and attributes, you can use them in the dialog box. Once again, click on a <category> button.

Appendix B. Other Features

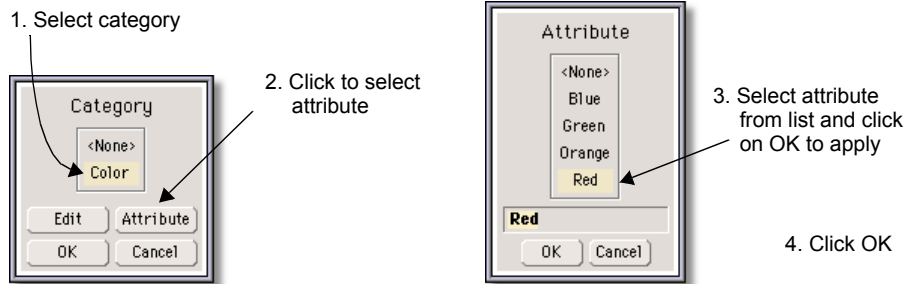


Fig. 0-3. Selecting a category and attribute.

Select the category to be applied from the available categories on the list (or select <none>). Click on the Attribute button to specify an attribute. Click OK to apply your selection to the Standards box.

B.2 Gel Layout

In Diversity Database, you can use the Gel Layout dialog box to compare samples across multiple gel images. In Quantity One, you can use it to enter general information about your image.

To open the Gel Layout form, select Gel Layout from the Edit menu.

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Lane #	Name	CPM Loaded	<category>
1	Protein		
2	cerebrum	18,268	
3	cerebellum	13,740	
4	stem	19,463	
5	thymus	5,939	
6	lung	8,012	
7	heart	4,017	
8	aorta	7,085	

Fig. 0-4. Gel Layout dialog box.

The following information about your gel can be specified at the top of the Gel Layout form:

- Category and attribute information (see above) for the whole gel.
- A brief description of the gel.
- Gel run date.
- Number of lanes.
- Lane width.
- Lane-based background subtraction and disk size.

Appendix B. Other Features

Each lane in your gel has its own line on the Gel Layout form. The following information can be specified for a lane.

- Band set type (standard or experimental).
- Lane number.
- Band set name.
- Sample name.
- Category / attributes information (see above) for individual lanes.

The pop-up buttons on the left side of the form offer a number of choices pertaining to the individual lanes on your gel. Clicking on one will open the Lane Choices list.

Lane Report will open a customizable lane report form that can be printed or exported.

Assign Band Set allows you to select the specific band set that is to be applied to that lane.

Unassign Band Set allows you to remove the band set that is currently applied to that lane.

View Band Set displays the band set form for the band set that is currently applied to that lane.

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